RealEstateManager

# User Manual

Property, lease and accounting management — the complete operating guide

Properties & Units · Tenants & Contracts · PDC Management · Invoicing & VAT · Double-Entry Accounting · Financial Reporting · Tenant Self-Service

Applies to: the RealEstateManager web application

Audience: property administrators, leasing staff, accountants, system administrators

Edition: November 2026 · The same topics appear under the **Help** button on every screen

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# About This System

RealEstateManager is a web-based system that manages a real-estate portfolio end to end: the **properties** you own or manage, the **units** inside them, the **tenants** who occupy them, the **lease contracts** that bind the two, and the **complete accounting** that results from all of it.

Its distinguishing characteristic is that operations and accounting are not two separate systems. Every operational action you take — signing a lease, receiving a cheque, issuing an invoice — produces a balanced double-entry journal automatically. You are never asked to write the accounting entry yourself, and the system refuses to save any journal whose debits do not equal its credits.

## What the system covers

| Area | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Portfolio** | Properties (owned or managed), units within each property, occupancy status, standard rents and areas. |
| **Leasing** | Tenant register, lease contracts with billing frequency and VAT, automatic generation of the full invoice schedule and the monthly revenue-recognition plan. |
| **Collections** | Post-dated cheque (PDC) register with memorandum and clearance postings, customer invoices and UAE tax invoices, customer receipts, security deposits. |
| **Payables** | Vendor register, multi-line vendor bills with VAT decided by the supplier's registration, vendor payments, petty cash floats. |
| **Assets & deferrals** | Fixed asset register with acquisition-cost accumulation, capitalisation and automatic depreciation schedules; recurring prepayment amortisation. |
| **General ledger** | Five-digit chart of accounts, account mapping, opening balances, manual journals, journal inquiry, monthly period close and fiscal year close. |
| **Reporting** | Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Statement of Cash Flows, General Ledger, Tenant Statement, VAT Return, P&L by Property, Property Utilization, Tenant Health, Owner Tenancy Schedule, Owner Withdrawals, Owner VAT Return, Project Costs & WIP, and reports you build yourself. |
| **Managed properties** | Landlord register, who holds the rent, invoicing in the company's or the owner's name, monthly commission tax invoices, costs recharged to owners, owner statements and settlements. |
| **Maintenance** | Jobs from tenant requests, jobs raised by management, make-ready work and planned maintenance, with materials, target times and a dashboard. |
| **HR & payroll** | Employee register with UAE documents, attendance, leave, monthly payroll with WPS file, bank transfer or cheques, salary advances, end-of-service provision, and an employee self-service portal. |
| **Owner controls** | Business Performance, the Owner Monitor, payment approval with limits and delegation, the Authorization Matrix. |
| **Tenant self-service** | A portal where tenants see their account and raise maintenance, payment-postponement and other requests, with a staff queue to answer them. |
| **Administration** | Multi-company support, per-user permissions with centralised master data, subscription control, audit logging, user feedback. |

## Two ownership models

For the complete invoicing walk-through of each case, including a landlord's property invoiced in the owner's name, see Invoicing, Step by Step.

Every property is flagged as either **Owned** or **Managed**, and this single flag changes the accounting for every lease under it:

- **Owned** — the rent is your revenue. Invoiced rent sits in *Advances from Customers* and is released monthly into *Rental Revenue – Owned*.
- **Managed** — the rent belongs to the landlord. Invoiced rent sits in *Due to Landlords*, and only your commission is released into *Management Fee Revenue*. What is left is paid to the landlord through **Operations ▸ Owner Settlements**.

> **Set the ownership type correctly the first time**
>
> Ownership type is read at the moment an invoice or a revenue-recognition entry is posted. Changing it after transactions exist will not restate what has already been posted.

## How to use this help

- Every screen has a **Help** button at the top right. It opens the help for the screen you are on, in a panel beside your work.
- **System Setup ▸ Help** opens the Help Center, where you can search all topics or read them by menu.
- **Menu ▸ Screen** notation shows where to find each function, e.g. **Master Data ▸ Properties**.
- Green/red **Dr** / **Cr** tables show the exact journal the system posts. They are for reference — the system writes them for you.
- Read The System Workflow and Draft, Post & Reset to Draft first. Between them they explain most of what you will see.

GETTING STARTED · 2

# Signing In & Finding Your Way

Where: **Home**

## Signing in

1. Open the application address in your browser. The **Login** page appears.
2. Enter the **Username** and **Password** issued by your administrator.
3. Select **Login**. You land on the **Dashboard**.

> **Tenants and employees can use the same page**
>
> A tenant given portal access, or an employee given self-service access, can sign in on this same Login page with the username and password they were issued. They are taken to their own portal — and, the first time, asked to choose their own password.

If you are a brand-new customer, use **Create New Company** on the login page. This registers a company, creates its first administrator, seeds the full chart of accounts and account mapping, creates the monthly accounting periods, and starts a 15-day trial.

Video: **Signing in and finding your way** (1:30) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## Language: English or Arabic

The **العربية** / **English** button in the top bar switches the language of the screens. In Arabic the screens read right to left; numbers, dates and amounts keep the same format in both languages. Your choice is saved on your profile and applied each time you sign in, from any device. The same button is on the tenant portal.

## On your phone: install the app and turn on notifications

RealEstateManager installs on a phone straight from the browser, without an app store. The **App and notifications** card on the dashboard offers what your device can do:

- **Install app** (Android, and Chrome or Edge on a computer) puts it on the home screen; it then opens full screen, without the browser bar.
- On **iPhone or iPad**, open the site in Safari, tap **Share**, then **Add to Home Screen**. Notifications on iPhone work once it is opened from the home screen.
- **Turn on notifications** asks the phone's permission, then tells you when something needs you: a maintenance job given to you, a document waiting for your approval, a payment to release, a request to reopen a month, a tenant's new request or reply, an employee's leave request - each to the people whose permission covers it.

Tapping a notification opens the page it is about. Turn notifications off for a device from **Password** in the top bar (the card at the bottom of the page). Signing out stops them on that device until you sign in and turn them on again. A notification shows a title and one line, so a locked phone never shows a full page of figures.

The step-by-step for iPhone, Android and a computer, and what to do when it does not work, are in Install the App on Your Phone.

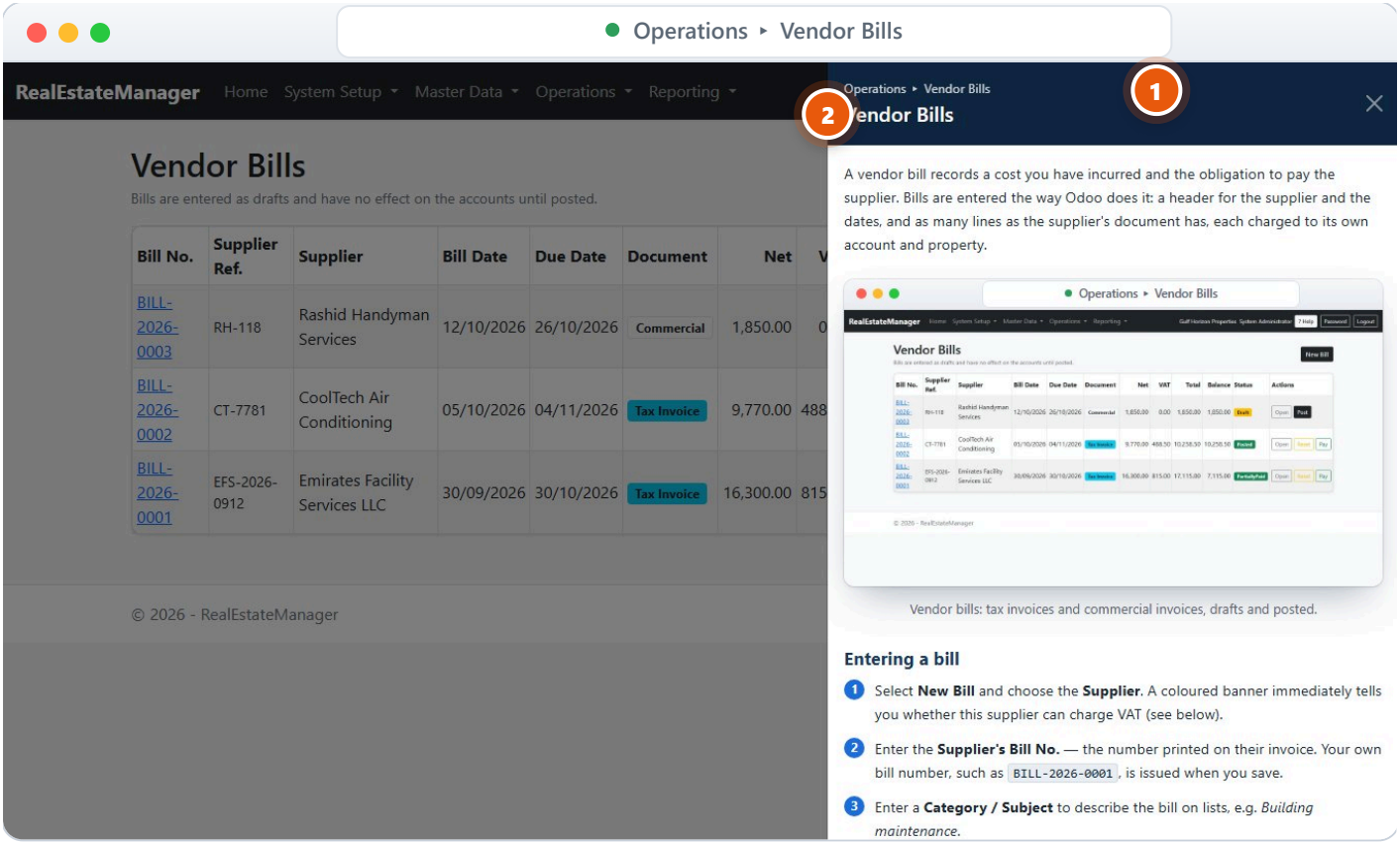
## The navigation bar

| Menu | Contains |
|---|---|
| **Home** | The dashboard. |
| **System Setup** | Accounting setup — Chart of Accounts, Account Mapping, Opening Balances, Owner Withdrawal Categories, VAT Settings, Bank Accounts, Owner Withdrawal Locations, E-Invoicing Settings, Revenue Recognition, Recurring Prepayments, Closing Cockpit, Period Reopen Requests. Administration (system administrators) — Companies, Users & Permissions, Audit Logs, Feedback Review. Subscription, Help, User Manual, Send Feedback. |
| **Master Data** | Properties, Units, Landlords, Tenants, Leases, Vendors, Document Expiry, Import Data. |
| **Operations** | Workflow Guide. Tenant Services — Tenant Requests, WhatsApp Messages, Maintenance Jobs, Planned Maintenance. Receivables — Customer Invoices, Credit Notes, Customer Receipts, PDC Receipts, Security Deposits. E-Invoicing — E-Invoice Monitor, Received E-Invoices. Payables — Vendor Bills, Vendor Payments. Development — Development Projects, Unit Sales. Landlords — Owner Settlements, Recharges to Owners. General Ledger — Petty Cash, Fixed Assets, Manual Journals, Journal Inquiry. |
| **Controls** | For owners and managers: Business Performance, Owner Monitor, Maintenance Dashboard, Document Expiry, Payment Approvals, Authorization Matrix, Approval Limits & Delegation, Controls & Security Guide. |
| **HR & Payroll** | People — Employees, Attendance, Leave, Employee Requests, Expiring Documents, Departments. Payroll — Payroll Transactions, Payroll Runs, Salary Advances, Payroll Settings. |
| **Reporting** | Build Your Own Report, Project Costs & WIP. Financial — Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Statement of Cash Flows, General Ledger, VAT Return. Management — Tenant Statement, Tenant Health & Ranking, Property Utilization, P&L by Property, Owner Tenancy Schedule, Owner Withdrawals. |

> **Menus adapt to your permissions**
> You will only see the menus your account is entitled to. If a colleague can see a menu that you cannot, the difference is a permission, not a fault — see Companies, Users & Permissions.

## Getting help on any screen

The **Help** button at the top right of every screen opens the instructions for the screen you are on, in a panel beside your work, so you can follow the steps without leaving the page. From the panel you can open the topic full-page, or go to the Help Center to search everything.




The Help button opens the instructions for the screen you are on, beside your work.

1 Help button — or press F1

2 The topic for this screen

## Switching company

If your user account has access to more than one company, a company selector appears at the top right. Choosing a different company reloads the current page in that company's data. Every list, report and balance in the system is filtered to the company you are currently in — you can never see another company's data by accident.

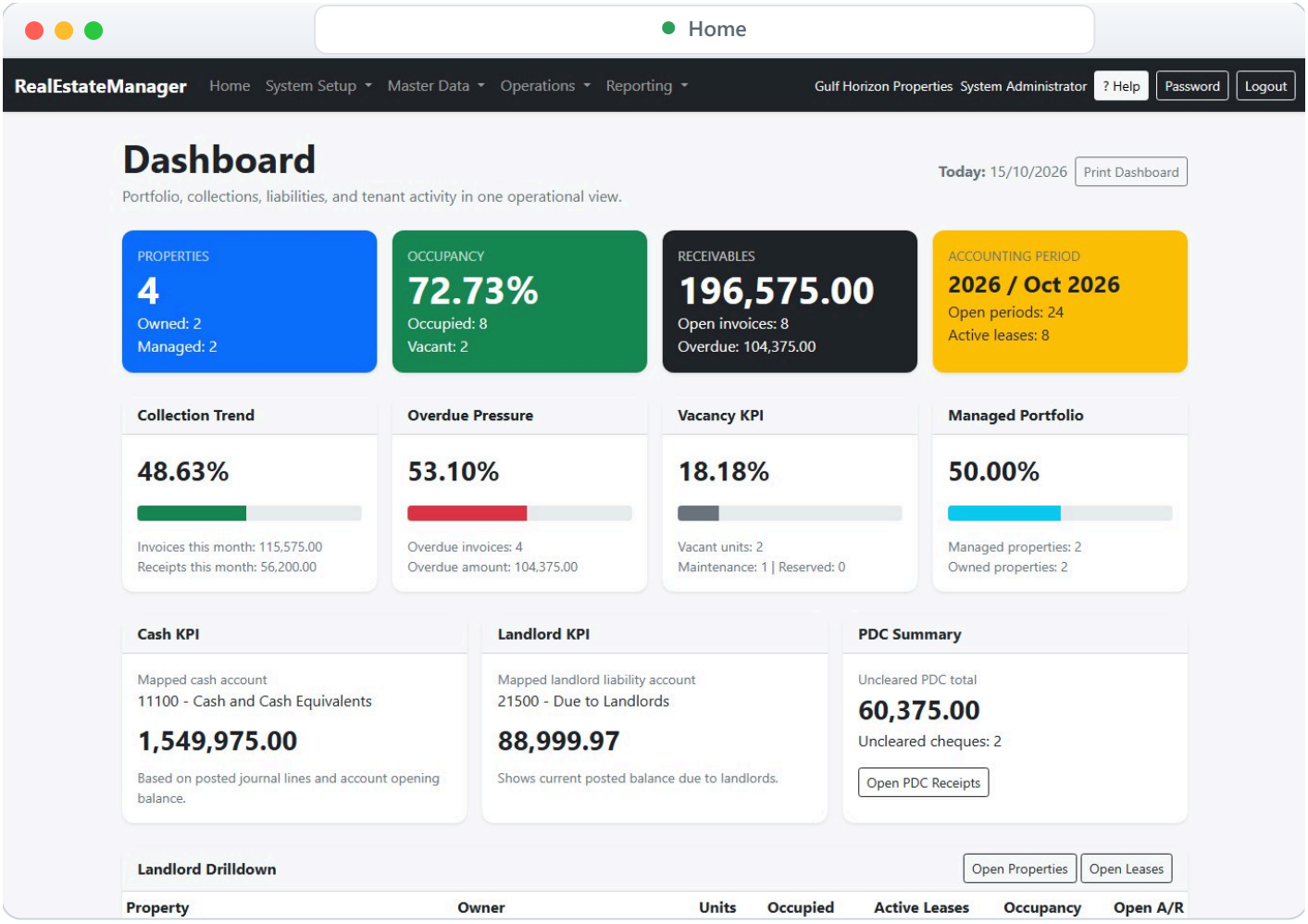
## Changing your password

Select **Password** in the top-right corner, enter your current password, then the new password twice.

## The Dashboard

**Home** shows the live operating picture: property and unit counts, occupancy rate, collections, outstanding receivables, liabilities and recent tenant activity. Use **Print Dashboard** for a clean printed snapshot.

- **Unclosed Periods** lists every period up to today that is still open, with its draft journals and how many days it is overdue for closing, and any reopen requests waiting. **Checklist** or **Open Closing Cockpit** takes you to the Closing Cockpit.
- **HR & Payroll**, for users with that access: active employees, the state of this month's payroll, staff documents expired or expiring within 30 days, and leave requests to decide.
- A bar at the top warns when the subscription is about to end; **Manage subscription** opens it.




The dashboard: portfolio, occupancy, collections and receivables at a glance.

## The speedometer gauges

Four gauges show how the portfolio is doing against its targets. The needle points at today's figure; the dial is red, amber and green, with a tick where each colour starts, and the word under the figure says which zone it is in.

| Gauge | What it measures | Red / amber / green |
|---|---|---|
| **Occupancy** | Units let out of all active units | below 75% / 75-90% / 90% and over |
| **Collection This Month** | Receipts this month against what was billed this month; it can pass 100% when old arrears are collected | below 70% / 70-90% / 90% and over |
| **Overdue Pressure** | The part of what tenants owe that is past its due date - lower is better | over 35% / 15-35% / below 15% |
| **Tenant Health** | Average Tenant Health score of tenants with a current contract, out of 100 | below 55 / 55-75 / 75 and over |

Each gauge links to the screen behind it. The same gauges appear where they help: occupancy, healthy tenancies and rent collected on each building in the Building View; collection ratio and average score on Tenant Health & Ranking; budget spent on a development project; and the share of the price paid on a unit sale.

## Subscription status

If the company's subscription expires, a red banner appears and the Master Data, Accounts and Reports menus are withdrawn until an activation code is entered under **System Setup** ▸ **Subscription**. Read-only access to Setup remains so that the subscription can be renewed.

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# Install the App on Your Phone

Where: **App and notifications**

RealEstateManager installs from the browser, with no app store. Once installed it has its own icon on the home screen (or in the taskbar and Start menu on a computer), opens full screen without the browser bar, and can send notifications. It is always the current version: an update reaches every installed device the next time it opens.

There are three apps on the one site, each installed from its own address:

| Who | Address |
|---|---|
| **Staff and owners** | `https://realestatemanager.odehanas.com` |
| **Tenants** | `https://realestatemanager.odehanas.com/portal` |
| **Employees (My HR)** | `https://realestatemanager.odehanas.com/me` |

## Where to find it in the system

The **App and notifications** card offers whatever your device can do: install the app, turn notifications on or off. It appears on the dashboard (staff), the account page (tenants) and the home page (employees); **Not now** hides it there for a week. The same card is always at the bottom of the **Password** page (tenants: the **Help** page), and the **phone button** in the top bar goes straight to it.

## iPhone and iPad

Apple does not let a website show an install button, so on an iPhone you install it through Safari's Share menu.

1. Open **Safari** and go to the address above. (Chrome on an iPhone does not offer it on every iOS version; Safari always does.)
2. Tap the **Share** button — the square with an arrow pointing up, at the bottom of the screen (at the top on an iPad).
3. Scroll the list down and tap **Add to Home Screen**. If it is not in the list, tap **Edit Actions…** at the bottom and add it.
4. Tap **Add**. The RealEstateManager icon appears on the home screen.
5. Close Safari and **open the app from the new icon**.
6. **Sign in again.** The home-screen app keeps its own sign-in, apart from Safari's.
7. Tap the **phone button** in the top bar, then **Turn on notifications**, and tap **Allow**.

> **On an iPhone, notifications need the home-screen app**
>
> They cannot be turned on in a Safari tab, and they need iOS 16.4 or later (**Settings** ▸ **General** ▸ **About**). In Safari, the card shows the steps above instead of the button.

## Android

1. Open the address in **Chrome** (Edge and Samsung Internet work too) and sign in.
2. On the card, tap **Install app** and confirm. If the card is not shown, use the browser menu ⋮ ▸ **Install app** (or **Add to Home screen**).
3. Open the app from its icon, tap **Turn on notifications** and tap **Allow**.

## Windows or Mac computer

1. Open the address in **Chrome** or **Edge** and sign in.
2. Select **Install app** on the card, or the install icon at the end of the address bar.
3. The app opens in its own window and is added to the Start menu (or Applications) and can be pinned to the taskbar or Dock. Turn on notifications from the card as on a phone.

## What you are notified of

| Who | Notifications |
|---|---|
| **Staff** | A maintenance job given to you; a tenant's new request or reply; a contract waiting for your approval and its decision; a payment waiting for release and its outcome; a request to reopen a month; an employee's leave or document request — each to the people whose permission covers it. |
| **Tenants** | A reply on their request, and each step it moves on: acknowledged, in progress, resolved, declined, closed. |
| **Employees** | Their leave approved, declined or cancelled; a requested document issued or declined. |

Tapping a notification opens the page it is about. A notification shows a title and one line, so a locked phone never shows a page of figures. Signing out stops notifications on that device until you sign in and turn them on again.

## When it does not work

| What you see | What to do |
|---|---|
| The card was closed by mistake | Tap the phone button in the top bar; the card on the Password (or Help) page never closes. The one on the home page comes back after a week. |
| No *Add to Home Screen* on the iPhone | Use Safari, not another browser, and scroll down the Share list; add it with **Edit Actions...**. |
| No *Turn on notifications* button on the iPhone | Open the app from the home-screen icon, not from Safari, and check the iOS version is 16.4 or later. |
| "Notifications are blocked for this site" | You tapped *Don't Allow* once. On an iPhone: **Settings** ▸ **Notifications** ▸ **RealEstateManager**. On Android or a computer: the padlock beside the address ▸ Site settings ▸ Notifications ▸ Allow. Then tap *Turn on notifications* again. |
| No notifications arrive | Check the phone is not in Do Not Disturb or a Focus mode, and that notifications for the app are on in the phone's settings. |
| "No connection" | The app needs the internet. It opens again by itself once you are online. |

GETTING STARTED · 4

# Training Videos

Where: **Help**

Ten short videos show the main tasks of the system from start to finish. Each one is recorded in the practice company **Al Waha Properties**, so every name and amount in them is fictional. Watch them in order the first time: the lease in video 3 is for the tenant added in video 2, and so on.

> **Practise as you watch**
>
> Every new company gets its own practice company with a year of sample data - switch to it from the company list at the top. Anything you do there leaves your real records untouched.

## Exercises waiting in the practice company

Besides a year of finished work, the practice company leaves some tasks for you to complete:

- **Approve a contract.** A shop lease in Al Naeem Retail Annex waits under **Master Data ▸ Approvals**. Review it, then approve or return it.
- **Book a supplier's e-invoice.** Two arrived under **Operations ▸ Received E-Invoices**. One supplier, Blue Wave Pest Control, is not set up yet - add it as a vendor first.
- **Correct a rejected e-invoice.** One rent invoice came back rejected on **Operations ▸ E-Invoice Monitor**. Read the reason, then generate it again. Last month's are ready to send.
- **Post the drafts.** A journal and a supplier bill are waiting in draft.
- **Set up depreciation for Marina Heights** under **Reporting ▸ Investment Property Note** - the business centre shows how it is done.
- **Follow a unit sale.** One shop has been sold and handed over; two flats in the Marjan Bay tower are sold off plan and still being paid for.
- **Read the Capital Assets Scheme record** for Al Naeem Business Centre and its year 1 adjustment.

## 1. Signing in and finding your way

Signing in, switching to the training company, the dashboard cards and the four menus.

Video: **Signing in and finding your way** (1:30) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 2. Adding a property, a unit and a tenant

Adding a building, a flat in it and a tenant - the master data every lease builds on.

Video: **Adding a property, a unit and a tenant** (2:33) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 3. Creating a lease

Creating a lease, and how one contract creates all of its rent invoices.

Video: **Creating a lease** (1:17) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 4. Posting an invoice and receiving the rent

Posting the month's invoice, recording the tenant's payment and checking their statement.

Video: **Posting an invoice and receiving the rent** (1:39) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 5. Post-dated cheques

Recording post-dated cheques when they are handed over, and clearing them when the bank pays.

Video: **Post-dated cheques** (1:53) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 6. Entering a supplier bill and paying it

Entering a supplier's bill line by line with VAT, posting it and paying it.

Video: **Entering a supplier bill and paying it** (1:54) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 7. Petty cash

Topping up the cash box from the bank and recording what is spent.

Video: **Petty cash** (1:25) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 8. Month-end

Revenue recognition, depreciation, posting the month-end drafts and closing the period.

Video: **Month-end** (1:22) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 9. The reports

A tour of the Trial Balance, P&L, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow, VAT Return and the tenant reports.

Video: **The reports** (1:46) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## 10. The tenant portal

Giving a tenant portal access, the tenant raising a request, and staff answering it.

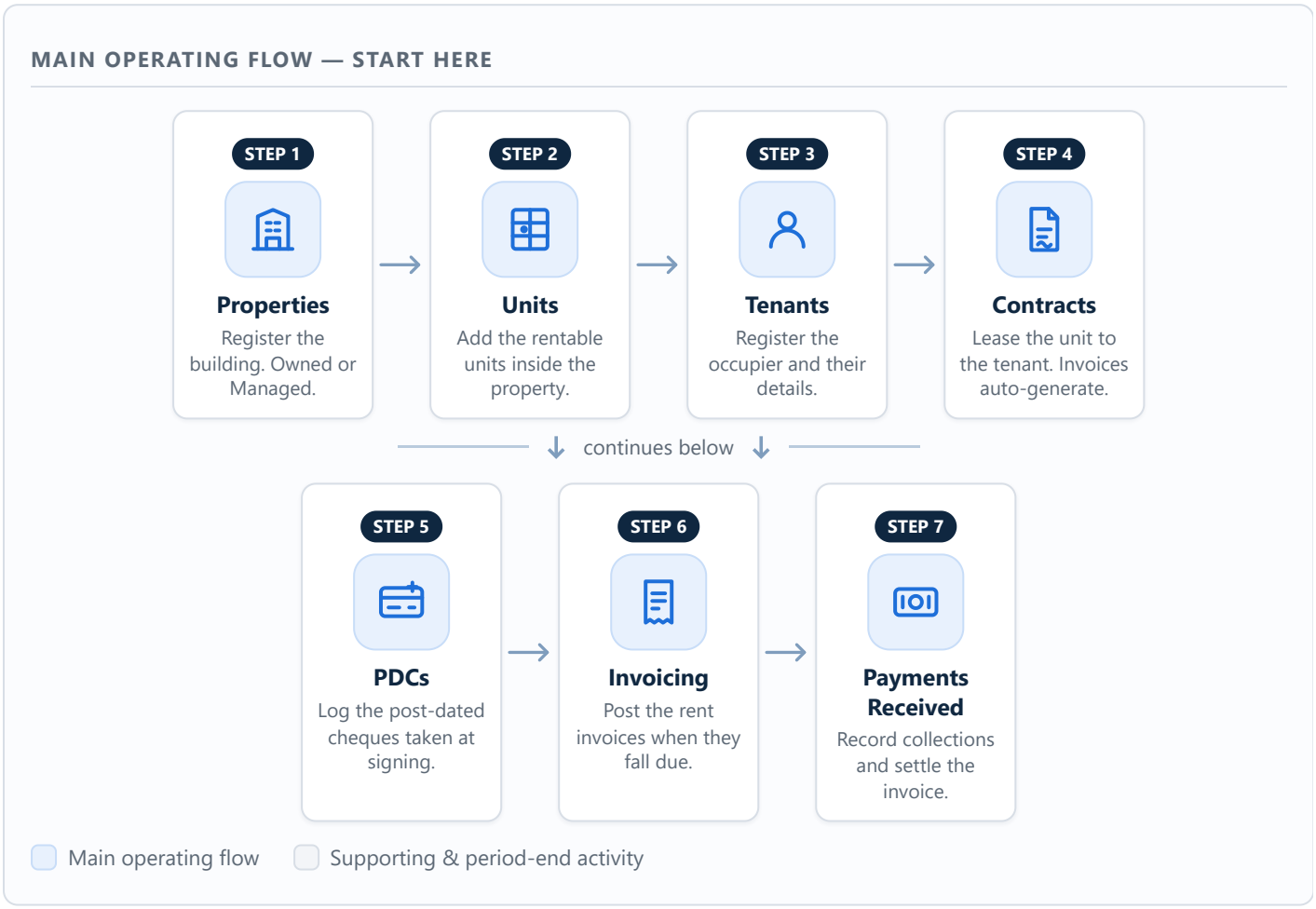
Video: **The tenant portal** (2:41) - watch it in the Help on screen.

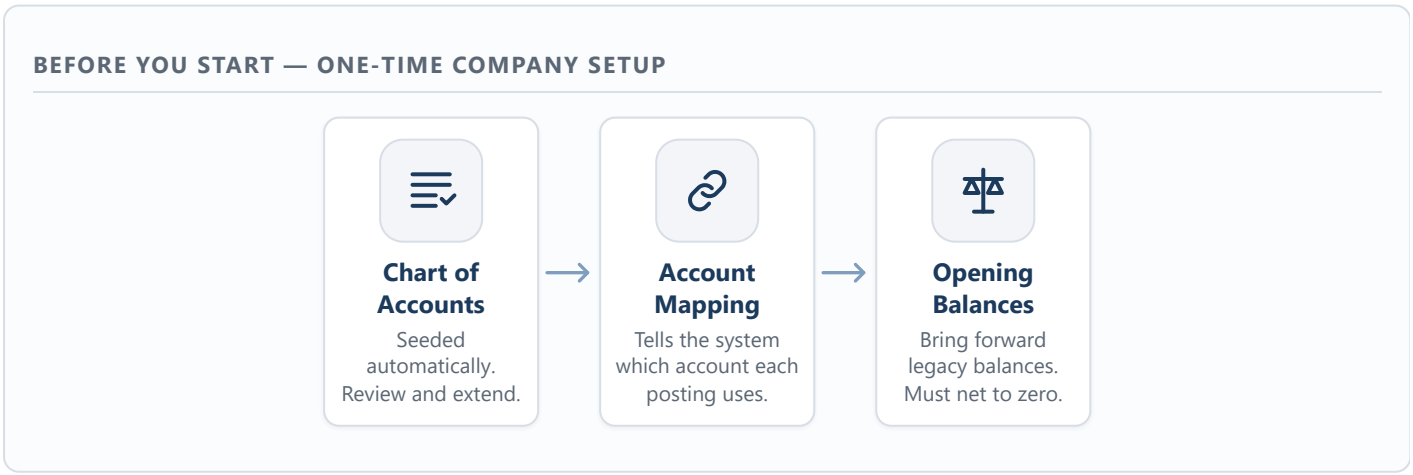
GETTING STARTED · 5

# The System Workflow

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Workflow Guide**

This is the operating map of RealEstateManager. Work left to right: each step depends on the one before it, because the record you create at each stage is selected in the next. The same diagram is available inside the application as a clickable home screen under **Operations** ▸ **Workflow Guide**.






## What happens at each step

| Step | Where | What it creates |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Properties** | Master Data ▸ Properties | The building record and its ownership type. No accounting. |
| **2. Units** | Master Data ▸ Units | Rentable units, each starting as *Vacant*. No accounting. |
| **3. Tenants** | Master Data ▸ Tenants | The tenant register and any opening receivable balance. |
| **4. Contracts** | Master Data ▸ Leases | The lease, **plus** the complete draft invoice schedule **plus** the monthly revenue-recognition plan. The unit becomes *Occupied*. |
| **5. PDCs** | Operations ▸ PDC Receipts | A cheque record and a memorandum journal dated on the received date (PDC On Hand / PDC Contra), posted on save. |
| **6. Invoicing** | Operations ▸ Customer Invoices | The receivable, the deferred-revenue liability and any VAT payable. |
| **7. Payments** | Operations ▸ Customer Receipts | The receipt, posted on save: cash in, receivable down, invoice status advanced to Partially Paid or Paid. |

**The one rule that makes the flow work**

You cannot skip a step, because each screen selects a record created by the previous screen. There is no unit without a property, no lease without a unit and a tenant, no invoice without a lease, and no receipt without an invoice. If a dropdown is empty, the previous step has not been completed.

> **Post your drafts**
>
> Steps 5 and 7 save **draft** journals that do not reach the reports until posted from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**. See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

## A typical first week

1. **Day 1 — Setup.** Review the Chart of Accounts, confirm Account Mapping, enter Opening Balances and confirm they are balanced.
2. **Day 2 — Portfolio.** Enter every property, then every unit under each property.
3. **Day 3 — People.** Enter tenants (with opening balances if migrating) and vendors.
4. **Day 4 — Contracts.** Enter each live lease. Check the generated invoice schedule after each one.
5. **Day 5 — Cheques.** Log the PDCs held against each lease.
6. **Day 6 — Verify.** Post every draft in Journal Inquiry, then run the Trial Balance and confirm total debit equals total credit.

GETTING STARTED · 6

# Draft, Post & Reset to Draft

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**

Every accounting transaction in RealEstateManager goes through three states, the same way Odoo works. Understanding this one idea explains why a transaction you have just saved may not yet appear in the Trial Balance.

| State | What it means |
|---|---|
| **Draft** | The journal exists and can be reviewed, but it has **no effect on any report**. The Trial Balance, Balance Sheet, Profit & Loss, ledgers and statements all ignore drafts. |
| **Posted** | The journal is in the accounts. Every report includes it. |
| **Reset to Draft** | A posted journal pulled back out of the accounts so it can be corrected, then posted again. |

## Which screens post straight away, and which leave a draft

| Screen | What Save / Post does |
|---|---|
| Customer Invoices, Vendor Bills, Credit Notes | The **Post** button builds the journal *and* posts it in one click. |
| Customer Receipts, PDC Receipts (receiving and clearing), Security Deposits, Vendor Payments, Petty Cash | Saving posts the journal straight away. If a check refuses it, it is kept as a **draft** and a yellow message gives the reason; post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** once resolved. |
| Manual Journals, Revenue Recognition, Recurring Prepayments | Saving creates a **draft** journal. You then post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**. |
| Owner Settlements, commission tax invoices, Owner Withdrawals, Salary Advances, development costs, unit sale payments | Saved and posted in one step. |
| Payroll | Nothing is posted while the payroll is a draft. Approving it posts the salary cost; each payment batch posts when it is made. |
| Fixed Assets (acquisition, capitalisation, depreciation) | Posted immediately. |
| Closing Cockpit buttons (Issue invoices, Run recognition, Run depreciation, Run amortisation, Post all drafts) | Create *and* post the entries of the period being closed. |

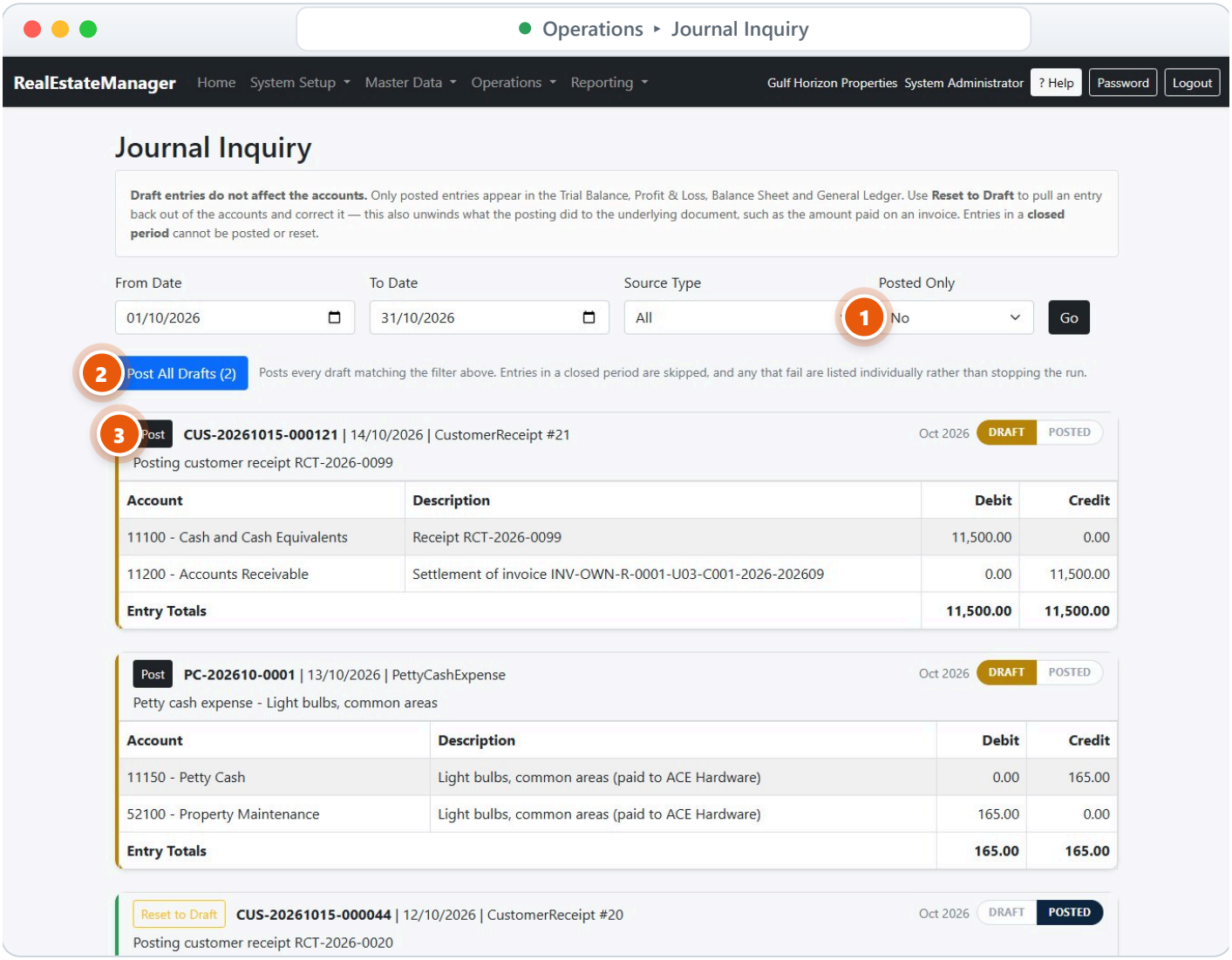
> **When payment approval is switched on**
>
> A vendor payment, petty cash voucher, owner settlement, owner withdrawal or development cost that the person who entered it may not release themselves is kept as a draft until someone with the authority releases it under **Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals**. Releasing it posts it. See Payment Approvals & Limits.

> **"I saved it but it is not in the Trial Balance"**
>
> That is almost always a draft waiting to be posted. Open **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**, set **Posted Only** to **No**, find the entry and press **Post**.

## Posting drafts

1. Open **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**.
2. Set **Posted Only** to **No** so drafts are listed. Narrow it by date or source type if you like — for example only `CustomerReceipt` — and select **Go**.
3. Review each draft. Press **Post** on one entry, or **Post All Drafts** to post every draft that matches the current filter.

**Post All Drafts** posts each entry separately. If one cannot be posted — for example because its date falls in a closed period — the others still go through, and the message lists the ones that failed and why.




Journal Inquiry with drafts showing. Drafts are not in any report until posted.

1. Posted Only = No lists drafts
2. Post All Drafts matching the filter
3. Post one entry

## When Post is refused

| Situation | What to do |
|---|---|
| The entry's date is in a **closed period** | Nothing can be posted into a closed period. Re-date the document into an open one, or post a journal there. |
| A **receipt** or **cheque clearance** whose invoice is still a draft | Post the invoice first, then the receipt or clearance. |
| A **vendor payment** whose bill is still a draft | Post the bill first, then the payment. |

A settlement must never reach the accounts before the invoice or bill it settles, or Accounts Receivable or Accounts Payable would be reduced by an amount that was never added. In **Post All Drafts** the invoice or bill is normally dated earlier and so is posted first, and its settlement follows in the same run.

## Correcting a posted transaction

1. Find the journal in Journal Inquiry and press **Reset to Draft**. It leaves the accounts immediately.
2. Correct the source document. A vendor bill, for instance, becomes editable again once its journal is a draft.
3. Post it again.

Resetting also undoes what posting did to the document. Resetting a receipt takes its amount back off the invoice it paid; resetting a cleared PDC puts the cheque back to *Received*.

## When Reset to Draft is refused

| Situation | Why, and what to do instead |
|---|---|
| The entry is in a **closed period** | Those figures have already been reported. Post a correcting journal in an open period. |
| An invoice has posted receipts, cleared cheques or credit notes against it | The later transaction depends on it. Reset those first, then the invoice. |
| An invoice or credit note has been **sent to your e-invoicing provider** | It is part of the FTA's record and can never be withdrawn. Correct an invoice with a credit note. |
| A vendor bill has posted payments or advances applied against it | Reset the payments and advance applications first. |
| A commission tax invoice issued to a landlord | It carries a tax invoice number and has been handed over. Adjust in the following month. |
| A PDC whose clearance has been posted | Reset the clearance entry first. |
| Year closing, prepayment set-up or amortisation, fixed asset postings | These create schedules or close a year, so unwinding them is not a simple reset. Post a reversing journal. |

> **Closed periods are locked in both directions**
>
> Nothing can be posted *into* a closed period and nothing can be reset *out of* one. The list screens show a **Period locked** badge instead of the buttons when this applies.

GETTING STARTED · 7

# Master Data: Codes, Uniqueness & Who Can Edit

Where: **Master Data**

Properties, units, tenants, vendors and contracts are **master data**: the records everything else refers to. Three rules keep them clean.

## 1. The system issues the codes

You never type a code. It is generated when the record is saved, and it never changes afterwards because it is already printed on contracts, invoices and statements.

| Record | Example | How it is built |
|---|---|---|
| Property | `OWN-R-0001` | **OWN** (owned) or **MNG** (managed), then the type — **R** residential, **C** commercial, **W** warehouse, **M** mixed use — then a running number. |
| Unit | `OWN-R-0001-U01` | The property code plus a unit number within that property. |
| Contract | `OWN-R-0001-U01-C001-2026` | The unit code, a tenancy number and the contract year. A **renewal** by the same tenant keeps the C number with the new year; a **new tenant** on the unit gets the next C number. |
| Tenant | `TNT-00001` | A running number for the company. |
| Vendor | `VEN-0001` | A running number for the company. |
| Vendor bill | `BILL-2026-0001` | Year and running number. The supplier's own number is stored separately. |
| Tenant request | `REQ-2026-0001` | Year and running number. |

The property create screen previews the code it will issue as you choose the ownership and type.

## 2. The same party cannot be entered twice

A tenant or supplier set up twice under two codes splits their balance in two, so statements are wrong and the same debt gets chased twice. The system refuses a duplicate of any of these, within a company:

- **Tenants** — trade licence number, Emirates ID / ID number, passport number, TRN.
- **Vendors** — trade licence number, TRN.
- **Properties** — the property name.

The message names the record that already holds the value, for example *Trade licence number "1234" is already registered to TNT-00007 – Al Noor Trading*. Open that record instead of creating a second one.

Blank values are never treated as duplicates. Any number of records may have no passport number on file.

## 3. Only the master data owners can create or change records

| Permission | What the user can do |
| --- | --- |
| **View Master Data** | Open the lists and look records up. The **Add** and **Edit** buttons are not shown, and a note explains why. |
| **Create & Edit Master Data** | Add and amend properties, units, tenants and vendors, and issue tenant portal logins. |

Accounting users can always look vendors up, because they need to find the supplier to enter a bill, but they cannot create one. Grant **Create & Edit** only to the small group responsible for master data — see Companies, Users & Permissions.

SYSTEM SETUP · 8

# Chart of Accounts

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**

The chart of accounts is the backbone of the ledger. A complete five-digit chart is created automatically for every new company, so in most cases you review it rather than build it.

## How the codes are organised

| Range | Group | Nature |
|---|---|---|
| `10000` | Assets | Debit |
| `20000` | Liabilities | Credit |
| `30000` | Equity | Credit |
| `40000` | Revenue | Credit |
| `50000` | Direct Expenses | Debit |
| `60000` | General Expenses | Debit |

The six codes above are **group** headers: they organise the tree and cannot be posted to. Detail accounts sit beneath them. The full seeded list is in Chart of Accounts Reference.

## Reading the tree

Accounts are shown as an expandable tree with the account code, name, type, reporting group and current balance. Group rows are shown in bold and have no **Edit** action for posting purposes.

## Adding an account

1. Select **New Account**.
2. Enter a **Code** that fits the range of its parent — a new expense account under General Expenses should begin with `6`.
3. Enter the **Name**, choose the **Account Type** and the **Reporting Group**. These two drive how the account behaves in the reports.
4. Choose the **Parent Account** so the account appears in the right branch of the tree.
5. Leave **Postable** at *Yes* and **Group** at *No* for a detail account; reverse them for a heading.
6. Set the **Opening Balance** only if you are migrating from another system — see Opening Balances.
7. **Save**.

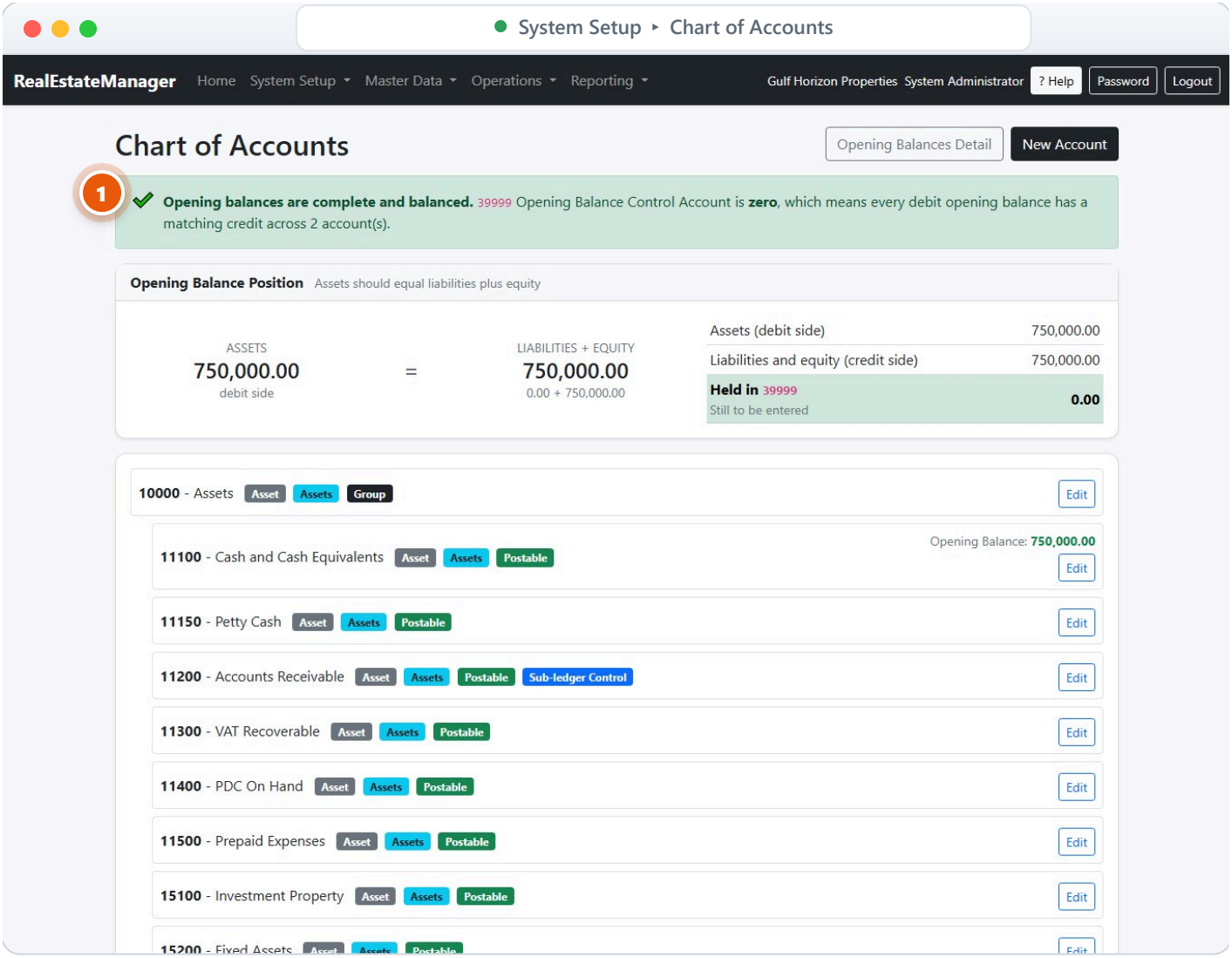
| Field | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| **Code** | Unique five-digit identifier within the company. Determines sort order in every report. |
| **Account Type** | Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense. Determines the account's natural balance side and whether it appears on the Balance Sheet or the P&L. |
| **Reporting Group** | Assets, Liabilities, Equity, Revenue, DirectExpense or GeneralExpense. Controls the section the account is presented in. |
| **Income statement line** | Revenue and expense accounts only: the line of the Profit & Loss the account appears on — rental income, management commission, property sales, other income, cost of revenue, **fixed costs**, **recurring costs** or finance costs. Left empty, the account takes its parent group's line, or the standard default shown in the list. A classification of its own: it changes the layout of the report, never the account type. |
| **Sub-ledger Control** (badge in the tree) | Marks an account whose balance is owned by a sub-ledger (Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable, Fixed Assets). See the warning below. |
| **Group / Postable** | A group account is a heading and cannot receive journal lines. A postable account can. |
| **Owner Account** (Edit screen) | Equity accounts only. Set to *Yes* for an owner's current account, so its journal lines can carry an owner withdrawal category. |
| **Petty Cash Float** (Edit screen) | Asset accounts only. Set to *Yes* for a petty cash float, so it appears on the Petty Cash screen. |
| **Is Active** | Untick to retire an account without deleting its history. |
| **Opening Balance** | Manual opening balance in natural form: positive means a debit balance for asset/expense accounts and a credit balance for liability/equity/revenue accounts. |

> **Control accounts take their opening balance from the sub-ledger**
>
> For Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable and the fixed-asset accounts, the opening balance is *calculated* from the tenants, vendors and assets beneath them. Typing an opening balance directly onto those accounts has no effect — enter it on the tenant, vendor or asset instead.

## The opening balance check

The top of the screen totals every account's opening balance and checks the accounting equation: **Assets = Liabilities + Equity**.

- A **green** banner means the opening balances agree.
- A **red** banner means they do not, and shows the difference. Your Trial Balance and Balance Sheet will be out by exactly that amount until it is fixed — see Opening Balances.




The chart of accounts, with the opening-balance check at the top.

1. Green when opening balances agree, red with the difference when not

## Accounts you should not remove

Several accounts are referenced by the automatic postings. Deactivating one of them will cause the related transaction to fail with a mapping error. Before retiring any account, check Account Mapping (Account Mapping) to confirm it is not in use.

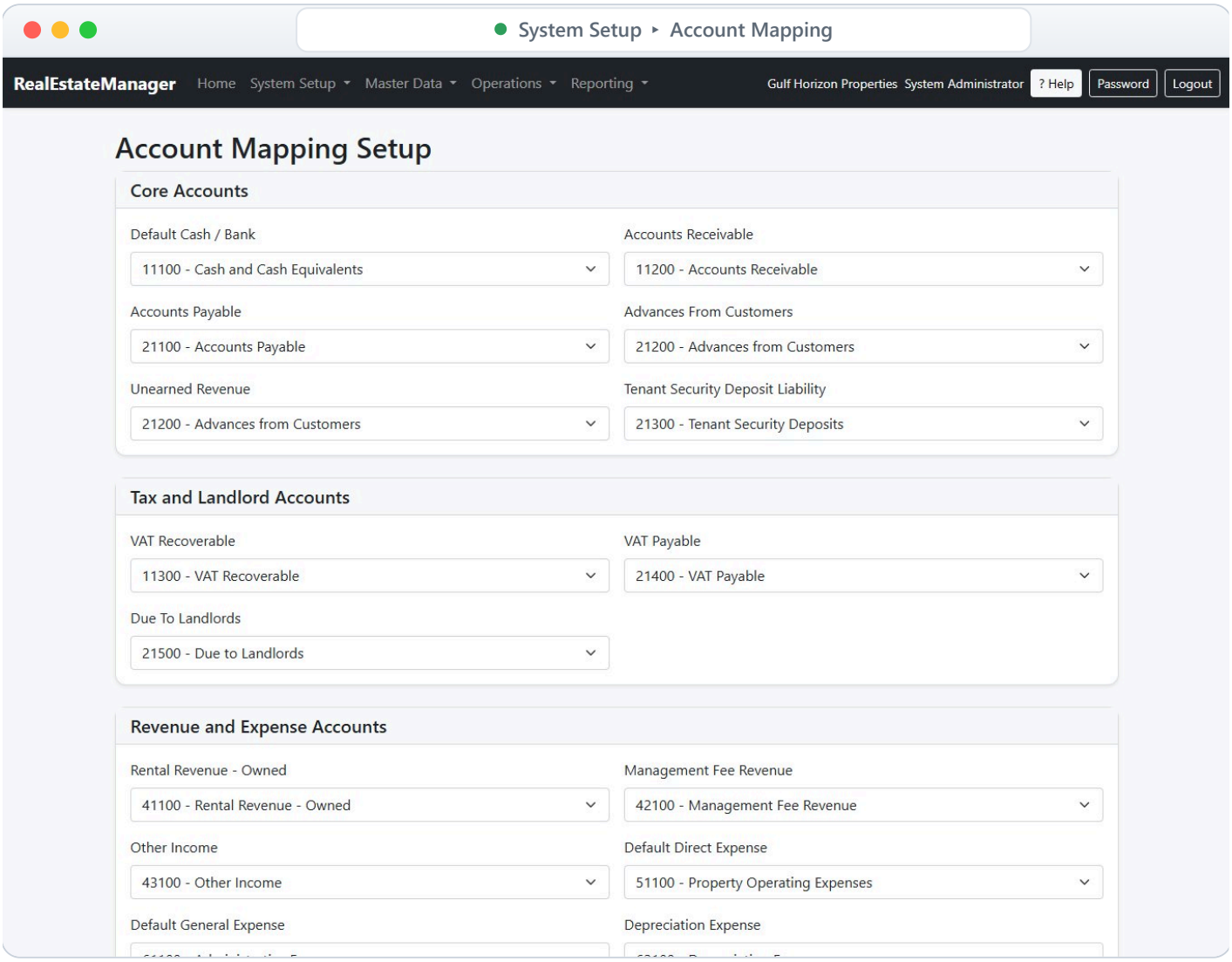
SYSTEM SETUP · 9

# Account Mapping

Where: **System Setup ▸ Account Mapping**

Account Mapping is the bridge between the operational side of the system and the ledger. When you post a customer receipt, the system needs to know *which* account is "cash" and *which* is "accounts receivable". Account Mapping answers exactly that question, once, for the whole company.

Defaults are applied automatically when a company is created, so the system works out of the box. You change a mapping only when your chart of accounts differs from the standard one — for example if you open a dedicated bank account and want receipts to land there instead of in `11100`.




Account Mapping: which account each automatic posting uses.

## The mappings

| Mapping | Default | Used by |
|---|---|---|
| Default Cash | `11100` | Customer receipts, security deposits, PDC clearance, vendor payments |
| Accounts Receivable | `11200` | Customer invoices, receipts, PDC settlement |
| VAT Recoverable | `11300` | Vendor bills |
| PDC On Hand | `11400` | PDC memorandum and clearance |
| Prepaid Expense (default) | `11500` | Recurring prepayments |
| Investment Property | `15100` | Property capitalisation |
| Fixed Asset (default) | `15200` | Fixed asset capitalisation |
| Accumulated Depreciation (default) | `15300` | Depreciation postings |
| Fixed Asset Clearing | `15400` | Acquisition cost accumulation before capitalisation |
| Accounts Payable | `21100` | Vendor bills and payments |
| Advances from Customers | `21200` | PDC cleared as an advance |
| Unearned Revenue | `21200` | Owned-property invoicing and revenue release |
| Tenant Security Deposit Liability | `21300` | Security deposits |
| VAT Payable | `21400` | Customer invoices |
| Due to Landlords | `21500` | Managed-property invoicing and commission release |
| PDC Contra | `21600` | PDC memorandum and its reversal |
| Cheques Under Collection | `11450` | Cheques deposited with the bank until they clear or bounce |
| Cheque charges income | `43100` (Other Income when blank) | Withdrawal and returned cheque charges to tenants. The default charge amounts are set beside it. |
| Retained Earnings – Prior Years | `32100` | Fiscal year closing |
| Current Year Profit or Loss | `33100` | Fiscal year closing |
| Rental Revenue – Owned | `41100` | Revenue recognition (owned) |
| Management Fee Revenue | `42100` | Revenue recognition (managed) |
| Other Income | `43100` | Miscellaneous income |
| Direct Expense (default) | `51100` | Vendor bills with a direct expense category |
| General Expense (default) | `61100` | Vendor bills with a general expense category |
| Depreciation Expense | `62100` | Depreciation postings |
| Finance Cost | `63100` | Interest and bank charges |

**Accounts that are set elsewhere**

The payroll accounts — salaries, allowances, salaries payable, employee advances and end of service — are chosen under **HR & Payroll ▸ Payroll Settings**. Bank accounts kept for landlords' money are listed under **System Setup ▸ Bank Accounts**. The default cheque charges are entered on this screen, under **PDC Setup**.

## Changing a mapping

1. Open **System Setup ▸ Account Mapping**.
2. Choose the replacement account from the dropdown beside the mapping you want to change.
3. **Save**.

**Mapping changes are not retrospective**

Changing a mapping affects **future** postings only. Journals already posted keep the account they were posted to. If you re-point "Default Cash" to a new bank account mid-year, the earlier balance stays in the old account and must be moved with a manual journal.

**If a posting fails with a mapping error**

A message such as "*Account mapping for Default Cash is not configured*" means the mapping is empty or points at an account that has been deleted or deactivated. Open Account Mapping, select a valid account, save, and retry the posting.

SYSTEM SETUP · 10

# Opening Balances

Where: **System Setup ▸ Opening Balances**

Opening balances carry your position from a previous system into RealEstateManager. This screen is both the place where you verify them and the single most important control in the whole setup.

## Entering balances on this screen

Users with **Manage Accounting** can type each account's opening balance straight into the **Manual OB** column:

1. Type the figures. Each changed box turns yellow and the bar at the bottom counts the changes.
2. Enter each balance on the account's **normal side** — debit for assets and expenses, credit for liabilities, equity and revenue. A negative figure goes to the other side.
3. Select **Save opening balances**. The message lists the accounts saved, and the totals and the balancing line are worked out again.

Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable and the fixed asset accounts are not typed here: their lines link to the tenants, vendors and assets that make them up. The balancing line 39999 is worked out from all the others. Each account code opens the account in the chart of accounts.

## Where each opening balance is entered

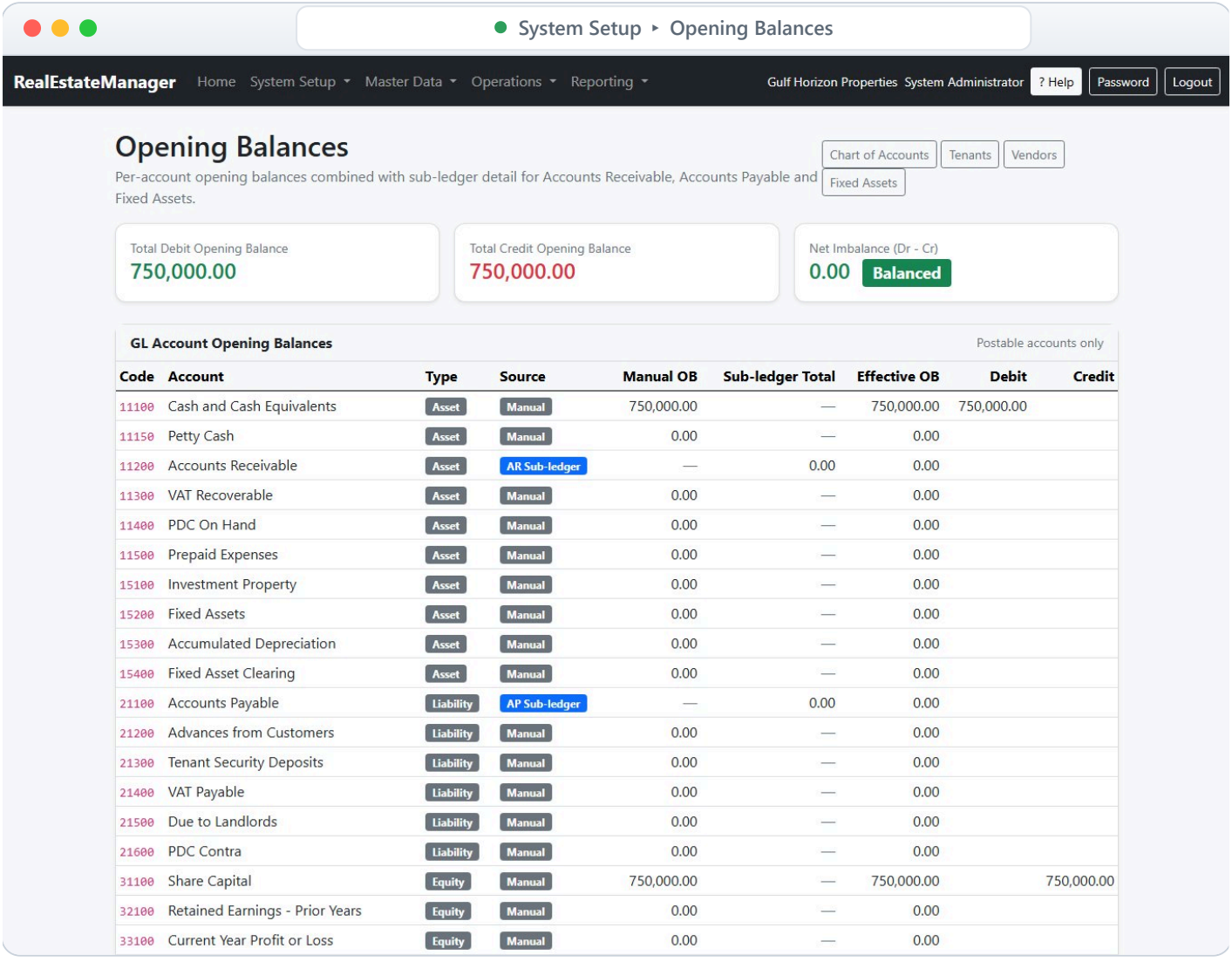
| Balance | Entered on | Screen |
|---|---|---|
| Ordinary GL accounts (cash, equity, loans…) | The account itself | **System Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts ▸ Edit** |
| Accounts Receivable | Each tenant | **Master Data ▸ Tenants ▸ Edit** |
| Accounts Payable | Each vendor | **Master Data ▸ Vendors ▸ Edit** |
| Fixed asset cost and accumulated depreciation | Each asset | **Operations ▸ Fixed Assets** |

The control accounts are deliberately not editable directly. Their opening balance is always the sum of the sub-ledger beneath them, which guarantees that the receivables ledger and the AR control account can never drift apart.

## Reading the reconciliation screen

The screen shows three summary cards — **Total Debit Opening Balance**, **Total Credit Opening Balance** and **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** — followed by a per-account table showing, for each account, the manual opening balance, the sub-ledger total, the effective opening balance actually used, and its debit/credit presentation. Beneath the table are the tenant, vendor and fixed-asset detail lists that make up the control account totals.

> **Net Imbalance must be 0.00**
>
> Opening balances are added into the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet as figures, not as a posted journal. Nothing forces the debit side to equal the credit side. If the Net Imbalance card shows any value other than zero, **your Trial Balance will be out of balance by exactly that amount**, and your Balance Sheet will not balance either.
>
> The usual cause is entering asset opening balances (cash, receivables) without entering the matching credit-side opening balance on `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years.




The opening balance reconciliation. Net Imbalance must be 0.00.

## Procedure for entering opening balances

1. Obtain the closing trial balance from your previous system as at the day before you go live.
2. Enter each **tenant's** outstanding balance on the tenant record. A positive value is an amount owed to you; a negative value is an advance you are holding.
3. Enter each **vendor's** outstanding balance on the vendor record.
4. Enter each **fixed asset's** opening cost and opening accumulated depreciation on the asset.

5. Enter every other balance directly on its **GL account** (cash, bank, loans, share capital, retained earnings).
6. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances** and confirm **Net Imbalance = 0.00** with a green *Balanced* badge.
7. Run **Reporting** ▸ **Trial Balance** and confirm total debit equals total credit.

> **Balancing figure**
> If your legacy trial balance was itself balanced, the figure that makes the Net Imbalance zero is your retained earnings. Post it to `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, not to a suspense account.

## The opening balance control account (39999)

If you create account `39999` *Opening Balance Control Account* (Equity), the system uses it to keep the opening position balanced automatically: any difference between the debit and credit opening balances is placed on `39999`, so the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet always balance.

Treat a balance on `39999` as a **to-do list, not an answer**. It means something was entered on one side only. When the missing figure is found and entered, `39999` returns to zero. Before closing the first year, clear whatever is left to `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years with a manual journal, once you are satisfied it really is retained earnings.

SYSTEM SETUP · 11

# Owner Withdrawal Categories

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Owner Withdrawal Categories**

Categories are the list used to tag what an owner's withdrawals were spent on — school fees, travel, household costs. They are an analysis dimension on the owner's equity account, not expense accounts, so company profit is never affected. See Owner Withdrawals Explained for the reasoning.

A starter set is created for every company and can be renamed, reordered, deactivated or replaced entirely:

| Code | Category | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| `OW-10` | Cash Drawings | Cash taken for personal use |
| `OW-20` | Household & Living | Groceries, utilities, household running costs |
| `OW-30` | Education | School and university fees |
| `OW-40` | Travel | Personal travel and accommodation |
| `OW-50` | Vehicles | Personal vehicles, servicing, fuel |
| `OW-60` | Medical & Insurance | Personal medical and insurance |
| `OW-70` | Charity & Donations | Personal giving |
| `OW-80` | Personal Investments | Funds moved to private investments |
| `OW-99` | Other Personal | Anything that fits nowhere else |

1. Select **New Category**.
2. Enter a unique **Code** and a **Name**.
3. Add a **Description** so other users apply it consistently.
4. Set the **Sort Order** to control where it appears in the selector and the report.
5. **Save**.

The list screen shows, for each category, how many posted journal lines use it and the net amount posted against it — so you can see at a glance which categories are actually being used.

> **Deactivate rather than delete**
>
> A category already used by a posted journal cannot be removed, because those journals reference it. Untick **Active** instead: it disappears from the General Journal selector while every journal already posted against it, and every historical report, stays exactly as it was.

SYSTEM SETUP · 12

# VAT Settings

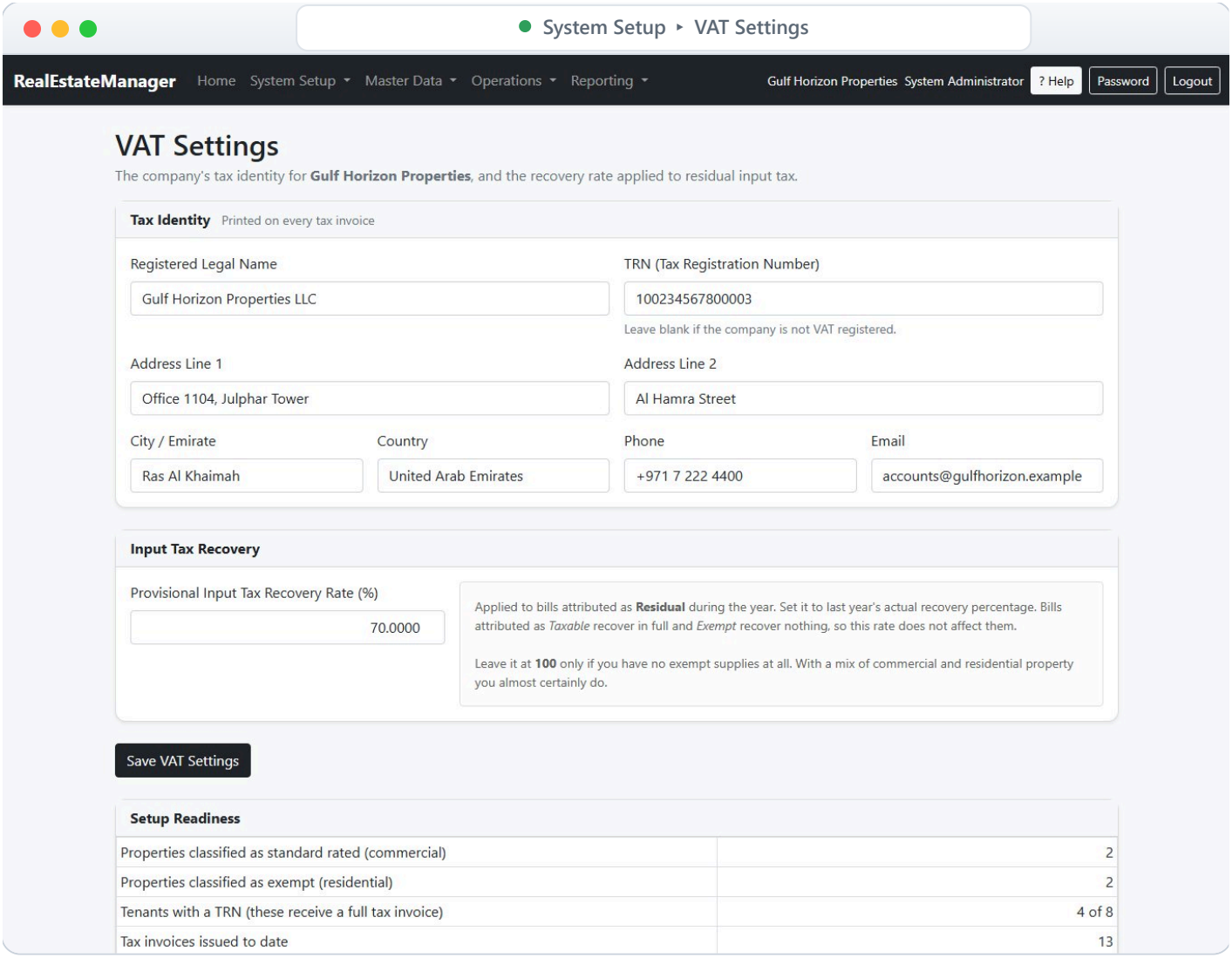
Where: **System Setup** ▸ **VAT Settings**

Your company's VAT identity and one recovery setting. Fill this in once, before you issue the first tax invoice.

## Tax identity

| Field | Why it matters |
|---|---|
| **TRN** | Your Tax Registration Number. Printed on every tax invoice. **Leave it blank if the company is not VAT registered** — the system then issues ordinary invoices with no VAT. |
| **Legal Name** | The registered name, if it differs from the trading name. A tax invoice must show it. |
| **Address, City, Country** | Required on a tax invoice. |
| **Phone, Email** | Printed in the invoice header. |

Until a TRN and address are entered, the screen shows *Tax invoices cannot be issued yet* and the **Setup Readiness** panel lists what is missing.




VAT Settings: your TRN, tax invoice details and the provisional recovery rate.

## Input tax recovery

A business that lets both commercial property (VAT at 5%) and residential property (exempt) can reclaim VAT on its costs only in proportion to its taxable activity. Costs clearly belonging to one side are handled on the bill line — *Taxable* or *Exempt*. Shared overheads such as head-office costs are **Residual**, and for those a percentage is used during the year:

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Provisional recovery rate (%)** | The share of residual input VAT reclaimed on each bill during the year. Normally last year's actual rate. **100** if all your lettings are commercial. |

At year end the VAT Return works out the rate you actually earned and shows the correction (the *wash-up*).

> **Where VAT is decided**
>
> - **On rent** — by the VAT category of the property or unit, copied to the contract and then onto each invoice. See Lease Contracts.
> - **On costs** — by whether the supplier is VAT registered, and by each bill line's attribution. See Vendor Bills.

## Costs passed on to owners

Choose how costs ticked **Charge to owner** are passed on to the owners of managed properties: **Recharge with 5% VAT** (the company's own supply, on its tax invoice) or **Disbursement, no VAT** (paid on the owner's behalf; the supplier's VAT is the owner's). See Costs passed on to owners.

SYSTEM SETUP · 13

# E-Invoicing Settings

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **E-Invoicing Settings**

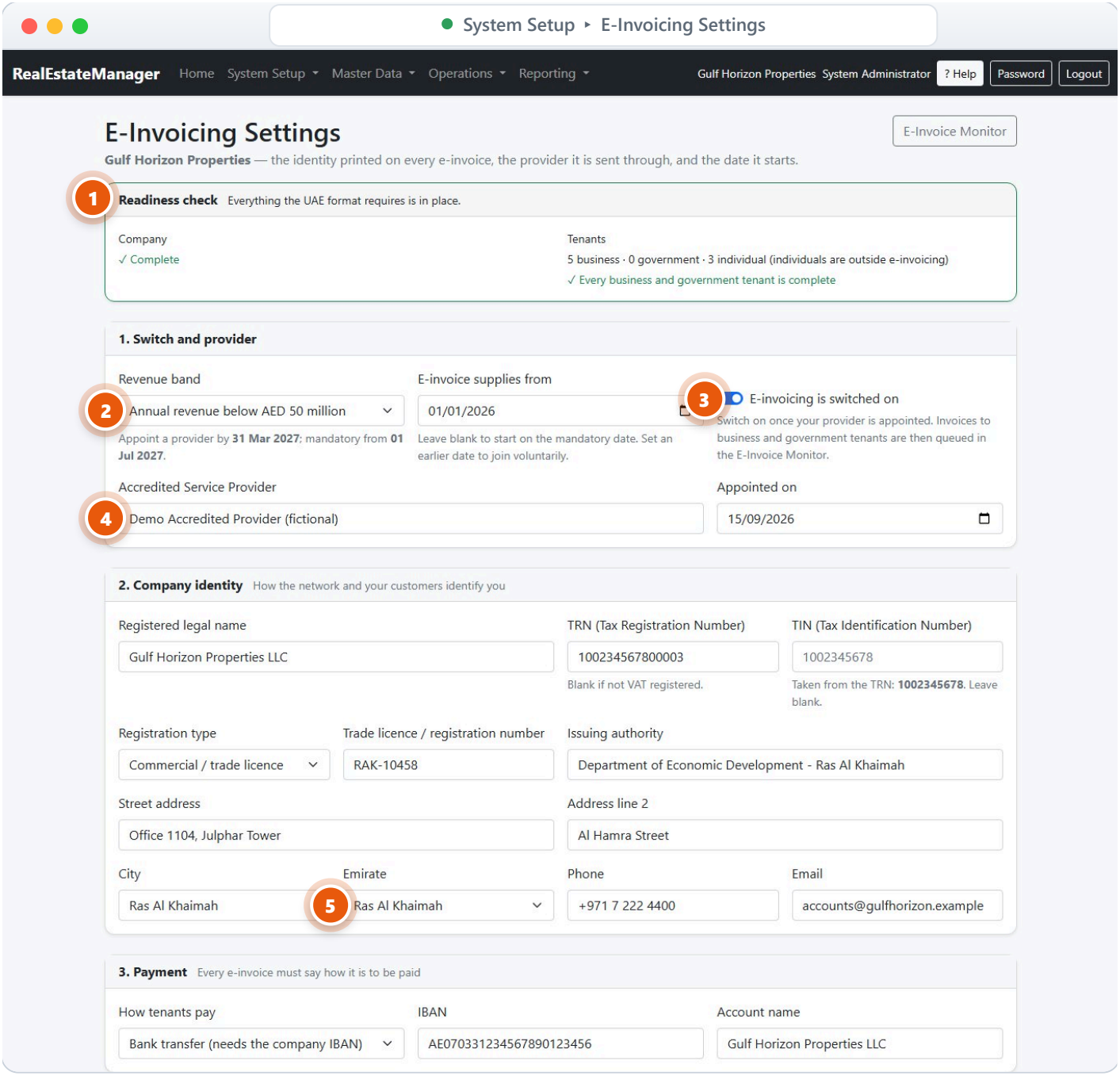
From 2027 every invoice and credit note a UAE business issues to **another business or a government entity** must be an **e-invoice**: a structured file in the official UAE format (PINT AE), sent through an **Accredited Service Provider** (ASP) that delivers it to your customer's provider and reports it to the FTA. This screen holds everything the system needs to produce those files for your company.

> **Who does what**
>
> **This system** produces each e-invoice in the official format, checks the data behind it, keeps the file and tracks what your provider said about it. **Your provider** validates it, delivers it and reports it to the FTA. You must appoint a provider yourself — it cannot be replaced by software.

## Is my company in scope, and from when?

| Revenue band | Appoint a provider by | E-invoices mandatory from |
|---|---|---|
| AED 50 million or more | 30 October 2026 | 1 January 2027 |
| Below AED 50 million | 31 March 2027 | 1 July 2027 |
| Government entity | 31 March 2027 | 1 October 2027 |

The mandate covers every business, whether or not it is VAT registered. Invoices to **individuals** (B2C) are outside it for now, so a residential tenant who is a private person is not affected.




E-Invoicing Settings: the readiness check, your revenue band and provider, and the identity printed on every e-invoice.

1. Readiness check — what is still missing
2. Revenue band — sets your deadlines
3. Switch on once the provider is appointed
4. Your Accredited Service Provider
5. Emirate — required on every e-invoice

## Setting up

1. Open **System Setup ▸ E-Invoicing Settings**.
2. Choose the **Revenue band**. The appointment deadline and start date appear underneath. Enter a **start date** only to join earlier, voluntarily.
3. Complete the **Company identity**: registered legal name, TRN (the 10-digit TIN is taken from it), trade licence number and the authority that issued it, and the address with its **emirate**.

4. Under **Payment**, choose how tenants pay. Bank transfer needs your **IBAN**, which is printed on every e-invoice.
5. Check the **Readiness check** at the top. It lists anything missing from the company and from any business tenant, with a link to the record to fix.
6. Once your provider is appointed, enter its name, tick **E-invoicing is switched on** and save.

Switching on re-assesses every invoice already posted: those to business and government tenants dated on or after the start date are queued in the E-Invoice Monitor.

## Which invoices become e-invoices

| Customer type | Treatment |
|---|---|
| **Business** | E-invoice required — even if the tenant is not VAT registered. |
| **Government** | E-invoice required. |
| **Individual** | Not required. Printed invoices continue as today. |

The customer type is set on each tenant — see Tenants. A tenant holding a trade licence or TRN was classed as a Business when this feature was installed; the readiness check flags anyone who looks misclassified.

## How each lease is described

| Supply | E-invoice type |
|---|---|
| Commercial lease (5%) | Tax invoice (380), standard rated |
| Zero-rated residential (first supply) | Tax invoice (380), zero rated |
| Residential lease (exempt) | Out-of-scope invoice (480), exempt — residential units |
| Company not VAT registered | Out-of-scope invoice (480), identified by its TIN |

Every rent invoice is marked as a **continuous supply** and carries the rent period, the contract number and the contract value, as the UAE format expects for leases.

> **Checked against the official rules**
>
> The files follow PINT AE Billing 1.0.4, published for the Ministry of Finance. Before release they were checked against the official validation rules and the UBL 2.1 schema — the same checks your provider runs.

SYSTEM SETUP · 14

# Revenue Recognition

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition**

This screen turns billed rent into earned revenue, one month at a time. It is the mechanism that keeps the Profit & Loss faithful to the period rather than to the billing cycle.

## How the schedule is built

When a contract takes effect — on activation or approval — one planned entry is created for the last day of every month in its term. For an owned property each is one-twelfth of the annual rent; for a managed property each is one-twelfth of the annual rent multiplied by the property's commission %, because only the commission is your income. Every entry starts with status **Planned**.

## Running the recognition

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition**. Planned and posted entries are listed.
2. Enter the **cut-off date** — normally the last day of the month you are closing.
3. Select **Post All Due Up To Selected Date**, or **Post** on a single entry. A journal is created for every planned entry dated on or before the cut-off, oldest first.
4. Post those journals from Journal Inquiry. Each entry's status then changes to **Posted**.

> **These buttons create draft journals**
>
> They reach the Profit & Loss only once posted from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** — filter the Source Type to `RevenueRecognitionSchedule` and use **Post All Drafts**. See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft. **Run recognition** in the Closing Cockpit creates and posts the month's entries in one step.

### Owned property

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21200` Advances from Customers | Monthly amount | — |
| `41100` Rental Revenue – Owned | — | Monthly amount |

### Managed property

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21500` Due to Landlords | Monthly amount | — |
| `42100` Management Fee Revenue | — | Monthly amount |

> **Make this the first task of every month-end**
>
> Run revenue recognition before printing the Profit & Loss. If you skip it, revenue for the month is missing and the deferred-income balance is overstated by the same amount. Running it late is safe: each entry keeps its own month-end date, so the figures land in the correct period.

## Reading the deferred balance

At any date, the balance on `21200` Advances from Customers is the rent you have billed but not yet earned. It should equal the sum of all planned (unposted) recognition entries for invoices already posted. This is a useful monthly reconciliation.

SYSTEM SETUP · 15

# Recurring Prepayments

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Recurring Prepayments**

Use a prepayment schedule when you pay once for something consumed over many months — annual insurance, a trade licence, a maintenance contract. The cost is parked on the balance sheet and released to the Profit & Loss evenly.

## Creating a schedule

1. Select **New Prepayment Setup**.
2. Enter a **Description** and choose the **Type**: prepaid rent, prepaid insurance, service contract or other. The schedule number is generated if left blank.
3. Enter the **Payment Date** and the **Total Amount**.
4. Enter the **First Recognition Month** (the entry is dated the month end) and the **Recognition Months**.
5. Choose the **Prepaid Asset Account** (default `11500`) and the **Expense Account** the cost belongs in.
6. Choose the account it was **Paid / Payable From** — cash or bank if you paid directly, or Accounts Payable with a **Vendor** if it is on credit.
7. Select **Save Prepayment Setup**.

Saving creates the setup journal as a draft; post it from Journal Inquiry:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11500` Prepaid Expenses | Total amount | — |
| Offset — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable | — | Total amount |

## Monthly amortisation

Each month end, set **As Of Date** and select **Post All Due Up To Selected Date** to release the instalments due, then post the resulting drafts from Journal Inquiry. **Run amortisation** in the Closing Cockpit does both in one step for the month being closed:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Expense account chosen on the schedule | Monthly amount | — |
| `11500` Prepaid Expenses | — | Monthly amount |

When the final instalment posts, the schedule is marked **Completed** and the prepaid balance for it is nil.

**Prepayment postings cannot be reset to draft**

Once posted, set-up and amortisation entries create and consume a schedule, so they cannot simply be reset. To correct one, post a reversing manual journal.

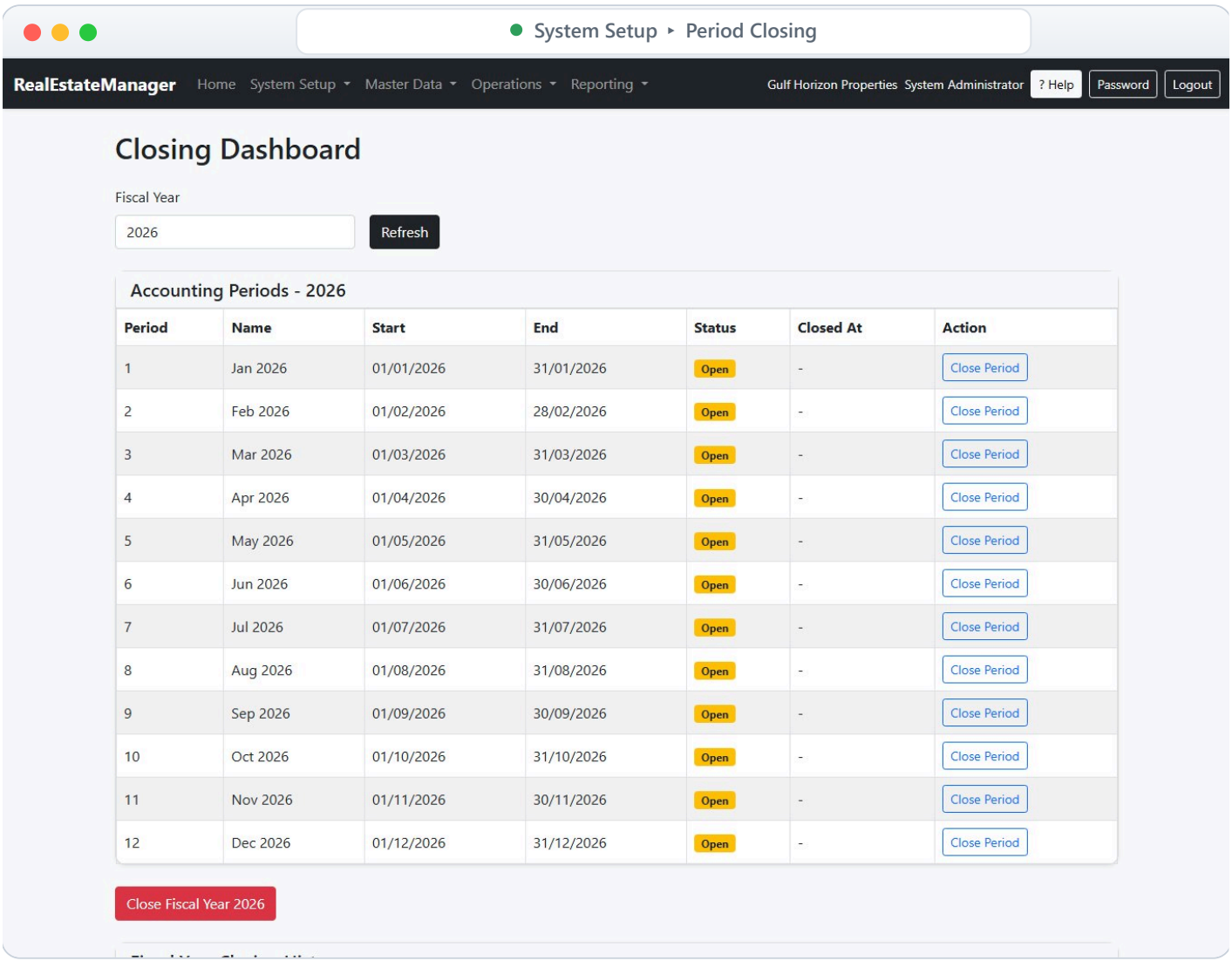
SYSTEM SETUP · 16

# Period & Year Closing

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Closing Cockpit**

Closing locks a period so that its reported figures cannot change afterwards. The screen shows the twelve monthly periods of the selected fiscal year with their status, and the history of fiscal years already closed.

Video: **Month-end** (1:22) - watch it in the Help on screen.




Period Closing: the twelve monthly periods and their status.

## The Closing Cockpit

**System Setup** ▸ **Closing Cockpit** shows the twelve periods of the fiscal year as tiles. Select a period to see its checklist. Each check compares what *should* be in the accounts for the month with what the general ledger actually holds, and shows a light:

| Light | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Green** | Done, and the ledger agrees. |
| **Amber** | A warning, such as the ledger differing from the schedule. You may close, but must tick that you have reviewed it; the warning is recorded with the close. |
| **Red** | Not done. The period cannot be closed until it is resolved. |

## The checks

| Check | What it wants | Button to fix it |
|---|---|---|
| **Earlier periods closed** | Months close in order, oldest first. | — |
| **No draft journals left in the period** | A draft has no effect on the accounts and cannot be posted once the month is closed. | **Post all drafts** |
| **Rent invoices of the month issued** | Every contract instalment dated in the month is posted. See Invoicing, Step by Step. | **Issue invoices** |
| **Revenue recognition run** | The month's rent (or commission) is released, and the ledger shows the same amount. | **Run recognition** |
| **Depreciation run** | Every asset in service is depreciated for the month. | **Run depreciation** |
| **Prepayment amortisation run** | The month's share of prepaid expenses is charged. | **Run amortisation** |
| **Post-dated cheques due are presented** | A cheque dated on or before the month end is deposited, and one at the bank is cleared or recorded as bounced. | — |
| **Transactions recorded in the month** | A month with nothing posted is unusual and worth a second look. | — |
| **Ledger in balance** | The trial balance at the month end has equal debits and credits. | — |
| **Opening balance control account is clear** | Nothing is left unexplained from Opening Balances. | — |

The buttons run each process for exactly that period's dates, so a run from the cockpit never reaches into another month.

## Closing a month, step by step

1. Record the month's receipts, cheques, vendor bills and payments, payroll, and any accruals or adjustments as manual journals.
2. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Closing Cockpit** and select the period.
3. Work down the checklist. Use the button beside each red check, or follow its link to the screen where the work is done.

4. Review the **Trial Balance**, **Profit & Loss** and **Balance Sheet** for the month.
5. If amber warnings remain, tick *I have reviewed the amber warning(s)*.
6. Select **Close**. The tile shows a padlock.

> **Closing locks the period both ways**
> After a period is closed, nothing can be posted into it and nothing in it can be reset to draft, edited or deleted. Late documents go into the next open period — for vendor bills, use the **Accounting Date**. Corrections are made with a journal in an open period, or by asking for the period to be reopened.

## Reopening a closed period

A closed period opens again only on a written request that an approver agrees to.

1. In the Closing Cockpit, select the closed period and **Ask for this period to be reopened**. Say what is wrong and what will be posted to correct it, then **Request reopening**. You can withdraw the request while it waits.
2. A user with the *Approve Period Reopening* permission opens **System Setup ▸ Period Reopen Requests** (the menu shows how many are waiting) and approves the request or turns it down, with a comment.
3. Once approved, make the correction, then close the period again through the same checklist.

Every request, its reason, who decided it and when stay on the period's history. If the fiscal year had already been closed, reopening one of its periods undoes the year close: the closing entry is removed and the year must be closed again.

## Closing the fiscal year

When all twelve periods are closed, the **Year-end close** panel at the foot of the cockpit shows the year's revenue, expenses and net result, and the balances that will be carried into the next year. Select **Close fiscal year**. The system posts one closing journal on the last day of the year that transfers the net result of every revenue and expense account into equity:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Each revenue account (cleared to nil) | Balance | — |
| Each expense account (cleared to nil) | — | Balance |
| `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years | Net loss | Net profit |

The closing is recorded with its fiscal year, the profit or loss amount, the timestamp and a link to the journal, so it is fully auditable.

**Close each year before reporting on the next**

The Balance Sheet presents the current fiscal year's profit as a separate equity line and takes prior years from Retained Earnings. If a year is never closed, its profit stays in the revenue and expense accounts — which the Balance Sheet does not present — and the Balance Sheet will not balance once you cross into the following year.

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# Companies, Users & Permissions

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Users & Permissions**

## Companies

**System Setup** ▸ **Companies & Subscriptions** — the platform owner only.

Each company is a completely separate set of books with its own chart of accounts, master data and ledger. Creating a company automatically seeds its chart of accounts, its account mapping and its monthly accounting periods.

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Name** | Appears in the company selector and on reports. |
| **Base Currency** | Reporting currency, e.g. AED. |
| **Fiscal Year Start Month** | 1 for a January–December year. Drives accounting periods and the Balance Sheet's current-year profit calculation. |

The same screen manages the company's subscription:

- **Generate Code** issues an activation code for a number of days. It works once, for this company only. Send it to the customer; the history shows when it was used and by whom.
- **Cancel** withdraws a code that has not been used yet - one sent by mistake or for the wrong period.
- **Suspend Company** blocks the company's users at once, with a reason that is kept on record but not shown to the customer. Its unused codes are cancelled with it, so an earlier code cannot undo the suspension. **Reactivate** lifts it; so does a new code issued afterwards, once the customer has paid.

### Sample data for training

On a company with no properties, tenants, vendors, leases or journals yet, **Load Sample Data** fills it with a fictional year of business — owned and managed properties, tenants, leases, receipts, cheques, supplier bills, petty cash, VAT, fixed assets, development projects, unit sales and e-invoices — so every screen and report has something to show. It takes up to a minute. Use it for a practice company, never for your real books.

## Users

**System Setup** ▸ **Users & Permissions** — system administrators, and each company's own administrators.

1. Select **New User**.
2. Enter the **Username**, **Display Name** and an initial **Password**.
3. Grant access to one or more **Companies**. Tick **Administrator of this company** for someone who should manage that company's users.
4. Choose a **Role** — Company Administrator, Owner, Manager (Approver), Data Entry, or Maintenance Engineer / Technician, or Maintenance Manager — to tick its permissions in one click, then adjust the **Permissions** if

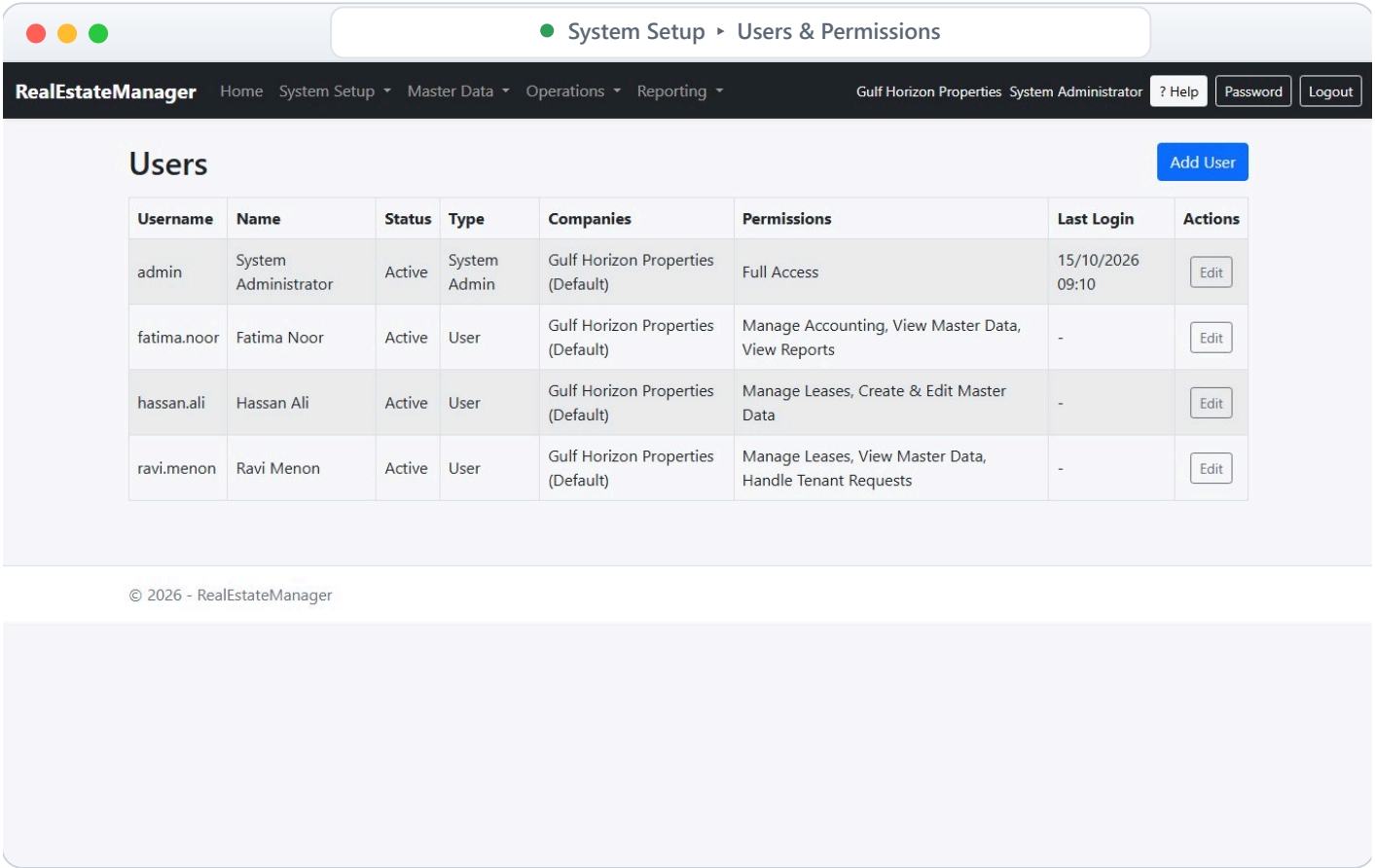
this person needs something different.

5. **Save** and give the user their credentials. They should change the password at first login.

## Who manages users

| Level | What they can do |
|---|---|
| **System Administrator** | Every company and every user. Set by the service provider. |
| **Company Administrator** | The users of the companies they administer: add them, reset passwords, choose their permissions - including who approves contracts - and appoint other administrators of the same company. They also open every **System Setup** screen of that company and its **Audit Logs**, which show only that company's activity. Approving a period reopening still needs its own permission. Whoever registers a company becomes its first administrator. |
| **User** | What their ticked permissions allow. |

> **What a company administrator cannot touch**
>
> System administrators, and anyone who also works for a company they do not administer: changing that person's password would open the other company to them. Those users are managed by the service provider. An administrator also cannot deactivate themselves or remove their own administrator rights - another administrator of the company has to.




Users and the permissions each one holds.

## The permissions

| Permission | Group | Grants access to |
|---|---|---|
| **View Master Data** | Master Data | Look up properties, units, tenants and vendors. Read only. |
| **Create & Edit Master Data** | Master Data | Add and amend properties, units, tenants and vendors; issue tenant portal logins. Implies View. |
| **Manage Leases** | Operations | Lease contracts, the draft contract and QR label. |
| **Approve Contracts** | Operations | Approve or return contracts submitted by others, and switch contract approval on or off. Never their own contracts. |
| **Handle Tenant Requests** | Operations | The Tenant Requests queue: replying, changing status, applying agreed postponements. |
| **Carry Out Maintenance Jobs** | Operations | For maintenance engineers and technicians only: new maintenance requests are assigned to them, and they see just their own jobs, record the work and materials, and mark them done. See Maintenance Jobs. |
| **Manage Maintenance** | Operations | For the maintenance manager: every maintenance job, assigning and closing them, jobs raised by management, the planned maintenance programme and the maintenance dashboard. No other tenant requests and no accounts. |
| **Manage Accounting** | Accounting | Invoices, receipts, PDCs, bills, payments, deposits, petty cash, fixed assets, prepayments, revenue recognition, journals, accounting setup and closing. Also lets the user look vendors up. |
| **Approve Period Reopening** | Accounting | Decide requests to reopen a closed period. See Period & Year Closing. |
| **Owner Oversight** | Owners & Controls | For owners: the Owner Monitor, approval limits and delegation, the Authorization Matrix and the Controls & Security Guide, and a read-only view of master data and reports. See Business Performance & Owner Monitor. |
| **Release Payments** | Owners & Controls | The Payment Approvals queue: releasing or turning down payments others entered, up to the person's approval level. See Payment Approvals & Limits. |
| **View Business Performance** | Owners & Controls | The Business Performance screen. |
| **Manage Employees** | HR & Payroll | Employees, their contracts and UAE documents, departments, attendance, leave and employee requests. See Employees. |
| **Prepare & Pay Payroll** | HR & Payroll | Payroll transactions, preparing the monthly payroll, payslips, salary advances, payroll settings, and paying salaries by WPS file, bank transfer or cheque. See Payroll. |
| **Approve Payroll** | HR & Payroll | Approve a prepared payroll, or return it to draft. |
| **Use the AI Assistant** | General | The assistant button on every screen. See AI Assistant. |

| Permission | Group | Grants access to |
|---|---|---|
| **View Reports** | Reporting | All financial and management reports, and Build Your Own Report. |

## Suggested role profiles

| Role | Permissions |
|---|---|
| **Master data owner** | Create & Edit Master Data · Manage Leases |
| **Leasing officer** | View Master Data · Manage Leases · Handle Tenant Requests |
| **Leasing manager (approver)** | View Master Data · Approve Contracts · View Reports |
| **Property / facilities manager** | View Master Data · Handle Tenant Requests |
| **Maintenance engineer / technician** | Carry Out Maintenance Jobs only (the Maintenance Engineer role) |
| **Maintenance manager** | Manage Maintenance · Carry Out Maintenance Jobs (the Maintenance Manager role) |
| **Accountant** | View Master Data · Manage Accounting · View Reports |
| **HR officer** | Manage Employees · Prepare & Pay Payroll |
| **Payroll approver** | Approve Payroll |
| **Owner** | Owner Oversight · Release Payments · View Business Performance · View Reports |
| **Auditor** | View Reports only |
| **Administrator** | The System Administrator role, which bypasses every permission check |

> **Keep Create & Edit Master Data to a few people**
>
> Master data is centralised so the same tenant or supplier is never set up twice. Give most users *View Master Data*, and *Create & Edit* only to the people who own the data. See Master Data rules.

> **Permissions are enforced at the server**
>
> Hiding a menu is not the control — the server independently refuses any request the user is not entitled to make. Typing a URL directly will not bypass a permission.

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# Subscription, Audit Log & Feedback

Where: **System Setup** ▸ **Subscription & Help**

## Subscription

**System Setup** ▸ **Subscription**

Shows the company's current subscription state, its expiry date and the days remaining. New companies start on a 15-day trial. To extend, enter the activation code supplied by your provider and select **Activate**. The days are added to whichever is later - today or your current end date - so renewing early never loses time. The code is recorded against your name.

- **Before it ends**, an orange notice appears at the top of every screen: in the last 5 days of the trial and the last 14 days of a paid subscription.
- **When it expires**, the processing menus are withdrawn until it is renewed. No data is lost.
- **If access is suspended** by your provider - for example over a payment - the same happens before the end date. Contact your provider: access returns as soon as they reactivate the company or you enter a new activation code.

## Audit Logs

**System Setup** ▸ **Audit Logs** — system administrators only.

Records who did what and when across the application. Filter by user, date range, action or entity to investigate a change. Combined with Journal Inquiry, this gives a complete evidence trail: the audit log shows the user action, the journal shows its accounting consequence.

## Help

**System Setup** ▸ **Help**

The Help Center: every help topic, grouped the same way as the menus, with a search box. The **Help** button on any screen opens just that screen's topic. **System Setup** ▸ **User Manual** opens the complete manual as one printable document, with a PDF to download.

## Feedback

**System Setup** ▸ **Send Feedback**

Submit a problem report or an improvement request. Include the screen name, what you did, what you expected and what happened, plus any document number involved — that is usually enough to resolve an issue without further correspondence. Administrators review submissions under **System Setup** ▸ **Feedback Review**.

## Database Updates

**System Setup** ▸ **Database Updates** — the platform owner only.

Each new version of the application brings its own database changes as numbered scripts, and applies any it has not applied before when the site starts. Nobody needs to run SQL in the hosting console any more: deploying the new version is enough. Every script is applied at most once, all or nothing, and the record of what has been applied is kept in the database itself.

- **Safety.** A script runs as a single unit: if any of its statements fails, none of it is kept. The application never removes tables, columns or data on its own - a script that would do so is refused unless it is explicitly marked as reviewed.
- **If an update fails**, the site still opens. The page shows the script and statement that failed and the database's own error message, and no later scripts are applied. Send the page to your developer; the next deployment tries again.
- **First start after this feature arrived.** Scripts 01 to 21 had already been run by hand. The application recognised them from the tables they created and recorded them as *Already in place* without running them again.

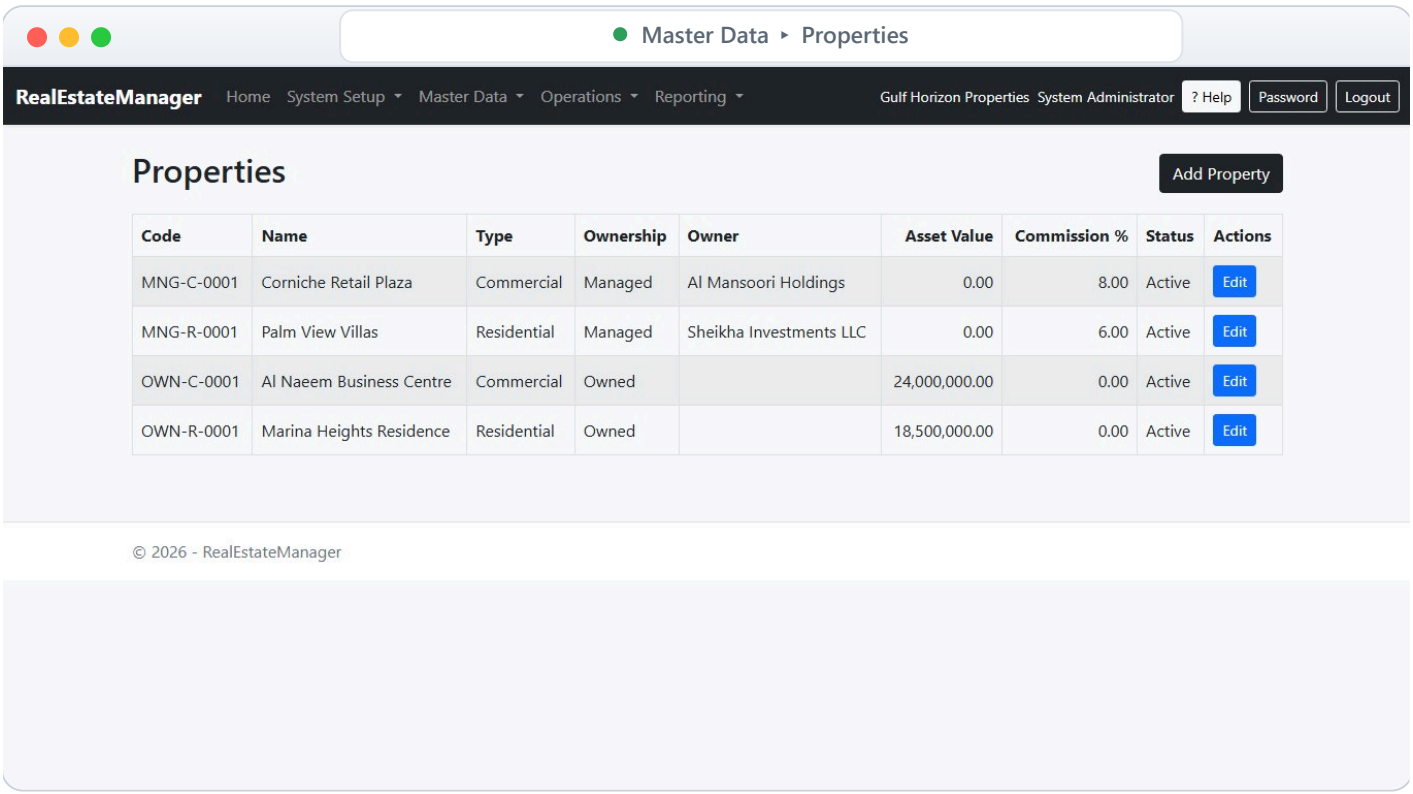
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# Properties

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**

**Workflow step 1.** A property is a building or a site. It is the top of the portfolio hierarchy and the anchor for every unit, lease, invoice and expense beneath it.

Video: **Adding a property, a unit and a tenant** (2:33) - watch it in the Help on screen.

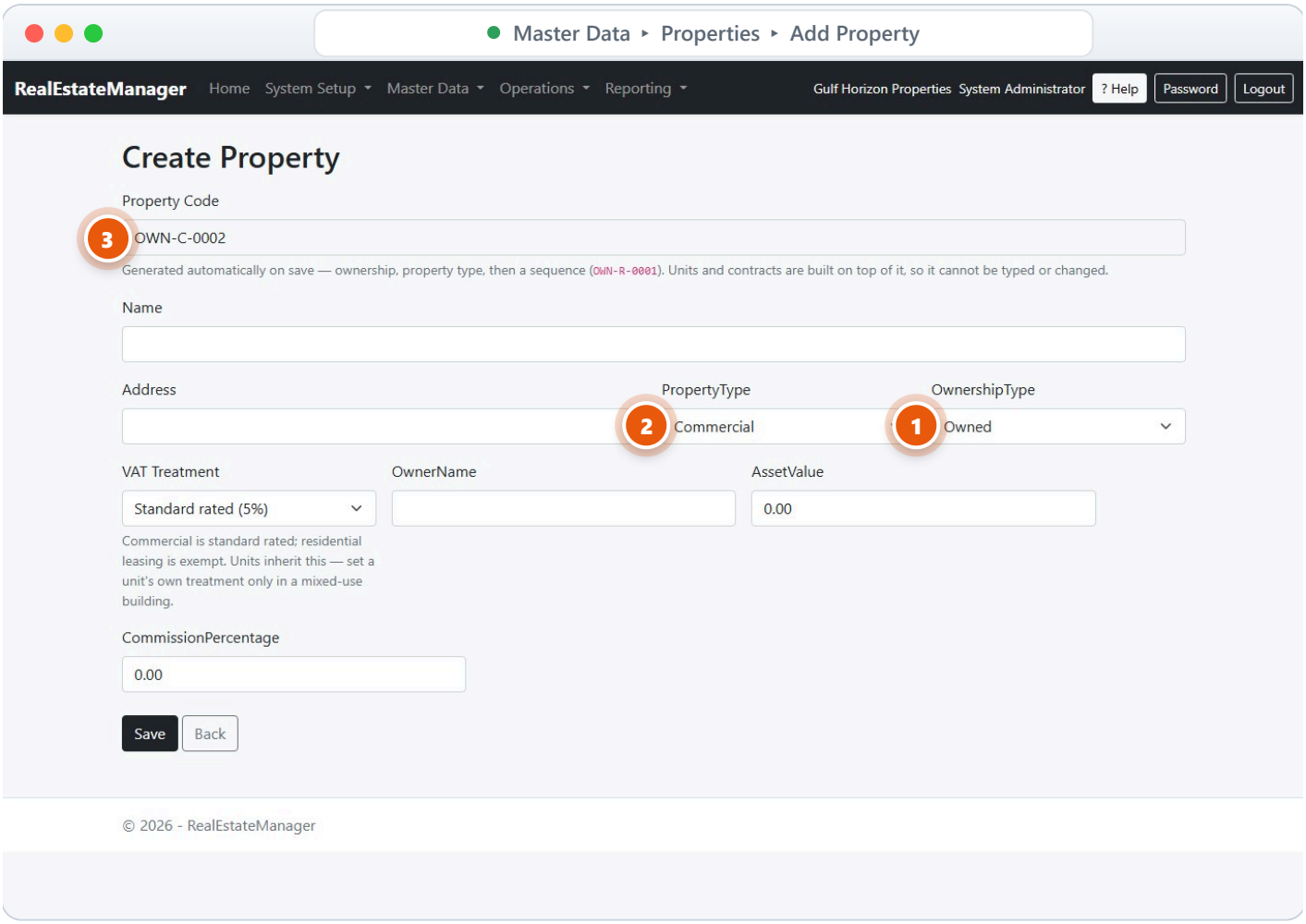



The property list. Codes are issued by the system.

## Creating a property

1. Select **Add Property**.
2. Choose the **Ownership Type** — *this is the field that drives the accounting*.
3. Choose the **Property Type**: Residential, Commercial, Warehouse or Mixed Use. The screen previews the code the property will receive, such as `OWN-R-0001`.
4. Enter the **Name** and **Address**. The name must be unique in the company.
5. Choose the default **VAT Category** for its units — Standard for commercial, Exempt for residential.
6. For a managed property, choose the **Landlord** — add one with **New landlord** if they are not in the list; their name and TRN are copied onto the property — and **Who holds the rent**, then enter the **Commission Percentage** you earn. See Owner Settlements for the three arrangements and Invoicing, Step by Step for what each choice does to the invoices.

7 Enter the **Asset Value** if you track the property's book value, then save.




Adding a property. The code is previewed as you choose ownership and type.

1 Ownership — drives the accounting

2 Type — part of the code

3 The code the property will receive

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Code** | Issued by the system and fixed once saved. Built from ownership and type — see Master Data rules. |
| **Ownership Type** | **Owned** — rent is your revenue.<br>**Managed** — rent belongs to the landlord; only your commission is revenue. |
| **Property Type** | Classification for reporting, and part of the code. |
| **VAT Category** | Default VAT treatment for units in this property. A unit can override it, which is what makes a mixed-use building work: commercial units at 5%, residential units exempt, under one roof. |
| **Owner Name** | The landlord. Used to group the Owner Tenancy Schedule, and to settle with the landlord in Owner Settlements. Spell it the same way on every property of the same owner. |
| **Owner TRN** | Managed properties only: the landlord's VAT registration number, if they are registered. Printed on our monthly commission tax invoice to them. |
| **Commission Percentage** | Your management fee rate on a managed property. |
| **Asset Value** | Reference book value. Does not itself post to the ledger. |
| **Is Active** | Untick to remove a disposed property from selection lists while keeping its history. |

## Registration details

Below the main fields, the form has five sections for what the title deed, affection plan, permits and policies show. All are optional; fill in what you have.

| Section | Fields |
|---|---|
| **Location** | Emirate, area or community, plot number, land or municipality number, a location reference such as a Makani number, and GPS coordinates (the property page links them to a map). |
| **Title Deed & Land** | Title deed number and date, the authority that issued it, tenure (freehold, leasehold, musataha, usufruct, government grant), land use, plot area, your ownership share, and whether the title is mortgaged — with the lender and reference. The same deed number cannot be recorded twice in one emirate. |
| **Building & Completion** | Building permit number and date, completion certificate number and **completion date**, built-up area, floors, parking bays, developer, main contractor and consultant. |
| **Utilities & Insurance** | Electricity / water account, insurer, policy number and expiry date, and notes. |
| **Valuation** | Fair value from the latest independent valuation, its date and the valuer. Not booked — disclosed in the Investment Property Note. |

Units have their own **unit title deed number** (for strata-titled units), **parking bays** and **electricity / water account**.

> **Why the completion date matters for VAT**
> The first sale or lease of a new residential unit within three years of completion is zero rated; later supplies are exempt. For an owned residential property the property page shows the last day of that window and how many days are left.

## The property page and its documents

Select **View** in the list to open everything recorded about a property: the registration details, its units and its **documents**. To keep a scanned document with the property:

1. Under **Upload a Document**, choose the type — title deed, affection / site plan, building permit, completion certificate, insurance policy, mortgage document, floor plan, lease registration and others.
2. Enter its number, issue and expiry dates, and the unit if it belongs to one unit only.
3. Choose the file — PDF, JPG or PNG, up to 5 MB — and select **Upload**.

Select the file name to open it. Documents that have expired are marked red, and those expiring within 60 days amber, with a warning at the top of the page; an expired insurance policy on the property is warned about the same way. Uploading and deleting needs *Create & Edit Master Data*; anyone who can view properties can open the documents.

> **Ownership type is decisive**
> Owned and Managed produce entirely different journals for the same invoice. Confirm the ownership type before you create any lease under the property — see Accounting Entries Reference.

> **Read only?**
> If you can see the list but not the **Add** and **Edit** buttons, your account has *View Master Data* only. Ask the master data owner to make the change.

## Invoicing tenants in the owner's name (managed properties)

Some owners want the tenants' invoices issued in **their** name, with the company acting as their managing agent. Tick **Invoice tenants in the owner's name** on a managed property (under the Owner TRN). It is off by default and applies to contracts and invoices posted after it is switched on.

| | Owner with a TRN | Owner without a TRN |
|---|---|---|
| **Supplier on the invoice** | The owner, "c/o" the company, with a note that the company issues it as agent and that paying the company settles it | |
| **VAT on the rent** | Charged as usual (commercial 5%) | None — the owner cannot charge VAT; the document is a plain invoice |
| **Document number** | The owner's own series: `OTI-<property>-<year>-0001` | The invoice number |
| **Where the VAT goes** | To 21500 Due to Landlords — it is the owner's to declare. It is left out of the company's VAT return and e-invoicing. | |
| **Our commission** | Unchanged: invoiced to the owner as a tax invoice under the company's TRN (see Owner Settlements) | |

The owner's statement adds the VAT collected for them, and Owner Property Profitability shows it in its own column.

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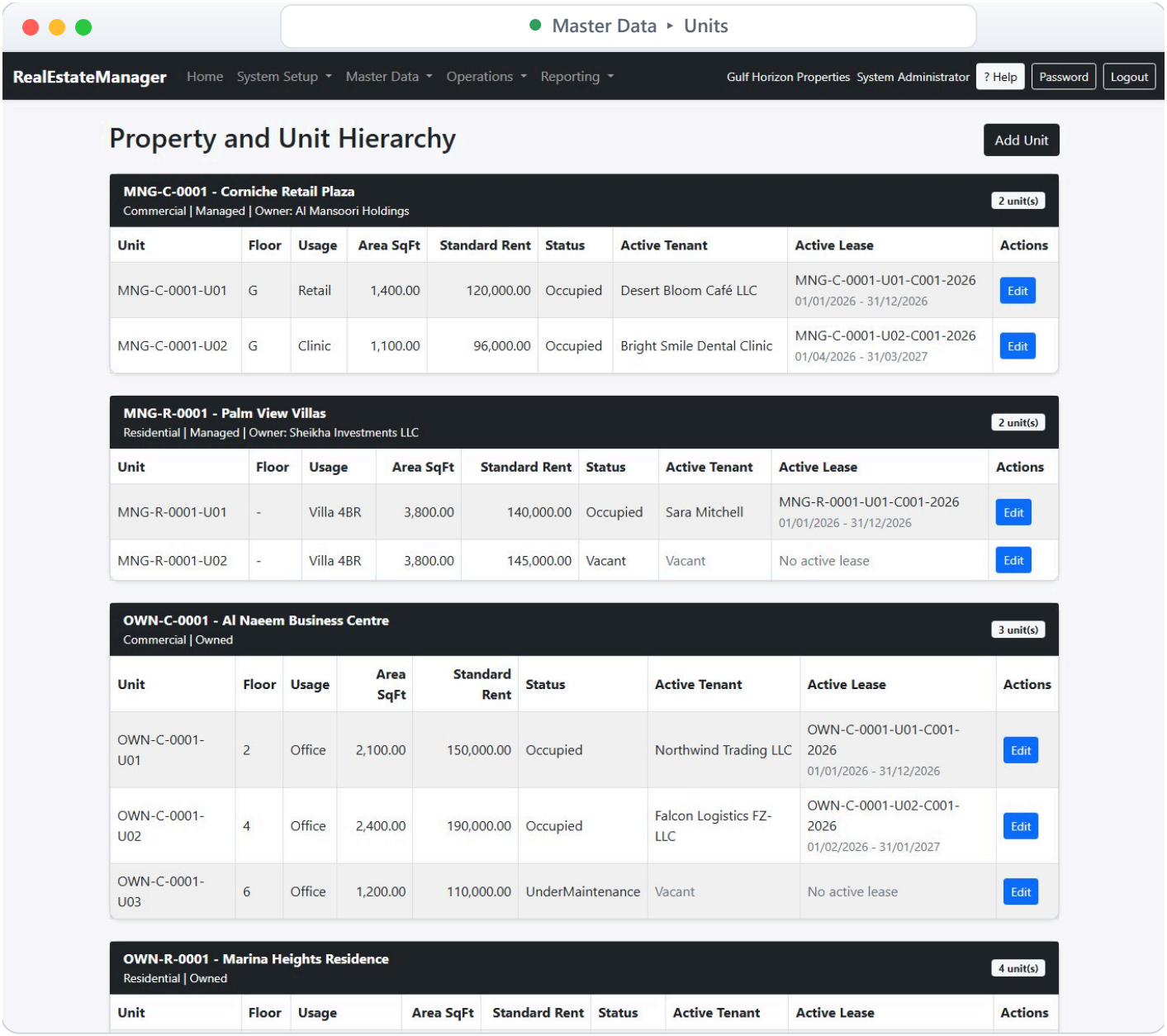
# Units

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Units**

**Workflow step 2.** A unit is an individually rentable space inside a property: an apartment, an office, a shop, a warehouse bay. Leases are signed against units, not against properties.

## Creating a unit

1. Select **Add Unit**.
2. Choose the **Property**. The unit receives the next code under it, such as `OWN-R-0001-U01`.
3. Enter the **Floor** and the **Usage Type**.
4. Enter the **Area (sq ft)** and the **Standard Annual Rent**.
5. Leave **VAT Category** blank to inherit the property's, or set it for a unit that is treated differently — a shop on the ground floor of a residential tower, for example.
6. Leave **Status** as *Vacant*; the system changes it automatically. Save.




Units grouped by property, with their status and asking rent.

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Unit code** | Issued by the system, unique within its property. |
| **Area (sq ft)** | Used for rent-per-square-foot and area utilization. |
| **Standard Annual Rent** | The asking rent. Offered as the default when a lease is created, and editable there. |
| **VAT Category** | Blank means inherit the property's. Set it only to override. |
| **Status** | Vacant · Occupied · Under Maintenance · Reserved. |

> **Status is maintained for you**
>
> An active lease sets the unit to **Occupied** automatically. Set the status yourself only for *Under Maintenance* or *Reserved*, which keep the unit out of the leasing flow.

The list is grouped by property so you can see each building's units and their occupancy together. Occupancy figures on the dashboard and in Property Utilization come from unit status, so keeping it accurate keeps the reporting accurate.

## Placing the unit in the building view

**Floor number** (0 = ground, negative = basement), **Position on the floor** (1 = far left) and **Side of the building** (front, back, left, right - for the 3D drawing) place the unit in the Building View. Both are optional: without them the floor is read from the Floor text and units are ordered by number.

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# Tenants

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants**

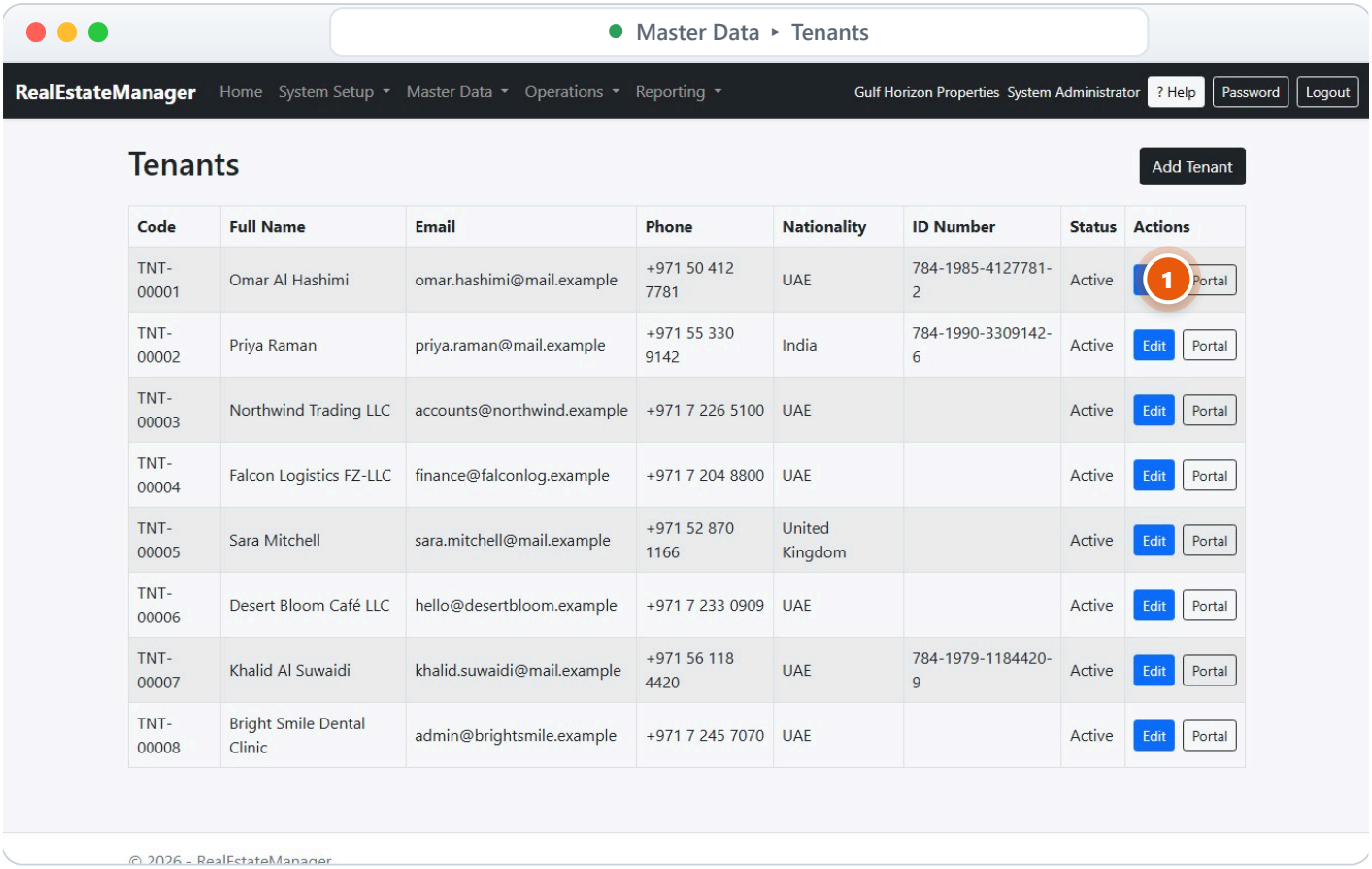
**Workflow step 3.** The tenant register is the receivables sub-ledger. Every tenant's balance rolls up into the `11200` Accounts Receivable control account.

## Creating a tenant

1. Select **Add Tenant**. The tenant code, such as `TNT-00001`, is issued when you save.
2. Enter the **Full Name** exactly as it should appear on contracts, invoices and statements.
3. Enter **Email**, **Phone** and **Nationality**, and the address: **Street address**, **City**, **Emirate** and **Country**.
4. Enter the identifiers you hold: **Trade Licence Number** for a company, **Emirates ID / ID Number** and **Passport Number** for an individual.
5. Enter the **TRN** if the tenant is VAT registered.
6. Under **E-invoicing**, choose the **Customer type**: Individual, Business or Government. For a business, complete the TIN (only if it has no TRN), what identifies it, and who issued its trade licence.
7. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating from another system. Save.

| Field | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Trade licence, Emirates ID, passport, TRN** | Each must be unique in the company. If another tenant already holds one, the save is refused and that tenant is named — open the existing record rather than creating a second one. |
| **TRN** | A tenant with a TRN receives a **full tax invoice** showing it; without one, a **simplified tax invoice**. |
| **Customer type** | Decides whether the tenant's invoices are e-invoices. A company or establishment is a **Business** even if it is not VAT registered; only private persons are **Individuals**. |
| **TIN** | The 10-digit Tax Identification Number — the tenant's address on the e-invoicing network. Leave blank when a TRN is entered: the TIN is the TRN's first 10 digits. |
| **Identified by / issued by** | The registration printed on the e-invoice: normally the trade licence and the authority that issued it. A passport also needs its issuing country as a two-letter code. |
| **Emirate** | Required on every e-invoice address. Choose from the seven emirates. |
| **Opening Balance** | **Positive** — the tenant owes you at go-live.<br>**Negative** — an advance you are holding for them.<br>Feeds the AR control account. |
| **Is Active** | Untick when the tenant leaves. History and statements are kept. |

> **Opening balances need a credit counterpart**
>
> Tenant opening balances add to the debit side of the opening trial balance. Check **System Setup ▸ Opening Balances** afterwards — see Opening Balances.




The tenant register. The Portal button issues a tenant their login.

1. Portal — issue or reset the tenant's login

## Giving the tenant portal access

The **Portal** button on a tenant's row issues them a login to the self-service portal, where they can see their account and send requests. See The Tenant Portal: Staff Guide.

## The tenant's statement

**Reporting ▸ Tenant Statement** produces the tenant's running account: opening balance, every charge and payment in date order, and the closing balance. Use it for collection calls and for confirming a balance with the tenant.

## Emirates ID, passport and other documents

The tenant form has **EID expiry** and **Passport expiry** beside the numbers; an expired one is marked in red. Under the form, **Tenant documents** keeps the scans themselves: Emirates ID, passport, residence visa, trade licence and others.

1. Choose the **Document** type and the **File** (PDF, JPG or PNG, up to 5 MB).
2. For an Emirates ID or passport, leave **Read the Emirates ID / passport** ticked. Number, issue and expiry date can be left empty — they are read from the scan.
3. Select **Upload**. The message says what was filled in.

- The **number** is copied to the tenant only when the tenant has none. If the tenant already has a different number, the message asks you to check it — it is never overwritten.
- The **expiry date** is always recorded on the tenant, because the newest document counts.
- **Nationality** is filled in if empty, and a different name on the card is pointed out.

Reading uses the same OpenAI service as the AI Assistant; when it is not switched on, type the number and expiry yourself. Expiring documents are listed on Document Expiry.

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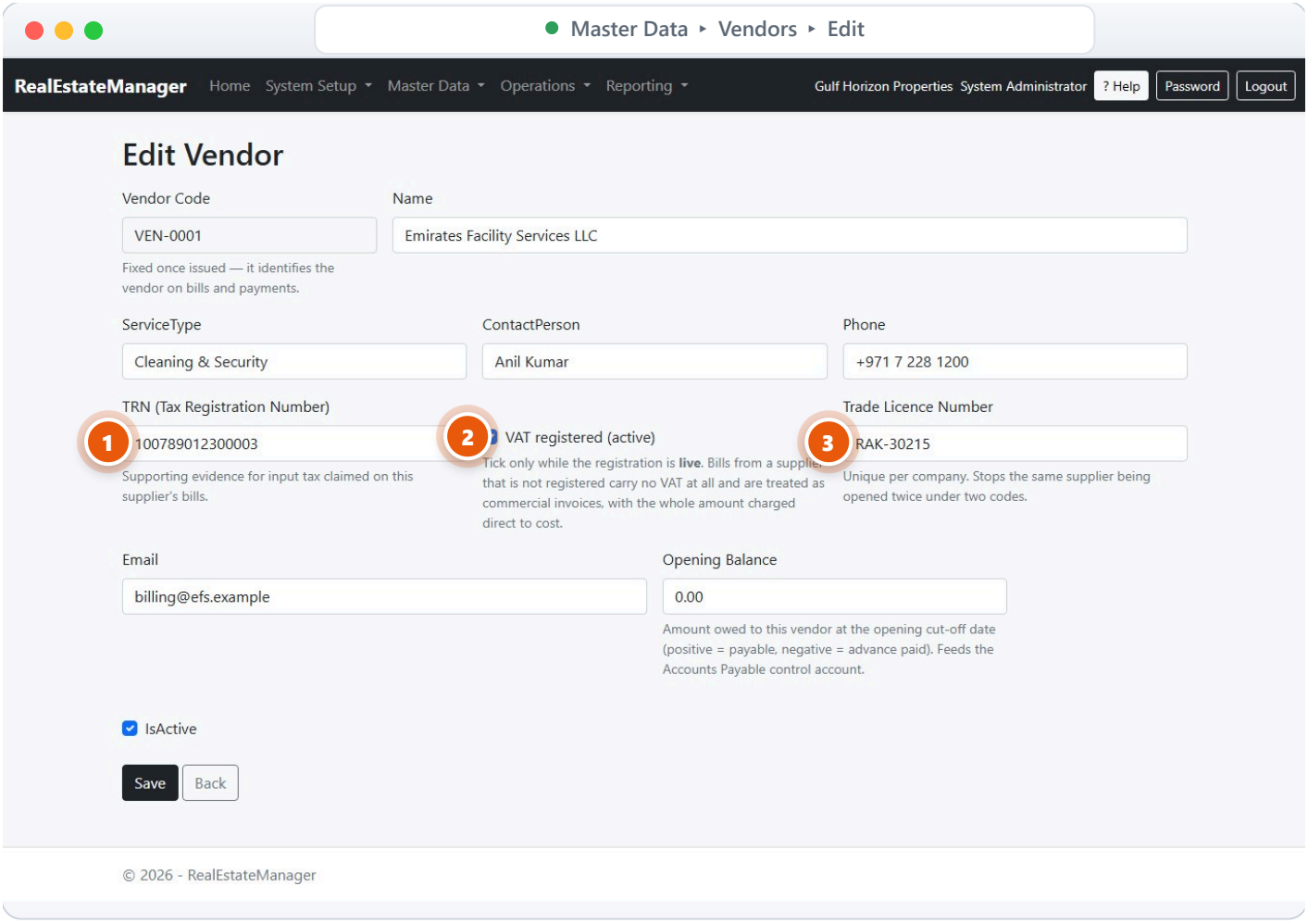
# Vendors

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Vendors**

Vendors are your suppliers and service providers — maintenance contractors, utilities, agencies. The vendor register is the payables sub-ledger and rolls up into `21100` Accounts Payable.

## Creating a vendor

1. Select **Add Vendor**. The vendor code, such as `VEN-0001`, is issued when you save.
2. Enter the **Name**, **Service Type**, **Contact Person**, **Phone** and **Email**.
3. Enter the **Trade Licence Number**.
4. Enter the **TRN**, and tick **VAT registered (active)** only if their registration is currently live. For a supplier that is not VAT registered, enter its **TIN** instead, so its e-invoices can be matched to this record — see Received E-Invoices.
5. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating — positive means you owe the vendor. Save.




A supplier record. 'VAT registered (active)' decides whether their bills carry VAT.

1. TRN — required for a registered supplier
2. VAT registered (active)
3. Trade licence — must be unique

## Why "VAT registered" matters

This tick box decides how every bill from this supplier is treated:

| Vendor is… | Their bills |
|---|---|
| **VAT registered** and has a TRN | Are **tax invoices**. Taxable lines carry 5% VAT, which you can reclaim to the extent the cost relates to taxable supplies. |
| **Not** registered | Are **commercial invoices**. No VAT is calculated anywhere on the bill, and the whole amount is a direct cost. |

A registered supplier must have a TRN on file — the system will not save the tick without one. Untick it when a supplier's registration is cancelled; bills already entered keep the treatment they were entered with.

> **No duplicates**
>
> A trade licence number or TRN can belong to only one vendor in the company. If you try to enter an existing supplier again, the save is refused and the existing vendor is named.

Accounting users can look vendors up to enter bills, but only users with *Create & Edit Master Data* can add or change one — see Master Data rules.

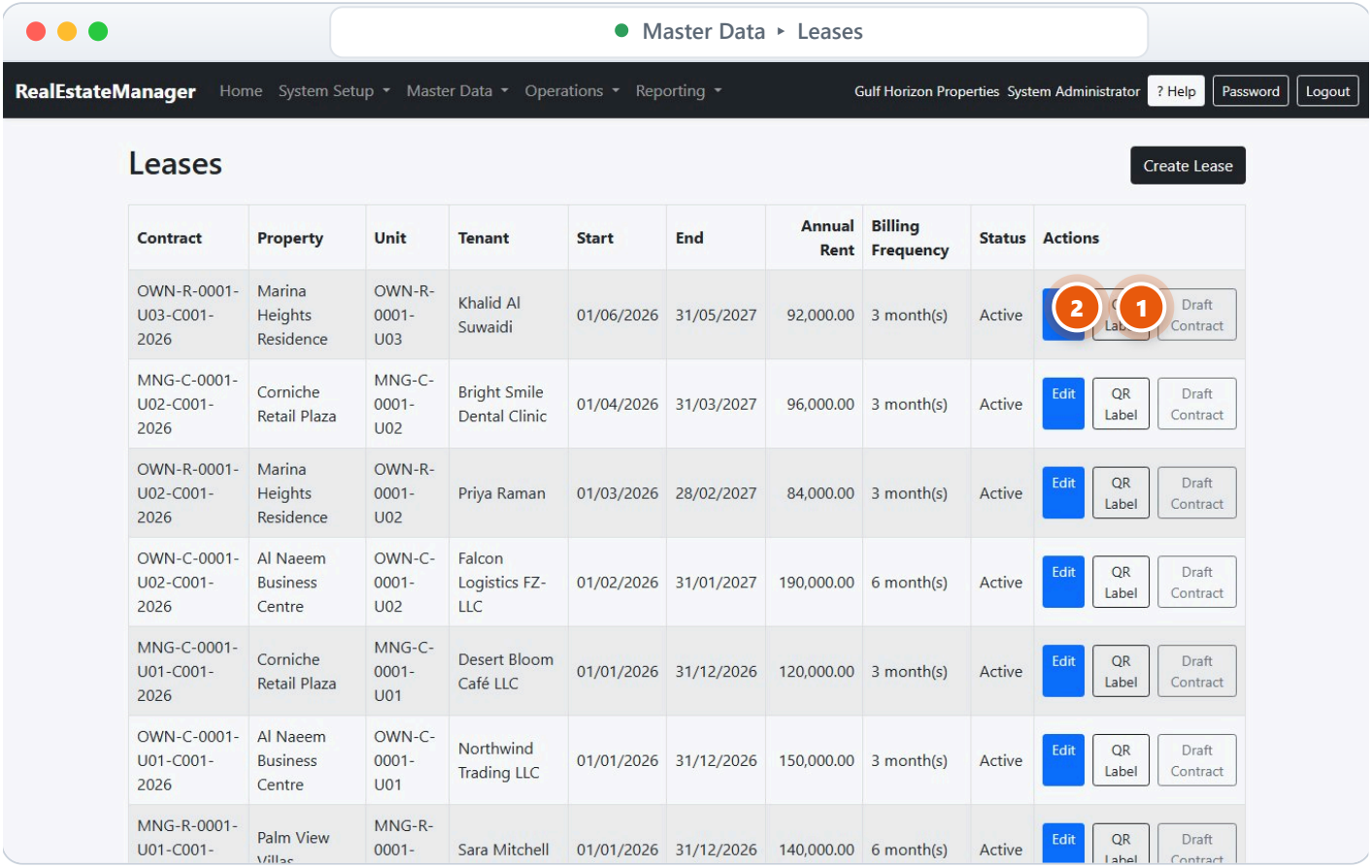
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# Lease Contracts

Where: **Master Data ▸ Leases**

The lease is the pivot of the whole system. A new contract is first saved as a **draft**, which can be corrected freely. The moment it takes effect - when it is activated, or approved if your company requires approval - it creates the entire schedule of rent invoices for its term and the month-by-month revenue-recognition plan, and its terms are locked.

Video: **Creating a lease** (1:17) - watch it in the Help on screen.




Lease contracts with their system-issued contract codes.

1. Draft Contract — the printable tenancy agreement
2. QR Label for the contract file

## Creating a lease

1. Select **New Lease**.
2. Choose the **Unit** and the **Tenant**.
3. Enter the **Start Date** and **End Date**.
4. Enter the **Annual Rent** for the full contract year.

5. Choose the **Billing Frequency (Months)** — it must divide 12 exactly: 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 or 12.
6. Check the **VAT treatment** shown for the unit. Override it only with a reason (see below).
7. Enter the **Security Deposit Amount** agreed in the contract and any **Notes**.
8. Choose how to save:
   - **Save and Activate** - the contract takes effect at once (companies without approval).
   - **Save and Submit for Approval** - it goes to a second person (companies with approval).
   - **Save as Draft** - to finish it later. A draft has no effect on anything.

## Approval in two levels

A company can require every new contract to be checked by a second person before it takes effect. Someone with the **Approve Contracts** permission switches this on or off in **Master Data ▸ Approvals**.

1. The creator saves the contract and **submits it for approval**. Its unit is held: no other contract can be submitted for the same unit and dates.
2. Approvers see it in **Master Data ▸ Approvals**, with a count in the menu and a note on the dashboard. **Review** shows the terms and every invoice it will create.
3. **Approve**: the contract becomes Active, its invoices and revenue plan are created and the unit becomes Occupied. **Return to creator** (a reason is required): it goes back to Draft, with the reason shown on the Leases list, to be corrected and submitted again.

> **The four-eyes rule**
> Nobody can approve a contract they created or submitted, even with the Approve Contracts permission. Until it is decided, the person who submitted it can **Withdraw** it back to draft. Every submission, approval and return is kept, with who did it, when and why - see the history at the bottom of the contract.

## The contract code

You do not type a contract number. The system issues one from the unit code, a tenancy number and the year, for example `OWN-R-0001-U01-C001-2026`:

- The **same tenant renewing** the same unit keeps the tenancy number with the new year — `…-C001-2027`.
- A **new tenant** on the unit receives the next tenancy number — `…-C002-2027`.

So a glance at the code tells you the building, the unit, which tenancy on that unit it is, and which year. See Master Data: Codes, Uniqueness & Who Can Edit.

## VAT treatment

The VAT category comes from the unit, or from its property if the unit does not set one:

| Category | Rate | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| **Standard** | 5% | Commercial property — offices, shops, warehouses. |
| **Exempt** | — | Residential lettings after the first supply. No VAT is charged and VAT on related costs cannot be reclaimed. |
| **Zero-rated** | 0% | The first supply of a new residential building. No VAT charged, but related input VAT can be reclaimed. |

If a specific contract genuinely needs different treatment, choose a **VAT category override** and enter the **reason**. The reason is kept on the contract so the decision can be explained later.

## What is generated when the contract takes effect

**Invoice schedule.** The annual rent is divided by the number of invoices per year (12 ÷ billing frequency). One draft invoice is created for each billing date from the start date until the end date. VAT is calculated per invoice from the contract's VAT category.

**Revenue-recognition plan.** One planned entry for the last day of every month in the term, each for one-twelfth of the annual rent. This spreads the rent evenly over time however it was billed or collected.

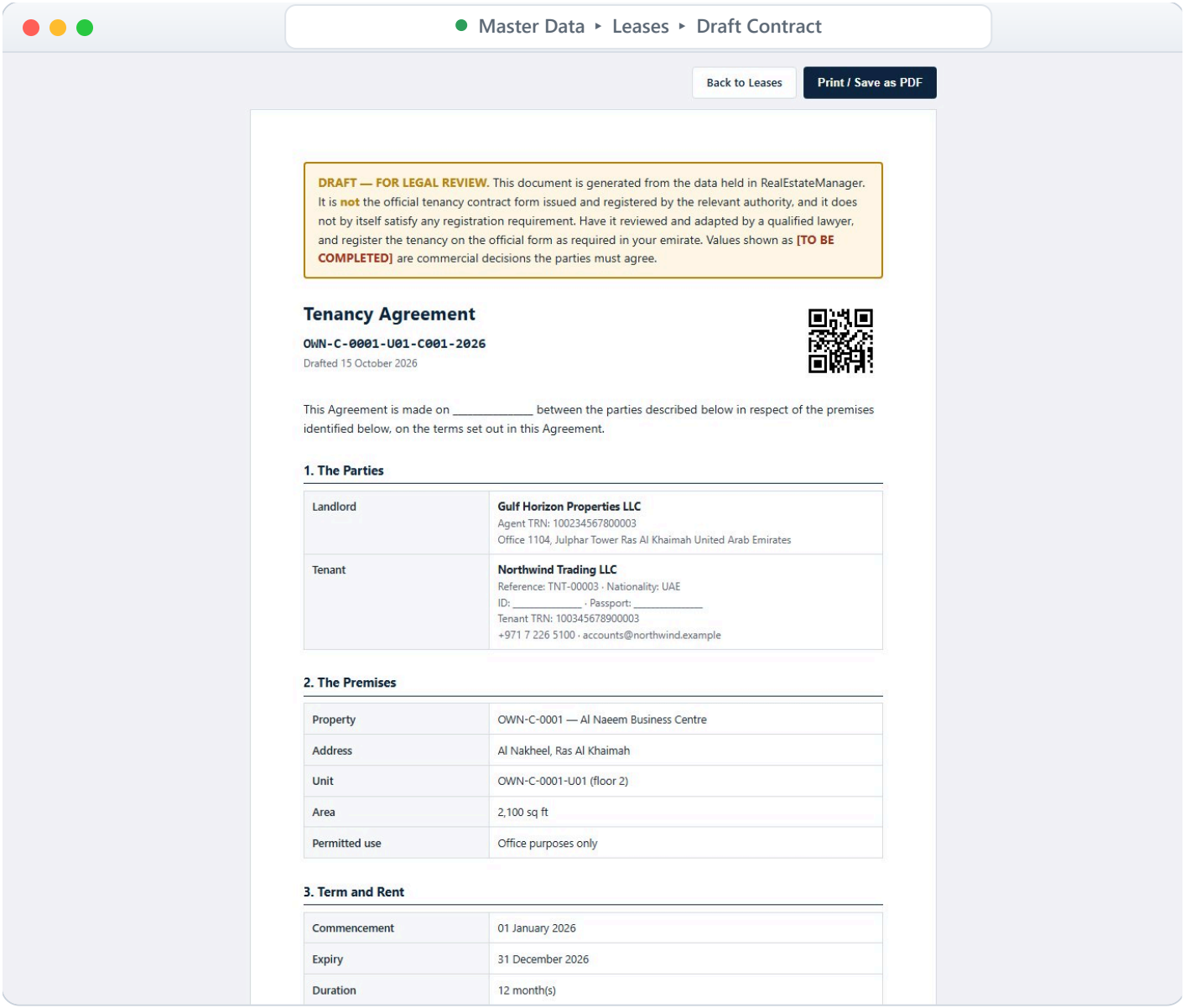
**Unit status.** The unit becomes *Occupied* and the lease *Active*.

> **Worked example**
> Annual rent 175,000, billed quarterly, one-year term starting 1 January:
>
> - 4 invoices of 43,750 each, dated 1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul, 1 Oct.
> - 12 revenue-recognition entries of 14,583.33 each, at each month end.
>
> After eight months, 116,666.64 has been recognised as revenue and 58,333.36 remains in *Advances from Customers* as deferred income.

## Printing the contract and its label

Each lease in the list has two print buttons, both opening in a new tab:

| Button | What it produces |
|---|---|
| **Draft Contract** | A full tenancy agreement filled in from the lease: parties, premises, term and rent, payment schedule, **schedule of charges** for breach and damage, use of the premises, maintenance and damage, security deposit, breach and termination, utilities, insurance and access. Review it with your legal adviser before first use. |
| **QR Label** | A label carrying the contract code and a QR code, to stick on the file or the signed copy so it can be scanned back to the record. |




The draft tenancy agreement, filled in from the lease.

## What the system validates

| Rule | Message you will see |
|---|---|
| End date after start date | "End date must be later than start date." |
| Billing frequency divides 12 | "Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12." |
| No other active or waiting contract on the same unit for overlapping dates | "The unit is already taken for these dates by contract …" |

> **An active contract's terms are locked**
>
> Its invoices were created from its rent, dates and billing frequency, so those can no longer be changed - only its notes. Check a contract while it is a draft. If commercial terms change later, end the lease and raise a new contract, then cancel any unposted invoices from the old one.

## Lease statuses

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Draft** | Being prepared. No invoices, not visible to the tenant, freely editable. Shown as *Returned* when an approver sent it back. |
| **Awaiting approval** | Submitted to a second person. Read-only; its unit is held for it. |
| **Active** | In force: invoices created, terms locked. Only active leases appear on the PDC screen. |
| **Terminated** | Ended early. |
| **Expired** | Ran to its natural end date. |
| **Renewed** | Superseded by a successor contract. |

## VAT on a new residential building

The VAT treatment of a lease comes from the unit, falling back to the property. For a **new** residential building — one with a completion date or a development project — the **first lease** of each unit within three years of completion is **zero rated** automatically; every later lease of that unit is exempt. The first lease is recorded on the unit when it is activated. See Real Estate VAT.

## Contract documents and the attested contract

Under the contract form, **Contract documents** keeps the papers of the tenancy: the **contract attested by the municipality** (for Ras Al Khaimah, RAK Municipality), the registration certificate (Ejari or equivalent) and the signed contract. Enter the attestation number in **Number**.

Until an attested copy is uploaded, the contract shows *"No attested contract is on file"*, and it is counted on Document Expiry under running contracts without an attested copy.

## Renewing a contract

To renew, create a new contract for the same tenant and unit starting the day after the current one ends — or ask the AI Assistant to "renew contract … at 82,000 in 4 cheques"; it prepares the new draft, shows the rent change and leaves the current contract as it is.

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# Document Expiry

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Document Expiry**

One page that shows every document about to lapse, so nothing expires unnoticed.

**Master Data** ▸ **Document Expiry** (also under Controls)

## What it lists

- Tenants' **Emirates IDs** and **passports** that have expired or expire within the period you choose (30, 60, 90 or 180 days).
- Other **tenant and contract documents** with an expiry date — visas, trade licences, registration certificates.
- **Property documents** with an expiry date — insurance policies, permits.
- **Running contracts without an attested copy** on file.
- **Tenants with a running contract and no Emirates ID expiry** recorded.

Expired items show in red with how long ago they expired; items within 14 days show in amber. Each name opens the record, where the new document is uploaded.

## Keeping it up to date

1. When a tenant brings a renewed Emirates ID or passport, open the tenant and upload it under **Tenant documents**. The new expiry date is read and recorded — see Tenants.
2. Upload each contract's attested copy under **Contract documents** — see Lease Contracts.
3. Keep property documents on the property page — see Properties.

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# Importing from a Previous System

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Import Data**

When a customer moves to RealEstateManager, their records come over from the previous system through one Excel file: download the template, fill it, upload it. The file is checked cell by cell and row by row, and imported only when everything in it is right — then all of it at once.

## What can be imported

| Sheet | What it holds | Permission needed |
|---|---|---|
| **Properties** | Buildings and plots, owned or managed, with their registration details. | Create & Edit Master Data |
| **Units** | The units of each property: floor, use, area, asking rent. | Create & Edit Master Data |
| **Tenants** | Individuals, businesses and government tenants, with IDs, TRN and opening balance. | Create & Edit Master Data |
| **Vendors** | Suppliers, with VAT registration and opening balance. | Create & Edit Master Data |
| **Leases** | Running contracts: unit, tenant, dates, rent, billing and deposit. | Manage Leases |
| **Employees** | Staff with documents, salary and bank details. | Manage HR |

The template has only the sheets you may import. A file with rows on a sheet you may not import is refused.

## Step by step

1. Open **Master Data** ▸ **Import Data** and select **Download template (.xlsx)**. It comes in the language you are working in; either language's file can be uploaded.
2. Fill one row per record from row 2. Start with the **Instructions** sheet; pointing at a header shows what the column takes. Columns marked ***** are required.
3. Give every record your own reference in its *ref* column, unique on that sheet — the old system's number works well. The other sheets use it: a unit gives its *Property ref*, a contract its *Unit ref* and *Tenant ref*, an employee the property they work for. A record already in the system can be named by its code instead, e.g. `OWN-R-0001`.
4. Select **Check the file** and upload it. Every problem is listed with its sheet, row and column; correct them in your file and upload it again.
5. When nothing is wrong, the screen shows how many records of each kind will be created. Select **Import**.
6. Select **Download the result file**: your file with a *System code* column holding each record's new code. Keep it; later files can name these records by those codes.

## How the data types are checked

Every column has a type, and a cell of the wrong type is reported, never guessed:

| Type | Accepted | Refused, for example |
|---|---|---|
| **Text** | Anything up to the column's length. ID and phone columns are text cells, so leading zeros are kept. | A name longer than the limit |
| **Number** | A number cell, or digits with a decimal point and thousands commas. Two decimals at most; within the column's range. | `AED 5,000`, `1,200 sq ft`, a negative area |
| **Whole number** | A number with no decimals. | `2.5` floors |
| **Date** | A date cell, or text as `31/12/2026`, `2026-12-31` or `31 Dec 2026`. | `12 Jan`, `next year` |
| **Yes / No** | Yes, No, True, False, 1, 0, نعم, لا. | `Maybe` |
| **List** | One of the dropdown values, in English or Arabic. | `Villa` as a property type |

Format rules apply on top: an email address must be valid, a TRN has 15 digits, a UAE IBAN 23 characters starting with AE, a MOHRE person code 14 digits, a bank routing code 9 digits, a country code two letters.

## The same rules as the entry screens

- Codes are generated by the system, exactly as when a record is entered by hand.
- A tenant's Emirates ID, passport, TRN or trade licence, a vendor's TRN or licence, a property's name or title deed and an employee's Emirates ID must not already be in the system — or on another row of the file. Uploading the same file twice is therefore refused the second time.
- A managed property needs its owner's name; a VAT registered vendor its TRN; a limited employment contract its end date; a salary paid by WPS or bank transfer an IBAN.
- A contract's end date must be after its start, its billing every 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 or 12 months, and its unit free for its dates — against running contracts and against the other contracts of the file.
- A department named on the Employees sheet that is not in the system yet is created; the check says which.

> **Contracts arrive as drafts**
>
> Importing a contract creates no invoice and no revenue. Open **Master Data ▸ Leases**, review each imported contract (its old number is in the notes) and activate it, as for any new contract. The unit becomes Occupied then.

> **All of it, or nothing**
>
> The import runs as one transaction: if anything fails part-way, nothing is kept. And the file is checked again at the moment of import, so records entered by someone else since the check are taken into account.

A sheet takes up to 5,000 rows and a file up to 10 MB; split a larger migration into several files, importing properties and units before the contracts that use them. Opening balances of tenants and vendors are recorded on their records; the ledger side is entered in Opening Balances.

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# Invoicing, Step by Step: Own, Managed & Owner-Named Properties

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Customer Invoices**

Every rent invoice follows the same seven steps, from the contract to the money. What changes from one property to the next is **whose rent it is** and **whose name is on the invoice**. This topic walks through the steps once, then shows exactly what differs in each of the three cases.

## Which case is yours

| | Case | How the property is set up | Whose rent, whose invoice |
|---|---|---|---|
| **A** | **The company's own property** | Ownership type **Owned**. | The rent is the company's revenue. The company invoices in its own name. |
| **B** | **A landlord's property, invoiced in the company's name** | Ownership type **Managed**, a **Landlord** and a **Commission %**. *Invoice tenants in the owner's name* is left unticked. | The rent belongs to the landlord; the company earns its commission. The company invoices in its own name. |
| **C** | **A landlord's property, invoiced in the owner's name** | As B, with **Invoice tenants in the owner's name** ticked. | The rent belongs to the landlord, and the landlord is the supplier on the invoice. The company issues it as agent. |

All of it is set on the property, under **Master Data** ▸ **Properties** — see Properties. Landlords and their bank details are kept under **Master Data** ▸ **Landlords**. One company can hold all three kinds of property side by side.

> **A building that belongs to the company's owner personally**
>
> **Owned** means the *company* owns the building and its rent is the company's revenue. A building that belongs to a shareholder or a family member in their own name is not the company's: register it as **Managed**, with that person as the landlord, so their rent is kept apart from the company's income and they receive an owner statement like any other landlord (case B or C).

> **Decide before the first contract**
>
> The ownership type and the owner's-name option are read when each invoice is **posted**. Changing them later does not restate invoices already posted, and existing contracts keep the monthly income plan they were created with. Set them correctly before you create any contract under the property.

## The seven steps, the same in every case

1. **Set up the property.** **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**: ownership type and VAT category; for a managed property also the landlord, the commission %, *Who holds the rent* and whether tenants are invoiced in the owner's name. Then add its units.

2. **Create the contract.** Master Data ▸ Leases. A new contract is a **Draft** with no invoices. When it is **activated** — or **approved**, if your company requires approval — the system creates every rent invoice of the term in one go: the annual rent divided by the invoices per year, one invoice for each billing date, numbered `INV-<contract>-<year and month>`, dated and due on the billing date. Each invoice starts as **Draft** and keeps the VAT treatment the contract had that day. See Lease Contracts.

3. **Post each invoice when it falls due.** Operations ▸ Customer Invoices, then **Post** on its row. To post a whole month at once, open System Setup ▸ Closing Cockpit and select **Issue invoices** beside *Rent invoices of the month issued*. Posting writes the journal on the **invoice date** and gives a taxable invoice its tax invoice number. A draft invoice is not in the accounts, cannot be paid and is not shown to the tenant.

4. **Hand over the invoice.** **Tax Invoice** (or **Invoice**, when no VAT is charged) on the row opens the document to print or save as PDF. Tenants with portal access see posted invoices there. Where e-invoicing applies, send it from the E-Invoice Monitor.

5. **Collect the money.** **Receive** on the row records cash or a transfer — see Customer Receipts. Post-dated cheques are registered under PDC Receipts and settle the invoice when the bank clears them. The invoice moves to *PartiallyPaid*, then *Paid*.

6. **Recognise the month's income.** System Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition, or **Run recognition** in the Closing Cockpit. For an owned property this releases one month of rent into revenue; for a managed property it takes one month of commission out of the landlord's money. See Revenue Recognition.

7. **Managed properties only: invoice the commission and pay the landlord.** Operations ▸ Owner Settlements: **Issue Commission Invoices** each month, then **Statement & Pay**. See Owner Settlements.

## What differs between the three cases

| | A. Company's own | B. Landlord's, company's name | C. Landlord's, owner's name |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Supplier printed on the invoice** | The company, with its TRN | The company, with its TRN | The landlord, with the landlord's TRN, "c/o" the company, and a note that the company issues it as agent |
| **VAT on the rent** | By the contract's VAT category: 5% on commercial rent, none on exempt residential rent, 0% on a zero-rated first supply | | The same when the landlord has a TRN. A landlord with no TRN cannot charge VAT: the invoice carries none |
| **Tax invoice number** | The company's single series, `TX-<year>-…` | | The landlord's own series for the property, `OTI-<property>-<year>-0001`. No TRN: the invoice number only |
| **The rent, when posted** | Cr `21200` Advances from Customers | Cr `21500` Due to Landlords | |
| **The VAT, when posted** | Cr `21400` VAT Payable — the company declares and pays it | | Cr `21500` Due to Landlords — it is the landlord's to declare, and is passed on with the rent |
| **VAT return** | In the company's VAT Return | | Left out of the company's return; shown in the **Owner VAT Return** for that landlord |
| **E-invoicing** | Queued for the E-Invoice Monitor when the tenant is a business or government body | | *Not required*: it is not the company's supply |
| **Where the tenant's money lands** | The company's bank or cash | Decided by *Who holds the rent*: the company's bank, the owners' funds bank account, or the landlord's own account | |
| **Monthly income entry** | One month of rent: Dr `21200`, Cr Rental Revenue – Owned | One month of commission (rent ÷ 12 × commission %): Dr `21500`, Cr Management Fee Revenue | |
| **The company's own invoice** | The rent invoice itself | The monthly **commission tax invoice** to the landlord, with 5% VAT, under the company's TRN | |
| **What is paid on** | Nothing — the rent is the company's | Rent less commission and the VAT on it | Rent plus the VAT collected for the owner, less commission and the VAT on it |

## Case A — the company's own property

1. Property: **Owned**. No landlord, no commission.
2. Activate the contract; the invoices appear as drafts under **Operations** ▸ **Customer Invoices**.
3. **Post** the invoice on its date. A taxable invoice receives its `TX-` number.
4. Print the tax invoice; send the e-invoice if the tenant is a business.

5. Receive the payment or clear the cheque.
6. Run revenue recognition every month.

| Step | Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| Invoice posted | `11200` Accounts Receivable | Rent + VAT | — |
| | `21200` Advances from Customers | — | Rent |
| | `21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0) | — | VAT |
| Money received | Bank or cash | Amount | — |
| | `11200` Accounts Receivable | — | Amount |
| Each month | `21200` Advances from Customers | Rent ÷ 12 | — |
| | Rental Revenue – Owned | — | Rent ÷ 12 |

## Case B — a landlord's property, invoiced in the company's name

1. Landlord: add them under **Master Data** ▸ **Landlords** with their TRN and bank account.
2. Property: **Managed**, choose the **Landlord**, enter the **Commission %** and choose **Who holds the rent**. Leave *Invoice tenants in the owner's name* unticked.
3. Activate the contract and **Post** each invoice on its date, exactly as in case A. The tenant's invoice looks the same as one for an owned property: the company is the supplier and the number is from the `TX-` series.
4. Receive the payment or clear the cheque. The money lands where *Who holds the rent* says.
5. Run revenue recognition every month: it moves that month's commission from the landlord's money into your revenue.
6. After the month end, **Operations** ▸ **Owner Settlements** ▸ **Issue Commission Invoices**. Each landlord gets one tax invoice (`CI-<year>-…`, with a `TX-` tax invoice number) for the month's commission plus 5% VAT.
7. **Statement & Pay** for the landlord: check the statement and pay the balance, in full or in part.

| Step | Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| Invoice posted | `11200` Accounts Receivable | Rent + VAT | — |
| | `21500` Due to Landlords | — | Rent |
| | `21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0) | — | VAT |
| Money received | Company bank, `11120` Bank – Owners' Funds, or `21500` Due to Landlords when paid to the owner directly | Amount | — |
| | `11200` Accounts Receivable | — | Amount |
| Each month | `21500` Due to Landlords | Commission | — |
| | Management Fee Revenue | — | Commission |
| Commission invoice | `21500` Due to Landlords | 5% of commission | — |
| | `21400` VAT Payable | — | 5% of commission |
| Landlord paid | `21500` Due to Landlords | Amount paid | — |
| | Bank it is paid from | — | Amount paid |

> **The VAT on the rent is the company's to pay in this case**
>
> Because the invoice is in the company's name, VAT charged on commercial rent goes to the company's VAT Payable and its VAT return — even though the rent itself is the landlord's. If the landlord is VAT registered and should declare that VAT themselves, use case C.

## Case C — a landlord's property, invoiced in the owner's name

1. Landlord and property as in case B, and tick **Invoice tenants in the owner's name** on the property. Record the landlord's TRN if they are VAT registered: with no TRN, no VAT is charged on the rent.
2. Activate the contract and **Post** each invoice on its date. On posting, the invoice is stamped with the owner's name and TRN as they are that day, and a registered owner's invoice takes the next number in `OTI-<property>-<year>-…`.
3. Select **Tax Invoice** to print it. The landlord is shown as the supplier, "c/o" your company, with a note that paying the company settles the invoice. A landlord with no TRN gets a plain **Invoice**.
4. There is nothing to send from the E-Invoice Monitor: the column shows *Not required*.
5. Receive the payment or clear the cheque; the money lands where *Who holds the rent* says.
6. Run revenue recognition, issue the monthly commission invoice and pay the landlord, as in case B. The owner statement shows an extra line, *Add: VAT on rent invoiced in the owner's name*, so the VAT you collected for them is paid over with the rent.
7. Give the landlord their figures for the FTA from **Reporting ▸ Owner VAT Return**: their output tax on the rent,

and as input tax the VAT on your commission and on costs recharged to them.

| Step | Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| Invoice posted | `11200` Accounts Receivable | Rent + VAT | — |
| | `21500` Due to Landlords | — | Rent |
| | `21500` Due to Landlords (VAT, the owner's to declare) | — | VAT |

Receipts, the monthly commission, the commission invoice and the payment to the landlord post exactly as in case B.

## Who holds the rent (cases B and C)

Set on the managed property. It changes only where the tenant's money lands when a receipt is posted or a cheque clears; the invoices are the same.

| Arrangement | The receipt debits | Paying the landlord |
|---|---|---|
| **Company bank account** | The company's own bank or cash | From the company's bank |
| **Owners' funds bank account** | `11120` Bank – Owners' Funds, or the landlord's own owners' funds account from **System Setup ▸ Bank Accounts** | From that account, so landlords' money never mixes with the company's |
| **Paid to the owner directly** | `21500` Due to Landlords: no company bank moves | Already with the landlord. The statement shows it as paid; what remains is the commission they owe you |

For *Paid to the owner directly*, use case C: if the rent is invoiced in the company's name, the VAT on it is still the company's to pay although the money never reached it.

## Other invoices the system issues

| Document | Number | Issued to, and when |
|---|---|---|
| **Cheque charge** | `CHG-<year>-…` | The tenant, when a cheque is withdrawn or returned with a charge. Always the company's own invoice and income, with 5% VAT when the company is registered — even on a property invoiced in the owner's name. It is raised for you with the cheque entry and appears in the Customer Invoices list. See PDC Receipts. |
| **Commission tax invoice** | `CI-<year>-…` | Each landlord, monthly, for the commission recognised. See Owner Settlements. |
| **Recharge tax invoice or disbursement note** | `TX-<year>-…` for a recharge | The landlord, for a cost the company paid on their property and ticked *Charge to owner*. Listed under **Operations ▸ Recharges to Owners**. |
| **Unit sale tax invoice** | `TX-<year>-…` | The buyer of a unit: on a standard-rated sale each payment received before handover gets a tax invoice number. See Unit Sales. |
| **Credit note** | Its own series | The tenant, to reduce or cancel a posted invoice. On an invoice issued in the owner's name its VAT comes back out of Due to Landlords, not the company's VAT. See Credit Notes. |

## Correcting an invoice

- **Not yet posted:** nothing is in the accounts. A wrong rent or date is a wrong contract — see Lease Contracts.
- **Posted, not sent as an e-invoice, nothing received against it:** reset its journal to draft from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry** — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft. The tax invoice number it was given stays with it.
- **Anything else:** issue a credit note from the **Credit Note** button on its row.

## Checking your work

- **Operations ▸ Customer Invoices**: the **GL** column shows *Posted* or *Not Posted* for every invoice.
- **System Setup ▸ Closing Cockpit**: *Rent invoices of the month issued* is red while any invoice dated in the month is unposted, and the period cannot be closed.
- **Reporting ▸ Tenant Statement**: every invoice, receipt and credit note of one tenant.
- **Operations ▸ Owner Settlements**: rent billed, commission and balance per landlord.

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# Customer Invoices

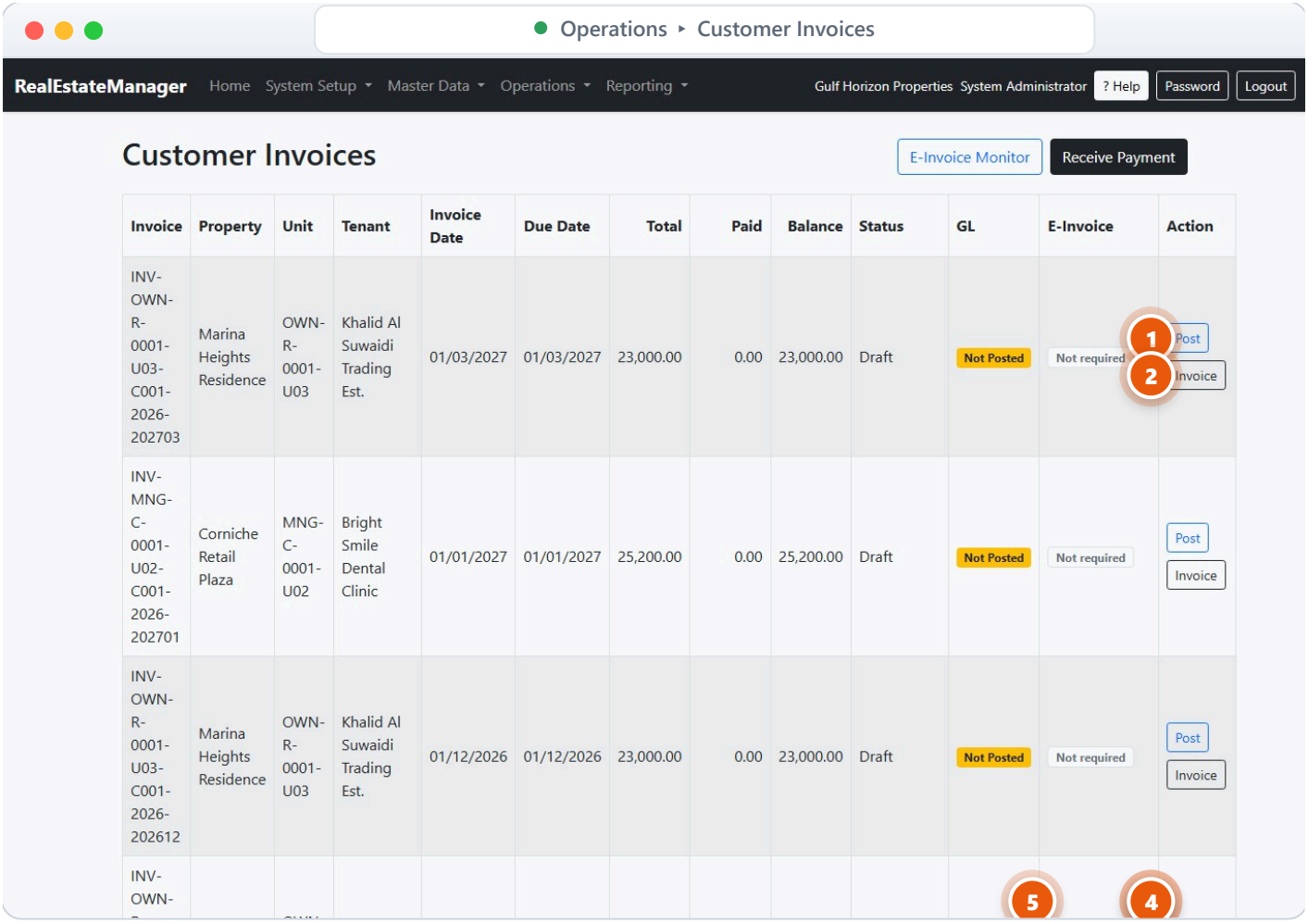
Where: **Operations** ▸ **Customer Invoices**

**Workflow step 6.** Rent invoices are created for you when the contract takes effect: when it is activated, or approved if your company requires approval. Your job on this screen is to post them when they fall due, print them for the tenant, and receive payment against them.

> **Your own property, a landlord's, or invoiced in the owner's name?**
>
> The steps on this screen are the same, but the invoice and its accounting differ. For the full walk-through of each case see Invoicing, Step by Step.

## The invoice list

The list shows the invoice number (with the tax invoice number beneath it once posted), property, unit, tenant, invoice date, due date, total, amount paid (and any amount credited), balance and status. The **GL** column says whether the invoice is in the accounts — *Posted* or *Not Posted* — and the **E-Invoice** column where it stands on the e-invoicing network. Invoices generated from a contract are numbered `INV-<contract>-<year and month>` and begin in **Draft**: they exist as documents but have not touched the ledger. Cheque charges raised from PDC Receipts (`CHG-<year>-…`) are listed here too.




Customer invoices. Draft invoices carry a Post button; posted ones can be printed, received against or credited, and show where they stand for e-invoicing.

1. Post — puts the invoice into the accounts
2. Print the tax invoice
3. Receive a payment
4. Credit note — reduce or cancel the invoice
5. E-invoice status

## Posting an invoice

1. Locate the invoice in the list.
2. Select **Post**. The journal is built and posted in one step, and the status becomes **Posted**.

The journal takes the **invoice date**, not the date you press Post. An invoice dated in a closed period cannot be posted. **Receive** and **Credit Note** appear on the row only once the invoice is posted.

To post every invoice of a month in one step, open **System Setup ▸ Closing Cockpit** and select **Issue invoices** beside *Rent invoices of the month issued* — see Period & Year Closing.

### Owned property

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | Total (rent + VAT) | — |
| `21200` Advances from Customers (unearned revenue) | — | Subtotal |
| `21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0) | — | VAT |

### Managed property, invoiced in the company's name

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | Total (rent + VAT) | — |
| `21500` Due to Landlords | — | Subtotal |
| `21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0) | — | VAT |

### Managed property, invoiced in the owner's name

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | Total (rent + VAT) | — |
| `21500` Due to Landlords | — | Subtotal |
| `21500` Due to Landlords (the VAT, the owner's to declare) | — | VAT |

> **Why invoicing does not create revenue**
> Billing and earning are different events. Issuing a rent invoice creates a receivable and an obligation to provide occupancy — not revenue. Revenue arrives month by month through Revenue Recognition, which is what keeps the Profit & Loss smooth even when a tenant is billed a year in advance.

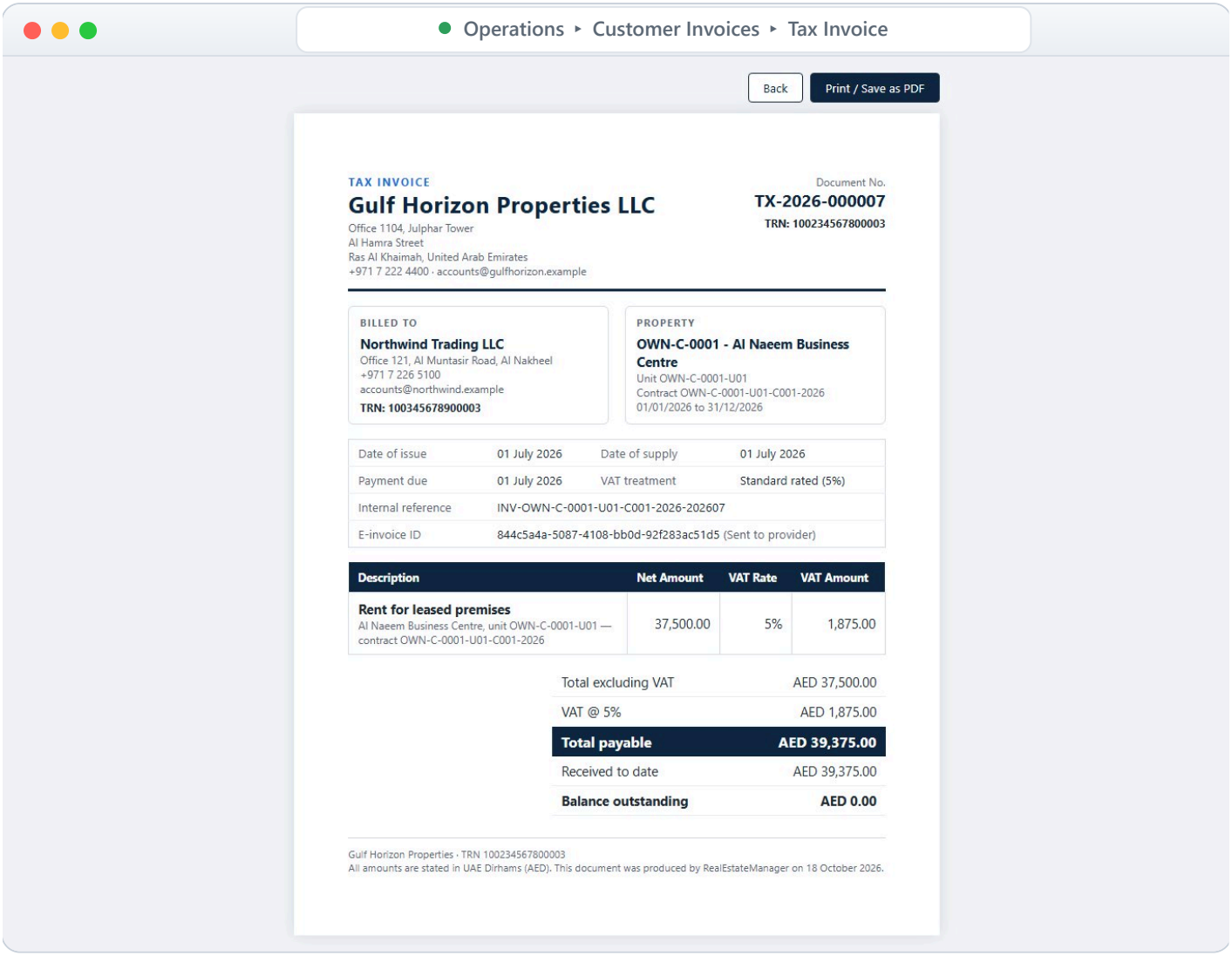
## Printing the invoice

The **Tax Invoice** button (or **Invoice**, when no VAT is charged) opens the printable document in a new tab.

| Document | When it is issued |
|---|---|
| **Full tax invoice** | VAT is charged and the tenant has a TRN on file. Shows both TRNs. |
| **Simplified tax invoice** | VAT is charged and the tenant has no TRN. |
| **Tax invoice at 0%** | A zero-rated supply. It is taxable at 0%, so it is numbered and issued as a tax invoice. |
| **Invoice** | No VAT is charged — an exempt residential letting, for example. |

Tax invoices are numbered in a **single sequence for the whole company** (`TX-<year>-…`), as UAE law requires. An invoice issued in a VAT-registered owner's name is the owner's document and is numbered in the owner's own series for the property (`OTI-<property>-<year>-…`); it shows the owner as supplier, "c/o" your company. The VAT

treatment is fixed on the invoice when it is generated, so a later change to the property or unit never rewrites an invoice already issued. Your own TRN, legal name and address come from VAT Settings.




A full tax invoice — the tenant is VAT registered, so both TRNs are shown.

## E-invoicing

The **E-Invoice** column shows where each invoice stands on the UAE e-invoicing network. Invoices to business and government tenants are queued for the E-Invoice Monitor when posted; invoices to individuals, and invoices issued in an owner's name, show *Not required*. Once an invoice has been sent to your provider its e-invoice ID also appears on the printed tax invoice.

## Receiving payment

**Receive** on an invoice row opens a customer receipt already pointing at that invoice — see Customer Receipts.

## Invoice statuses

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Draft** | Generated but not posted. No ledger impact. |
| **Posted** | Journal posted; receivable outstanding in full. |
| **PartiallyPaid** | Some payment posted; a balance remains. |
| **Paid** | Fully settled. |
| **Credited** | Fully reduced by credit notes. |
| **Cancelled** | Voided. Excluded from PDC and receipt selection. |

To reduce or cancel a posted invoice, select **Credit Note** on its row — see Credit Notes. An invoice not yet sent to your e-invoicing provider can instead be reset to draft from Journal Inquiry — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft. This is refused while receipts, cleared cheques or credit notes are posted against it, and always once the invoice has been sent.

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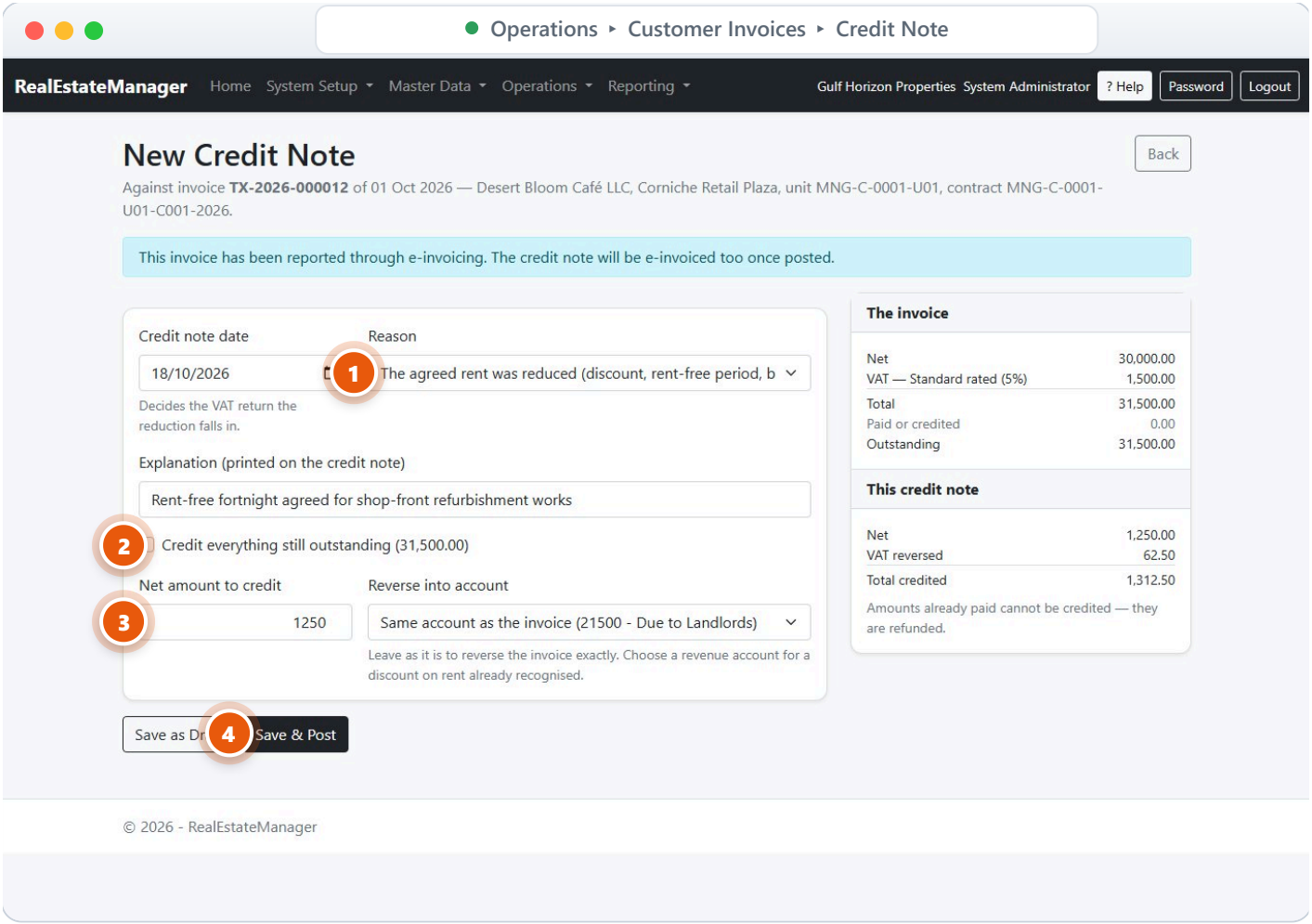
# Credit Notes

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Credit Notes**

A credit note reduces or cancels a customer invoice: a rent discount, a lease ended early, tax charged in error. Under e-invoicing it is the **only** lawful way to correct an invoice once it has been reported — invoices can no longer be edited, deleted or issued with negative amounts.

## Raising a credit note

1. In **Operations** ▸ **Customer Invoices**, select **Credit Note** on the invoice.
2. Enter the **Credit note date**. It decides which VAT return the reduction falls in.
3. Choose the **Reason** from the statutory list, and write a one-line **Explanation** — it is printed on the document.
4. Enter the **Net amount to credit**, or tick **Credit everything still outstanding**. VAT is reversed automatically at the invoice's own rate.
5. Leave **Reverse into account** as it is to undo the invoice exactly, or choose a revenue account for a discount on rent already recognised.
6. Select **Save & Post**, or **Save as Draft** to post later from **Operations** ▸ **Credit Notes**.




A credit note against one invoice: the statutory reason, the amount, and the VAT reversed automatically.

1. Reason, from the statutory list
2. Or credit everything outstanding
3. Net amount — VAT is added for you
4. Save & Post

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21200` Advances from Customers, or `21500` Due to Landlords (the account the invoice credited) | Net | — |
| `21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT was charged) | VAT | — |
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | — | Total |

## What a posted credit note changes

- The invoice's balance falls by the credit. The invoice list shows it as *credited* under the amount paid, and a fully credited invoice shows the status **Credited**.
- The VAT return for the credit note's period shows it as *Less credit notes*, reducing both the supplies and the output tax.
- The tenant's statement, in the system and in the portal, lists it as a credit.
- If the invoice was e-invoiced, the credit note is queued in the E-Invoice Monitor too. It can only be sent after the invoice it reduces.

**Only what is still owed**

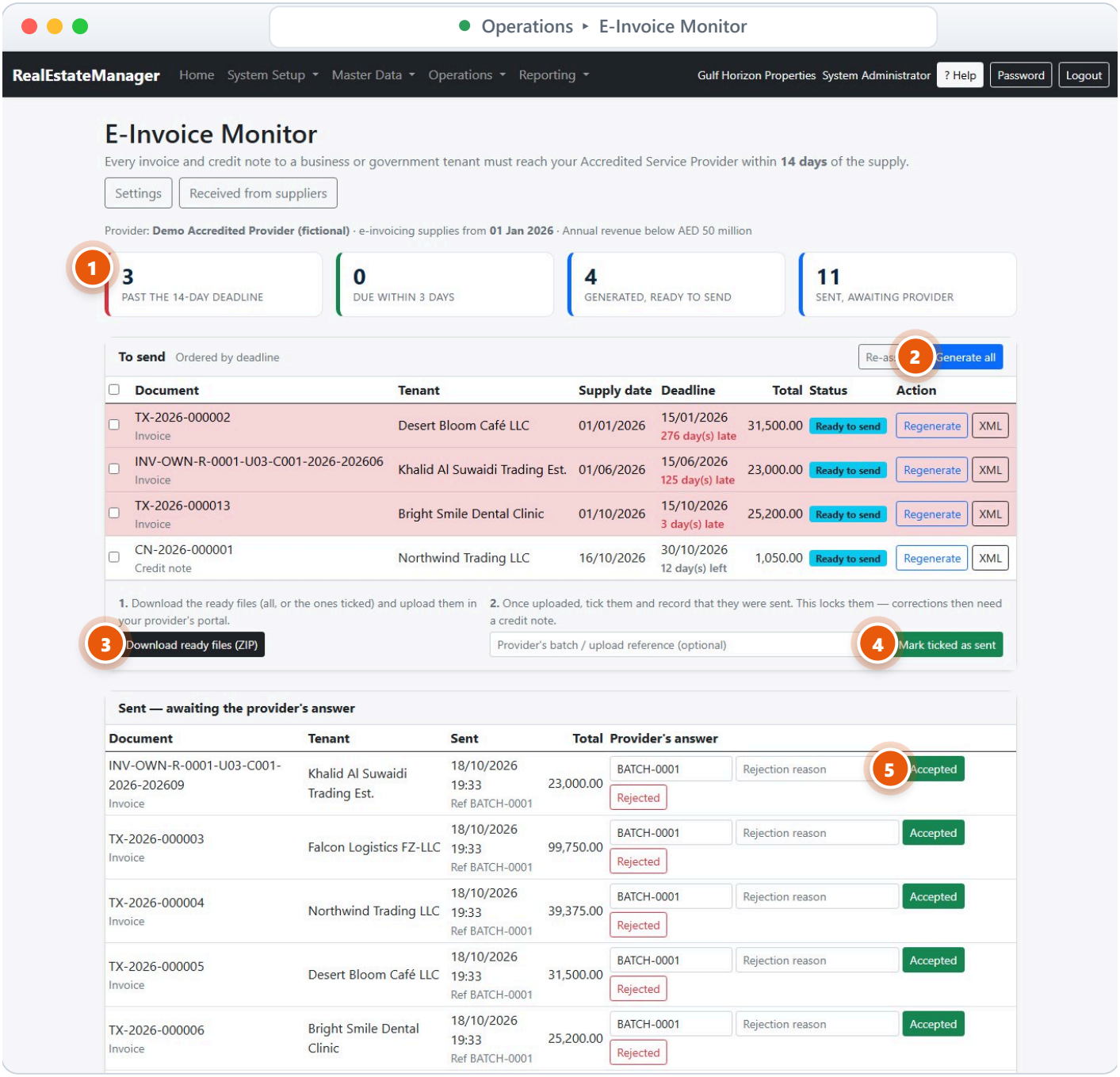
A credit note cannot exceed the invoice's outstanding balance. Money the tenant has already paid is refunded, not credited. A posted credit note can be reset to draft until it has been sent to your provider; an invoice with a posted credit note cannot be reset until the credit note is.

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# E-Invoice Monitor

Where: **Operations ▸ E-Invoice Monitor**

The work queue for e-invoicing. Every posted invoice and credit note to a business or government tenant appears here until your provider has accepted it, ordered by its **14-day deadline**: the file must reach your provider within 14 days of the supply.




The E-Invoice Monitor: every document to send, ordered by its 14-day deadline.

1. Deadlines at a glance
2. Generate all
3. Download the files for your provider
4. Record them as sent — this locks them
5. Record the provider's answer

## The daily routine

1. Post the month's invoices as usual in Customer Invoices. Those in scope arrive here as **To generate**.
2. Select **Generate all**. Each file is built and checked. Anything that cannot be generated is listed with the reason — usually a missing TIN, licence or address on the tenant — and a link to fix it.
3. Select **Download ready files (ZIP)** and upload them in your provider's portal.
4. Back here, tick the documents you uploaded, enter the provider's batch reference if it gave one, and select **Mark ticked as sent**.
5. When the provider reports back, record **Accepted** (with its reference) or **Rejected** (with its reason) under *Sent — awaiting the provider's answer*.

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Not required** | Individual tenant, e-invoicing off, or supplied before the start date. |
| **To generate** | In scope; no file produced yet. |
| **Ready to send** | File produced and checked. Download it and upload it to the provider. |
| **Sent to provider** | Handed over. Now part of the FTA's record — **locked**. |
| **Accepted** | The provider validated, delivered and reported it. Final. |
| **Rejected** | The provider refused it. Fix the cause and generate again; a fresh identifier is issued. |

> **Sent means locked**
>
> Once a document is marked as sent it can no longer be reset to draft or changed. The law allows only one correction: a credit note. Mark documents as sent only after the upload has actually happened.

## The warnings at the top

- **Past the 14-day deadline / Due within 3 days** — send these first. Late issue carries a penalty of AED 100 per invoice, up to AED 5,000 a month.
- **Draft invoices with a passed supply date** — the clock runs from the supply, not from posting, so post them promptly.
- **Setup is incomplete** — open E-Invoicing Settings for the list.

**Re-assess** re-applies the scope rules to posted documents that have not been generated yet — use it after changing a tenant's customer type.

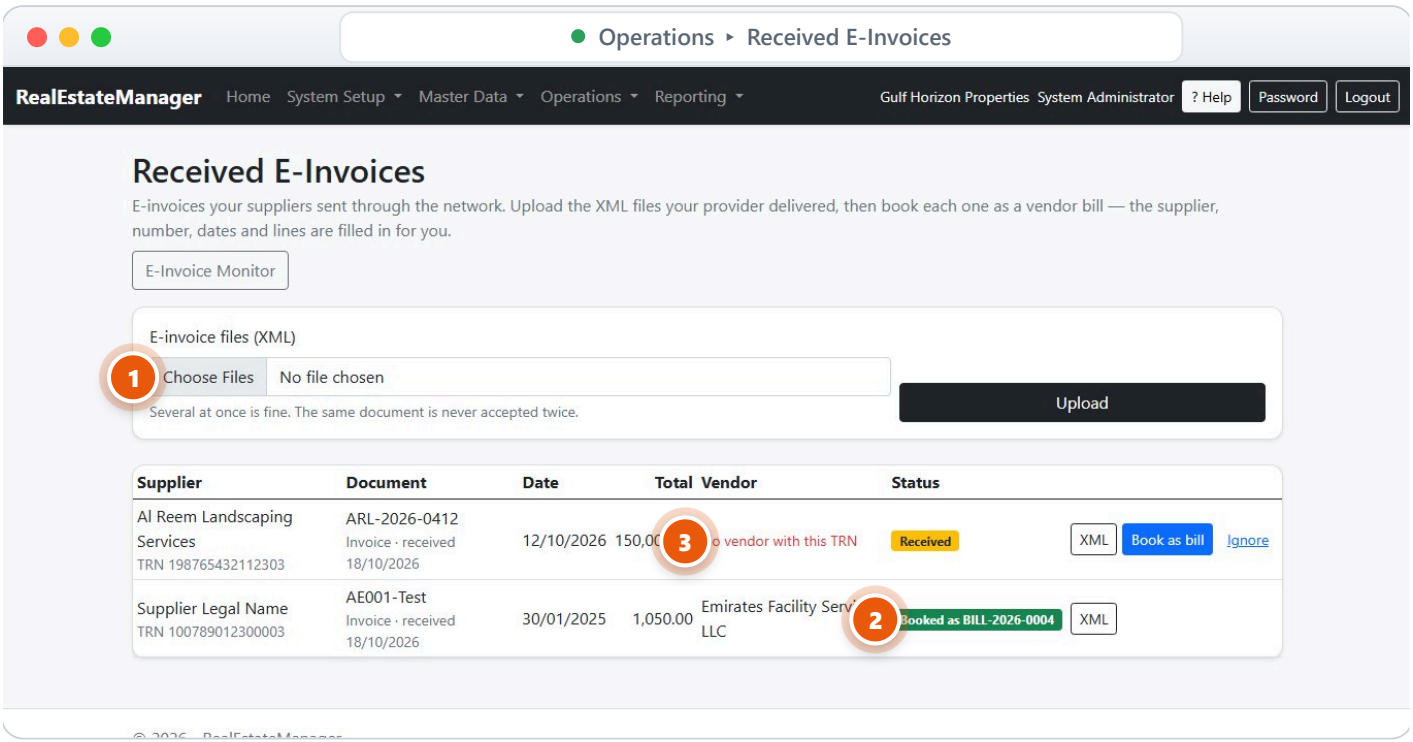
Each file is kept exactly as produced. **XML** downloads it again at any time, for your provider or an auditor; the e-invoice ID is also printed on the tax invoice.

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# Received E-Invoices

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Received E-Invoices**

Your suppliers' e-invoices arrive through your provider as XML files. Upload them here and book each one as a vendor bill without retyping it: the supplier, their invoice number, dates and lines are filled in for you.




Suppliers' e-invoices: matched to the vendor by TRN, then booked as a bill in one click.

1. Upload the files from your provider
2. Already booked as a vendor bill
3. No vendor with this TRN yet

## Receiving

1. Download the files from your provider's portal.
2. Open **Operations** ▸ **Received E-Invoices**, choose the files (several at once is fine) and select **Upload**.
3. Each file is read and matched to a vendor by **TRN**, or by **TIN** for a supplier that is not VAT registered. The same document is never accepted twice.

If no vendor matches, the file is still kept and marked *No vendor with this TRN*. Ask whoever maintains master data to set the supplier up, with their TRN or TIN, then book it.

## Booking as a bill

1. Select **Book as bill**. The vendor bill form opens with the supplier's figures shown alongside.
2. Choose the **account** for each line — the supplier cannot know how you classify their charge — and the

property it relates to.

3. Check that the totals agree with the supplier's, then save. The bill is a draft as usual; post it from Vendor Bills.

The received file is linked to the bill and kept as the evidence for your input tax claim.

**Ignore** sets aside a file you will not book — a duplicate sent by mistake, for example. It can be restored. Supplier **credit notes** are listed but not booked automatically: record them by reducing or reversing the bill they relate to.

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# Customer Receipts

Where: **Operations ▸ Customer Receipts**

**Workflow step 7.** A customer receipt records money collected from a tenant against a specific invoice — cash, bank transfer, or a cheque you are banking directly. Cheques handled through the PDC register clear themselves and do **not** need a receipt.

Video: **Posting an invoice and receiving the rent** (1:39) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## Recording a receipt

1. Select **New Receipt**, or **Receive** on the invoice in Customer Invoices.
2. Choose the **Invoice** being paid. Its outstanding balance is shown.
3. Leave the **Receipt Number** blank to have one generated, or enter your own — it must be unique within the company.
4. Enter the **Receipt Date** — the date the money actually arrived.
5. Enter the **Amount**. Part payments are allowed.
6. Choose the **Payment Method** and select **Save and Post**.

> **Save and Post puts the receipt straight into the accounts**
> The invoice and the tenant's balance go down at once. If the posting is refused - for example the period is closed - the receipt is kept as a draft and a yellow message says why; post it from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry** once that is resolved. See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

> **Only posted invoices can be received against**
> The invoice list shows posted invoices with a balance. A draft invoice is not yet a receivable, so a receipt against one is refused with *"Invoice … has not been posted yet"*. Post the invoice first; the **Receive** button on the invoice list only appears once it is posted.

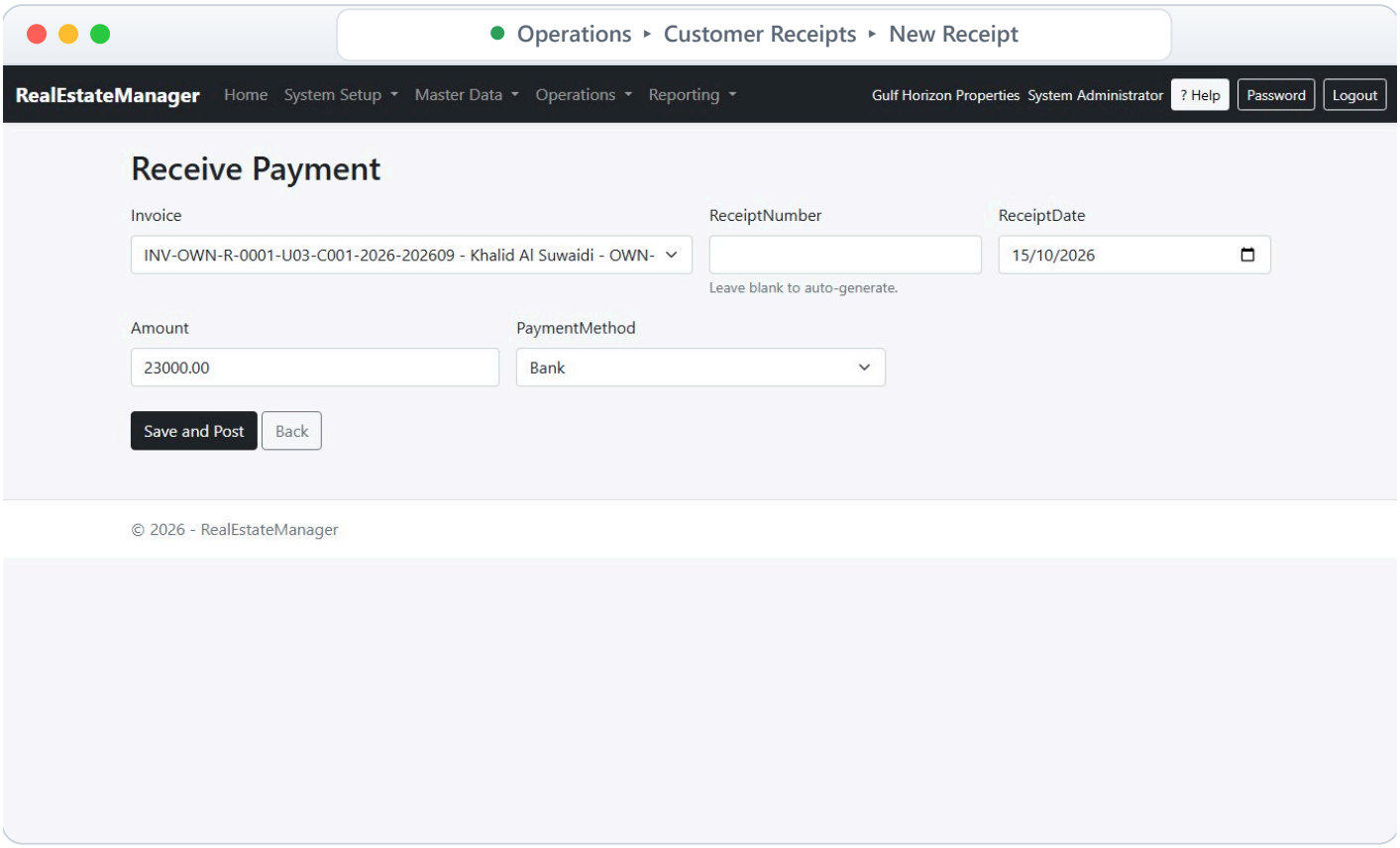
| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | Amount | — |
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | — | Amount |

## Managed property: where the money lands

For a tenant of a managed property the debit follows **Who holds the rent** on the property. Nothing is chosen on the receipt; the credit to Accounts Receivable is the same in every case.

| Who holds the rent | The receipt debits |
|---|---|
| **Company bank account** | `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents, as for an owned property. |
| **Owners' funds bank account** | `11120` Bank - Owners' Funds, or the owners' funds account kept for that landlord. |
| **Paid to the owner directly** | `21500` Due to Landlords. The tenant paid the landlord, so no company bank moves; record the receipt so the invoice is settled and the owner statement shows the rent as already paid. |

A cheque charge invoice (`CHG-…`) is the company's own income and is always received into the company's account. See Owner Settlements.




Recording a receipt against an invoice. It is saved as a draft.

## Effect on the invoice

When the receipt's journal is posted, the amount is added to the invoice's *Amount Paid* and its status moves to **PartiallyPaid** or **Paid**. Resetting the journal to draft takes it back off again.

> **One receipt, one invoice**
>
> Each receipt settles a single invoice. If a tenant pays one amount covering three invoices, enter three receipts with the same date and reference, splitting the amount. This keeps the tenant statement accurate at invoice level.

**If saving fails**

If the posting cannot be prepared — a missing account mapping, or a date in a closed period — nothing is saved and the message tells you why. You will not be left with a half-recorded receipt.

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# PDC Receipts

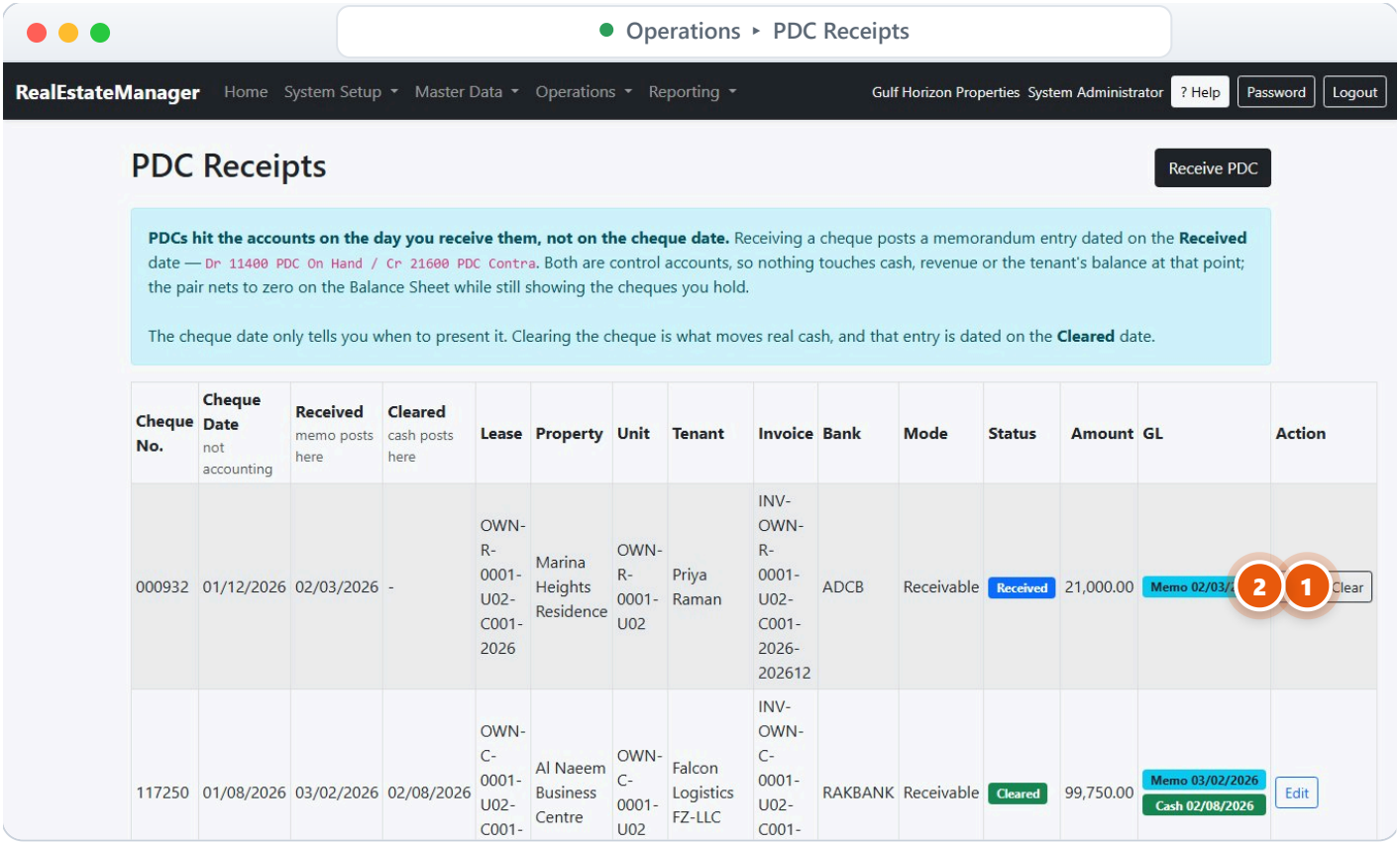
Where: **Operations** ▸ **PDC Receipts**

**Workflow step 5.** Post-dated cheques are the normal way rent is secured in the region. A PDC is a cheque you hold today that the bank will only honour on a future date. The system follows it from your drawer to the bank and on to clearance — or back to the tenant if it bounces or is withdrawn — with a journal at each step, so the cheque is visible in the accounts from the day you receive it without overstating cash.

| Step | Status | What it does |
|---|---|---|
| Receive | **On hand** (Received) | Memorandum entry; the cheque is in your drawer. |
| Deposit | **At bank** (Deposited) | Sent to the bank for collection; moves to `11450` Cheques Under Collection and **the tenant is credited**. |
| Clear | **Cleared** | The bank honoured it; the money is in the bank. |
| Bounced | **Bounced** | Returned unpaid; **charged back to the tenant**, plus any returned cheque charge. |
| Withdraw | **Withdrawn** | The tenant took it back before it was deposited; a **withdrawal charge** is invoiced to them. |

Video: **Post-dated cheques** (1:53) - watch it in the Help on screen.

> **Two dates, two different jobs**
>
> The **Received Date** is when the cheque came into your hands. The **Cheque Date** is the date written on it. The accounts record the cheque on the **received date** — that is when you hold it — not on the cheque date. The cheque date only matters when the cheque is banked.




The post-dated cheque register: received, cleared and still in hand.

1 Clear — when the bank honours the cheque

2 Edit — correct dates or cheque details

## Stage one — receiving the cheque

1. Select **New PDC** and choose the **Lease**. Only active leases are listed.
2. Choose the **Settlement Mode**:
   - **Receivable** — the cheque pays a specific invoice, which you then select. Only invoices with an outstanding balance appear.
   - **Advance** — the cheque is taken before any invoice exists and will sit as a customer advance.
3. Enter the **Cheque Number** (unique in the company) and the **Bank Name**.
4. Enter the **Received Date** — it cannot be in the future — and the **Cheque Date**, which cannot be earlier than the received date.
5. Enter the **Amount** and any **Notes**, then save.

Saving creates the memorandum journal, dated on the received date, as a **draft**. Post it from **Operations ▸ Journal Inquiry**; the cheque then shows as **Received**.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11400` PDC On Hand | Amount | — |
| `21600` PDC Contra | — | Amount |

A memorandum pair: it records custody of the cheque without touching cash or receivables. Its net effect on the balance sheet is nil.

## Correcting a cheque's details

**Edit** on a cheque lets you correct the received date, cheque date, cheque number, bank and notes — the usual fix when a cheque was keyed with the wrong date. Changing the received date re-dates the memorandum journal to match. The amount, lease and settlement mode cannot be changed here; if those are wrong, reset the journal and record the cheque again.

## Stage two — depositing the cheque to the bank

When cheques fall due, they go to the bank for collection. Select **Deposit** on a cheque, or tick several on the register, choose the date and select **Deposit to Bank** (**Tick cheques due by that date** ticks them for you). The cheque shows as **At bank**.

Depositing reverses the memorandum and credits the tenant: in Receivable mode the invoice is settled now, and the cheque appears on the tenant's statement as a payment on the deposit date.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21600` PDC Contra (reverse memo) | Amount | — |
| `11400` PDC On Hand (reverse memo) | — | Amount |
| `11450` Cheques Under Collection | Amount | — |
| `11200` Accounts Receivable (Receivable mode)<br>`21200` Advances from Customers (Advance mode) | — | Amount |

Cheques Under Collection is mapped in **System Setup** ▸ **Account Mappings** ▸ **PDC Setup**. A cheque only needs an invoice in the accounts before it is deposited, as with clearing below.

## Stage three — clearing the cheque

1. When the bank honours the cheque, select **Clear** (**Cleared** on a cheque at the bank).
2. Enter the **Cleared Date**. It cannot be earlier than the received date.
3. If the cleared date is **before the cheque date**, you are warned that a bank will not normally honour a post-dated cheque early, and asked to confirm. Confirm only if the cheque really was presented early by agreement.
4. Save, then post the clearance journal from Journal Inquiry. The cheque becomes **Cleared**.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21600` PDC Contra (reverse memo) | Amount | — |
| `11400` PDC On Hand (reverse memo) | — | Amount |
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | Amount | — |
| `11200` Accounts Receivable (Receivable mode)<br>`21200` Advances from Customers (Advance mode) | — | Amount |

That is the entry for a cheque cleared **straight from on hand**, without a deposit step. In Receivable mode, posting it also settles the invoice — its *Amount Paid* rises and its status moves to PartiallyPaid or Paid.

A cheque that was **deposited first** was credited to the tenant then, so clearing only moves it into the bank:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | Amount | — |
| `11450` Cheques Under Collection | — | Amount |

## When the bank returns a cheque — Bounced

1. On a cheque at the bank, select **Bounced**.
2. Enter the date it was returned and the bank's **reason** (insufficient funds, signature mismatch...).
3. The **charge to the tenant** starts at the company's returned cheque charge (0 for none); change it if needed.
4. Select **Record Bounce and Post**.

The amount is charged back to the tenant: in Receivable mode the invoice is open again; in Advance mode the advance is taken back. The tenant statement shows the deposit and then the *PDC Returned* line.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11200` Accounts Receivable (Receivable mode)<br>`21200` Advances from Customers (Advance mode) | Amount | — |
| `11450` Cheques Under Collection | — | Amount |

A cheque recorded as bounced without being deposited here only has its memorandum reversed — the tenant was never credited, so there is nothing to charge back.

> **A bounced cheque holds the tenant**
>
> Until it is replaced, the tenant counts as having a returned cheque: their maintenance requests are held and it shows on Tenant Health and the building view. On the bounced cheque, select **New cheque** to receive the replacement (it starts with the same lease, invoice and amount, and the old cheque becomes **Replaced**), or **Paid otherwise** when the tenant settled by cash or transfer.

## When the tenant asks for a cheque back — Withdraw

A tenant may ask to take back a cheque you hold, to pay another way or swap it. That costs the business, so the tenant is charged.

1. On a cheque **on hand**, select **Withdraw**. (A cheque already at the bank cannot be withdrawn; if the bank returns it, record it as bounced.)
2. Enter the date it was handed back and a note.
3. The **charge to the tenant** starts at the company's withdrawal charge (500 by default); type a different amount if needed, or 0 for none. The screen shows the VAT and total.
4. Select **Withdraw and Post**.

The memorandum is reversed and the cheque stays in the register as **Withdrawn**, with its charge. The rent it was for is still owed: in Receivable mode the invoice stays open. Replace it with **New cheque** or **Paid otherwise**, as for a bounced cheque.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21600` PDC Contra (reverse memo) | Amount | — |
| `11400` PDC On Hand (reverse memo) | — | Amount |

## Charges to the tenant

A withdrawal or returned cheque charge is raised as its own **tax invoice** to the tenant (numbered `CHG-yyyy-nnnnn`, described as *Cheque withdrawal charge* or *Returned cheque charge*), with 5% VAT when the company is VAT registered. It is on the tenant's statement, is collected like any invoice, and is declared on the company's VAT return as a standard-rated supply.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11200` Accounts Receivable | Amount | — |
| `43100` Other Income (or the mapped cheque charges income)<br>`21400` VAT Payable | — | Amount |

The charge is always the company's own income, issued in its own name, even for a managed property whose rent is billed in the owner's name — it is never part of what the owner is paid. The default amounts and the income account are set in **System Setup ▸ Account Mappings ▸ PDC Setup**. To undo a withdrawal or bounce that carried a charge, credit the charge invoice first.

> **The invoice must be posted before the cheque clears**
>
> In Receivable mode, clearing settles the invoice, so the invoice has to be in the accounts already. If it is still a draft, clearing is refused with "*Invoice … has not been posted yet*". Post the invoice, then clear the cheque. You can still *receive* a cheque against a draft invoice — the memorandum entry does not touch the receivable.

## Validation rules

- Cheque number must be unique within the company.
- Amount must be greater than zero.
- In Receivable mode an invoice is required, it must belong to the selected lease, and the cheque cannot exceed the invoice's outstanding balance.
- A cheque cannot be cleared twice, and a bounced, withdrawn or replaced cheque cannot be cleared.
- Only a cheque on hand can be deposited or withdrawn; only one at the bank (or on hand) can bounce.
- No step can be dated in the future, or before the step it follows.
- Each step's journal can be reset only in reverse order: reset a clearance or bounce before the deposit, and the deposit before the receipt.

## PDC statuses

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Draft** | Saved; memorandum journal not yet posted. |
| **Received** (on hand) | Memorandum posted; the cheque is in your custody. |
| **Deposited** (at bank) | Sent to the bank for collection; in Cheques Under Collection and credited to the tenant. |
| **Cleared** | Clearance posted; the money is in the bank. |
| **Bounced** | Returned unpaid by the bank and charged back to the tenant; waiting to be replaced. |
| **Withdrawn** | Handed back to the tenant at their request, with a charge; waiting to be replaced. |
| **Replaced** | A bounced or withdrawn cheque the tenant has since replaced or paid otherwise. |

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# Security Deposits

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Security Deposits**

A security deposit is money you hold on the tenant's behalf and expect to return at the end of the lease. It is never income. The system records it as a liability from the moment it is received.

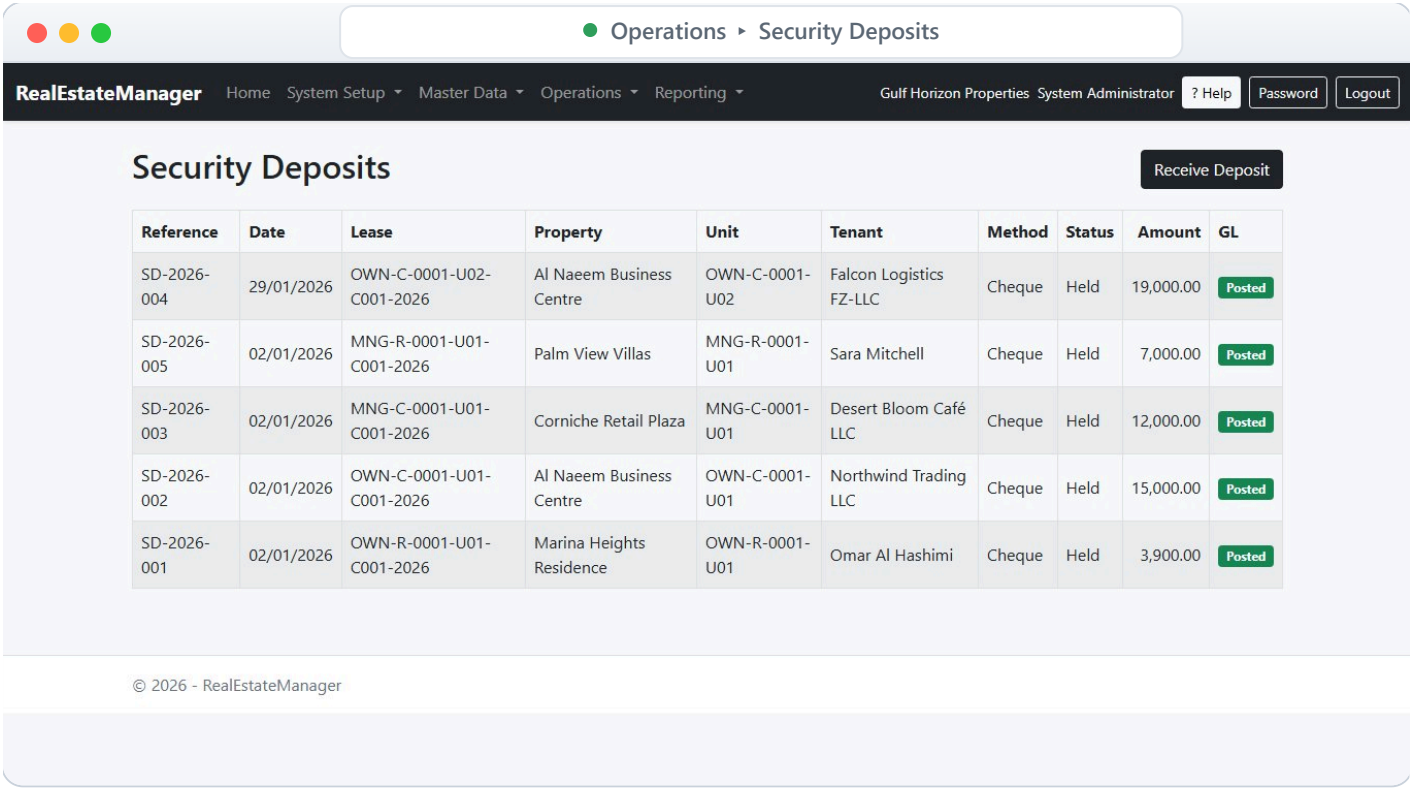
## Recording a deposit

1. Select **Receive Deposit** and choose the **Lease**.
2. Leave the **Reference Number** blank to have one generated, and enter the **Receipt Date** and the **Payment Method**.
3. Enter the **Amount** — normally the deposit agreed on the lease. Leave **Status** as *Held*.
4. Select **Save and Post**. The deposit is posted straight away. If a check refuses it — a closed period, for example — it is kept as a draft and a message gives the reason; post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** once resolved.

The list shows each deposit with its status — *Held*, *Applied*, *Refunded* or *Forfeited* — and whether it is posted. On a managed property the deposit is still held by the company.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | Amount | — |
| `21300` Tenant Security Deposits | — | Amount |

> **Never treat a deposit as rent**
>
> Recording a deposit as a customer receipt would reduce the tenant's receivable and eventually show as revenue. Always use this screen. At the end of the lease, refund or forfeit the deposit with a manual journal that debits `21300`.




Security deposits held, each a liability until refunded or forfeited.

## Releasing a deposit at lease end

| Situation | Manual journal to post |
|---|---|
| Refunded in full | Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash |
| Forfeited to cover damages | Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `43100` Other Income |
| Applied against unpaid rent | Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable |

The draft tenancy contract's **Schedule of Charges** sets out what may be deducted from the deposit, which is your basis for a forfeiture — see Lease Contracts.

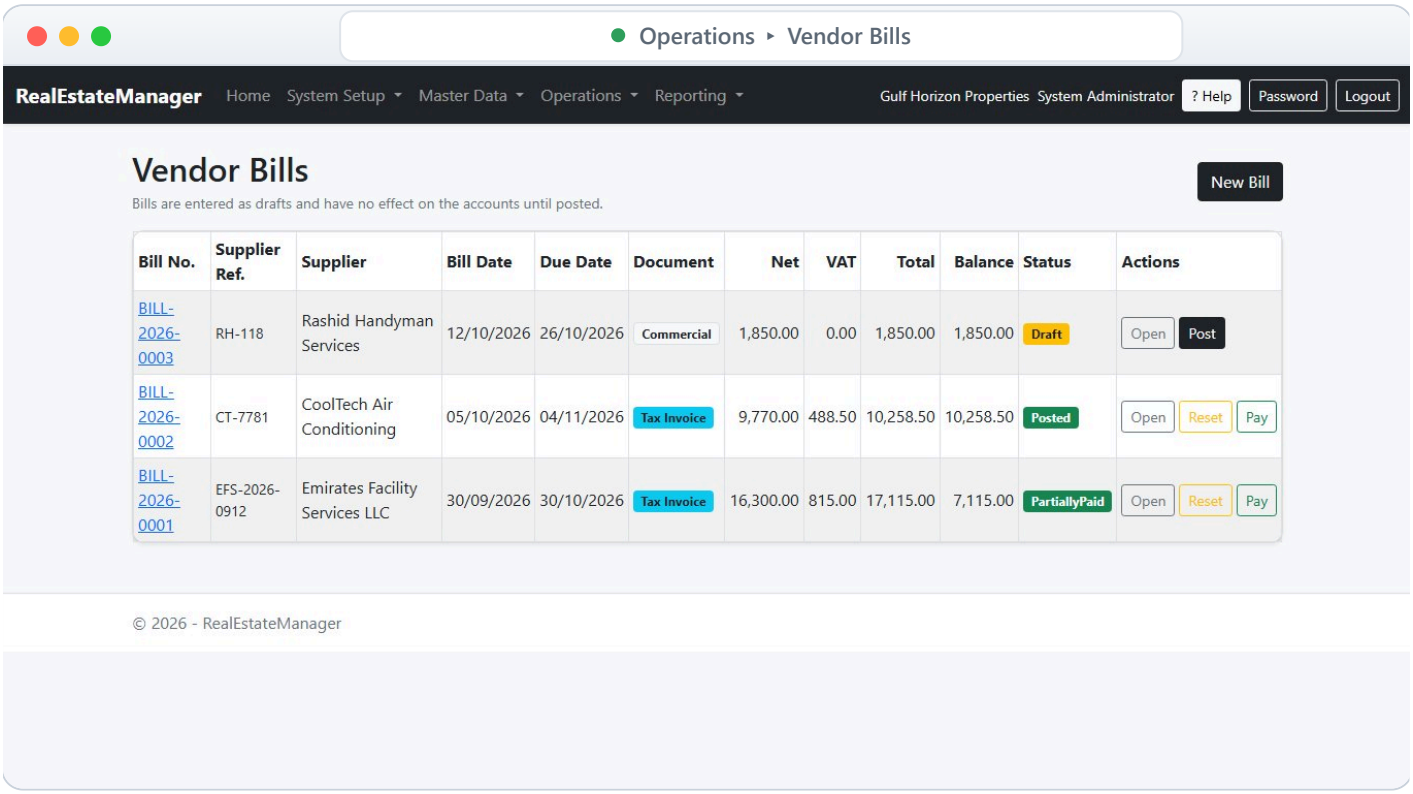
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# Vendor Bills

Where: **Operations ▸ Vendor Bills**

A vendor bill records a cost you have incurred and the obligation to pay the supplier. Bills are entered the way Odoo does it: a header for the supplier and the dates, and as many lines as the supplier's document has, each charged to its own account and property.

Video: **Entering a supplier bill and paying it** (1:54) - watch it in the Help on screen.



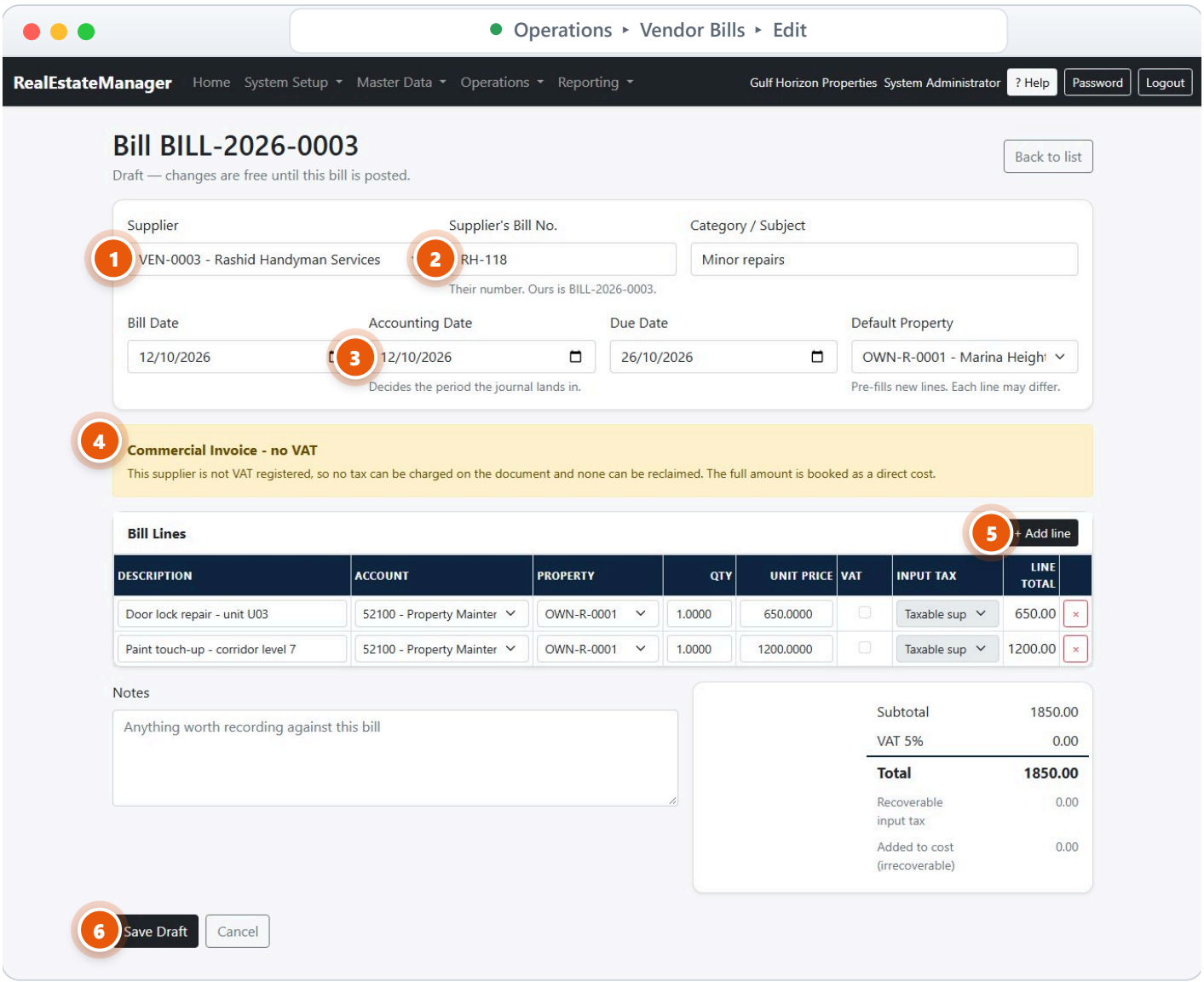

Vendor bills: tax invoices and commercial invoices, drafts and posted.

A supplier that sends **e-invoices** needs no retyping: upload the file in Received E-Invoices and choose **Book as bill**. The form below opens with their number, dates and lines filled in.

## Entering a bill

1. Select **New Bill** and choose the **Supplier**. A coloured banner immediately tells you whether this supplier can charge VAT (see below).
2. Enter the **Supplier's Bill No.** — the number printed on their invoice. Your own bill number, such as `BILL-2026-0001`, is issued when you save.
3. Enter a **Category / Subject** to describe the bill on lists, e.g. *Building maintenance*.
4. Enter the **Bill Date** (the date on their document), the **Accounting Date** and the **Due Date**.

5. Optionally choose a **Default Property**. New lines pick it up automatically.
6. For a building under construction, choose the project and cost category in the box under each line's **Property**. The line is then charged to the project's work-in-progress account — see Development Projects.
7. Fill in the **lines**: description, account, property, quantity, unit price, and for a VAT-registered supplier whether the line is taxable and its input tax attribution. **+ Add line** adds a row and **×** removes one. Totals update as you type.
8. Add any **Notes** and select **Save Draft**.
9. Review the bill, then select **Post**.




A draft bill from a supplier who is not VAT registered: no VAT anywhere, and the full amount is a cost.

1. Supplier — decides whether VAT applies
2. The supplier's own bill number
3. Accounting date — the period it lands in
4. Tax invoice or commercial invoice
5. Add a line
6. Save Draft

> **Bill date and accounting date**
> They are usually the same. They differ when a supplier's document arrives after its month has been closed: keep the supplier's date as the **bill date**, and set the **accounting date** in the open period. The accounting date decides which period the journal lands in.

## Reading a scanned invoice

Instead of typing a supplier's invoice, scan or photograph it:

1. On **New Vendor Bill**, use **Read a scanned invoice** at the top: choose the PDF, JPG or PNG (up to 10 MB) and select **Read invoice**. Reading takes up to a minute.
2. The bill form opens filled in: the **supplier** (found by its TRN, otherwise by name), their invoice number, dates, and each line's **description, quantity and unit price**, with VAT per line. Each line gets the account this supplier's earlier bills usually went to.
3. A blue panel shows the invoice's own net, VAT and total to compare with, and any warnings: no supplier matched, lines not adding up to the subtotal (a discount or a misread line), another currency, VAT charged by a supplier not set up as VAT registered.
4. Check every field against the document, choose any missing account, and **Save Draft**.

Nothing is saved until you save. When no supplier matches, create the vendor first. The same reading is available in the AI Assistant with its paperclip button.

## Charging a line to the owner of a managed property

Tick **Charge to owner** under a line's property, and choose the kind of cost, to pass that cost on to the property's owner instead of keeping it as our expense — as a recharge with 5% VAT or as a disbursement with no VAT, as chosen in VAT Settings. The property must be a managed property. See Costs passed on to owners.

## VAT is decided by the supplier

| Supplier | What happens on the bill |
|---|---|
| **VAT registered** with a TRN | Blue banner: *Tax Invoice — 5% VAT applies*. Taxable lines get 5% VAT, calculated for you. |
| **Not** registered | Amber banner: *Commercial Invoice — no VAT*. The VAT controls switch off, no VAT is calculated anywhere, and the full amount is charged to cost. |

The supplier's registration is set on the vendor record — see Vendors. It is copied onto the bill when you save, so a later change to the vendor never alters a bill already entered.

## Input tax attribution, line by line

How much of the VAT you can reclaim depends on what the cost was for. Set it on each line:

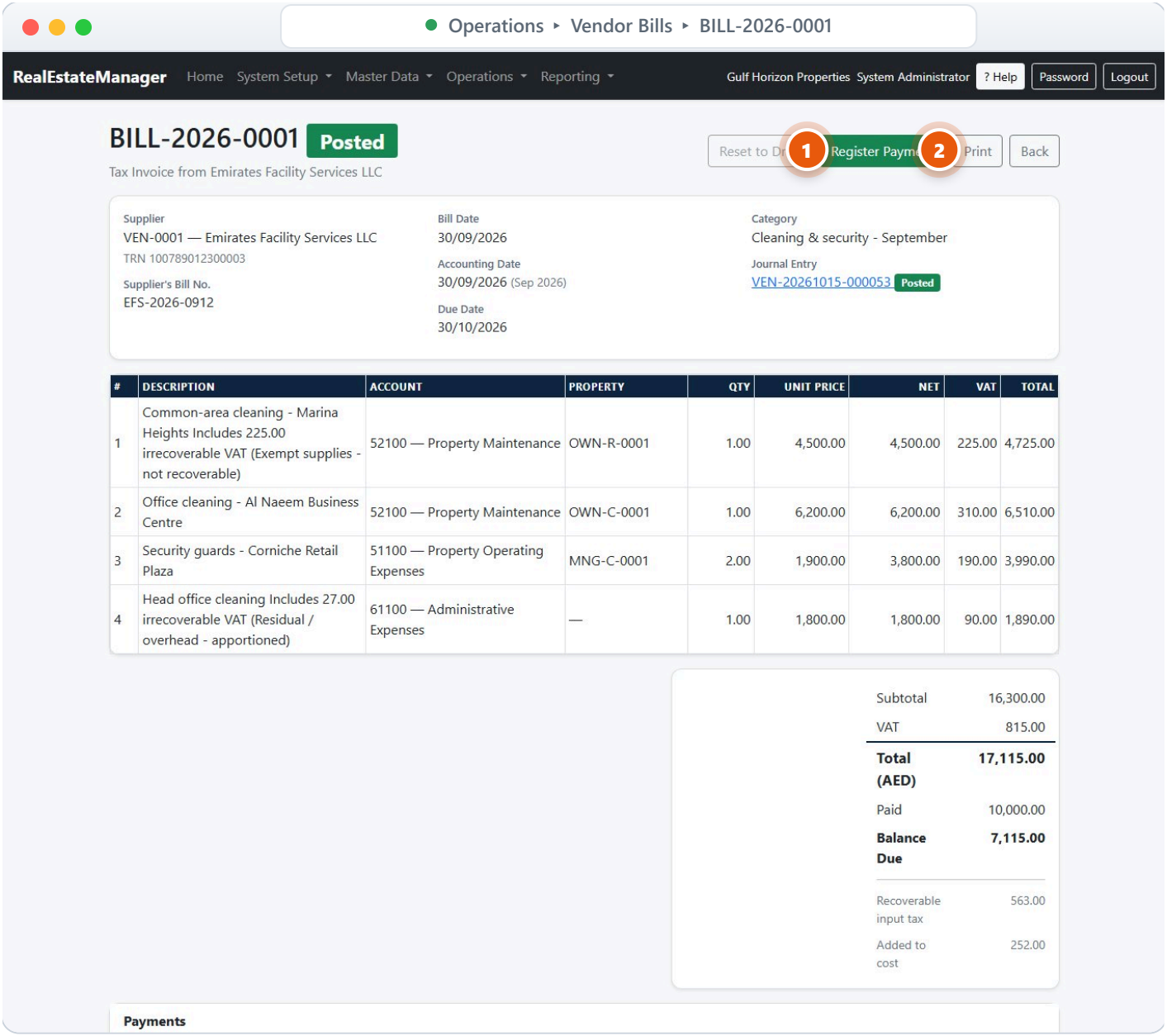
| Attribution | Use for | Result |
|---|---|---|
| **Taxable** | Costs of commercial (standard-rated) property | VAT reclaimed in full. |
| **Exempt** | Costs of residential lettings | None reclaimed; the VAT is added to the cost of that line. |
| **Residual** | Overheads serving both, e.g. head office | Split by the provisional recovery rate in VAT Settings, corrected at year end. |

Because attribution is per line, one supplier invoice covering a commercial tower and a residential block is handled correctly: one line reclaims, the other does not.

## The journal

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Each line's own account, tagged with that line's property | **Line net + any irrecoverable VAT** | — |
| `11300` VAT Recoverable (only if any) | **Total recoverable VAT** | — |
| `21100` Accounts Payable | — | **Bill total** |

VAT you cannot reclaim is never shown on its own line. It is part of what the item cost, so it is added to the line it belongs to.




A posted multi-line tax invoice, partly paid. Irrecoverable VAT is shown on the line it belongs to.

1. Register a payment
2. Print with letterhead and sign-off strip

## Draft, post and reset

- A **draft** bill can be edited freely and has no effect on the accounts.
- **Post** builds the journal from the current lines and posts it, subject to the closed-period rules.
- **Reset to Draft** takes it back out of the accounts so it can be edited, then posted again. This is refused if the period is closed or a payment has been posted against the bill.

See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

## Printing

**Print** on the bill produces an A4 document with your letterhead, the supplier and bill details, the lines, the totals and a signature strip for *Prepared by / Checked by / Approved by*. If the supplier is not VAT registered, the printed copy says so.

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# Vendor Payments

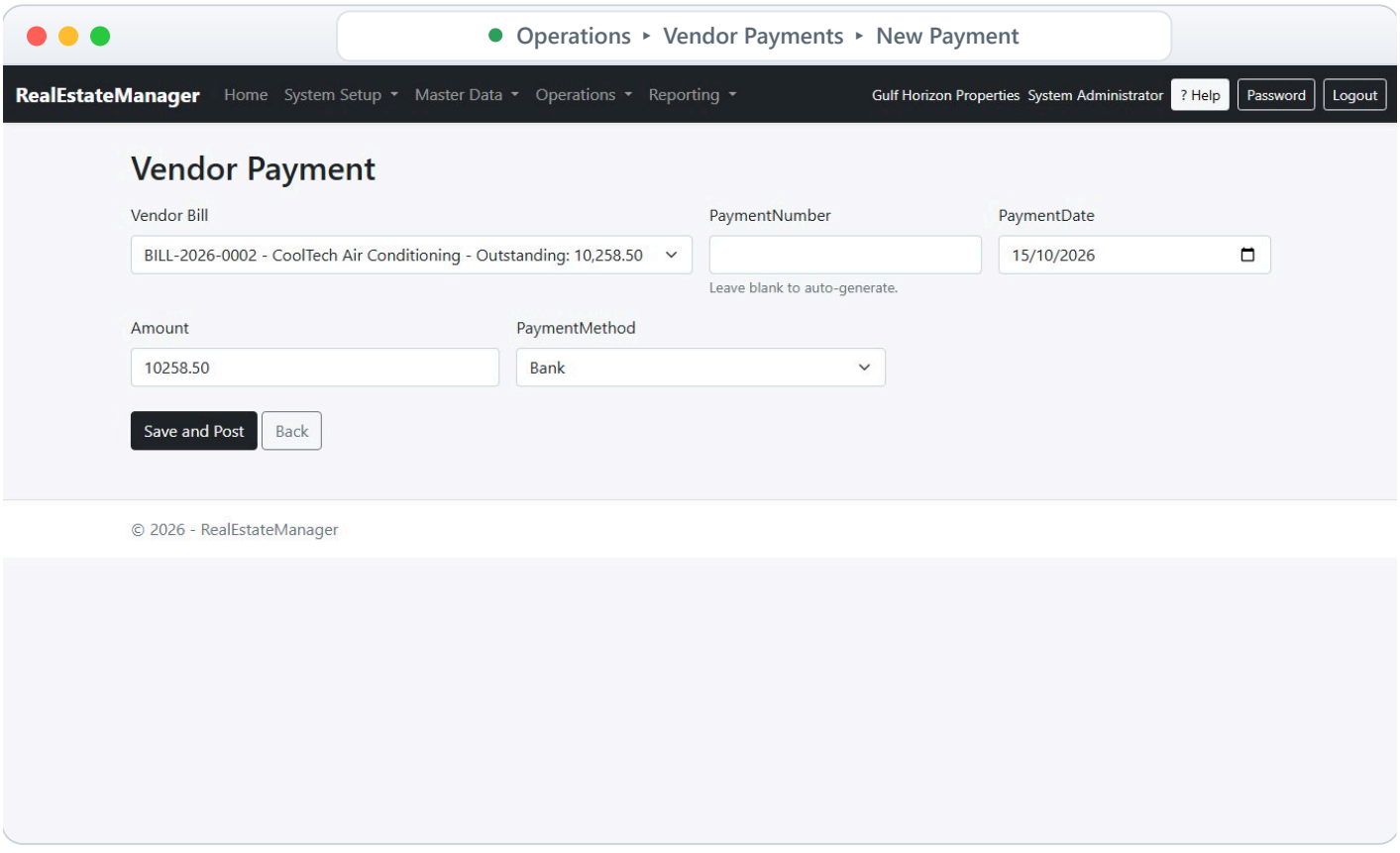
Where: **Operations** ▸ **Vendor Payments**

Operations ▸ Vendor Payments

Money paid to a supplier always settles specific bills. Each settlement gets a **clearing document** number, and money paid before there is a bill — an **advance** — is kept on its own account until it is applied to bills. The list shows every payment with its type, clearing document, the bills it settled and its status.

## Paying bills

1. Select **New Vendor Payment**, or **Register Payment** on a posted vendor bill.
2. **1. Vendor**: choose the supplier. Their posted bills with something still open are listed.
3. **2. Payment type**: leave it on **Pay open bills**.
4. **3. Open items**: tick the bills to pay. **Pay now** starts at each bill's full open amount; lower it for a part payment.
5. **4. Payment details**: the **Payment date**, the bank or cash account it is **Paid from**, the **Method** (bank, cheque, cash or transfer) and the cheque or transfer reference. The payment number is given automatically.
6. Check **Total to pay** and select **Save and Post**.




Paying a posted bill. Only posted bills are offered.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21100` Accounts Payable (one line per bill) | Amount | — |
| The account paid from | — | Amount |

The payment receives a clearing document number (`CLR-year-…`). A bill paid in full becomes **Paid** and shows the clearing document that settled it; a part-paid bill becomes **PartiallyPaid** and stays open for the balance. Select a payment in the list to see the bills it settled.

> **Only posted bills can be paid**
> A draft bill is not offered: it has not been added to Accounts Payable, so there is nothing to pay off. Post the bill first. A payment must settle at least one open bill — money paid before there is a bill is an advance.

## Paying an advance (down payment)

1. Select **Pay an advance** — or choose **Advance (down payment)** as the payment type.
2. Choose the vendor and enter the **Amount**.
3. Enter the payment details and select **Save and Post**.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11550` Advances to Suppliers (tagged with the vendor) | Advance | — |
| The account paid from | — | Advance |

The advance is an asset, not a reduction of Accounts Payable, so what you owe suppliers is never understated by advances that have not been billed yet. The list shows how much of each advance is still open.

## Applying an advance to bills

When the supplier's bills arrive and are posted:

1. Select **Apply advance to bills**, or **Apply to bills** on the advance itself.
2. Choose the vendor and the **Advance to apply**, and the **Clearing date**.
3. Under **Open bills**, enter how much of each bill to **Settle from advance**.
4. Select **Apply and Post**.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21100` Accounts Payable (one line per bill) | Applied | — |
| `11550` Advances to Suppliers | — | Applied |

No money moves; the application gets its own clearing document number. Pay any remainder of the bills with a normal payment. A contractor's mobilisation advance recovered over several progress bills is applied part by part,

as each bill is certified.

> **VAT on an advance**
>
> If the supplier issues a *tax invoice* for the advance, record it as a vendor bill — so its input VAT is recovered — and pay that bill. Use the advance function for advances without a tax invoice.

## When payment approval is on

The payment waits under **Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals** and shows *Awaiting approval / draft* in the list until someone whose authority covers it releases it. Meanwhile its amounts are held against the bills, so they cannot be paid twice. See Payment Approvals & Limits.

## Corrections

- Reset the payment or the advance application to draft from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**: the bills reopen and an advance's open amount is restored. Post again when corrected.
- An advance that has been applied cannot be reset until its applications are reset.
- A bill settled by a payment or an advance cannot be reset to draft until those are reset first.

## Month-end checks

- `11550` Advances to Suppliers in the Trial Balance equals the open advances on the vendor statements.
- Accounts Payable equals the open bill balances of all vendors.
- Review advances that have been open for long: apply them, or chase the supplier.

To see everything billed by and paid to one supplier, with their advances, use **Reporting** ▸ **Vendor Statement**.

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# Development Projects

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Development Projects**

Operations ▸ Development Projects

A **development project** is a building under construction. Until it is complete, everything it costs — land, design, permits, contractors, supervision, borrowing costs — is collected in one asset account and stays on the balance sheet. Nothing is charged to profit and loss while the building is being built.

## Where the cost is collected depends on what the building is for

| Intended use | Account | Standard | On completion it becomes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **For sale** | `13100` Properties Under Development - For Sale | IAS 2 Inventories | Completed units held for sale; cost of sales when each unit is sold |
| **For rental** | `15500` Investment Property Under Construction | IAS 40 Investment Property | Investment property (cost or fair value model) |
| **Own use** | `15600` Capital Work in Progress | IAS 16 Property, Plant and Equipment | A fixed asset, depreciated |

Choose the main use. A building that will be partly sold and partly rented is split between the two on completion.

## Setting up a project

1. Record the plot as an **Owned** property in **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**, with its title deed and building permit.
2. Select **New Project**. Enter the name, choose the property, the intended use (the account follows it), the main contractor and the dates.
3. Enter the **budget** for each cost category and save. The project is numbered DEV-0001, DEV-0002 and so on.

## Recording costs

Every cost line carries the project and a **cost category**. The project's cost to date is read from the posted ledger lines that carry it, so it always agrees with the balance sheet.

- **Supplier invoices** (contractor certificates, consultants): enter a vendor bill and, on each line, choose the project and category in the box under *Property*. The line's account switches to the project's account by itself. Irrecoverable VAT, if any, becomes part of the project cost.
- **Everything else** — land paid from the bank, a plot contributed by the shareholders, authority fees — use **Record a Cost without a Supplier Bill** on the project page. Choose the account it is paid from or moved from. It is posted straight away.

- **Adjustments**: a manual journal line can carry a project too, but only on the project's own account.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `13100` / `15500` / `15600` the project's account | Cost | — |
| Accounts Payable, bank, share capital, or the account chosen | — | Cost |

> **What belongs in project cost - and what does not**
> Only costs *directly* needed to bring the building to completion: land and its transfer fees, design, permits, construction, infrastructure and utility connections, supervision, and borrowing costs on money borrowed to build it while it is being built (IAS 23). Marketing, sales commissions, show-flat running costs, general overheads and abnormal waste are expenses of the period, not project cost.

## Following the project

The project page shows the budget, cost to date, remaining budget and percentage spent; budget against actual for each category; and the **cost ledger** — every posted cost with its date, source, supplier and category. Draft bills or journals tagged to the project are flagged until they are posted. On the project list, an amount posted to a development account *without* a project is shown as *Not in any project* so it can be corrected.

## Project status

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Planning** | Set up with its budget; nothing spent yet. |
| **Under construction** | Select **Start Construction** on the project page. Recording the first cost does this too. |
| **Completed** | The completion certificate has been entered. Costs can now be transferred. |
| **Cancelled** | Abandoned before anything was recorded against it. |

## Completion

When the completion certificate is issued, enter its date and number under **Completion**. The date is copied to the property record, where it starts the VAT window below. Late invoices and retention releases can still be tagged to a completed project.

## Transfer on completion

Once the project is complete, its cost leaves work in progress for where each unit now belongs. First add the building's units, with their areas, to the project's property (**Master Data** ▸ **Units**). Then, on the project page:

1. Under **Transfer on Completion**, check the units, their areas and their share of the cost.
2. Choose what each unit is for — **for sale**, **for rental** or **own use**. A mixed building simply has units of

different kinds. *Set every unit to* changes them all at once.

3. Enter the transfer date and, for rental and own-use units, the building's **useful life** in years.
4. Select **Transfer and Post**. It is posted at once and cannot be reset to draft.

The cost is shared by area. The *Land and acquisition costs* category is kept apart from everything else (the building), so land is never depreciated:

| Unit for | Debited to | Afterwards |
|---|---|---|
| **Sale** | `13200` Completed Properties Held for Sale, one line per unit at its cost | Inventory at cost until the unit is sold |
| **Rental** | `15100` Investment Property, land and building on separate lines | Cost model: the building part is entered in the fixed asset register and depreciated monthly to `15150`; land is not depreciated. See Investment Property Note |
| **Own use** | `15200` Fixed Assets, land and building on separate lines | The building part is depreciated monthly to `15300`; land is not |

The project's work-in-progress account is credited with the whole amount. The project page then shows the transfer, each unit's land, building and total cost, and links to the building's record in the fixed asset register. Depreciation starts in the month of the transfer. If a late invoice arrives after the transfer, a second transfer moves the remainder the same way.

> **VAT on a new residential building**
>
> The first sale or first lease of each new residential unit, made within **three years of completion**, is zero rated; later supplies of residential units are exempt. That is why input VAT on a residential project is normally entered as *Taxable* (recoverable) on the supplier bills. If the building is kept and rented out, the later exempt leases reduce that recovery over the following years under the Capital Assets Scheme — confirm the treatment of each project with your tax adviser.

## The Project Costs & WIP report

**Reporting** ▸ **Project Costs & WIP** shows what each development project has cost as at a date. Choose **As at** and either *All projects (summary)* or one project, then **Show**.

| Section | What it shows |
| --- | --- |
| **1. Cost by project** | Budget, supplier bills net of VAT, VAT taken into cost, other costs, cost to date, VAT recovered, amounts transferred out, the WIP balance, what is committed in draft bills, the budget left and what is still unpaid to suppliers. |
| **2. WIP reconciliation** | The WIP account's balance in the ledger against the sum of the projects' WIP balances. A difference is explained by postings not tagged to a project, which are listed so you can tag them. |
| **3. Budget against cost, by category** | Posted, committed and left for each budget category. |
| **4. Spend by month** | Posted cost each month and cumulatively. |
| **5. Contractors, subcontractors and suppliers** | Per vendor: bills, net, VAT in cost, total billed, paid and unpaid. |
| **6. Bills charged to the project** | Each bill with its status; drafts count as committed. |

Only the lines of a bill that belong to the project are counted, and payments on a bill are shared across its lines in proportion. A difference that untagged postings do not explain usually comes from an opening balance entered on the WIP account itself: give it to a project with a manual journal.

## Cancelling a project

A project can be cancelled only while nothing is recorded against it. An abandoned project's costs must first be written off with a journal.

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# Unit Sales

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Unit Sales**

Operations ▸ Unit Sales

Selling units — completed or off plan — with a sale and purchase agreement, a payment plan, the buyer's payments and the **handover**. Revenue is recognised **at handover**: until then, everything the buyer pays is held as an advance.

## Signing a contract

1. Add the buyer to the customer register first (**Master Data** ▸ **Tenants**), with their Emirates ID or passport and, for a company, its TRN.
2. Select **New Sale Contract**. Choose the unit, the buyer, the contract date and the **sale price before VAT**. The VAT treatment appears at once, with the reason.
3. Enter the **payment plan** — up to six instalments with due dates, amounts including VAT — or leave it empty for one payment of the full price. *Split 20 / 30 / 30 / 20* fills a typical off-plan plan. The plan must add up to the price including VAT.
4. Select **Sign Contract**. It is numbered SPA-year-0001; the unit becomes *Reserved*.

## The VAT treatment

| Unit | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Commercial (standard rated unit or property) | Standard rated, 5% |
| Residential, the unit's **first** supply, within three years of completion — or before completion (off plan) | Zero rated |
| Residential, any later supply (resale, or sold after it was first let) | Exempt |

A building is treated as new when its property has a completion date or a development project. The decision and its reason are kept on the contract, and the sale is recorded as the unit's first supply. See Real Estate VAT.

## Recording the buyer's payments

On the contract page, under **Record a Payment**, enter the date, amount (including VAT), method and the bank account. It is posted at once. The payment plan shows each instalment as paid, part paid, due or overdue.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| *Before handover* | | |
| `11100` Bank | Amount | — |
| `21250` Advances from Unit Buyers | — | Price part |
| `21400` VAT Payable — standard-rated sales only | — | VAT part |
| *After handover* | | |
| `11100` Bank | Amount | — |
| `11250` Receivable from Unit Buyers | — | Amount |

On a standard-rated sale, VAT is due when each payment is received, so each payment before handover gets a number from the tax invoice series (TX-year-…).

## Handover

The unit must have its cost in `13200` Completed Properties Held for Sale — that is, its development project is complete and the unit was transferred *for sale*. Enter the handover date and, if known, the buyer's new title deed number, and select **Hand over**:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21250` Advances from Unit Buyers | Advances received | — |
| `11250` Receivable from Unit Buyers | Unpaid balance with its VAT | — |
| `41200` Revenue from Sale of Properties | — | Sale price |
| `21400` VAT Payable | — | VAT on the unpaid balance |
| `51200` Cost of Properties Sold | Unit's cost | — |
| `13200` Completed Properties Held for Sale | — | Unit's cost |

The unit becomes *Sold*; the contract page shows revenue, cost of sales and gross profit, and **Print statement** prints the buyer's statement: the price, the payment plan and every payment received. Payments and the handover cannot be reset to draft — a correction is a journal.

## Cancelling

A contract can be cancelled only while nothing has been paid; the unit becomes available again. If the buyer has paid, agree the refund or forfeiture and record it with a journal first.

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# Owner Settlements

Where: **Operations ▸ Owner Settlements**

Operations ▸ Owner Settlements

For a **managed** property we collect the rent on the landlord's behalf. The landlord is owed that rent less our commission and the VAT on it. An **owner settlement** is the payment of that money to the landlord, in full or in part, with a settlement advice to hand over.

## How the amount owed is worked out

| | |
|---|---|
| Rent billed to the tenants up to the statement date (before VAT, after credit notes) | A |
| Less: our commission at the property's *Commission %* | (B) |
| Less: 5% VAT on that commission (when your company is VAT registered) | (V) |
| **Owner's share** | **A − B − V** |
| Less: settlements already paid to the owner | (C) |
| **Balance payable to the owner** | **A − B − V − C** |

Only posted invoices, credit notes, receipts and cleared cheques count. VAT charged to the tenants is never part of the owner's money — it is paid to the FTA. The statement also shows the **total rent of each agreement** for its full term, for reference.

Next to the balance you see **Available from collections**: the owner's share of rent the tenants have actually *paid*, less what was already settled. That is the cash you hold for the owner. You may pay more, up to the full balance, but the difference is an advance of rent the tenant still owes you.

## VAT on our commission: the monthly commission tax invoice

Our commission is a service we supply to the landlord — property management. It is **standard rated at 5%** even when the rent itself is exempt residential rent: the exemption covers the lease between landlord and tenant, not our fee. So every month each landlord receives a tax invoice from us for the commission plus VAT, and that amount is taken from the rent we collected for them.

1. Post the month's revenue recognition first (**System Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition**). That is what moves the month's commission into Management Fee Revenue.
2. Open **Operations ▸ Owner Settlements**. Under **Commission Tax Invoices** the month just ended is offered, with the commission waiting to be invoiced per owner. Choose another **Month ending** and select **Check** if needed.
3. Select **Issue Commission Invoices**. One invoice per landlord is created, dated the month end, with a number from your tax invoice series (TX-year-..., the same series as tenant invoices), and posted straight away.

4. Select **Invoice** on any of them to print the tax invoice for the owner. Record the owner's TRN on the property (**Master Data** ▸ **Properties**, *Owner TRN*) if they are VAT registered, so it appears on the invoice.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21500` Due to Landlords | VAT | — |
| `21400` VAT Payable | — | VAT |

The commission itself is already in revenue through revenue recognition, so the invoice only adds the VAT. It appears in the **Reporting** ▸ **VAT Return** for that month as *Standard rated - management commission to landlords*. Commission that was invoiced once is never invoiced again; commission recognised late (for example a month posted after its invoice run) is picked up by the next run. A company with no TRN issues the invoice without VAT.

> **An issued commission tax invoice cannot be reset to draft**
>
> It has a number from your tax invoice series and has been handed to the owner, so its VAT must stay in the return. Correct a mistake with an adjustment in the following month rather than by undoing the invoice.

## Who holds the rent: three arrangements

Each landlord is a record under **Master Data** ▸ **Landlords**, with their TRN, contact details and their own bank account. On a managed property, choose the **Landlord** and **Who holds the rent**. It decides only where a tenant's money lands, on a receipt or when a cheque clears. Invoices, the cheque register, deposits and returned cheques work the same way whichever you choose.

| Arrangement | Where the money goes | In the accounts |
|---|---|---|
| **Company bank account** | The company's own bank, as before. | Dr the company's cash account. |
| **Owners' funds bank account** | A company bank account kept for landlords' money only. You pay landlords from it, so their money never mixes with the company's. | Dr 11120 Bank - Owners' Funds, or the account listed under **System Setup** ▸ **Bank Accounts**. |
| **Paid to the owner directly** | The landlord's own bank account. Tenants pay the landlord and cheques are written to the landlord; you still keep the cheque register and follow every cheque. | Dr Due to Landlords: no company bank moves. |

- A landlord who wants an owners' funds account of their own: add it under **Bank Accounts** and choose them in **Kept for one landlord only**. Their rent goes there; everyone else's goes to the shared account.
- A cheque keeps the arrangement it was recorded under, so changing a property's arrangement never moves cheques already received.
- **Paid to the owner directly**: the owner statement shows *rent the tenants paid to the owner directly* as already paid. When the landlord has received more than their share, the balance turns into what they owe you: your commission. Collect it with the commission tax invoice. If the rent is invoiced in the company's name, the VAT on it is still yours to pay, so invoice it in the owner's name for this arrangement.
- Security deposits are still held by the company.

## Paying an owner

1. Open **Operations** ▸ **Owner Settlements**. Every landlord named on a managed property is listed with the rent billed, commission, owner's share, what was paid and the balance.
2. Select **Statement & Pay** for the owner. Change **Statement as at** if you are settling up to an earlier date, for example a month end.
3. Check the contracts: property and unit, tenant, agreement rent, rent billed, commission % and amount, the VAT on the commission, and the owner's share. The commission tax invoices issued to the owner are listed underneath.
4. Under **Pay the Owner**, the amount starts at what has been collected. Keep it to pay in full, or enter a smaller amount for a part payment.
5. Enter the **Payment date**, **Payment method** (bank transfer, cheque or cash), the account it is **Paid from**, and the cheque or transfer reference.
6. Select **Save and Post Payment**. The payment is posted straight away and the settlement advice opens, ready to print for the owner.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `21500` Due to Landlords | Amount paid | — |
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents (or the account chosen) | — | Amount paid |

> **An owner can never be paid twice**
> The most you can pay is the balance, less any settlement still waiting to be posted. A larger amount is refused with "*The most that can be paid to … is …*". Settlement numbers run OS-year-0001, OS-year-0002 and so on.

> **Why Due to Landlords in the Trial Balance can be higher than the balances here**
> When an invoice is posted the whole rent goes to *Due to Landlords*, and our commission is taken out of it month by month by revenue recognition, with its VAT by the monthly commission invoice. The settlement statement deducts the commission and VAT on everything billed at once. So when rent is billed in advance, *Due to Landlords* also holds the commission and VAT for the months still to come, and is higher than the total balance payable by that amount.

## Correcting a settlement

Find the settlement's journal in **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** (source *OwnerSettlement*) and reset it to draft. A draft settlement no longer counts as paid, but still holds back the amount until it is posted again, so nothing is paid twice by mistake.

## Rent invoiced in the owner's name, and costs charged to the owner

Two lines can appear between the commission and the owner's share:

- **Add: VAT on rent invoiced in the owner's name** — for a property set to invoice tenants in the owner's name, the VAT collected from tenants belongs to the owner, who declares and pays it to the FTA. It is passed on with the rent.
- **Less: maintenance and expenses charged to the owner** — materials taken from the maintenance store for the owner's units (see Maintenance Jobs), and other costs booked to Due to Landlords for the owner's properties. Each is listed with its date, property and entry.

The amount that may be paid to the owner follows: it can never exceed the owner's share after these lines.

## Costs passed on to owners: recharge or disbursement

Costs the company incurs for an owner's managed property — a contractor's bill, petty cash, an item from the maintenance store — can be passed on to the owner. Tick **Charge to owner** on the vendor bill line (under its property) or on the petty cash voucher, and choose the **kind of cost**. Store items for a job on a managed property are passed on automatically.

How they are passed on is chosen once for the company in **System Setup ▸ VAT Settings**:

| | Recharge with 5% VAT | Disbursement, no VAT |
|---|---|---|
| **Who the supplier invoices** | The company | The owner; the company pays as the owner's agent from its own cash |
| **Supplier's VAT** | Reclaimed by the company | Passed to the owner with the cost; the owner reclaims it |
| **Charged to the owner** | Cost + 5% VAT, on our tax invoice | Cost + the supplier's VAT, as paid, on a disbursement note |
| **Company VAT return** | Our 5% as output tax (*costs recharged to owners*) | Nothing — the line is kept off the company's input tax too |
| **Owner VAT return** | Our 5% as the owner's input tax | The supplier's VAT as the owner's input tax |

Store items are the company's own goods, so they are always recharged with VAT. The choice is kept on each bill and voucher when saved, so changing it later does not alter what is already recorded.

The entry charges the owner through 21500 Due to Landlords, tagged to the property, in two lines: the cost, carrying its **kind** (maintenance & repairs, utilities, cleaning & security, insurance, government fees, leasing & marketing, legal & professional, other), and the VAT. The cost is not in the company's Profit & Loss.

- The **owner statement** deducts the cost and its VAT.
- Owner Property Profitability breaks the owner's costs down **by kind**, and leaves the VAT out of the cost for a VAT-registered owner, who reclaims it.
- **Operations ▸ Recharges to Owners** lists every cost passed on, with its tax invoice (recharge) or disbursement note to print for the owner.

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# Petty Cash

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Petty Cash**

Petty cash is the small float kept on site to pay for minor items — cleaning supplies, a plumber's call-out, courier fees. Each float is its own asset account with its own running balance, so you always know how much cash should be in the box.

Video: **Petty cash** (1:25) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## Setting up a float

1. In **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**, create an **Asset** account for the float — for example `11150` Petty Cash – Marina Tower. Then **Edit** it and set **Petty Cash Float** to *Yes*.
2. Give it an **Opening Balance** if cash is already in the box on go-live, or fund it with a first replenishment.

Create one account per float if you keep cash at more than one site. Each appears in the float selector on this screen.

## Recording an expense voucher

1. Choose the float at the top of the screen, then select **New Expense Voucher**.
2. Enter the **Voucher Date**, **Paid To** and a **Description** of what was bought.
3. Choose the **Expense Account** the cost belongs in.
4. Optionally choose the **Property** and **Unit**, so the cost appears against the right building in P&L by Property.
5. Enter the **Amount** and any **Reference Number** (the receipt number), then save.

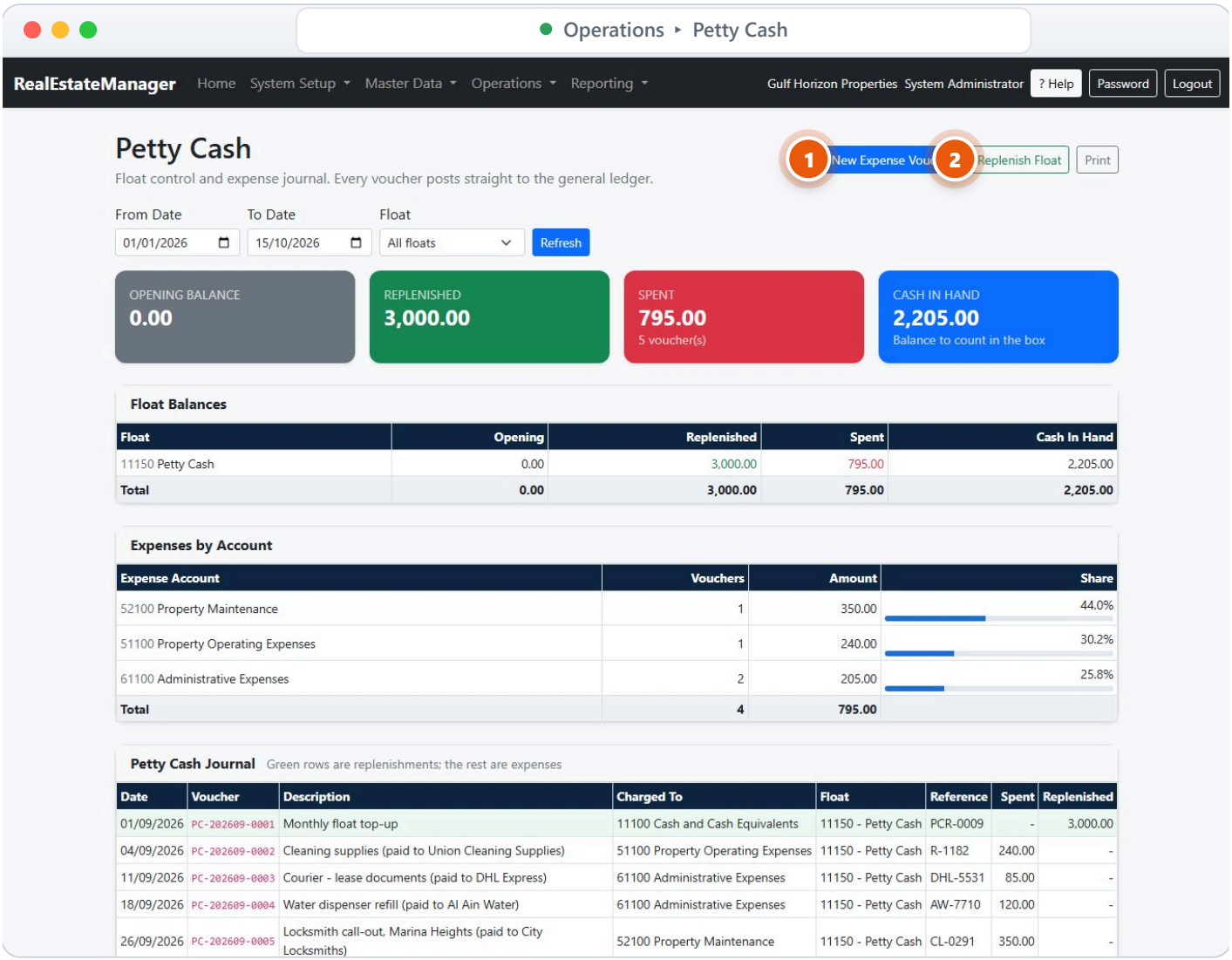
| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Expense account chosen on the voucher | Amount | — |
| The petty cash float account | — | Amount |

## Replenishing the float

When the box runs low, top it back up from the bank with **Replenish Float**: enter the date, choose the **Funding Account** (normally your bank or main cash account), the amount and a reference.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| The petty cash float account | Amount | — |
| Funding account — bank or main cash | — | Amount |

> **Vouchers and replenishments post straight away**
>
> The float balance changes as soon as you save. If the posting is refused, the entry is kept as a draft and the message says why; post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry** once resolved - see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.
>
> A voucher is refused with "*This voucher would take the float below zero*" when the float does not hold enough cash. **Replenish the float first**, then enter the vouchers it pays for.




A petty cash float: vouchers, the top-up and the running balance.

1 New Expense Voucher

2 Replenish Float

## Vouchers waiting for approval: the amount on hold

When payment approval is switched on, a voucher above the custodian's own limit is not posted at once: it waits in **Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals**. Its amount is then **on hold** in the float - the cash is still in the box, but it is promised to that voucher, so no other voucher can spend it.

- The **Float Balances** table shows **On Hold** and **Available** (cash in hand less what is on hold); the Cash In Hand card shows both too.

- Each held voucher appears at the top of the journal, in amber, marked *On hold* with who entered it and since when. It is outside the totals until it is released.
- A new voucher larger than the **Available** balance is refused, with the cash in hand and the amount on hold in the message. The voucher form shows what is available as you choose the float.
- Releasing the voucher posts it and the hold becomes spending; turning it down frees the amount.
- A top-up waiting for approval is listed too, but it is not counted until it is released: the money is not in the box yet.

## Counting the cash

The screen shows the float's opening balance, every voucher and replenishment in the date range, and the closing balance. Count the box and compare it with the closing balance. A shortfall means a voucher is missing or a slip was lost. **Print** gives a signed-off petty cash report.

> **Replenishing is not an expense**
>
> Moving cash from the bank into the box changes where the cash is, not how much the company has. The Statement of Cash Flows leaves these transfers out for that reason.

## A voucher for an owner's property

For a cost of a managed property that the owner should bear, choose the property, tick **Charge to the owner** and choose the kind of cost. The voucher then charges the owner — plus 5% VAT when the company recharges, or as paid when it disburses (see VAT Settings) — instead of being our expense. See Costs passed on to owners.

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# Fixed Assets & Depreciation

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Fixed Assets**

The fixed asset register tracks long-lived items — lifts, generators, air-conditioning plant, vehicles, fit-out — from acquisition through capitalisation to monthly depreciation.

## Creating an asset

1. Select **Add Fixed Asset**.
2. Enter the **Asset Code**, the **Asset Name** and the **Category** (furniture, equipment, vehicles …). Choose the **Property** it belongs to, or leave *Not Property-Specific*.
3. Enter the **Acquisition Date** and the **In Service Date**.
4. Enter the **Useful Life (Months)** and any **Residual Value**.
5. Optionally enter the **Initial Acquisition Cost** with the account it was **Paid / Payable From** (and the **Vendor**, when that is Accounts Payable). Further costs are added afterwards.
6. Check the **Asset Account**, the **Accumulated Depreciation Account** and the **Depreciation Expense Account** (defaults `15200`, `15300` and `62100`).
7. For assets migrated from a previous system, enter the **Opening Cost** and **Opening Accumulated Depreciation**.
8. Select **Save Draft Asset**.

The asset is saved as a **draft**. It is not depreciated until it has been capitalised.

## Acquisition costs

Select **Acquisition** on the asset's row to accumulate the costs that make up its value — the supplier invoice, freight, installation, customs, testing. For each cost enter the **Cost Date**, **Cost Type**, **Amount**, whether it is **Capitalizable**, and the account it was **Paid / Payable From**, then select **Add Cost**. Only a draft asset accepts new costs. Each entry posts immediately:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `15400` Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable) or the expense account (not capitalisable) | Amount | — |
| Offset account — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable | — | Amount |

Choosing a vendor with an Accounts Payable offset also raises the vendor bill automatically, so the payable appears in the vendor's sub-ledger.

## Capitalisation

When the asset is complete and in use, capitalise it on the same screen: enter the **Capitalization Date** and select **Capitalize Asset**. The accumulated clearing balance moves to the asset account and the depreciation schedule is generated over the useful life. Depreciation starts only after capitalisation:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `15200` Fixed Assets | Capitalised cost | — |
| `15400` Fixed Asset Clearing | — | Capitalised cost |

## Running depreciation

1. Open **Operations** ▸ **Fixed Assets**. The **Due to Post** card shows how many monthly instalments are waiting.
2. Enter the **Posting Date** — normally the month end being closed.
3. Select **Post Due Depreciation**. Every planned instalment up to the month end of that date is posted, for all assets.

**Depreciation** on an asset's row shows its schedule month by month, with what has been posted and its net book value. The same run is offered as **Run depreciation** in the Closing Cockpit.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `62100` Depreciation Expense | Monthly charge | — |
| `15300` Accumulated Depreciation | — | Monthly charge |

> **Accumulated Depreciation presentation**
>
> In this chart of accounts, `15300` is classified as an asset and carries a credit balance, acting as a contra-asset. It therefore reduces Total Assets on the Balance Sheet, which is the correct presentation. Do not "correct" its sign.

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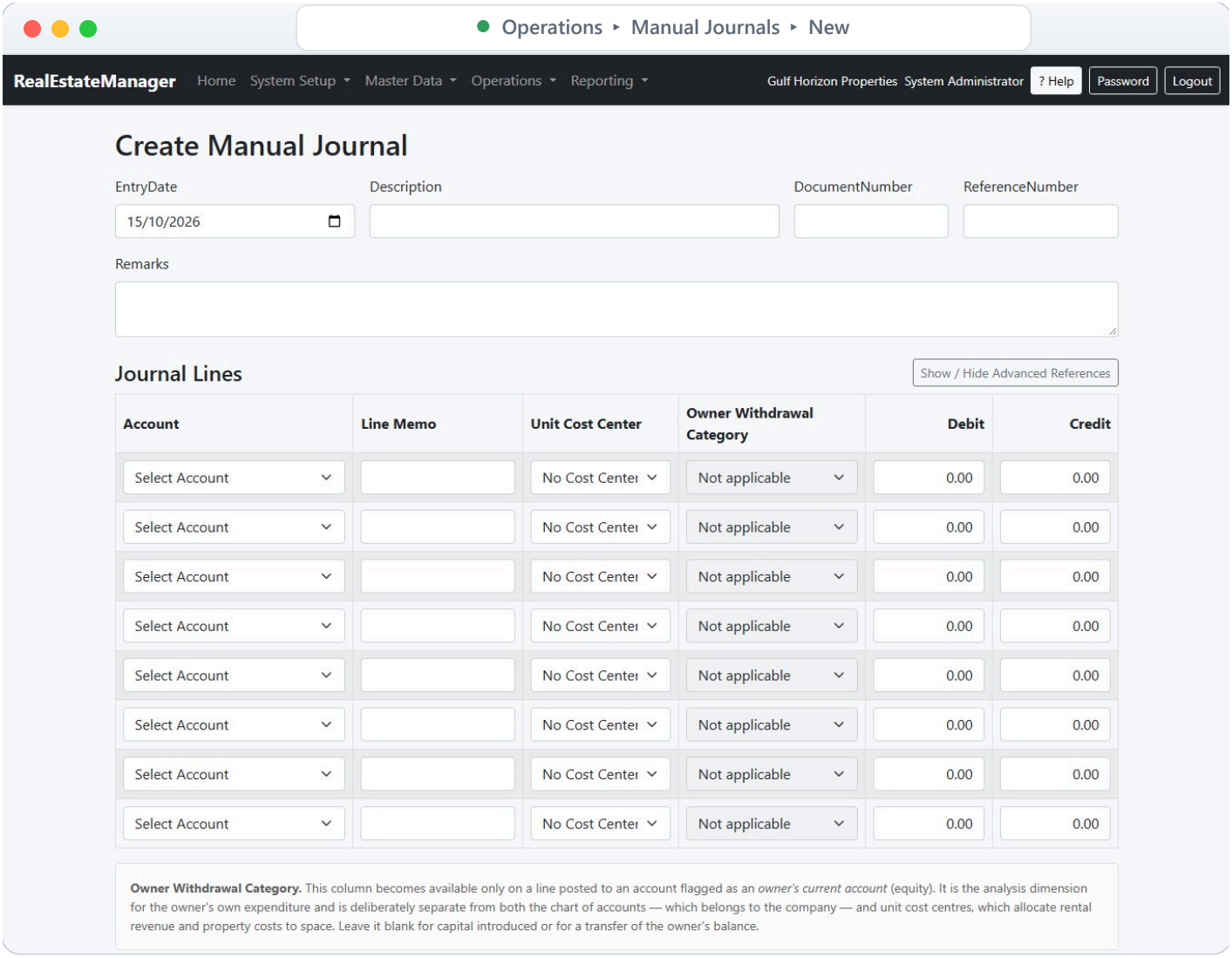
# Manual Journals

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Manual Journals**

Manual journals cover what the automatic postings cannot: accruals, corrections, deposit refunds, bank charges, reclassifications, and opening entries that do not belong to a sub-ledger.

## Creating a journal

1. Select **New Manual Journal**.
2. Enter the **Entry Date** — the accounting date, which is the date the reports will use.
3. Enter a clear **Description** explaining why the entry exists.
4. Enter the **Document Number** and **Reference Number** where relevant.
5. For each line: choose the **Account**, enter either a **Debit** or a **Credit** (never both), and add a line **Description**. Choose a **Unit** on lines that relate to a building, so they appear against the right property in P&L by Property.
6. Add lines until total debits equal total credits. The running totals are displayed as you type.
7. Select **Save as Draft**.
8. Post it from **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**. Until then it is not in any report — see Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.




A manual journal. It is saved as a draft and posted from Journal Inquiry.

> **The balance rule is absolute**
>
> The system will not save a journal whose debits do not equal its credits, and will not accept a journal with fewer than two lines. If you see *"Journal entry is not balanced"*, check for a line with an amount in both columns, or a typing error in one figure.

When development projects exist, a **Development Cost** column appears. Choose the project and cost category on a line posted to the project's own account to capitalise it into that project; choosing one sets the account for you. A project can only be chosen on its own account.

The **Owner Withdrawal Category** column is hidden until you select **+ Owner withdrawal category** at the top right of the journal lines. Money the owner takes out is quicker to record in Operations ▸ Owner Withdrawals.

## Common manual journals

| Purpose | Entry |
|---|---|
| Refund a security deposit | Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash |
| Bank charges | Dr `63100` Finance Costs · Cr `11100` Cash |
| Accrue an unbilled expense | Dr expense account · Cr `21100` Accounts Payable |
| Write off an irrecoverable receivable | Dr `61100` Administrative Expenses · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable |
| Settle VAT with the authority | Dr `21400` VAT Payable · Cr `11300` VAT Recoverable and/or `11100` Cash |
| Pay a landlord their share | Dr `21500` Due to Landlords · Cr `11100` Cash |
| Owner takes money for personal use | Dr `34100` Owner's Current Account *with a withdrawal category* · Cr `11100` Cash — see Owner Withdrawals |

> **Write the narration for someone else**
>
> Six months from now, an auditor will read the description without any of today's context. Write it so that it explains itself: *"Refund of security deposit, lease LSE-0042, tenant Al Noor Trading, cheque 100233"*, not *"deposit refund"*.

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# Journal Inquiry

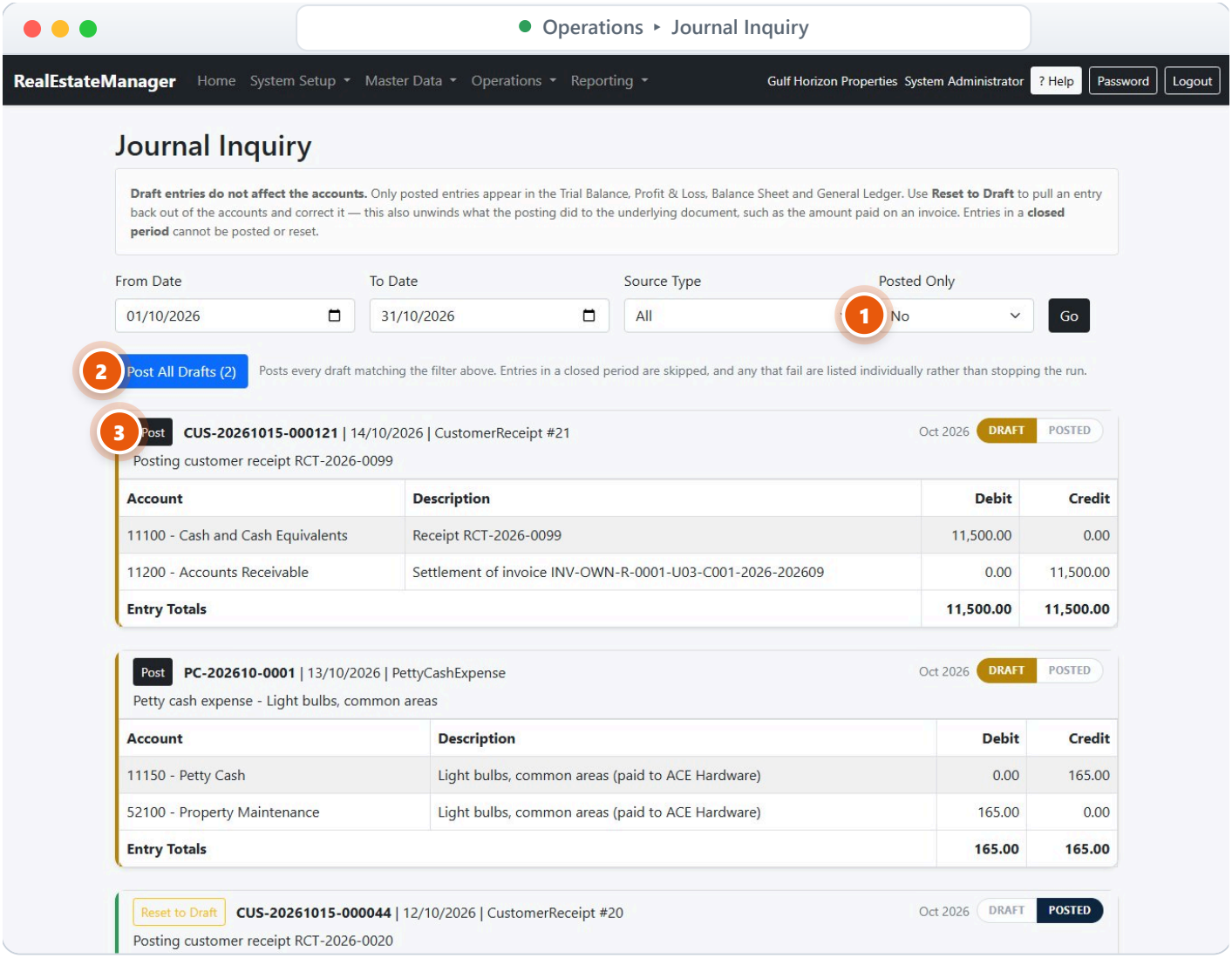
Where: **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**

Journal Inquiry is the audit trail and the place where drafts become postings. Every journal in the company — automatic or manual, draft or posted — is listed here with its entry number, date, description, source and value.

## Finding journals

1. Set the **From** and **To** dates.
2. Optionally choose a **Source Type** to see only one kind of transaction.
3. Set **Posted Only** to **No** to include drafts, or **Yes** to see only what is in the accounts.
4. Select **Go**.

Every journal line carries the property, unit, tenant, lease, vendor and source document it came from, so any figure in a report can be traced back to the transaction that caused it.




Journal Inquiry with drafts showing. Drafts are not in any report until posted.

1. Posted Only = No lists drafts
2. Post All Drafts matching the filter
3. Post one entry

## Posting and resetting

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Post** | Puts one draft into the accounts. |
| **Post All Drafts (n)** | Posts every draft matching the current filter. Each is posted separately; any that cannot be posted are listed with the reason, and the rest still go through. |
| **Reset to Draft** | Takes one posted entry back out of the accounts so its document can be corrected. |
| **Period locked** badge | Shown instead of the buttons when the entry's period is closed. |

Read Draft, Post & Reset to Draft for which screens leave drafts and when a reset is refused. The links on each entry open the journal itself and the original document it came from.

> **A good end-of-day habit**
>
> Filter today's date with **Posted Only = No** and post what is waiting. Drafts left behind are the commonest reason a report looks short.

## Source types

| Source type | Created by |
|---|---|
| `CustomerInvoice` | Posting a customer invoice |
| `CustomerCreditNote` | Posting a credit note |
| `CustomerReceipt` | Saving a customer receipt |
| `PdcReceiptMemo` / `PdcDeposit` / `PdcClearance` / `PdcBounce` / `PdcWithdrawal` | Receiving a PDC, depositing it, and its clearing, return or withdrawal |
| `SecurityDeposit` | Saving a security deposit |
| `RevenueRecognitionSchedule` | Processing revenue recognition |
| `VendorBill` / `VendorPayment` / `VendorAdvanceClearing` | Posting a bill, saving a payment or an advance, applying an advance to bills |
| `OwnerCommissionInvoice` / `OwnerSettlement` | The monthly commission tax invoice to a landlord, and paying a landlord |
| `OwnerWithdrawal` | Recording an owner withdrawal |
| `DevelopmentCost` / `DevelopmentTransfer` | A cost on a development project, and its transfer at completion |
| `UnitSaleReceipt` / `UnitSaleHandover` | A buyer's payment, and the handover of a sold unit |
| `PayrollRun` / `PayrollPayment` / `EmployeeAdvance` | Approving a payroll, paying salaries, paying a salary advance |
| `CapitalAssetVatAdjustment` | A yearly Capital Assets Scheme adjustment |
| `PettyCashExpense` / `PettyCashReplenishment` | Petty cash vouchers and top-ups |
| `FixedAsset…` | Acquisition, capitalisation, depreciation |
| `PrepaymentSchedule` / `PrepaymentRecognition` | Prepayment setup and amortisation |
| `ManualJournal` | A manual journal |
| `FiscalYearClosing` | Closing the fiscal year |

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# Tenant Requests

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Tenant Requests**

Everything tenants raise through the self-service portal lands here: maintenance calls, requests for more time to pay, contract renewal questions, complaints and anything else. You need the **Handle Tenant Requests** permission to see this screen.

> **Maintenance requests go to the maintenance team**
>
> A new **maintenance** request is assigned automatically to a user who carries out maintenance jobs — the least busy one — and appears in their **My Maintenance Jobs** list. Requests for more time to pay, complaints and other requests stay with you here. See Maintenance Jobs.

## Maintenance is on hold for tenants with payment issues

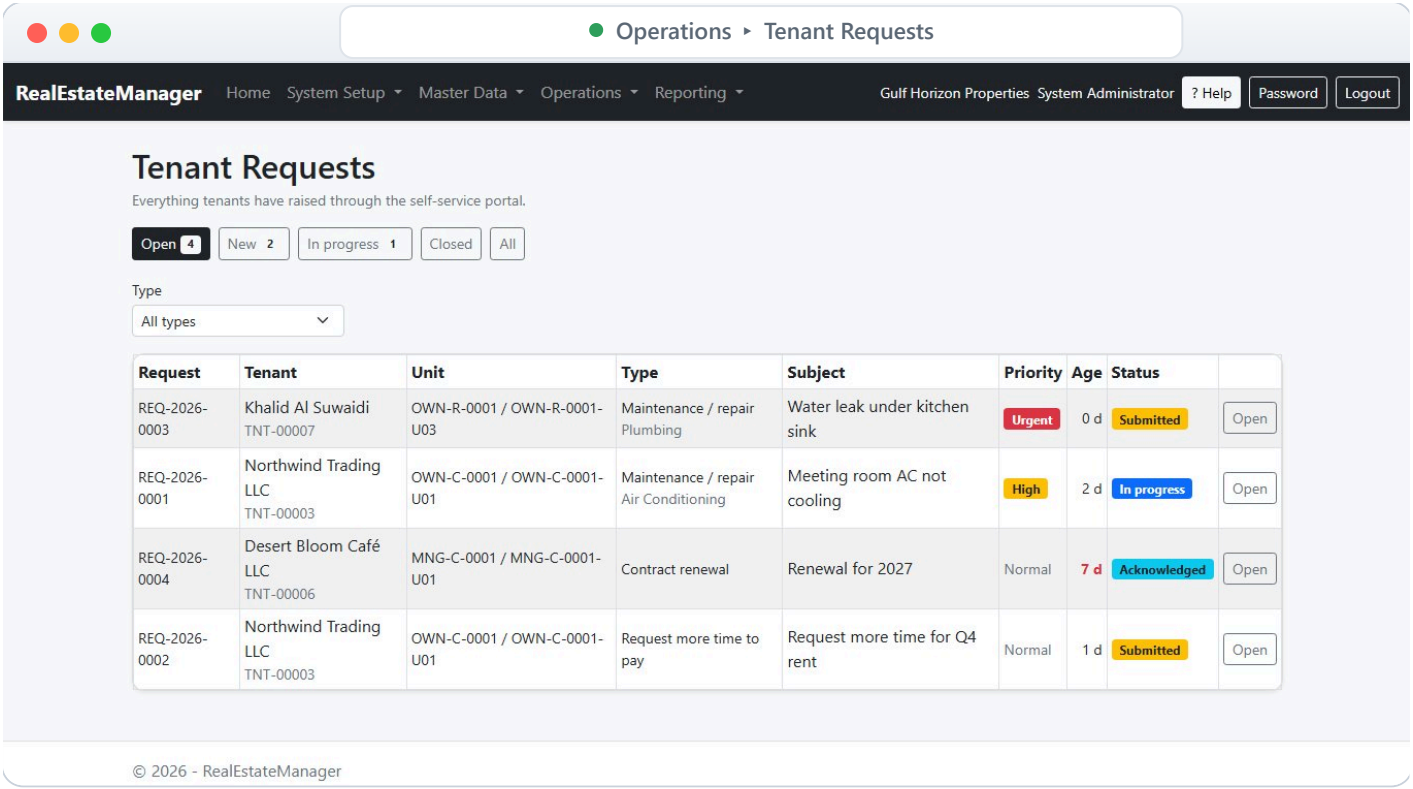
A tenant who has an **overdue invoice**, or a **returned (bounced) cheque** that has not been replaced, cannot request maintenance through the portal. The New Request page tells them their maintenance requests are on hold, how much is overdue, and to contact the administration office. They can still send other requests — for example, asking for more time to pay.

- An invoice is overdue when it is posted, past its due date and not fully paid. An invoice that a post-dated cheque on hand is waiting to settle does not count.
- The hold lifts by itself as soon as the overdue amount is received or the cheque is replaced.
- Staff can still raise or handle a request for the tenant when the office agrees to it.

## The queue

The screen opens on the **Open** requests — the work still outstanding. The buttons across the top filter it: **New** (not yet acknowledged), **In progress**, **Closed** and **All**, each with a count. The **Type** filter narrows it further.

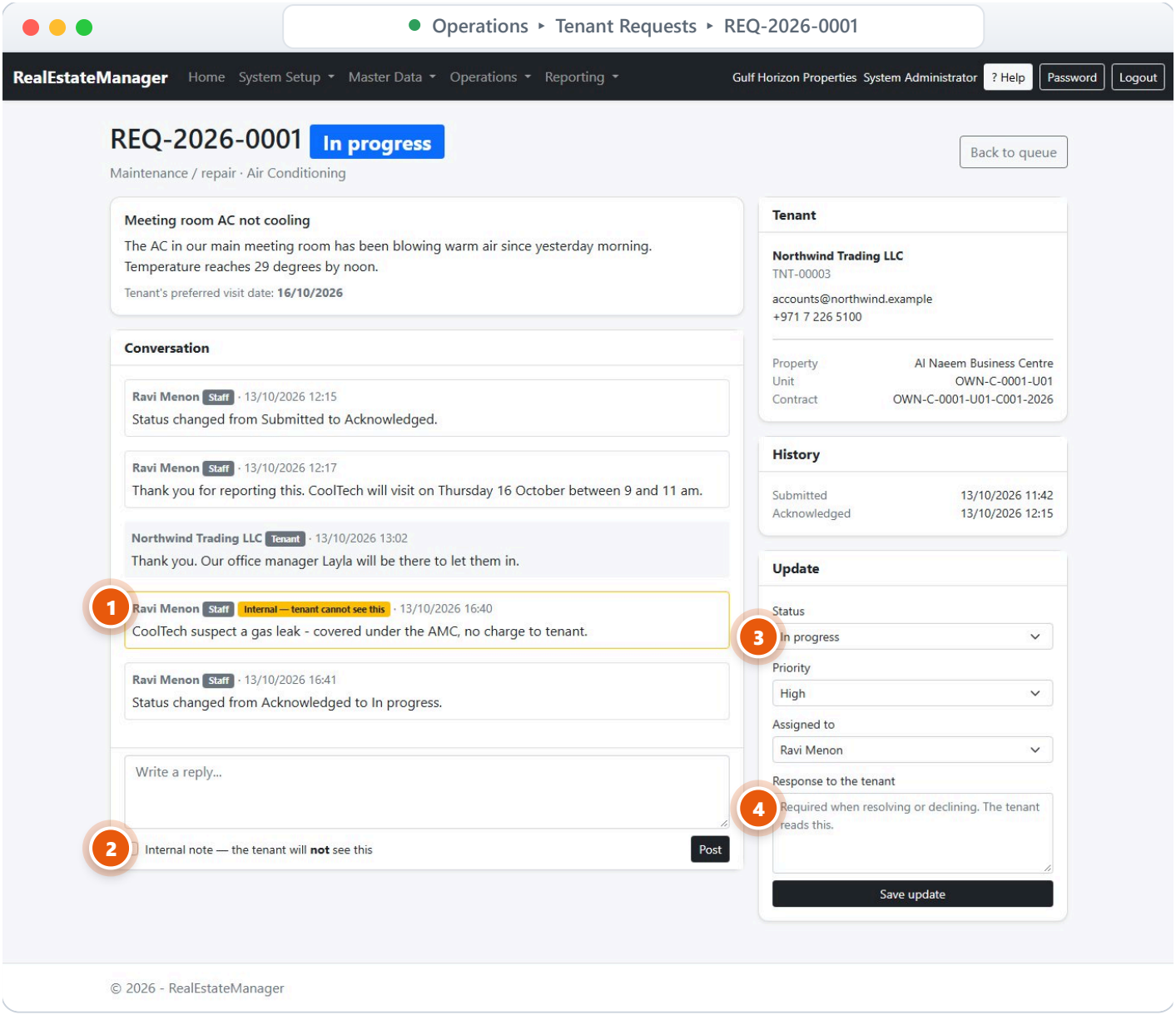
- Requests are listed **worst first**: Urgent, then High, then oldest first.
- The **Age** column turns red once a request is 7 days old.
- An amber badge marks a payment postponement that was agreed but not yet applied to the invoice.




The tenant request queue: urgent first, oldest first, with ageing.

## Working a request

1. Select **Open** on the request. You see what the tenant asked, their contact details, the property, unit and contract, and the full conversation.
2. Under **Update**, set the status to **Acknowledged** so the tenant knows it has been seen. Adjust the **Priority** if the tenant's own rating was off, and choose who it is **Assigned to**.
3. Use the **Conversation** box to reply. The tenant sees your reply in their portal.
4. Move it to **In progress** when work starts.
5. When done, set **Resolved** and write the **Response to the tenant** — what was done. It is required, because the tenant reads it. Use **Declined** if you will not do it, again with the reason.
6. Set **Closed** once nothing further is expected.




Working a request: the conversation, an internal staff note, and the update panel.

1. Internal note — never shown to the tenant
2. Tick to keep a message among staff
3. Move the request along
4. Response the tenant reads

> **Internal notes**
>
> Tick **Internal note** before posting a message to keep it among staff — for instance, a note about the tenant's payment history. Internal notes are shown with an amber background and are **never** sent to the portal. Anything not ticked is visible to the tenant.

## Payment postponement requests

A tenant asking for more time names the invoice and the date they could pay by. Agreeing to it and actually moving the date are two separate, deliberate steps:

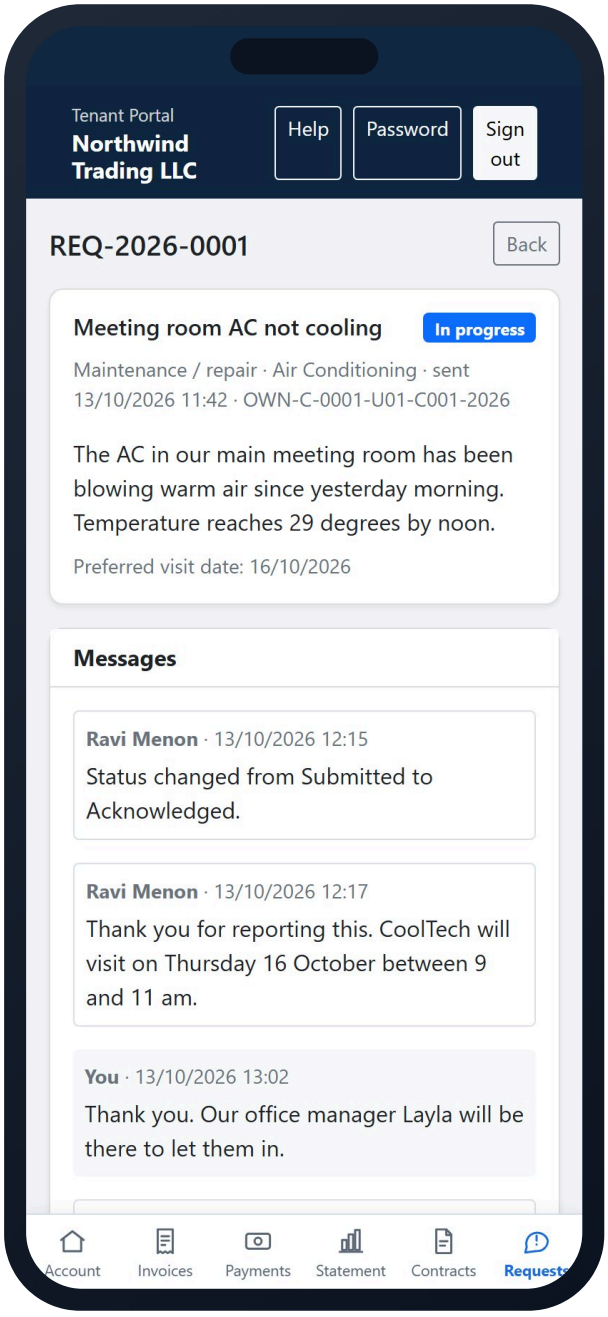
1. Decide, and set the request to **Resolved** with your response — for example *"Agreed, invoice INV-… may be paid by 20 November."*

2. A button appears: **Apply new due date to INV-…**. Press it and confirm.

Only the invoice's **due date** changes. The amount owed, the VAT and the journal are untouched — giving more time to pay is not a credit note, so no figure in any financial report moves. The change is recorded in the conversation, the tenant sees it, and the button cannot be pressed twice.

## What the tenant can and cannot do

- Raise a request and add messages to it until it is closed.
- Withdraw it, but only while it is *Submitted* or *Acknowledged* — once work is under way, it stays.
- They cannot change its status, priority or assignment, and cannot see internal notes.




The same request as the tenant sees it — the staff internal note is not there.

## Statuses

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Submitted** | New. Nobody has looked at it yet. |
| **Acknowledged** | Seen by staff. The tenant can still withdraw it. |
| **In progress** | Work has started. |
| **Resolved** | Done, with a response to the tenant. |
| **Declined** | Will not be done, with the reason. |
| **Withdrawn** | Cancelled by the tenant. |
| **Closed** | Finished. No more messages can be added. |

> **Nobody is notified automatically**
>
> There are no emails yet. Check this queue daily, and remind tenants to look at the portal for your replies.

## Requests that arrive by WhatsApp, phone or a visit

Not every tenant uses the portal. Choose **Log a Request for a Tenant**, find the tenant by name, code or phone number, say how the request reached you and when, and paste their message. It becomes an ordinary request on the tenant's record: the tenant sees it on the portal, a maintenance job goes to the maintenance team, and it counts on the dashboard, where its response time runs from the moment it came in. The thread records who logged it.

When the message comes in on a connected WhatsApp number, nobody needs to type it: see below.

## Messages that arrive by themselves on WhatsApp

A company can connect its own WhatsApp Business number. A tenant then simply sends a message, and it becomes a request on their record: it shows in this queue with **WhatsApp** as its source, and on the tenant's portal. The people who handle requests are notified.

- **How the tenant is found.** The sender's number is compared with the **Phone** on each active tenant. It must be the same number once written in full: *+971 50 123 4567* and *050 123 4567* match, and a record may hold two numbers separated by a slash.
- **It arrives as "Other request".** A message does not say what kind of request it is. Open it and use **Sort this WhatsApp request**. Choosing maintenance sends it to the maintenance team. You see any payment hold first, because a message from WhatsApp never gets round the hold by itself. For more time to pay, log a request yourself, because that needs an invoice and a date.
- **Several messages in a row.** Further messages from the same person within 30 minutes join the request they just opened as messages in its conversation, while it is still open.
- **Sent twice by WhatsApp.** WhatsApp sometimes repeats a delivery. Each message is only ever taken once.

## The WhatsApp Messages review list

A message that cannot safely go on one tenant's record waits under **WhatsApp Messages**, and never reaches any tenant by itself. That happens when:

- no active tenant has that number, or **several** do (for example a couple, or one company renting two units);
- WhatsApp did not give the number, because the person uses a WhatsApp username;
- the message has no text, such as a voice note or a photo with no caption;
- the company's subscription was inactive when it arrived, or the request could not be created.

For each message, choose **Log for** a suggested tenant, **Choose a tenant**, or **Dismiss** it. Logging opens the usual form filled in with the message, and the time received is when it was sent. If the number really is that tenant's, add it to their record so the next message finds them by itself.

> **Nothing is sent back on WhatsApp**
> The system only receives. The tenant gets no reply on WhatsApp: your replies appear on the portal. Photos and voice notes are not stored here. A photo's caption becomes the request and the picture stays in WhatsApp, so ask for it if you need it.

## Connecting a WhatsApp number

You need the **Owner Oversight** permission, a Meta Business account and a phone number that is not already in use on the ordinary WhatsApp apps. Meta may charge for some conversations, according to its own price list.

1. In Meta for Developers, create an app with the WhatsApp product and add your number.
2. In this system, open **WhatsApp Messages**, then **WhatsApp Connection**. Enter the **Phone Number ID** (under WhatsApp, API Setup) and the **App Secret** (under App settings, Basic), and save. The secret is stored encrypted and is never shown again.
3. The screen now shows a **Callback URL** and a **Verify token**. Enter both in your Meta app under WhatsApp, Configuration, and subscribe to the **messages** field.
4. Send a message to the number from a phone that is on a tenant's record, and check that it appears in the queue.

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# Maintenance Jobs & Dashboard

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Tenant Services** ▸ **Maintenance Jobs**

Maintenance requests raised by tenants are worked as **jobs** by the maintenance team. Each job records who did it, when it was answered, started and finished, and the materials it used. The owner follows the whole operation on the **Maintenance Dashboard**.

## Setting up the maintenance team

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Users & Permissions** and select **New User** for the maintenance engineer or technician.
2. Under **Role**, select **Maintenance Engineer / Technician**. This ticks only the permission **Carry Out Maintenance Jobs**.
3. Grant access to the company and **Save**.

From then on, every new maintenance request from a tenant is assigned to a maintenance user automatically. With more than one, the job goes to the one with the fewest open jobs. If nobody has the permission yet, jobs wait unassigned and the Maintenance Jobs screen says so.

> **The maintenance manager**
> Give the person who runs maintenance the **Maintenance Manager** role, which ticks **Manage Maintenance**. They see every maintenance job, assign and close them, raise make-ready and inspection jobs, set up the **Planned Maintenance** programme and open the **Maintenance Dashboard**. New maintenance requests and low ratings reach them too. They do not see the other tenant requests or the accounts. The role also ticks **Carry Out Maintenance Jobs**, so jobs can be given to them; untick it if they only supervise.

## What the maintenance user sees

**Operations** ▸ **Tenant Services** ▸ **My Maintenance Jobs**

A maintenance user sees **only the jobs assigned to them** — not the accounts, not other requests, and not other technicians' jobs. The list opens on the **Open** jobs, worst first (Urgent, then High, then oldest); **Done** and **All** show the rest. The age turns red once a job is past its target time.

> **A notification for every new job**
> A technician who installs the app on their phone and turns on notifications (the card on **My Maintenance Jobs**) is told the moment a job is given to them, and when the tenant replies on it. Tapping the notification opens the job.

## Working a job

1. Open the job. The card shows what the tenant asked, the unit, the tenant's phone number, the preferred visit date and the timeline.
2. Select **Acknowledge — I have seen it**. This is the first response the dashboard measures.
3. Select **Start work** when you begin. (Starting also counts as the first response if you skipped acknowledging.)
4. Record the **materials** used, as below, and add **messages** as you go. Notes are *internal* by default; untick the box for a message the tenant should read.
5. Write **What was done** and select **Mark as done**. The tenant reads this text in the portal.

A supervisor — anyone with **Handle Tenant Requests** — sees every job, can **Assign** it to another technician, **Reopen** it, and **Close the job** once nothing more is expected. A technician cannot close a job.

## Materials

Under **Materials used**, enter the item, quantity and unit cost, and where it came from:

| From | What happens |
|---|---|
| **Maintenance store** | Taken from the items you keep for maintenance. The cost is posted at once out of account `11650` Maintenance Materials Stock. |
| **Bought for the job** | Give the bill or petty cash receipt number it was bought on. The item is recorded against the job; its cost is booked by that bill or voucher. |

Who bears the cost depends on the property:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| 21500 Due to Landlords (managed property — the owner bears it, plus 5% VAT)<br>or 52100 Property Maintenance (owned property) | Amount (+ 5% for the owner) | — |
| 11650 Maintenance Materials Stock | — | Amount |
| 21400 VAT Payable (owner's property only) | — | 5% |

The entry carries the property and unit, so the cost shows on the owner's statement and in Owner Property Profitability.

> **The maintenance store is a control account, not an inventory system**
>
> Buy stock for the store with a vendor bill (or petty cash) charged to account `11650`. Items taken out for jobs reduce it. The balance is shown on the Maintenance Dashboard; a negative balance means items were issued before their purchase was booked.

## Target times

| Priority | First response within | Done within |
|---|---|---|
| **Urgent** | 2 hours | 24 hours |
| **High** | 8 hours | 3 days |
| **Normal** | 24 hours | 5 days |
| **Low** | 2 days | 10 days |

## Jobs no tenant asked for

Maintenance is not only what tenants ask for. A supervisor, anyone with **Handle Tenant Requests**, can raise a job from **Maintenance Jobs** ▸ **Raise a Job**: choose the property, and the unit or leave it for the building and its common areas, then say what it is for. The choices are making a vacant unit ready for the next tenant, a repair, an inspection, preventive maintenance or an improvement.

- It goes to the least busy technician, or to the one you choose, and is worked like any other job: acknowledged, started, materials recorded and marked as done.
- Materials are charged the same way: to the owner for a managed property, to the company for its own.
- It has no tenant, so it never shows on a tenant's portal, all its notes are internal and it is not rated.
- It is listed on **Maintenance Jobs**, not on **Tenant Requests**.

## Units to make ready

When a tenancy ends, the unit should be inspected, repaired and cleaned before it is let again. **Maintenance Jobs** lists every vacant unit whose last tenancy has ended and that has had no make-ready job since, with a **Raise make-ready job** button. The owner sees the same list on the dashboard, with the days each unit has been vacant.

## Planned maintenance

Regular work is set up once under **Operations** ▸ **Tenant Services** ▸ **Planned Maintenance**. Examples are the AC service every 3 months, the fire alarm check every 6 months and the water tank cleaning every 12.

1. Select **New Planned Work**. Name the work, choose the property and, if it is for one unit, the unit.
2. Say **every how many months** it is due, the **next due** date, and how many days before the due date the job should open, so the visit can be booked.
3. Leave **Assign to** empty to give each job to the least busy technician, or choose the one who always does it.

The system checks every few hours. When a plan comes due it opens a job, marked **Planned maintenance** with its due date, and moves the plan to its next date. **Open due jobs now** runs the check at once. A planned job counts as late only once its due date has passed, and the dashboard shows the share of planned work done by its due date.

## The Maintenance Dashboard

**Controls ▸ Maintenance Dashboard** — for the owner (Owner Oversight), supervisors and report viewers.

Choose a **From** and **To** date (the last 90 days by default) and, if you like, one technician. It covers the jobs raised in the period and every job still open:

- **Jobs received**, how many are done and declined.
- **Still open**, how many are past their target and how many are unassigned.
- **Average first response** — from the request to the engineer acknowledging it.
- **Average time to complete**, and the share done within target.
- **Materials used** and the **maintenance store** balance.
- The open jobs, worst first, and breakdowns **by technician**, **by property** and **by kind of job**.

### The charts

| Chart | What it tells you |
|---|---|
| **Jobs raised and completed, by month** | Whether the team keeps up. A month that completes fewer jobs than it receives is building a backlog. |
| **Within and past target, by priority** | How many urgent, high, normal and low jobs met their completion target, and how many did not. |
| **Jobs by status** | Where the jobs stand today, from submitted to closed. |
| **Jobs by kind** | What breaks most often: air conditioning, plumbing, electrical and so on. |
| **Workload by technician** | Jobs done and jobs still open for each person, and those not assigned. |
| **Cost of materials, by property** | Materials recorded on the jobs: borne by the company on its own properties, charged to the owner on managed ones. |

Point at a bar to see its figures. The charts follow the period and the technician you chose.

### Cost per property and per unit

The cost shown is the **materials recorded on the jobs** — items taken from the maintenance store and items bought for the job (see *Materials* above). The tiles give the total, how much came from the store and how much was bought, the **materials per completed job**, and how much was **charged to owners**. **Jobs and cost by unit** lists each unit with its jobs, its materials and the materials per job, highest cost first; work on a building's common areas is shown on its own line. A contractor's bill that was not recorded as a material on a job is not in these figures: it is in the property's costs under P&L by Property.

### Excel and PDF

- **Export to Excel** downloads a workbook for the same period and technician: a summary of the figures, then one sheet each for every job, cost by property, cost by unit, the technicians, the kinds of job, the months, and every material line with its quantity, cost and who it was charged to.
- **Print / Save as PDF** lays the dashboard out as a *Maintenance Report* on A4, with the company name, the period and the date it was prepared. Choose *Save as PDF* in the print window to keep it as a file for the follow-

up meeting or to send to an owner.

## The tenant's rating

When a job is marked as done, the tenant is invited to rate it on the portal from **1 to 10** and write feedback. A job is rated once. If the tenant gives the rating by WhatsApp or phone, a supervisor can record it on the job; the job then shows who entered it, and nobody can enter the rating of a job they carried out themselves. Once a job has a rating it can no longer be moved to another technician.

The dashboard shows the **team rating**, which is the maintenance manager's score, as the average of all rated jobs, with each technician's own average beside their name, the number of low ratings, and the feedback, lowest first. A rating of 5 or below also sends a notification to the people who handle tenant requests.

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# Employees, Departments & Documents

Where: **HR & Payroll ▸ Employees**

HR & Payroll ▸ Employees

The staff register: who works for the company, their contract and UAE documents, what they are paid and how. Everything the payroll, leave and attendance screens do starts from these records. The **HR & Payroll** menu is shown to users with *Manage Employees*, *Prepare & Pay Payroll* or *Approve Payroll*.

## Before the first employee

1. **HR & Payroll ▸ Departments**: type each department's name (for example *Building Maintenance*) and select **Add**. A department no longer used is deactivated, not deleted.
2. **HR & Payroll ▸ Payroll Settings**: the WPS details, the accounts and the calculation rules — see Payroll.

## Adding an employee

1. Open **HR & Payroll ▸ Employees** and select **Add Employee**. The employee code (EMP-0001, EMP-0002 …) is generated on save.
2. **Personal**: name in English and Arabic, gender, date of birth, nationality, mobile, email and an emergency contact.
3. **Job and contract**: job title, department, joining date, end of probation, the contract type (Unlimited, Limited, Part-time or Temporary) and, for a limited contract, its end date.
4. **Works for building**: choose a property when the person works for one building — a watchman or a cleaner, for example. Their salary is then charged to that building and appears in P&L by Property. Leave it at *Head office / none* otherwise.
5. **UAE documents**: passport, Emirates ID, residence visa, labour card and health insurance, each with its expiry date, and the 14-digit **MOHRE person code** from the labour card, needed for the WPS salary file.
6. **Salary and payment**: basic salary, housing, transport and other allowances; and **Paid by** — WPS, bank transfer or cheque — with the bank, IBAN and the bank's 9-digit routing code for WPS.
7. **Leave and end of service**: annual leave days a year (30 under UAE law after the first year).
8. Select **Save**.

> **Staff moved from a previous system**
>
> Enter **Balances as at**, the **Opening leave balance** in days and the **Opening gratuity provision** already in your books at that date. Leave then accrues, and the provision is topped up, from that date onwards. For new joiners leave these blank. Many employees can be loaded at once from Excel — see Importing from a Previous System.

## The employee page

Select an employee in the list to see everything about them in one place:

- **Monthly gross**, split into basic and allowances.
- **Annual leave available**, and any days waiting for approval.
- **End-of-service gratuity today**, how it is worked out, and how much of it is already **provided in the accounts**.
- Their documents with expiry dates, their leave, payslips and salary advances.
- The **Employee portal** panel, where you give them a login — see Employee Self-Service.

## End-of-service gratuity

Worked out as UAE law gives it, on the last basic salary: 21 days' basic pay for each of the first five years of service and 30 days for each year after, part years pro rata, never more than two years' pay. Nothing is payable for less than one year's service, but the full amount is provided for in the accounts from the first day, month by month, by the payroll.

## Status and leavers

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Active** | Employed and paid by the payroll. |
| **Suspended** | Still employed but left out of the payroll. |
| **Resigned / Terminated** | Enter the **Last working day** and the reason. The payroll of that month pays them pro rata up to that day; later payrolls leave them out. |

## Expiring documents

**HR & Payroll ▸ Expiring Documents** lists passports, Emirates IDs, visas, labour cards, insurance and limited contracts of current staff that have expired or expire within the chosen number of days, soonest first, ready to print.

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# Attendance & Leave

Where: **HR & Payroll ▸ Attendance**

Attendance and leave are what make one month's pay differ from the next: overtime adds to it; unpaid leave, absence and lateness reduce it. Record them here and the payroll picks them up by itself. Both screens need *Manage Employees*.

## Leave

HR & Payroll ▸ Leave

1. Under **Book leave**, choose the employee, the type and the **From** and **To** dates, add a reason and select **Book**. Days are counted as calendar days, both dates included. Employees can also ask for leave themselves from the employee portal; their request arrives here as *Pending*.
2. On a pending request select **Approve** or **Reject**, with a comment if you wish.
3. Approved leave that will not be taken after all: **Cancel leave**.

| Type | Effect when approved |
|---|---|
| **Annual** | Comes off the employee's annual leave balance. Paid as usual. |
| **Unpaid** | The days are deducted by the payroll of the month they fall in. Leave that spans two months is split between them. |
| **Sick, Maternity, Parental, Compassionate, Hajj, Other** | Recorded and shown on the attendance sheet as *On leave*. No effect on the annual balance or the pay. |

The annual leave balance is the opening balance, plus leave earned month by month at the employee's yearly entitlement, less approved annual leave taken. It is shown on the employee's page and in their portal.

## Attendance: the day sheet

HR & Payroll ▸ Attendance

1. Choose the **Date**. Everyone employed that day is listed. People not yet recorded start as *On leave* (when approved leave covers the day), *Weekly off* (on the company's rest day) or *Present*.
2. Set each person's **Status** and, if you record times, **In** and **Out**. Hours worked, overtime and minutes late are worked out from the times.
3. Select **Save the day**.

- **Absent** means absent without leave. It becomes an unauthorised-absence deduction.
- Times entered on a weekly off or a holiday are paid as rest-day overtime.
- On a working day, overtime is the time beyond the normal working day set in Payroll Settings.

## Importing from a time-attendance device

Under **Import device file (CSV)**, choose the file exported from the device and select **Import**. The file has one line per employee per day:

| Column | Format |
|---|---|
| `EmployeeCode` | The code from the employee register, e.g. EMP-0007 |
| `Date` | yyyy-MM-dd or dd/MM/yyyy |
| `CheckIn`, `CheckOut` | HH:mm |

A header line is skipped. Someone clocked in is present; someone clocked in on a rest day is recorded as working on their weekly off.

## From attendance to pay

1. Select **Month summary & payroll**. Each employee's month is summarised: days present, absent, on leave, rest days, days not recorded, late days and minutes, overtime hours and rest-day overtime hours.
2. Check it. Working days with nothing recorded are treated as worked; complete the day sheets first if that is not right.
3. Select **Generate payroll transactions**. One approved transaction is made per employee and kind: overtime, rest-day overtime, unauthorised absence and — if *Deduct late time from pay* is on in Payroll Settings — late arrival.
4. Select **See the transactions** to review them under Payroll Transactions.

Generating again replaces what was generated before, so attendance can be corrected and re-run until the month's payroll is approved.

## Certificates and letters employees ask for

**HR & Payroll ▸ Employee Requests** lists the salary certificates, salary transfer letters and employment certificates employees asked for in their portal, with who the letter is addressed to and why.

- **Issue** gives the letter a reference number. You can **Print** it here, and the employee can open and print it from their phone.
- **Decline**, with a reason.

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# Payroll

Where: **HR & Payroll** ▸ **Payroll Runs**

The monthly payroll runs in three stages — **prepare**, **approve**, **pay** — and writes its own accounting entries. Preparing and paying needs *Prepare & Pay Payroll*; approving needs *Approve Payroll*.

## Payroll Settings: once, before the first payroll

HR & Payroll ▸ Payroll Settings

| Section | What to enter |
|---|---|
| **WPS** | The company's 13-digit MOHRE establishment number, and the name and 9-digit routing code of the bank that sends the salary file. |
| **Accounts** | The accounts the payroll posts to — basic salaries, allowances, overtime and bonuses, salaries payable, employee advances, end-of-service expense and provision — and the default bank salaries are paid from. A payroll cannot be approved until they are chosen. |
| **Calculation** | Overtime rate (1.25 = 125% of the basic hourly wage), rest-day and holiday overtime rate (1.5), working hours a day, the time the working day starts, the weekly rest days, minutes of grace before an arrival counts as late, whether late time is deducted from pay, and whether to provide for end-of-service gratuity every month. |
| **Cheque layout** | Where the date, payee, amount in words and amount in figures print on your bank's cheque, in millimetres, for laser/inkjet or dot matrix printers. Use the test print buttons on plain paper first. |

## Payroll Transactions: the month's additions and deductions

HR & Payroll ▸ Payroll Transactions

Anything beyond the fixed salary is a transaction: overtime, rest-day overtime, a bonus, a commission, another addition; unauthorised absence, late arrival, a penalty, a damage recovery, another deduction.

1. Under **New transaction** choose the employee, the date and the **Kind**.
2. Enter the **Hours** (or minutes or days) for kinds measured in time, or the **Amount** for kinds entered as money, and a description.
3. Tick **Approve now** if you may approve it yourself, and select **Save**. Otherwise it waits; tick the waiting ones in the list and select **Approve selected** or **Reject selected**.

- **Generate from attendance** creates the overtime, absence and lateness transactions from the month's attendance — see Attendance & Leave.
- Overtime is priced at the overtime rate on the basic hourly wage (basic ÷ 30 ÷ daily hours); late minutes at that wage; unauthorised absence reduces the days paid, so it comes off the whole fixed salary.

- The next payroll pays every approved transaction dated on or before its month end that no earlier payroll has paid. Draft payrolls update by themselves when transactions are approved, changed or removed.

## Salary Advances

HR & Payroll ▸ Salary Advances

1. Under **Pay an advance** choose the employee, the date, the **Amount**, the **Monthly recovery**, the account it is **Paid from** and the cheque or transfer reference.
2. Select **Save and Post**.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `11600` Employee Advances | Advance | — |
| Bank or cash it is paid from | — | Advance |

The advance is an asset until it is repaid. Each payroll recovers one instalment, oldest advance first, and the list shows what has been recovered and what is outstanding. Where payment approval is on, the person recording the advance must hold an approval level that covers its amount; otherwise it is refused and someone with that authority records it.

## Step 1 — Prepare the payroll

HR & Payroll ▸ Payroll Runs

1. Choose the **Month** and **Year** and select **Prepare payroll**. The run is numbered `PR-year-month` and calculated for everyone employed in the month.
2. Check each line: days paid, basic, allowances, overtime, unpaid and absent days, additions, advance recovery, deductions and net.
3. To change what one person repays this month, edit **Advance** on their line and select **Save the advance recovery**. To add overtime, a bonus or a deduction, use **+ / − Transaction** on the line.
4. If employee records changed since — a new joiner, a leaver, a salary change, newly approved unpaid leave — select **Recalculate from employee records**. Transactions already entered are kept.
5. **Print register** prints the whole payroll for review. **Delete draft** removes a run prepared by mistake.

Fixed pay is pro rata to the days paid: someone who joined or left during the month, or took unpaid leave, is paid for their days only. Suspended employees are left out.

## Step 2 — Approve

A user with *Approve Payroll* opens the run and selects **Approve payroll**. When the company has more than one payroll approver, the person who prepared the payroll cannot approve it. Where payment approval is on, the approver's level must cover the month's net pay. A payroll with a negative net salary is refused until the deductions are corrected.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Salary expense — basic, allowances, overtime and bonuses (by building, for staff assigned to one) | Gross less deductions | — |
| Employee Advances (instalments recovered) | — | Recovered |
| Salaries Payable | — | Net |
| End-of-service expense | Month's provision | — |
| End-of-service provision | — | Month's provision |

The cost is posted on the day of approval when that falls inside the payroll's month, otherwise on the month end, so it always lands in its own month. Payslips become available — **All payslips** on the run, and each employee's own in their portal.

A mistake found after approval: **Return to draft for a correction**, provided nothing has been paid and the month is still open.

## Step 3 — Pay salaries

Under **Pay salaries** the unpaid employees are grouped by how they are paid. Pay each group:

1. Enter the **Payment date** (on or after the date the salary cost was posted) and the account it is **Paid from**. For cheques, enter the **First cheque number**; each employee gets the next number in the cheque book.
2. Confirm the payment. It appears under **Payments** with its documents.

| Method | Documents |
|---|---|
| **WPS** | **Download SIF**: the Salary Information File in the standard UAE layout, to upload to your bank or exchange house. The same file can be downloaded again later. |
| **Bank transfer** | **Transfer list (CSV)** and a **Letter to bank** to sign. |
| **Cheque** | The cheques themselves, printed on your cheque stationery by laser/inkjet or as a dot matrix file, or on A4 to check the layout. |

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Salaries Payable | Batch total | — |
| Bank it is paid from | — | Batch total |

The bank details and MOHRE code are taken from the employee record as it is on the day of payment, so a corrected IBAN does not need the payroll redone. A rejected WPS file or a spoilt cheque run: **Cancel** the payment while its month is open, and the salaries are payable again.

## Payroll statuses

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Draft** | Being prepared. Nothing in the accounts. |
| **Approved** | Salary cost posted; salaries payable, nothing paid yet. |
| **PartlyPaid** | Some payment batches made. |
| **Paid** | Every salary in the payroll is paid. |

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# Employee Self-Service

Where: **Employee portal (/me)**

Employees have their own small portal, made for a phone, at `/me` on your system's address. There they see their payslips, leave balance and salary advances, ask for leave and ask HR for certificates. Employees are not staff users: they have a separate login and cannot reach any company screen.

## Giving an employee a login (HR)

1. Open **HR & Payroll** ▸ **Employees** and select the employee.
2. In the **Employee portal** panel, enter a **Username** — their mobile number or email — and select **Give portal access**.
3. A temporary password is shown once. Pass it to the employee together with the portal address.

- **Reset password** issues a new temporary password when one is forgotten.
- **Disable** stops the login at once — for a leaver, for example; **Enable** restores it.

## What the employee does

1. Open the portal address and sign in with the username and temporary password.
2. Choose a password of their own when asked: at least ten characters, with capital and small letters and a digit, and not the username.

| Page | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Home** | Annual leave left, last net salary, any advance still to repay, end of service to date, and the monthly package: basic, housing, transport, other and gross. |
| **Payslips** | One payslip for every approved payroll, to view or print. |
| **Leave** | Days available, pending and taken; **Request leave** with the type, dates and a reason, then **Send to HR**; and the status of every request. |
| **Certificates** | **Ask HR for a document** — a salary certificate, a salary transfer letter or an employment certificate — saying who it is addressed to and why. Once HR issues it, the letter can be viewed and printed here. |

Leave requests arrive under **HR & Payroll** ▸ **Leave** and document requests under **HR & Payroll** ▸ **Employee Requests** — see Attendance & Leave.

> **Three separate sign-ins**
>
> Staff sign in to the system itself; tenants to the tenant portal; employees to the employee portal. A login for one never opens another.

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# Business Performance & Owner Monitor

Where: **Controls** ▸ **Business Performance**

Two read-only screens for owners and managers, under the **Controls** menu. **Business Performance** answers "how is the business doing, and what is waiting for me?". The **Owner Monitor** answers "what happened to the money?". Neither can change anything.

## Business Performance

**Controls** ▸ **Business Performance** — needs *View Business Performance* or *Owner Oversight*. All figures come from posted entries.

| Section | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Waiting for your decision** | Everything only you (or your level) can move on: contracts to approve, payments to release, period reopen requests. **Review** opens each one. |
| **Revenue and net profit this year** | With expenses, against last year. |
| **Cash and bank** | The balance now, and collections this month and this year. Collections are receipts plus cleared cheques. |
| **Occupancy** | Units let and vacant, and the annual rent roll. |
| **Owed by tenants** | Total receivable and how much is overdue, with a chart of overdue rent by age: 1–30, 31–60, 61–90 and over 90 days. |
| **Cheques in hand** | Post-dated cheques held, and those due in the next 30 days. |
| **Owed to suppliers** | Total payable and what falls due in 30 days. |
| **Contracts ending in 90 days** | Each contract, tenant, unit, end date and the annual rent to renew. |
| **Revenue and expenses, last 12 months** | A chart month by month. |

**Print** gives a one-page summary. The detailed reports behind each figure are under **Reporting**.

## Owner Monitor

**Controls** ▸ **Owner Monitor** — needs *Owner Oversight*.

1. Choose the **From** and **To** dates.
2. Set **Large if over** to the amount above which you want a posting pointed out, and select **Show**.

| Section | What it shows |
| --- | --- |
| **Cash and bank now** | The balance, and money in and out in the period. |
| **Payments waiting for release** | How many and how much, with a link to the queue. |
| **Authority delegated now** | Who is acting above their level, up to how much and until when. |
| **Needs your attention** | Postings over your "large" amount, and journals left as drafts for more than a week. |
| **Payments released and waiting** | Every payment in the period: who entered it, the amount, its status and who released or decided it — or that it was released within the person's own limit. |
| **Postings to the accounts** | Every entry posted in the period, with large ones highlighted. |

The Owner Monitor is about the business, not about who clicked what: the record of every user's actions is the audit log, under **System Setup ▸ Audit Logs** — see Subscription, Audit Log & Feedback.

## Also on the Controls menu for owners

- **Maintenance Dashboard** — see Maintenance Jobs & Dashboard.
- **Document Expiry** — see Document Expiry.
- **Payment Approvals**, **Authorization Matrix**, **Approval Limits & Delegation** and the **Controls & Security Guide** — see Payment Approvals & Limits.

OWNER CONTROLS · 50

# Payment Approvals & Limits

Where: **Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals**

Payment approval makes sure no money leaves the company on one person's say. A payment is entered by one person and **released** by another whose authority covers the amount. The screens are under the **Controls** menu.

## How a payment travels

1. An accountant records a payment as usual — a vendor payment, a petty cash voucher, an owner settlement, an owner withdrawal or a development cost.
2. If it is within their own limit (and the company allows that), it posts at once and is marked *Released within own limit*. Otherwise it is **held**: saved as a draft journal that has no effect on the accounts or the bank.
3. It goes to the lowest approval level whose limit covers the amount. People on that level, or above it, see a red count beside **Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals** and on **Controls** ▸ **Business Performance**.
4. The approver opens it, checks the journal lines and selects **Approve & release** — the payment posts — or **Turn down**, with a comment saying why.
5. The person who entered it is told the outcome. Every decision is kept with who made it and when.

> **Two rules that never bend**
> Nobody releases a payment they entered themselves above their own limit, and **petty cash always needs a second person**, however small the amount.

## Payment Approvals: releasing

**Controls** ▸ **Payment Approvals** lists what is waiting: who entered it, the payment, the amount and the journal it will post. **Show decided too** adds the payments already released or turned down. Needs *Release Payments* or *Owner Oversight*.

## Approval Limits & Delegation: setting it up (owners)

Controls ▸ Approval Limits & Delegation

1. **Payments need approval**: switch the control on.
2. **The person entering a payment may release it within their own limit**: leave it off and every payment needs a second person.
3. **Apply the limits to contracts too**: the approver's level must then cover a contract's annual rent. Off, any contract approver may approve any contract (never their own).
4. **Levels**: a new company starts with Accountant (1,000), Manager (5,000) and Owner (no limit). Change the limits or add a level; leave a limit blank for no limit. Select **Save levels**.

5. **People**: put each user on a level, or *No authority*, and select **Save assignments**.

Payroll and salary advances post directly rather than waiting in the queue, so there the check is made on the spot: the person approving the payroll or recording the advance must hold a level that covers the amount.

## Delegating while you are away

1. Under **Delegate authority while you are away**, choose the person, an amount **Up to** (blank gives them your own limit), the **From** and **Until** dates and a reason.
2. Select **Delegate**.

It ends by itself on the last day; **End now** ends it earlier. Delegations in force are shown on the Owner Monitor and the Authorization Matrix.

## The Authorization Matrix

**Controls** ▸ **Authorization Matrix** is a printable statement of who may do what in the company: each role and what it allows, the approval levels with their limits and the people on them, delegations in force, how an approval travels, and every user with their role and level. Print it for your auditors or your policy file. Roles are changed under Users & Permissions.

## Controls & Security Guide

**Controls** ▸ **Controls & Security Guide**, for owners: the controls the system enforces by itself, the ones to adopt as company policy, and plain answers to the security questions owners ask.

REPORTING · 51

# Trial Balance

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Trial Balance**

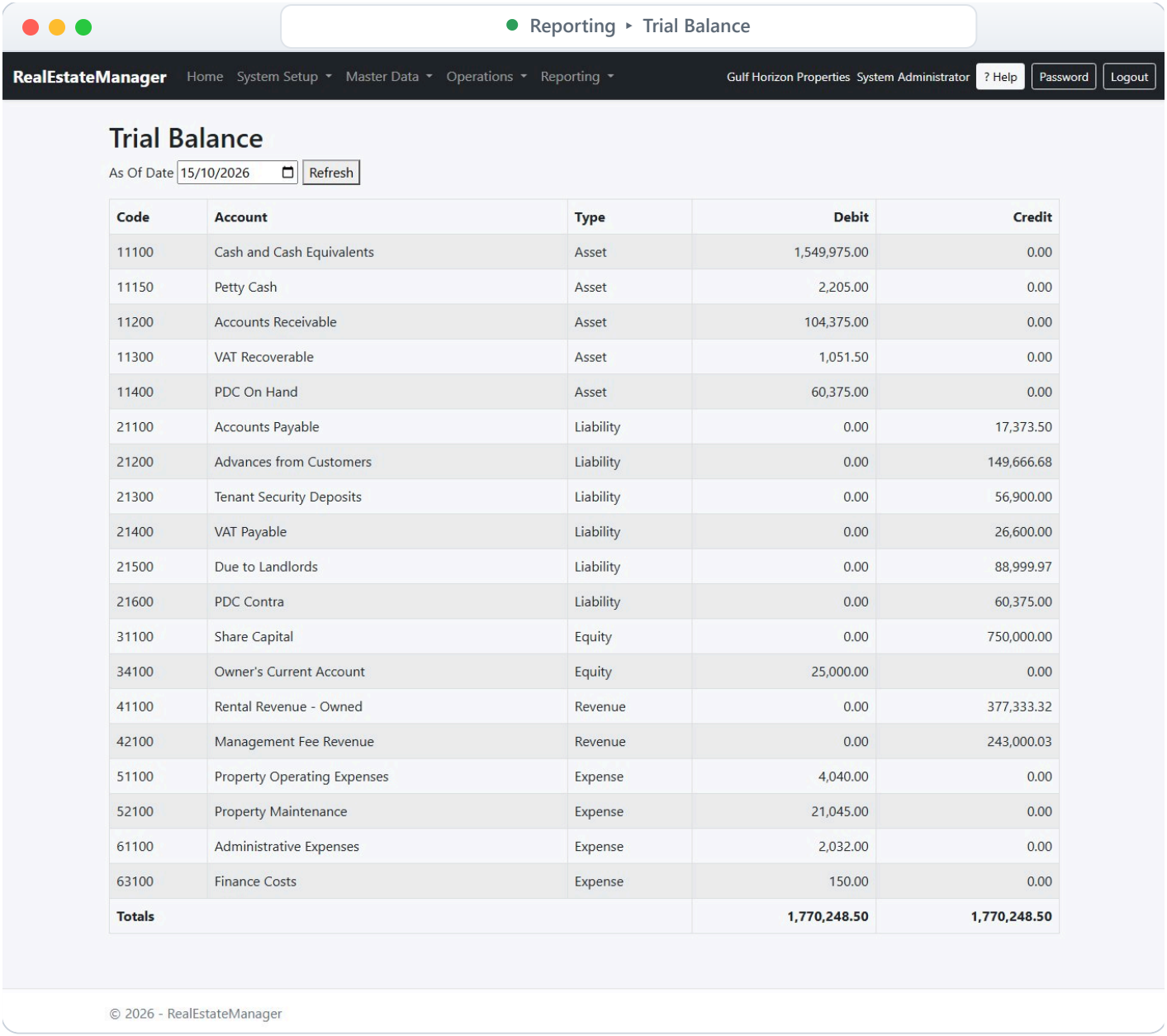
The Trial Balance lists every account with a balance as at a chosen date and proves that the ledger is internally consistent. It is the first report to run and the last one to check.

Video: **The reports** (1:46) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.

The report is **cumulative**: it includes every posted journal from the beginning of the ledger up to and including the as-of date, plus opening balances. That is the correct behaviour for a trial balance — it shows a position, not a movement. To see movement between two dates, use the **General Ledger** report (General Ledger & Tenant Statement), which shows opening balance, period debits, period credits and closing balance per account.




The trial balance: total debits equal total credits.

> **Posted journals only**
> Drafts are left out of this and every other report. If a figure is missing, look for a draft in Journal Inquiry.

## Columns

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Code / Account** | The account, sorted by code. |
| **Type** | Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense. |
| **Debit** | Shown when the account's net balance is on the debit side. |
| **Credit** | Shown when the account's net balance is on the credit side. |

Each account appears once, with its net balance on one side only. Accounts with a nil balance are omitted.

**Totals must be equal**

Total Debit must equal Total Credit. Because the system refuses to post an unbalanced journal, any difference comes from opening balances, not from transactions. Go to **System Setup ▸ Opening Balances** and check the Net Imbalance card — the difference on the Trial Balance will match it exactly. Troubleshooting walks through the diagnosis.

**Click any figure**

Account codes, names and amounts open the account's General Ledger for this report's period; ← **Back to …** in the ledger brings you back. See General Ledger.

REPORTING · 52

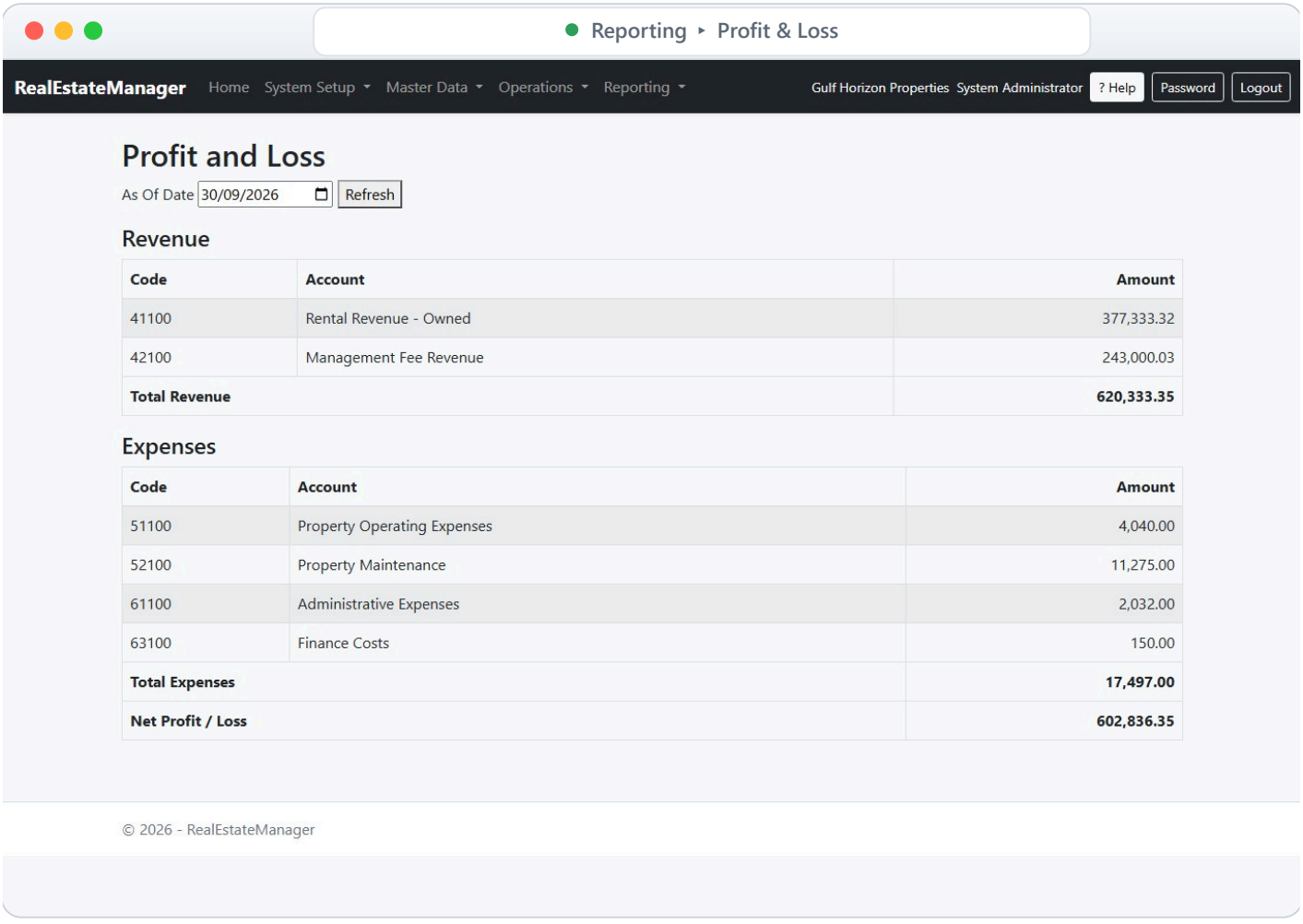
# Profit & Loss

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Profit & Loss**

The Profit & Loss reports performance **over a period**: revenue earned less expenses incurred between two dates.

## Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date** — the end of the period you want.
2. Select **Refresh**. The report covers **1 January of that year to the as-of date**.




Profit & Loss for the year to date.

## What it contains

The report is laid out as an income statement. Each account sits on its **income statement line**, chosen on the account in the Chart of Accounts.

| Section | Contents |
|---|---|
| **Revenue** | By kind: rental income from owned properties, management commission from managed properties, property sales, other income. |
| **Cost of revenue** | The costs of earning that revenue: property operating costs, maintenance of owned properties, the cost of units sold. |
| **Gross profit** | Revenue less cost of revenue. |
| **Fixed costs** | The same every month whatever the activity: salaries, office rent, depreciation, insurance. |
| **Recurring costs** | Running costs that move with the activity: utilities, office supplies, overtime, irrecoverable VAT. |
| **Operating profit** | Gross profit less fixed and recurring costs. |
| **Finance costs** | Interest and bank charges. |
| **Net profit / (loss)** | The result. This is the figure the Balance Sheet shows as Current Year Profit / Loss. |

To move an account to another line — say, from recurring to fixed costs — open it in the chart of accounts and change its **Income statement line**. Totals do not change; only where the account is shown.

> **Managed properties**
> The rent of a managed property belongs to its owner and is not revenue here; only the commission is. Costs of managed properties are charged to their owners and do not appear here either — see Owner Reports.

> **Revenue appears only after recognition**
> Invoicing a tenant does not create revenue. If the Profit & Loss shows less rent than you expect, the usual reason is that revenue recognition has not been processed up to the report date. Run **System Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition** and refresh.

> **Non-calendar fiscal years**
> The report currently starts the period at 1 January of the as-of year. If your company's fiscal year starts in another month, the Profit & Loss period and the Balance Sheet's Current Year Profit / Loss will not agree. In that case, read the year-to-date result from the Balance Sheet, which follows the company's configured fiscal year start.
>
> The **Profit & Loss by Property** report (Management Reports) does not have this limitation: it takes an explicit From and To date and defaults to the company's configured fiscal year. Use it when you need a period other than calendar year to date.

## Analysing the result by property

This report presents the company as a whole. To see the same revenue and expenses broken down per property, use **Reporting ▸ P&L by Property** — see Management Reports.

**Click any figure**

Account codes, names and amounts open the account's General Ledger for this report's period; ← **Back to …** in the ledger brings you back. See General Ledger.

REPORTING · 53

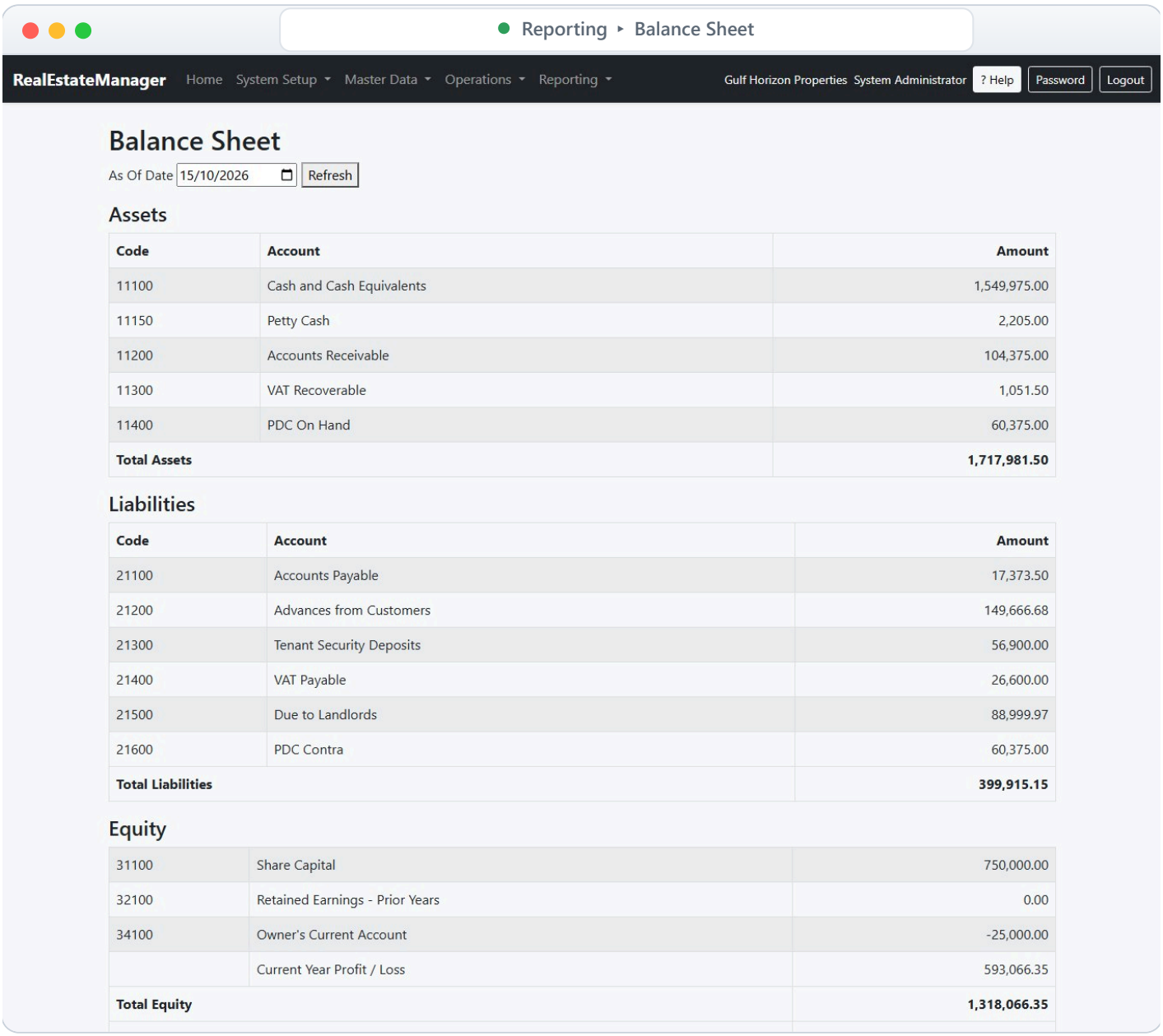
# Balance Sheet

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Balance Sheet**

The Balance Sheet reports financial position **at a single date**: what the company owns, what it owes, and the residual belonging to the owners.

## Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.




The balance sheet: assets equal liabilities plus equity.

## Structure

| Section | Contents |
|---|---|
| **Assets** | Cash, receivables, VAT recoverable, PDCs on hand, prepaid expenses, investment property, fixed assets net of accumulated depreciation. |
| **Liabilities** | Payables, advances from customers (deferred rent), security deposits held, VAT payable, amounts due to landlords, PDC contra. |
| **Equity** | Share Capital, Retained Earnings – Prior Years, any other equity accounts, and **Current Year Profit / Loss** computed from the fiscal-year-to-date Profit & Loss. |

## The balancing check

**Total Assets** must equal **Total Liabilities and Equity**. If they differ, the cause is almost always one of:

- **Unbalanced opening balances.** Check **System Setup ▸ Opening Balances**; the difference will match the Net Imbalance exactly.
- **An unclosed prior fiscal year.** Prior-year profit remains in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present. Close the year (Period & Year Closing).

> **Cross-check against the Trial Balance**
>
> Trial Balance total debit minus total credit equals Total Assets minus Total Liabilities and Equity. The two reports fail together and are fixed together — you never have to diagnose them separately.

> **Click any figure**
>
> Account codes, names and amounts open the account's General Ledger for this report's period; ← **Back to …** in the ledger brings you back. See General Ledger.

REPORTING · 54

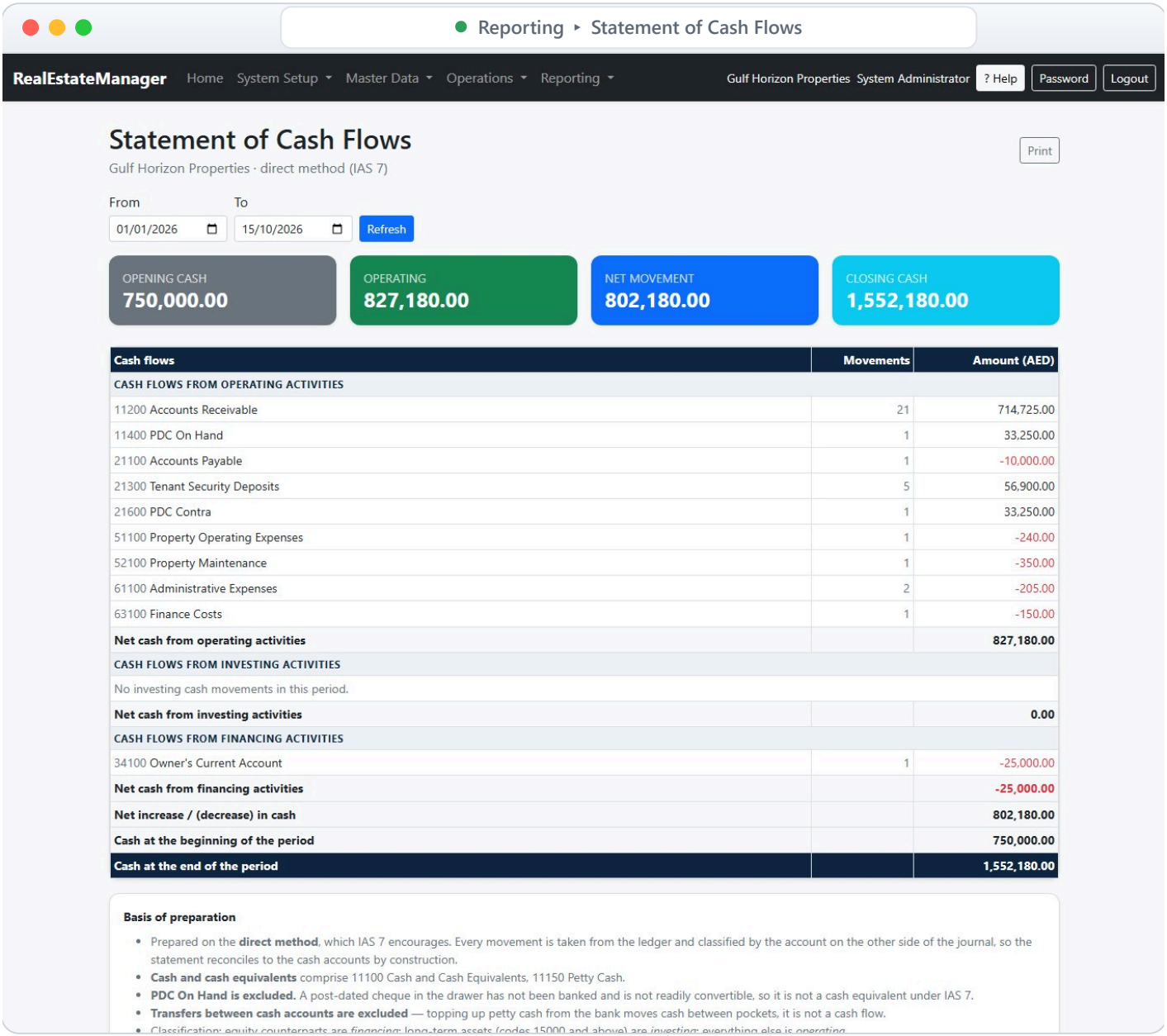
# Statement of Cash Flows

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Statement of Cash Flows**

The Statement of Cash Flows shows where cash came from and where it went over a period, prepared under **IAS 7** using the **direct method**. It answers the question the Profit & Loss cannot: the business made a profit, so why is there less cash?

## Running the report

1. Enter the **From** and **To** dates. The default is the fiscal year to date.
2. Refresh. **Print** gives a clean copy.




The Statement of Cash Flows (IAS 7, direct method).

## How to read it

Four cards summarise the period: **Opening Cash**, **Operating** cash flow, **Net Movement** and **Closing Cash**. The statement below splits the movement three ways:

| Section | What lands there |
|---|---|
| **Operating** | Rent collected, suppliers and expenses paid, VAT paid or refunded, deposits taken or returned — the day-to-day business. |
| **Investing** | Buying or selling long-term assets — property, fixed assets (accounts coded 15000 and above). |
| **Financing** | Capital put in by owners, owner drawings, loans — anything touching equity. |

Each line is the account on the other side of the cash movement, with a **Movements** count of the journals behind it, so a surprising figure can be traced in Journal Inquiry.

The statement ends: net increase or decrease in cash + cash at the beginning = cash at the end.

## What counts as cash

- **Included:** the account mapped as Default Cash, plus every petty cash float.
- **Excluded: PDC On Hand.** A post-dated cheque in the drawer has not been banked, so it is not a cash equivalent. It enters the statement when it clears.
- **Excluded: transfers between cash accounts.** Topping up petty cash from the bank moves cash between pockets; it is not a cash flow.

> **It always reconciles**
> Every movement is read from the ledger itself, so the closing figure always agrees with the cash accounts in the Trial Balance. If it ever does not, a red warning appears at the top with the difference. That would mean a journal shape the report did not expect — report it through **System Setup ▸ Send Feedback**.

> **Nothing appears?**
> If the report says no cash accounts are configured, set the **Default Cash** mapping in Account Mapping. Like every report, it includes posted journals only.

REPORTING · 55

# General Ledger, Tenant & Vendor Statements

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **General Ledger**

## General Ledger

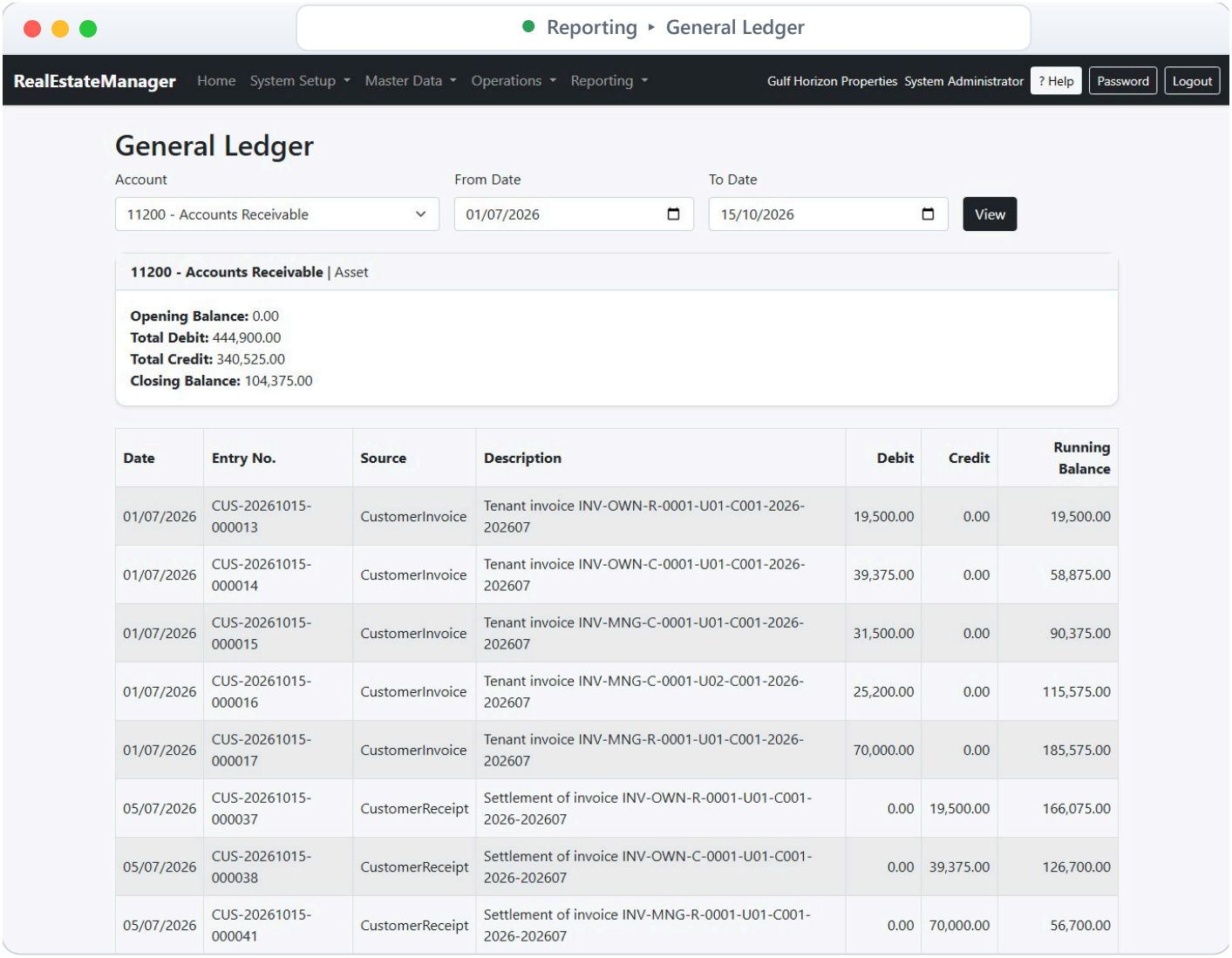
> **From any report figure to the ledger, and back**
> On the Trial Balance, Profit & Loss and Balance Sheet, every account code, name and amount (underlined with dots) opens the General Ledger of that account for the report's period. At the top left of the ledger, ← **Back to …** returns to the report you came from, and the buttons beside it open the Trial Balance, Balance Sheet, Profit & Loss or General Journal for the same date.

**Reporting ▸ General Ledger**

The General Ledger shows the detailed movement of a single account between two dates. This is the report to use when you need *activity for a period* rather than a position at a date.

1. Choose the **Account**.
2. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**.
3. Select **Refresh**.

The report presents the **opening balance** at the from-date, then every journal line in the period with its date, entry number, description and debit or credit, with a **running balance**, and finally the **closing balance** and period totals.




The general ledger for Accounts Receivable: opening balance, movements and running balance.

> **Use this to explain any Trial Balance figure**
>
> If an account's Trial Balance figure looks wrong, run the General Ledger for that account across the full period. Every posting that produced the balance is listed, each traceable to its source document through Journal Inquiry.

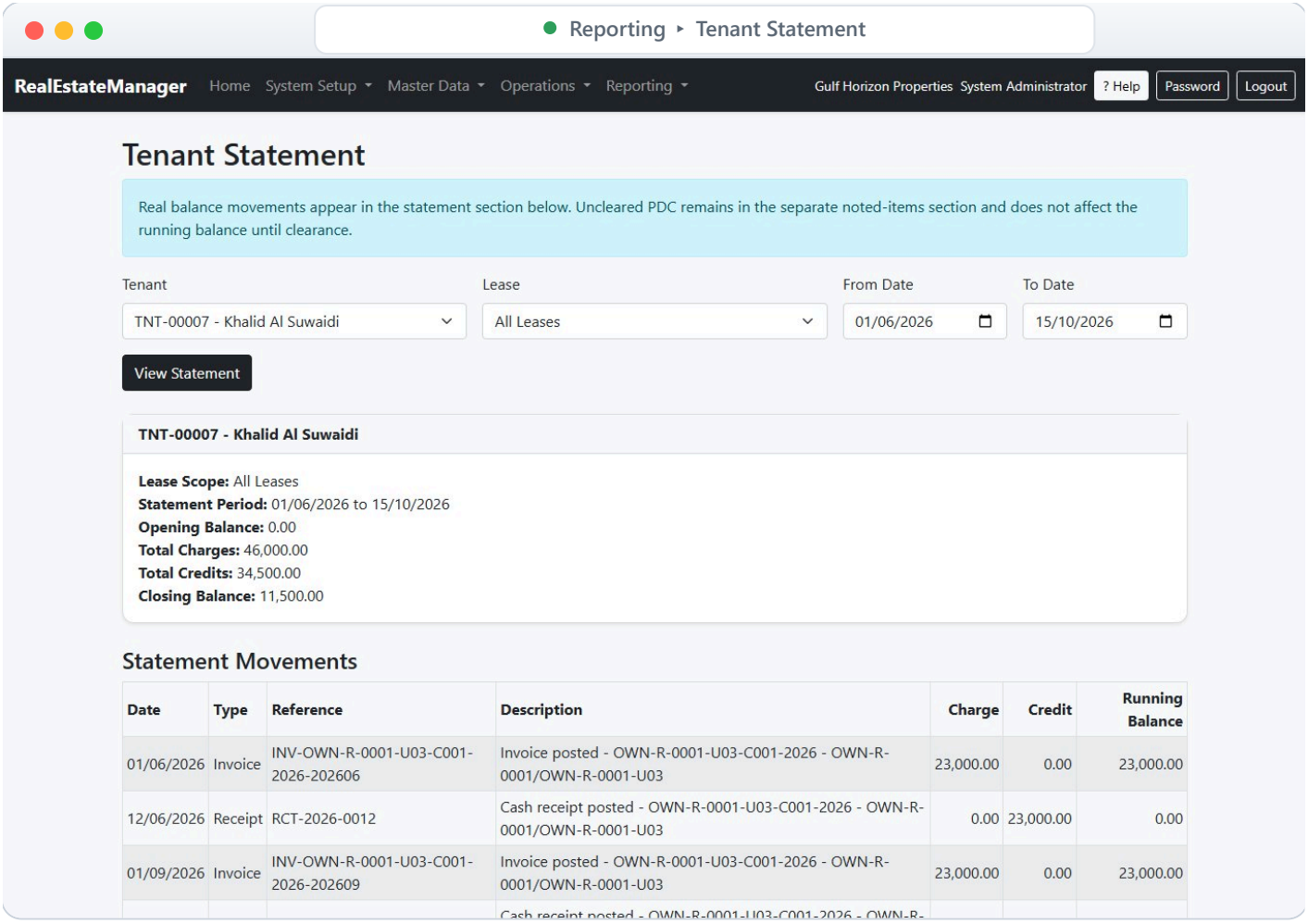
## Tenant Statement

**Reporting ▸ Tenant Statement**

A tenant-facing account showing everything charged to and received from one tenant.

1. Choose the **Tenant**.
2. Enter the date range.
3. Select **Refresh**, then print or save to PDF for the tenant.

The statement shows the tenant's opening balance, each invoice as a charge and each receipt or cleared PDC as a credit in date order with a running balance, then total charges, total payments and the closing balance owed.




A tenant statement with an overdue balance.

## Vendor Statement

### Reporting ▸ Vendor Statement

One supplier's account with you: what you owe them and how it arose. Use it to agree your balance with the supplier's own statement, or to answer "what have we paid them this year?".

1. Choose the **Vendor**.
2. Enter the date range.
3. Select **View Statement**, then **Print** or save to PDF.

The statement shows the opening balance owed, then every posted bill (billed, a credit) and payment (paid, a debit) in date order with a running balance, then the closing balance you owe. Underneath, **Open Bills** lists the posted bills not yet fully paid at the end date, with the days overdue. **Advances (down payments)** are listed separately, each with the amount applied to bills and the amount still open: they are kept on `11550` Advances to Suppliers, apart from payables — see Vendor Payments.

It is read from Accounts Payable itself, so draft bills and payments are not shown, and the closing balances of all vendors add up to Accounts Payable in the Trial Balance. Manual journals on Accounts Payable appear when the line was given the vendor.

## Opening the original document

In the General Ledger, Journal Inquiry, the General Journal and the tenant and vendor statements, the **entry number** opens the journal entry with all its lines, and the **source** or **reference** opens the original document — the invoice, bill, receipt, cheque, payment, petty cash voucher, depreciation run and so on. From the journal entry page, **Open original document** does the same, and each account opens its ledger.

## General Journal

**Reporting ▸ General Journal**

Every journal entry of a period with all its lines, its source and the document it came from. Filter by **source** (invoices, bills, payroll, manual journals…), **status** and a search text; a summary shows the count and total by source. **Export CSV** gives one row per line for a spreadsheet.

REPORTING · 56

# Investment Property Note

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Investment Property Note**

Reporting ▸ Investment Property Note

Buildings held to earn rent are **investment property**. The company uses the **cost model** (IAS 40): investment property is carried at cost less accumulated depreciation. Land is never depreciated; buildings are depreciated straight-line over their useful lives. The fair value is *not* booked — it is disclosed in the note, as the standard requires.

## Running the note

1. Enter the period — normally the financial year — and select **Refresh**.
2. The first table is the **movement in the carrying amount**: cost at the start, additions, buildings transferred from properties under construction, disposals, cost at the end; then accumulated depreciation at the start, the charge for the period and at the end; and the carrying amount at both dates.
3. The second table shows each property's cost, accumulated depreciation, carrying amount and **fair value**, with the valuation date and valuer.
4. Select **Print** to take it into the financial statements. A suggested wording for the accounting policy and fair value disclosure is printed underneath.

The figures are read from `15100` Investment Property and `15150` Accumulated Depreciation - Investment Property, so they agree with the balance sheet. Opening balances brought forward from a previous system, and entries posted without a property, are shown on a separate line as *not allocated to a property*.

## Recording the fair value

Open the property in **Master Data** ▸ **Properties** ▸ **Edit** and fill in the **Valuation** section: the fair value from the latest independent valuation, its date and the valuer. Update it at each year end. If any investment property has no fair value, the note warns you.

## Where the depreciation comes from

When a rental building is completed and transferred (see Development Projects), its building part is entered in the fixed asset register with the useful life you gave, and the monthly depreciation run posts the charge:

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| `62100` Depreciation Expense | Monthly charge | — |
| `15150` Accumulated Depreciation - Investment Property | — | Monthly charge |

## Depreciating a building brought in as an opening balance

An investment property brought in as an opening balance on `15100` is not depreciated until it is set up. At the foot of the note, under **Depreciate an Existing Building** (needs *Manage Accounting*):

1. Choose the property and the month depreciation starts.
2. Split its carrying amount into **land** (never depreciated) and **building**. If the building was depreciated in a previous system, enter its carrying amount — cost less the depreciation so far.
3. Enter the building's **remaining useful life** in years.
4. Leave *allocate* ticked to move land and building out of the unallocated opening balance and onto the property, so the note shows them against the building. Select **Set Up Depreciation**.

The building is entered in the fixed asset register and the monthly depreciation run charges it from then on.

REPORTING · 57

# Real Estate VAT

Where: **Operations** ▸ **Capital Assets Scheme (VAT)**

How the system applies UAE VAT to the sale and lease of real estate, and the ten-year review of input tax on buildings. Confirm the treatment of unusual cases with your tax adviser.

## Supplies: sales and leases

| Supply | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Commercial property — sale or lease | Standard rated, 5% |
| Residential — the **first supply** of a new unit (its first sale or first lease), within three years of the building's completion, or before completion | Zero rated — the related input tax is recoverable |
| Residential — any later supply | Exempt — no output tax, and related input tax is not recoverable |

The system decides this for every new lease and sale:

- A building is *new* when its property has a **completion date** (from the completion certificate) or a development project. Without either, a residential building is treated as existing and its supplies are exempt.
- Each unit records its **first supply** — the date, whether it was a sale or a lease, and the contract — when the first contract takes effect. Every later lease or sale of the unit is exempt.
- The three years run from the completion date. The property page shows the last day of the window.
- A unit or property deliberately set to zero rated keeps that; a lease's treatment can still be overridden with a reason.

## The Capital Assets Scheme

**Operations ▸ Capital Assets Scheme (VAT)**

A building costing **AED 5 million or more** before VAT is a capital asset. The input tax recovered on it is reviewed every year for **ten years** against how it was actually used. The usual case: a residential building built to rent out recovers its construction VAT because the first leases are zero rated, but later leases are exempt — so part of that VAT is paid back over the following years.

1. **Register the building.** Completed rental or own-use development projects of AED 5 million or more are listed; **Register** takes the input VAT charged and recovered from the project's posted supplier bills. A building bought or built outside the system is registered by hand. Year 1 starts on the first-use date.
2. **Review each year once it is over.** Open the asset: the next year due is offered, with a proposed **taxable use** worked out from the building's leases — each unit's area for the days it was let, standard or zero-rated leases

counting as taxable and exempt leases as exempt. Change it if you know better.

3. **Post the adjustment.** Adjustment = input VAT × (taxable use this year − taxable use at recovery) ÷ 10. It is dated after the year ends and goes in that period's VAT return.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| *Tax to pay back (use became more exempt)* | | |
| `61200` Irrecoverable VAT - Capital Assets Scheme | Adjustment | — |
| `11300` VAT Recoverable | — | Adjustment |
| *More tax recoverable (use became more taxable)* | | |
| `11300` VAT Recoverable | Adjustment | — |
| `61200` Irrecoverable VAT - Capital Assets Scheme | — | Adjustment |

## In the VAT return

The VAT return shows unit sales by treatment (… - *sale of units*): payments received before handover in the period they are received, and the balance at handover in the handover period. Capital Assets Scheme adjustments appear under input tax as *Capital Assets Scheme adjustment*.

REPORTING · 58

# VAT Return

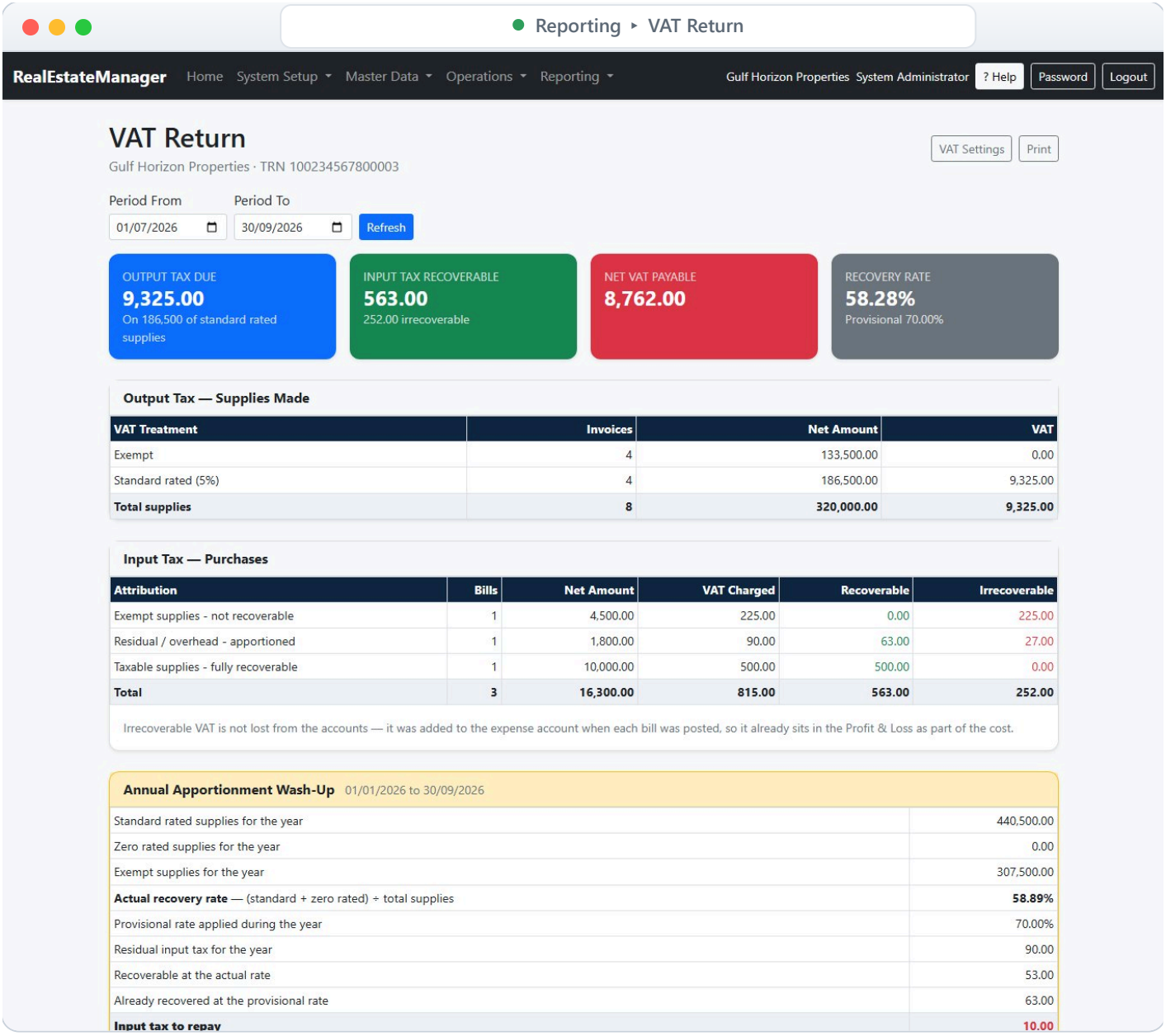
Where: **Reporting** ▸ **VAT Return**

The figures for your UAE VAT return for a tax period: VAT you charged tenants, VAT you can reclaim on costs, and the difference you owe. Use it to fill in the return on the FTA portal.

## Running the report

1. Enter the tax period **From** and **To** dates. The default is the calendar quarter you are in, the usual period for a business of this size.
2. Refresh.

If no TRN is set, the report warns you first — see VAT Settings.




The VAT return for the third quarter: output tax, recoverable input tax and the recovery rate.

## What it shows

| Section | Contents |
|---|---|
| **Output Tax Due** | VAT charged on posted customer invoices in the period. |
| **Input Tax Recoverable** | VAT you can reclaim on posted vendor bills in the period. |
| **Output Tax — Supplies Made** | Invoices grouped by VAT treatment (standard, exempt, zero-rated): number of invoices, net amount, VAT. Posted credit notes dated in the period appear under each treatment as *Less credit notes* and reduce both the supplies and the output tax. Our monthly commission tax invoices to landlords of managed properties appear as *Standard rated - management commission to landlords* (see Owner Settlements). Unit sales appear as … - *sale of units*, and Capital Assets Scheme adjustments under input tax (see Real Estate VAT). |
| **Input Tax — Purchases** | Bill lines grouped by attribution (taxable, exempt, residual): number of bills, net amount, VAT charged, recoverable and irrecoverable. |
| **Recovery Rate** | The actual recovery rate for the period — taxable supplies as a share of all supplies made — with the provisional rate from VAT Settings shown underneath for comparison. |

**Net VAT payable** is Output Tax Due less Input Tax Recoverable. A negative figure is a refund due to you.

> **Only posted documents count**
>
> Draft invoices and draft bills are left out, because they are not in the accounts. Post everything for the period before you run the return. Bills from suppliers who are not VAT registered carry no VAT and do not appear in the input tax figures at all.

> **Owners' rent and our recharges**
>
> Rent invoiced in an owner's name is the owner's supply and is left out of this return. Costs we recharge to owners are our own standard-rated supplies and appear as *Standard rated – costs recharged to owners*. See Costs passed on to owners.

## The annual apportionment wash-up

Residual input VAT is reclaimed during the year at the *provisional* recovery rate. At the end of the fiscal year the report compares that with the **actual recovery rate** — your taxable supplies as a share of all supplies for the year — and shows the difference:

- A **positive** figure is additional VAT you may reclaim.
- A **negative** figure is VAT reclaimed too generously that must be repaid.

This figure is **not posted automatically**. Enter it on the return for the first period after year end, and record it with a manual journal between `11300` VAT Recoverable and the expense account the residual costs were charged to. Then update the provisional rate in VAT Settings for the new year.

## Settling with the FTA

When you pay the VAT due, post a manual journal: Dr `21400` VAT Payable for the output tax, Cr `11300` VAT Recoverable for the input tax, Cr `11100` Cash for the net amount paid.

## Owner VAT Return

**Reporting ▸ Owner VAT Return**

The VAT position of a VAT-registered owner of managed properties, for them to file under their own TRN. Choose the owner (only owners with a TRN are listed) and the tax period — the calendar quarter by default.

| Part | What it contains |
|---|---|
| **Output tax** | Rent invoiced in the owner's name (see invoicing in the owner's name), by VAT category, less credit notes against it. |
| **Input tax** | The company's tax invoices to the owner — management commission and recharged costs — and the supplier's VAT on costs the company paid on the owner's behalf (disbursements). |
| **Net VAT** | Payable when output exceeds input, refundable otherwise. |

Every document is listed and opens. If some of the owner's properties are still invoiced by the company, a note says so: that rent is on the company's return, not the owner's. The owner adds any other income or costs of theirs that are outside this system.

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# Building View

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Building View**

**Reporting** ▸ **Building View**, or **Building view** on a property's page.

Each building drawn floor by floor, every unit coloured by the health of its rent, so an owner sees at a glance where the building earns well and where it needs attention. Select a unit for its details.

## All buildings

The first page shows every property as a card: how much of it is let, a bar of its units by colour, the counts of healthy, watch and at-risk units, and the rent overdue. **Open building** draws it.

## The colours

| Colour | When |
|---|---|
| **Green - healthy** | Let, and none of the warning signs below |
| **Yellow - watch** | Tenant health score below 75, or rent overdue more than 30 days, or a request to postpone a payment in the last 12 months |
| **Red - at risk** | Tenant health score below 55, or rent overdue more than 90 days, or a cheque on the contract bounced in the last 12 months |
| **Grey** | Vacant (no current contract); striped grey is under maintenance |
| **Blue** | Reserved for a buyer (light) or sold and handed over (darker) - see Unit Sales |

The score is the tenant's score from Tenant Health & Ranking, so the drawing and the report always agree. Select a colour above the drawing to show only those units; select it again to show all.

## A unit's details

Selecting a unit shows its tenant (linked to their statement) and contract, the health score and grade, the annual rent, what was billed, collected, outstanding and overdue (with the age of the oldest overdue item), bounced cheques and postponement requests in the last 12 months, the days to the contract's end (highlighted inside 90 days), a bar of billed rent collected, and **Why this colour** - each reason that set it. For a vacant unit it shows how long it has been empty and the rent lost.

## How the building is drawn

- Floors run from the lowest to the highest unit, and up to the property's *Number of floors* when recorded, so a tower with only some units entered still has its full height. Floors with no units say so.
- Each unit is placed on its floor by the unit's **Floor number**; when that is empty, it is read from the *Floor* text (G = ground, 3 = third, B1 = first basement).

- Along the floor, units go left to right by **Position on the floor**, then by unit number, and each is as wide as its share of the floor's area.

Set both on the unit in **Master Data** ▸ **Units** ▸ **Edit** to arrange a building exactly as it stands.

## 2.5D, 3D and Photo

The **2.5D | 3D | Photo** switch above the drawing changes how the building is shown; the colours, the legend and the unit details are the same in both, and the choice is remembered on your computer.

- **2.5D** draws the building's front face with its side and roof at an angle. Every unit is visible at once, and it prints well.
- **3D** builds a model you can turn: drag to rotate, scroll or pinch to zoom, right-drag to move it. It turns slowly by itself until you touch it. Point at a unit to see its number; select it for its details.

In 3D each unit sits on its **Side of the building** - front, back, left or right - set on the unit. Front and back units share the depth of the floor; left and right units take its two ends. A floor whose units have no side recorded is shared between front and back.

## Photo mode: the real building

In **Photo** mode the building view shows a real photograph of the building, with each unit's windows or balcony tinted in its colour. Select a tinted unit for its details; the legend filter works here too. A building can have several photos - front, back, sides - shown as buttons above the photo. Units not marked on the photo shown are listed underneath it.

Setting it up takes two steps, once per photo (needs *Create & Edit Master Data*):

1. **Upload the photo.** On the building view select *Manage photos and mark units* (or Photo mode ▸ the upload link). Name the side it shows and choose the file - JPG or PNG, up to 8 MB. A photo taken straight on, with the whole building in frame, works best.
2. **Mark the units.** The marking screen opens: pick a unit on the right, click the corners of its windows or balcony on the photo, and select **Save outline** (or press Enter). The next unmarked unit is chosen for you. *Undo corner* (Backspace) removes the last click; click a saved outline to select its unit again; *Remove outline* clears it.

> **A tower in minutes: repeat floors**
> Mark the units of two floors one above the other - for example floors 1 and 2. Under **Repeat Floors Up the Building** choose those two floors and the last floor, and select **Repeat floors**. The distance between the two marked floors is measured and the upper floor's outlines are repeated on every floor above, matched to each floor's units left to right (by their position on the floor, then unit number). Outlines already marked are kept unless you tick *Replace*. Check the result - a photo taken at an angle makes upper floors smaller - and adjust any outline that does not sit right.

Photos are stored with the company's data and seen only by users who can open the building view.

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# Tenant & Property Reports

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Management — Tenants & Properties**

The three reports in this chapter answer management questions rather than accounting questions: *which property is making money*, *how hard is the portfolio working*, and *which tenants can we rely on*. They are listed under **Reporting** ▸ **Management** and require the **View Reports** permission.

## Profit & Loss by Property

**Reporting** ▸ **P&L by Property**

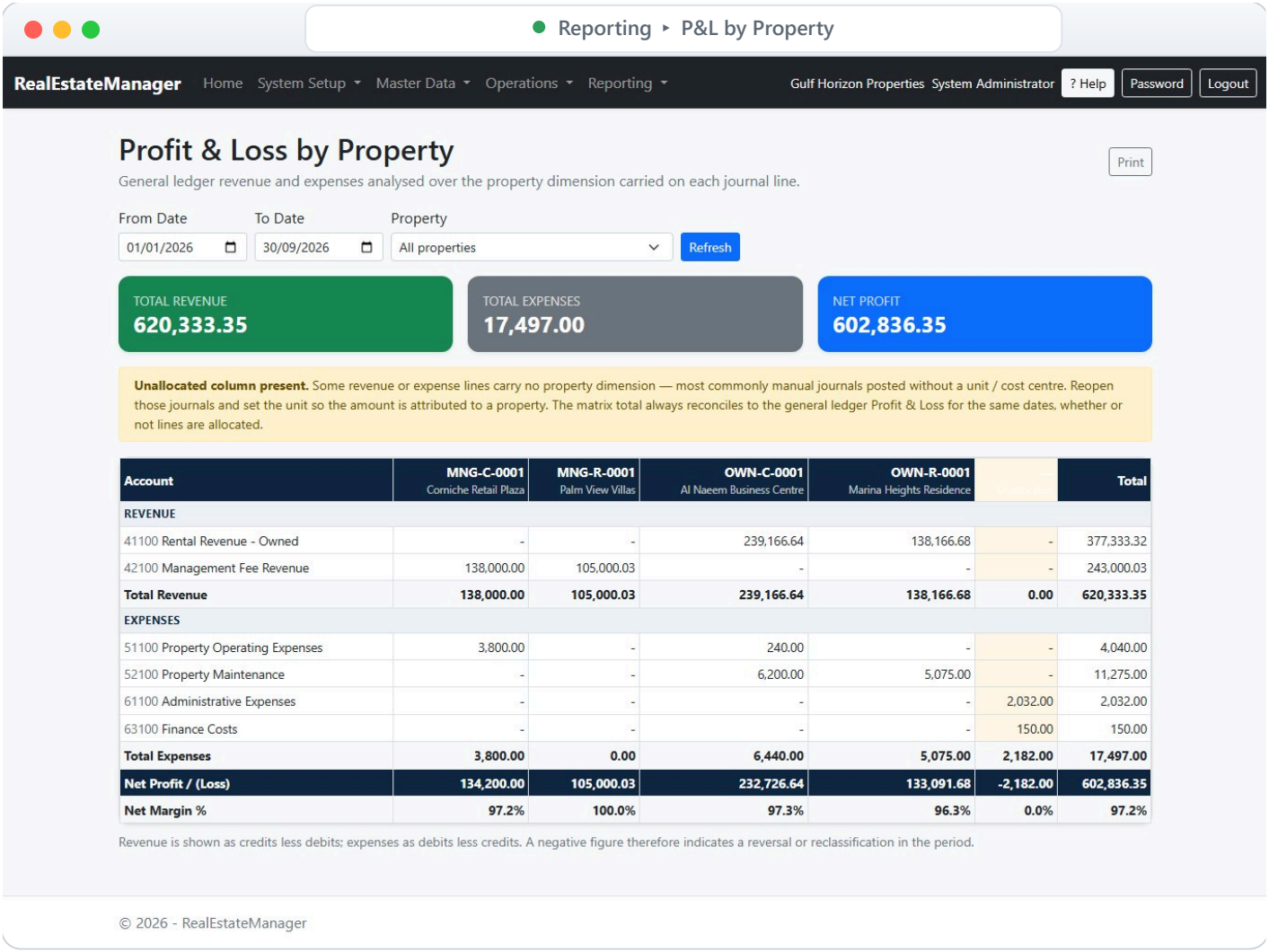
This is the general ledger Profit & Loss analysed across the **property dimension** that every journal line already carries. Accounts run down the rows, properties across the columns, so you can read one property's result down a column or one account across the whole portfolio along a row.

1. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**. The default is the current fiscal year to date, honouring the company's fiscal year start month.
2. Optionally choose a single **Property** to narrow the report to one column.
3. Select **Refresh**.

Each column shows total revenue, total expenses, net profit or loss and net margin percentage. The final column totals the row across all properties and reconciles to the general ledger Profit & Loss for the same dates.

> **The Unallocated column**
>
> A journal line only carries a property if the source transaction identified one. Invoices, receipts, PDCs, revenue recognition and security deposits always do, because they descend from a lease. Vendor bills do when a property is chosen on the bill. **Manual journals only do when a unit / cost centre is selected on the line** — the property is then derived from that unit.
>
> Anything without a property is collected into a highlighted **Unallocated** column so the report still reconciles to the GL. If that column is large, the fix is to reopen those manual journals and set the unit.

Revenue is presented as credits less debits and expenses as debits less credits, so a negative figure means a reversal or reclassification occurred in the period rather than an error.




Profit & Loss by property, with the portfolio total.

## Property Utilization

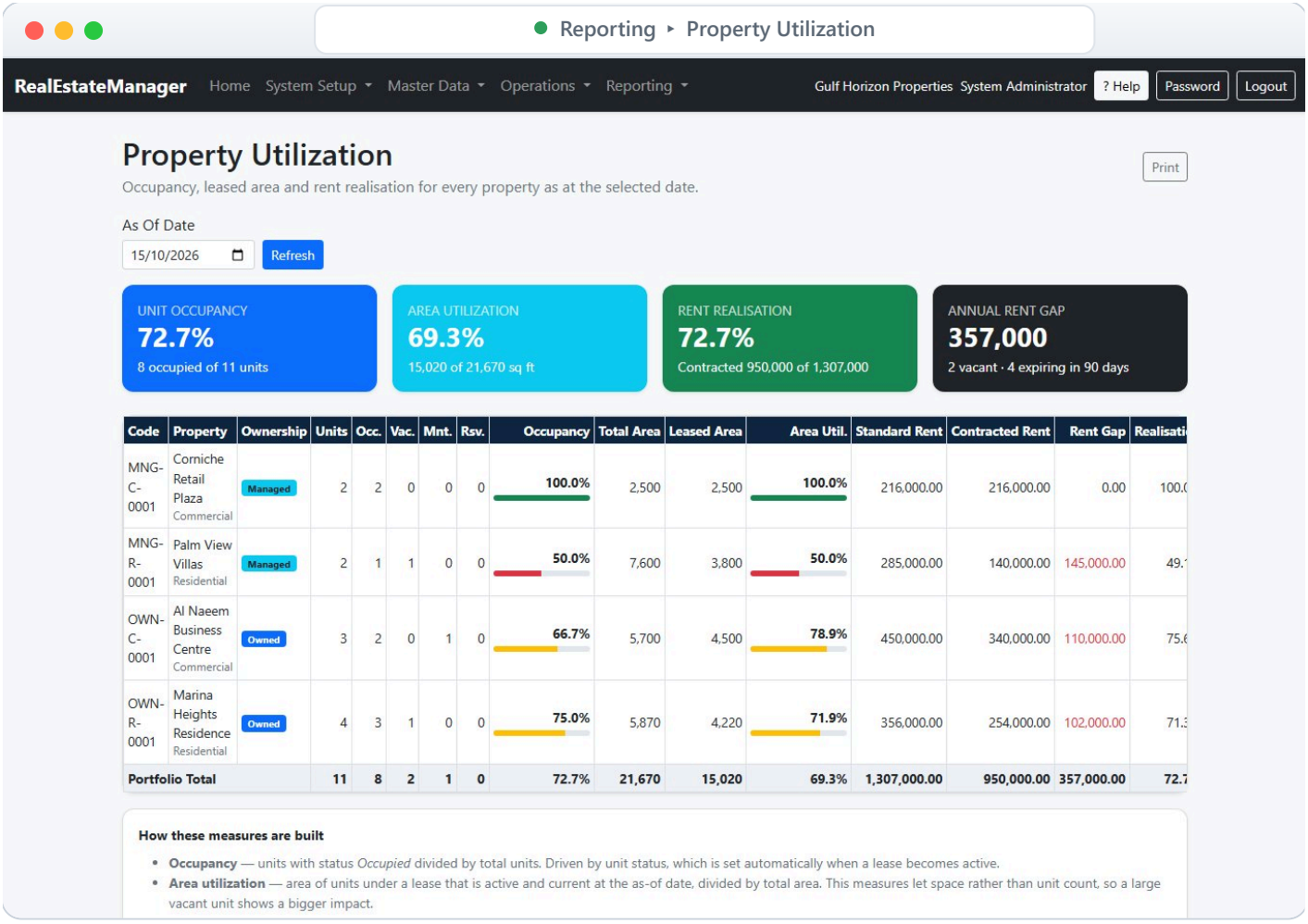
### Reporting ▸ Property Utilization

A single-page view of how hard each property is working at a chosen date.

| Measure | How it is calculated |
|---|---|
| **Occupancy %** | Units with status *Occupied* ÷ total units. Driven by unit status, which is set automatically when a lease becomes active. |
| **Area utilization %** | Area of units under a lease that is active and current at the as-of date ÷ total area. Measures let space rather than unit count, so one large vacant unit shows its true weight. |
| **Standard annual rent** | Sum of each unit's asking rent. |
| **Contracted annual rent** | Sum of the annual rent on leases active at the as-of date. |
| **Rent realisation %** | Contracted ÷ standard. Below 100% means vacancy or leases signed under the asking rent; above 100% means units are let above asking. |
| **Rent gap** | Standard less contracted — annualised revenue being forgone. The number to attack first. |
| **Rent per sq ft** | Contracted rent ÷ leased area. Compares pricing across properties of different sizes. |
| **Expiring 90d** | Active leases ending within 90 days of the as-of date — the renewal pipeline. |

Summary cards at the top give the portfolio position, and a total row closes the table. Occupancy and area utilization each carry a colour bar: green at 85% and above, amber from 60%, red below.

> **Occupancy and area utilization can disagree — and that is useful**
>
> High unit occupancy with low area utilization means your small units are let and your large ones are empty. That single comparison usually points straight at where the revenue is being lost.

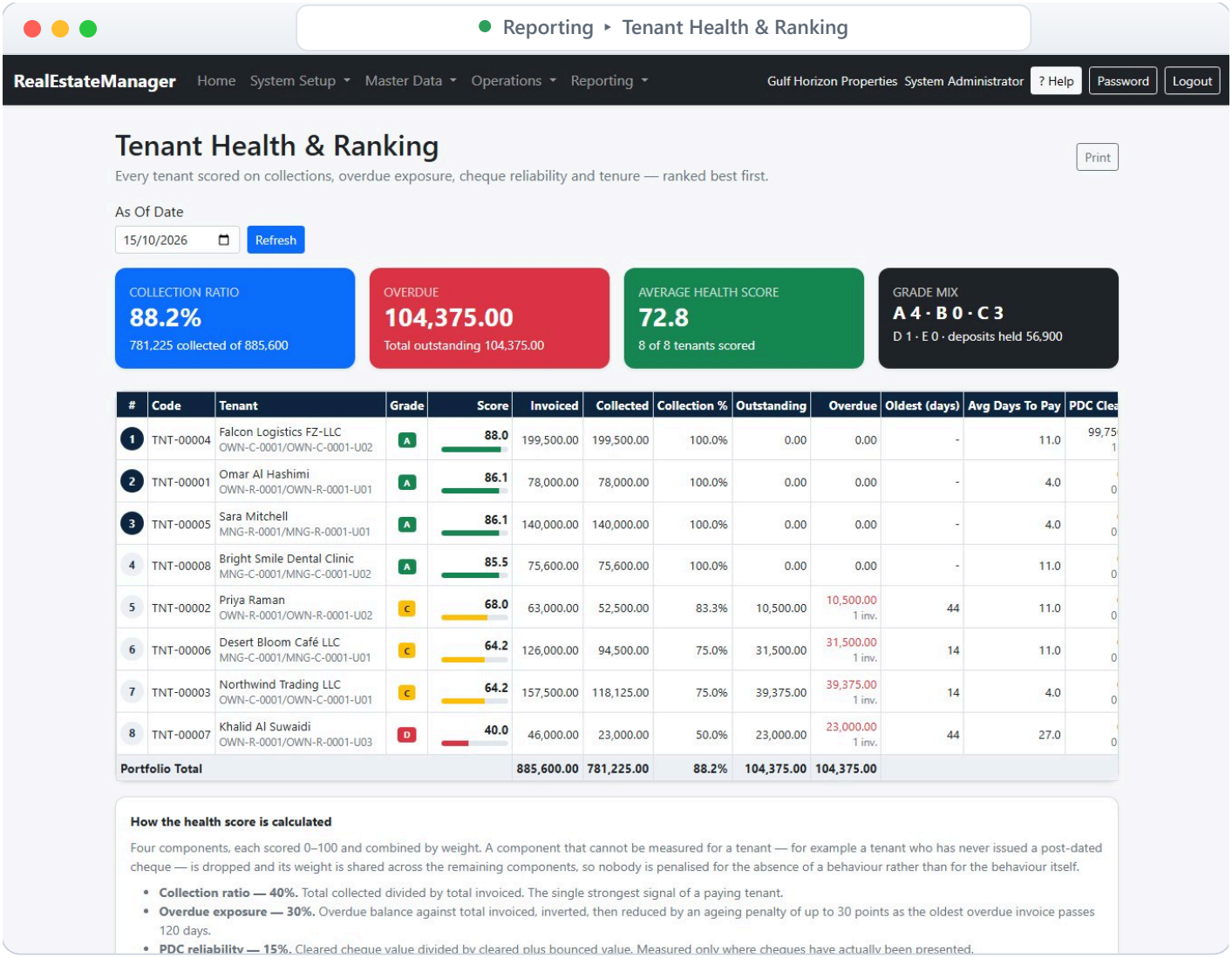



Occupancy, area utilization and the rent gap per property.

## Tenant Health & Ranking

### Reporting ▸ Tenant Health & Ranking

Every tenant scored from 0 to 100 and ranked best first, with the underlying figures shown alongside the score so the ranking can always be explained to the tenant or to management.




Every tenant scored and ranked, with the figures behind each score.

## The four components

| Component | Weight | Basis |
|---|---|---|
| **Collection ratio** | 40% | Total collected ÷ total invoiced. The strongest single signal of a paying tenant. Collections include cleared PDCs, because clearance updates the invoice. |
| **Overdue exposure** | 30% | Overdue balance ÷ total invoiced, inverted, then reduced by an ageing penalty of up to 30 points as the oldest overdue invoice passes 120 days. |
| **PDC reliability** | 15% | Cleared cheque value ÷ (cleared + bounced) value. |
| **Tenure & commitment** | 15% | Years occupied since the first lease start, capped at five years (70% of the component), plus current contract length capped at 36 months (30%). |

> **Missing data never counts against a tenant**
>
> A component that cannot be measured — a tenant who has never issued a post-dated cheque, or one with no invoices yet — is dropped, and its weight is shared across the components that can be measured. Nobody is penalised for the absence of a behaviour rather than for the behaviour itself. A tenant with no measurable activity at all is shown as *No activity* and graded N/A.

## Grades

| Grade | Score | Reading |
|---|---|---|
| **A** | 85 – 100 | Pays in full and on time, long tenure. Prioritise renewal. |
| **B** | 70 – 84 | Reliable with minor slippage. |
| **C** | 55 – 69 | Watch list. Follow up before the next billing date. |
| **D** | 40 – 54 | Material arrears or a short, unproven relationship. Secure additional cover. |
| **E** | Below 40 | Serious exposure. Check deposit cover and consider legal steps. |

## Columns worth knowing

- **Outstanding** includes the tenant's opening balance, so it agrees with the tenant statement.
- **Overdue** counts only posted invoices past their due date and not fully paid. Draft and cancelled invoices are excluded because they carry no ledger balance.
- **Oldest (days)** is the age of the earliest unpaid overdue invoice — often more telling than the amount.
- **Avg days to pay** is the average of receipt date less invoice due date. A negative figure means the tenant pays early.
- **PDC on hand** is cheque value held but not yet cleared — future cash, not yet collected.
- **Deposit held** is the security deposit still in *Held* status, i.e. your cover against the arrears in the same row.
- **Tenure (yrs)** runs from the tenant's earliest lease start date to the as-of date, across all their contracts.

> **PDC reliability counts every returned cheque**
>
> A cheque recorded as *Bounced* on the PDC Receipts screen counts against the tenant here even after it has been replaced, because it is part of how the tenant has paid.

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# Owner Reports

Where: **Reporting** ▸ **Management — Owners**

Two reports written for property owners: what is let to whom in their buildings, and what they have personally drawn from the business.

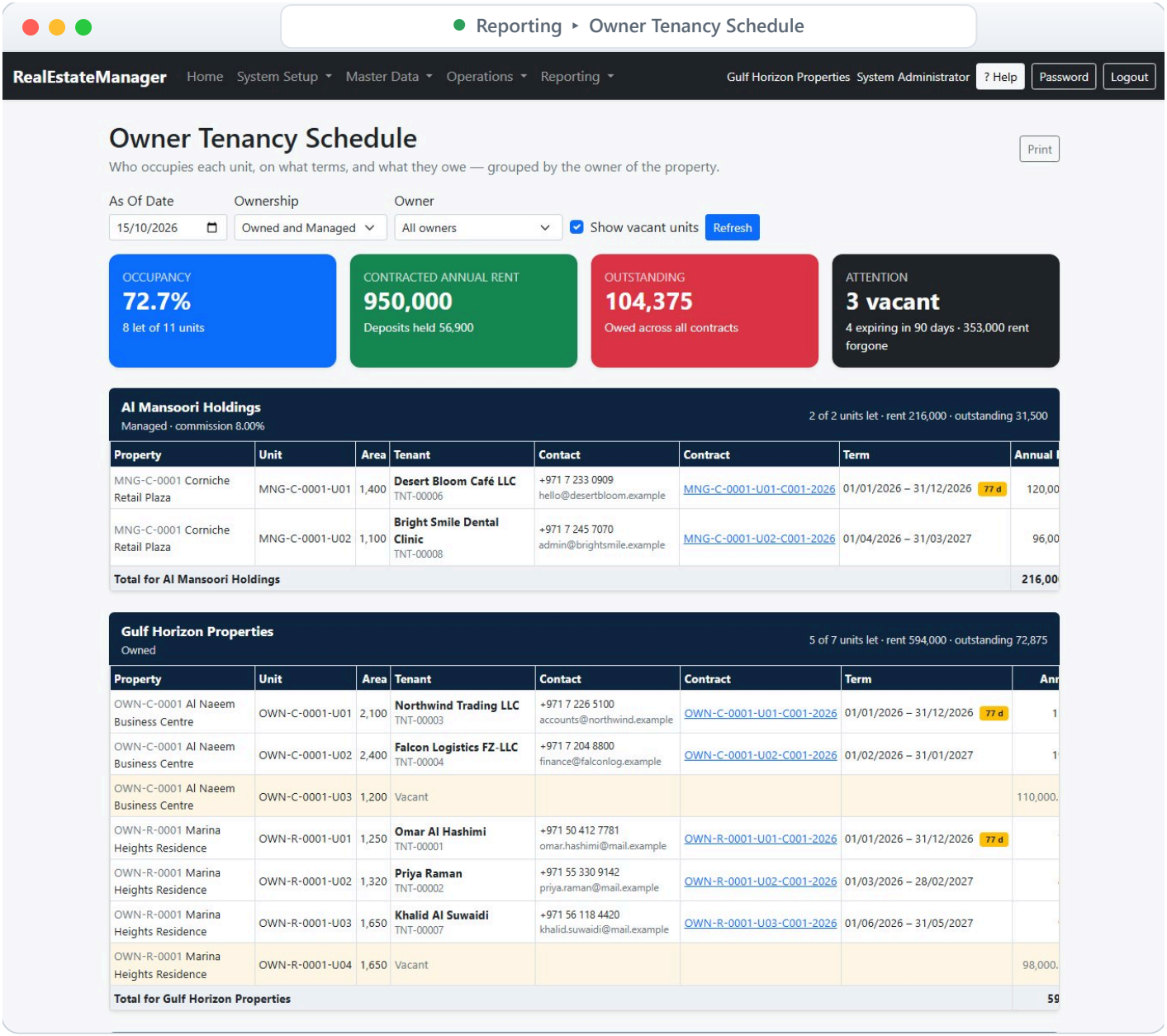
## Owner Tenancy Schedule

**Reporting ▸ Owner Tenancy Schedule**

Who occupies each unit, on what terms and what they owe, grouped by property owner. It is the report to send an owner of a managed building, or to review your own portfolio unit by unit.

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Optionally narrow it to **Owned** or **Managed** property, or to one **Owner**.
3. Tick **Show vacant units** to list empty units too — useful for seeing what is available to let.
4. Refresh, then print for the owner.

Each row shows the property and unit, the tenant and their contact details, the contract and its term, the rent and VAT treatment, what is outstanding, and the contract status. The owner name comes from the property record.



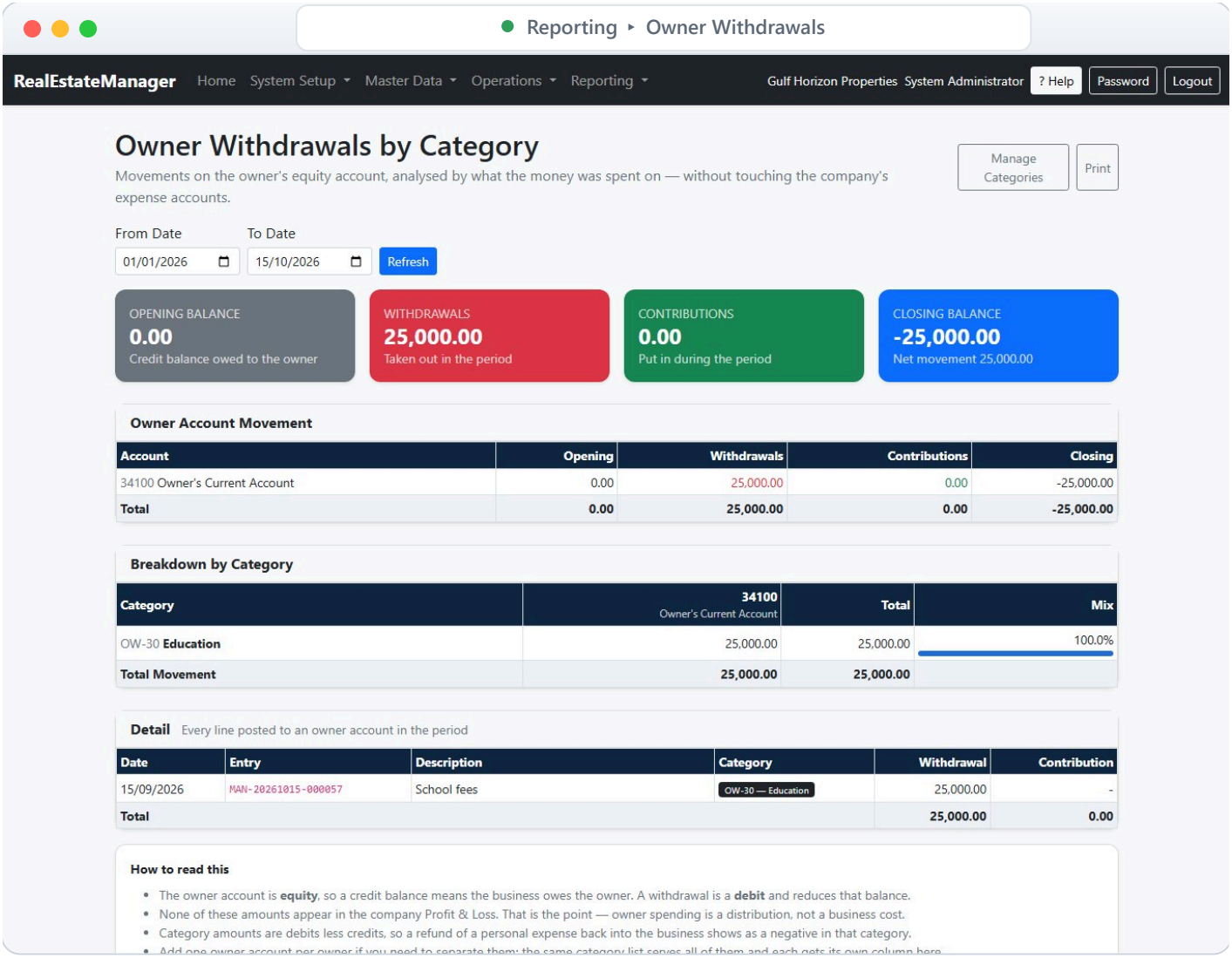

The owner tenancy schedule, grouped by owner, including vacant units.

## Owner Withdrawals

### Reporting ▸ Owner Withdrawals

Enter a **From** and **To** date — the default is the company's fiscal year to date. The report has three parts:

- **Owner Account Movement** — per owner account: opening balance, withdrawals and contributions in the period, and closing balance.
- **Breakdown by Category** — categories down the rows, owner accounts across the columns, with each category's share of total spend.
- **Detail** — every line posted to an owner account in the period, with its date, entry number, description and category.




Owner withdrawals analysed by category — company profit untouched.

| Reading | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Credit closing balance** | The business still owes the owner this amount. |
| **Debit closing balance** | The owner has drawn more than they put in and now owes the business. |
| **Negative category amount** | A refund of personal spend back into the business, posted against that category. |
| **Uncategorised row** | Movement with no category. Expected for capital introduced or a transfer of the owner's balance; investigate if it represents spending. |

> **One posting, two truthful reports**
>
> The owner gets a full personal expenditure statement, and the company's Profit & Loss stays a true record of trading. Both come from the same posted journal, so there is no separate spreadsheet to reconcile. See Owner Withdrawals Explained.

## Owner Property Profitability

Reporting ▸ Owner Property Profitability

For each managed property, what it earned its **owner** in the period and what it earned the **company**. Choose the dates (the fiscal year to date by default) and, if you like, one owner.

| Column | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Let** | Units let out of units in the property. |
| **Rent billed** | Posted rent invoices less credit notes, before VAT. |
| **Commission** | The company's income from the property, at the property's commission rate. |
| **VAT on commission** | Charged to the owner on our commission tax invoice. |
| **Maintenance & costs** | Costs of the property charged to the owner, without the VAT a registered owner reclaims. Underneath, a table breaks them down **by kind** — maintenance, utilities, cleaning, insurance and so on — for each property. |
| **Owner's net income** | Rent billed less commission, its VAT and costs — and the owner's margin on the rent. |
| **VAT collected for owner** | On rent invoiced in the owner's name: the owner's to declare, not income. |

The company's own profitability by property is in P&L by Property.

## Owner's Combined View

**Reporting ▸ Owner's Combined View**

For an owner who owns the business and also owns properties the business manages: the **business** (the company's income statement) and the owner's **personal investments** (their managed properties) side by side, and **combined**. Choose the dates and the owner.

- **The business** — revenue by kind, cost of revenue, fixed, recurring and finance costs, net profit, as on the Profit & Loss.
- **Personal investments** — the rent of the owner's properties, less the commission paid to the business, less maintenance and costs charged to the owner. The VAT on the commission is a cost only when the owner is not VAT registered.
- **Between them** — the commission is income to the business and a cost to the owner. This column removes it, so the combined total does not count it twice.

It is a management view, not a tax consolidation: the business and the owner stay separate taxable persons, each with its own TRN and VAT return. Figures are before VAT.

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# Build Your Own Report

Where: **Reporting ▸ Build Your Own Report**

Reporting ▸ Build Your Own Report

When none of the ready-made reports answers your question, build one: choose what to report on, the columns, the filters and the totals, and show the result as a table or a chart. Save it to run again, or share it with the company. Needs *View Reports*.

## Building a report, step by step

1. **What do you want to report on?** Choose one kind of record: properties, units, tenants, vendors, contracts, customer invoices, receipts, credit notes, post-dated cheques, security deposits, vendor bills and payments, journal entries and ledger lines, the chart of accounts, fixed assets, tenant service requests, owner settlements, unit sales, development projects, employees, leave, attendance, salary advances, payroll runs and payslips, contract approvals and payment approvals. You are offered only what your permissions let you see.
2. **Show** either **A list of records** — tick the **Columns** you want; use the search box to find a field — or **Totals by group**: choose what to **Group by** (a date can be grouped by day, month, quarter or year) and what to **Calculate**: a count, or the total, average, lowest or highest of a number.
3. **Filters** (optional): select **+ Add a filter** for each condition, for example status is Posted, or invoice date within this year.
4. **Sort and size**: the order, and the most rows to show.
5. **Show as** a **Table**, **Bar**, **Line** or **Pie** chart. Charts use the groups and totals; for a list, the first text column and the first number column.
6. Select **Run report**.

## Using the result

- **Export to Excel (CSV)** downloads the rows.
- **Print** prints the table or chart.

## Saving and sharing

1. Under **Save this report**, give it a name, for example *Rent by property this year*.
2. Tick **Share with everyone in the company** if colleagues should have it. Each person still sees only the data they are allowed to see.
3. Select **Save**. After changing a saved report, **Save** updates it and **Save as new** keeps both.

Your own and shared reports are listed under **Saved reports**; select one to run it again with today's data.

## Examples

| Question | How to build it |
|---|---|
| Rent invoiced by property this year | Customer invoices · Totals by group · group by property · total of subtotal · filter invoice date this year · Bar |
| Unposted invoices | Customer invoices · A list of records · filter status is Draft · sort by invoice date |
| Cheques falling due by month | Post-dated cheques · Totals by group · group by cheque date, by month · total of amount · Line |
| Headcount by department | Employees · Totals by group · group by department · count · Pie |

> **For the accounts, use the financial reports**
>
> A built report lists and totals records as they are. Statements that must follow accounting rules — the Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet and VAT Return — are under **Financial Reports**.

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# The Tenant Portal: Staff Guide

Where: **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants** ▸ **Portal**

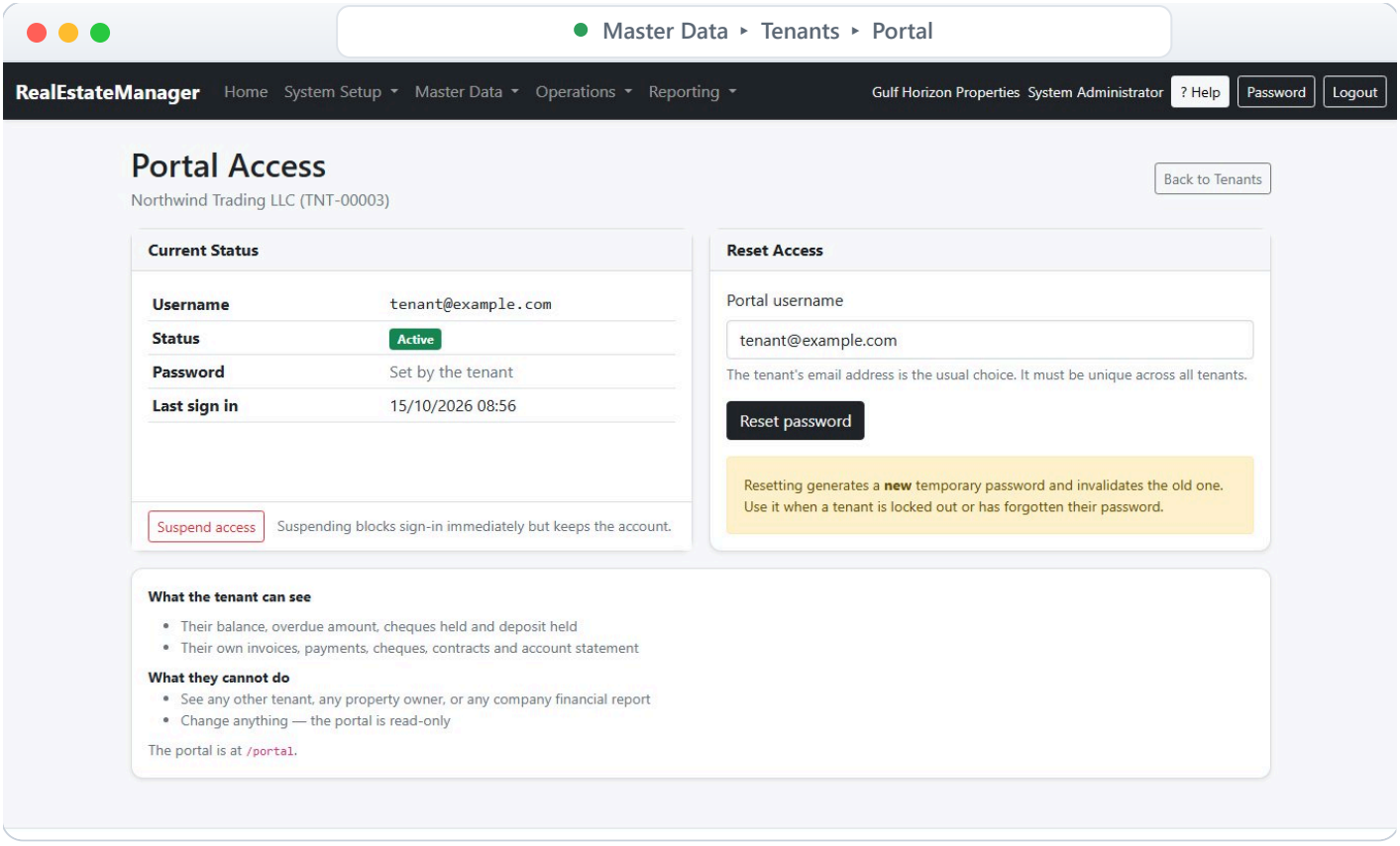
The tenant portal is a separate, mobile-friendly site where each tenant sees their own account and sends you requests. Tenants cannot register themselves: you issue each one a login.

Video: **The tenant portal** (2:41) - watch it in the Help on screen.

## Giving a tenant access

1. Open **Master Data** ▸ **Tenants** and select **Portal** on the tenant's row.
2. Under **Issue Access**, check the **username**. The tenant's email is filled in when it is on file; it must be unique across all tenants.
3. Select **Issue portal access**.
4. A green box shows the **username** and a **temporary password**. Copy both now — the password is shown only once and cannot be looked up later, by anyone.
5. Send the tenant the address `https://realestatemanager.odehanas.com/portal/login` with their username and temporary password.

On first sign-in the tenant must choose their own password before going any further.




A tenant's portal login: its status, and where to issue or reset it.

## Managing an existing login

The **Current Status** panel shows the username, whether the account is active, whether the temporary password has been changed yet, the last sign-in, and any lock-out.

| Situation | What to do |
|---|---|
| Tenant forgot the password | **Reset password** issues a new temporary password and the old one stops working. |
| Tenant is locked out | Too many wrong passwords lock the account for a while. Wait, or reset the password. |
| Tenancy has ended | **Suspend access** blocks sign-in immediately. The account and its history are kept, and **Re-enable access** restores it. |

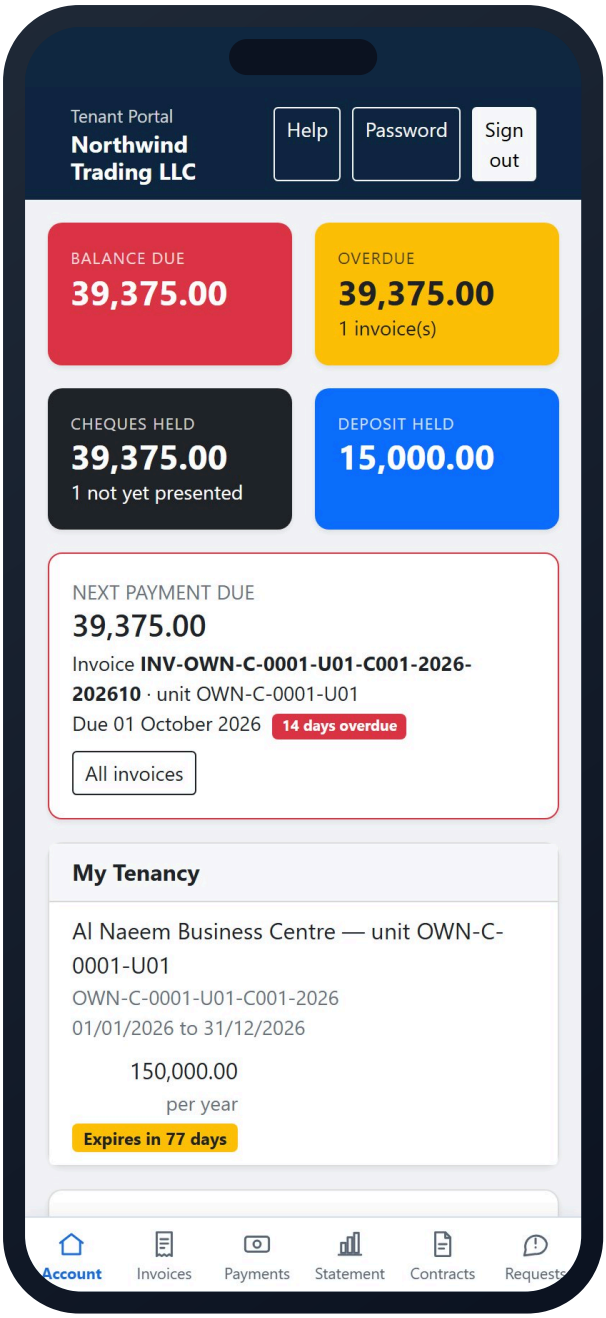
Only users with *Create & Edit Master Data* can issue or change portal logins.

## What the tenant sees

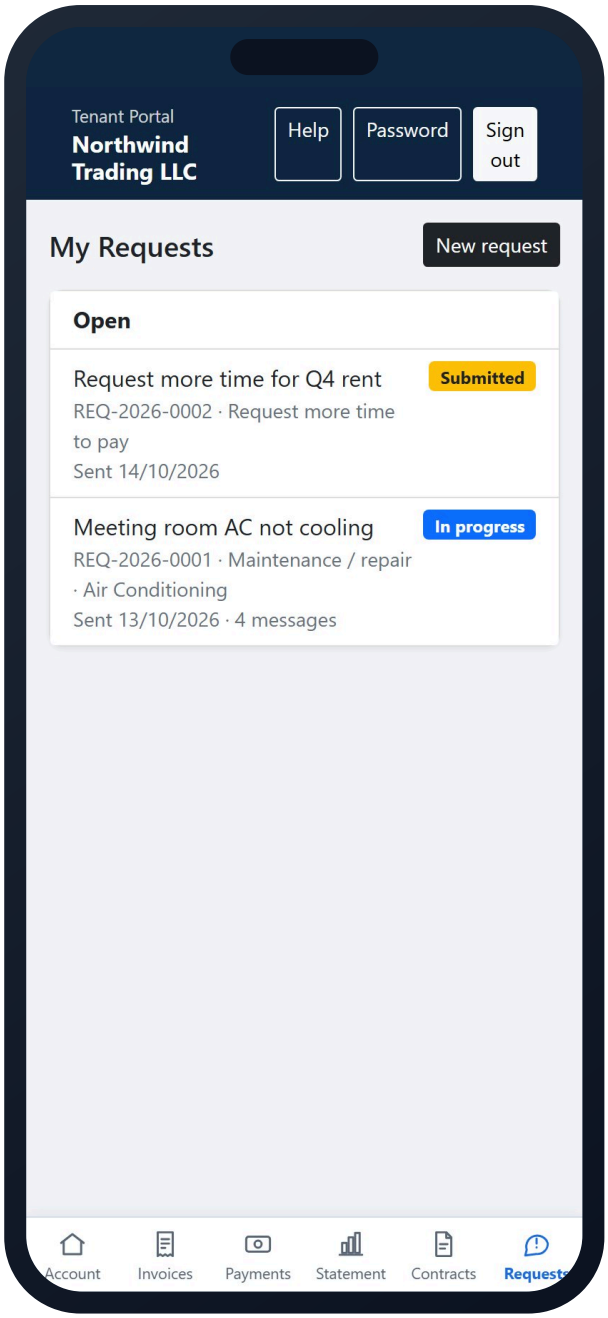
| Tab | Contents |
|---|---|
| **Account** | Balance due, overdue amount, cheques held, deposit held, and their tenancy. |
| **Invoices** | Every invoice with its total, paid and outstanding amounts; overdue ones highlighted. |
| **Payments** | Receipts, and their post-dated cheques with each one's status. |
| **Statement** | Their running account over a chosen date range. |
| **Contracts** | Their contracts, terms and expiry. |
| **Requests** | Requests they have raised, and the conversation with you. |

Tenants can sign in at the portal address, or on the system's main Login page with the same username and password — they are taken to the portal either way.

A tenant with an overdue invoice or a returned cheque not yet replaced sees that their **maintenance requests are on hold**, with the amount overdue, and is asked to contact the office. See Tenant Requests.




The tenant's account page on a phone.




The tenant's requests and their status.

> **Tenants see posted transactions only**
>
> Invoices, receipts, cheques and deposits appear in the portal once their journal is posted, so what a tenant sees always agrees with their balance. A receipt you have saved but not yet posted does not show — post receipts and cheques the same day so tenants see their payments promptly.

Tenants can install the portal on their phone and turn on notifications from its home page. They are then told when you reply to a request (not an internal note) or move it on - acknowledged, in progress, resolved, declined or closed.

Send tenants the Guide for Tenants; it is also available to them from the portal.

**A tenant only ever sees their own account**

Every portal screen takes the tenant from their sign-in, never from the address bar, so changing a number in the URL cannot open another tenant's data. A tenant who tries to open a staff page is sent back to their portal.

**Testing it yourself**

Issue a login to a test tenant and sign in as them in a **private window** (Ctrl + Shift + N). In the same window as your staff session, each kind of sign-in would keep sending you back to its own side.

Requests that tenants raise are handled in Tenant Requests.

TENANT SELF-SERVICE · 64

# Guide for Tenants

Where: **Tenant portal**

Welcome to your tenant portal. Here you can check your account at any time and send us requests, from your phone or computer.

## Signing in

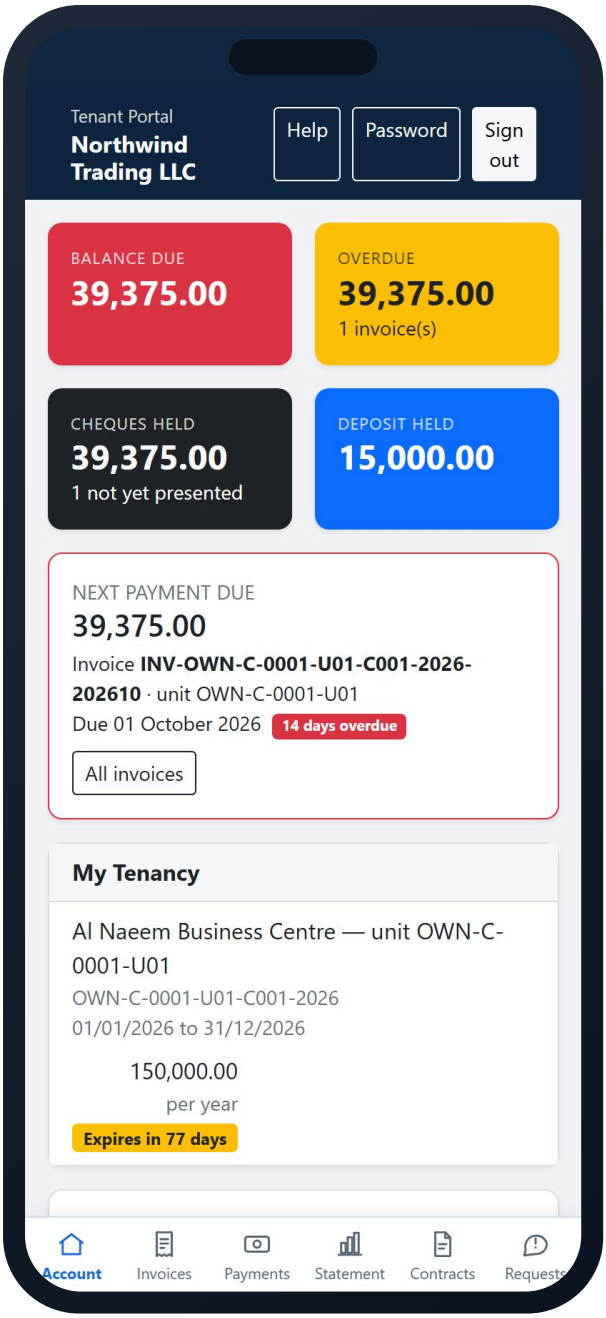
1. Open the portal address you were sent.
2. Enter the username and temporary password we gave you.
3. The first time, you will be asked to choose your own password. Keep it private.

If you forget your password, or enter it wrongly too many times, contact us and we will send you a new one.

You can also sign in on the main Login page of the system with the same username and password.

## Your account

| Tab | What you will find |
|---|---|
| **Account** | How much is due, anything overdue, the cheques we are holding, your deposit, and your tenancy details. |
| **Invoices** | All your invoices and what is still outstanding on each. Overdue invoices are highlighted. |
| **Payments** | Payments we have received, and the cheques you have given us with their status. |
| **Statement** | Your full account for any dates you choose. You can print it. |
| **Contracts** | Your tenancy contracts, rent and dates, and when each one expires. |
| **Requests** | Things you have asked us for, and our replies. |




The tenant's account page on a phone.



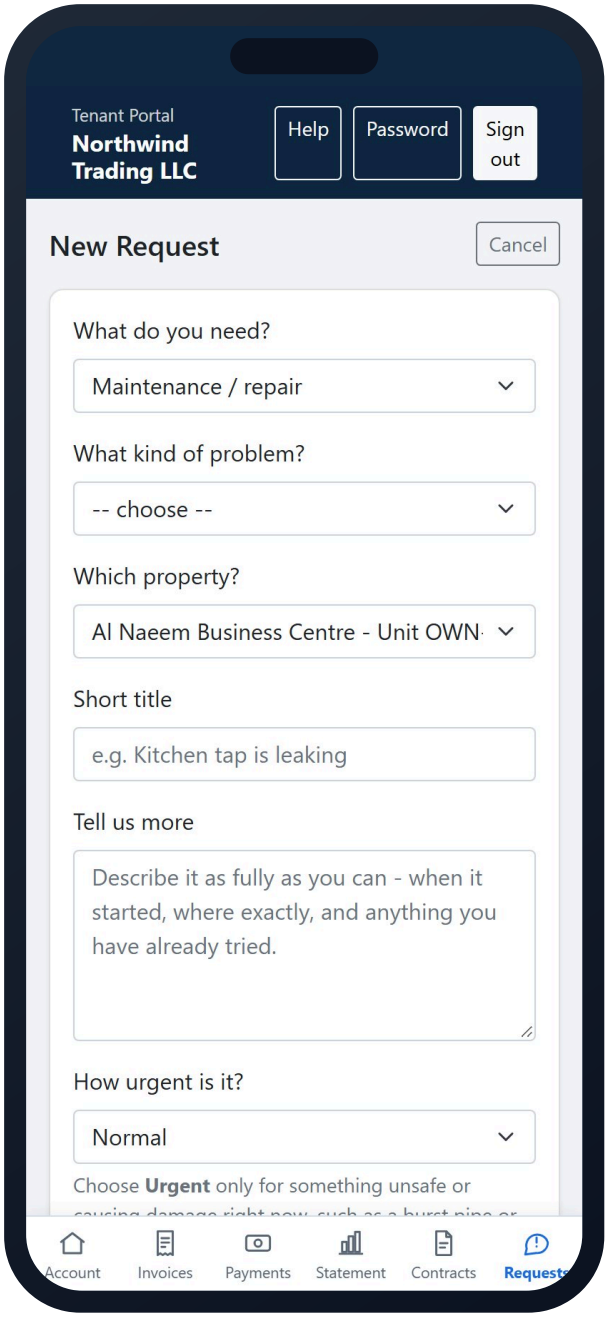

The tenant's invoices, overdue ones highlighted.

A payment can take a little time to appear while we record it. If something looks wrong, send us a request.

## Making a request

1. Open **Requests** and select **New request**.
2. Choose what you need:
   - **Maintenance / repair** — something needs fixing. Choose the kind of problem and, if you like, a preferred visit date.
   - **Request more time to pay** — choose the invoice and the date you could pay by.
   - **Contract renewal**, **Complaint** or **Other request**.
3. Give it a short title and describe it as fully as you can.

4. If your account has an overdue amount or a returned cheque, maintenance requests are on hold: the page tells you so. Please contact our office to settle it, and you can then request maintenance again.
5. Choose how urgent it is. Please use **Urgent** only for something unsafe or causing damage right now, such as a burst pipe or no electricity.
6. Select **Send request**. You will receive a reference number such as `REQ-2026-0001`.

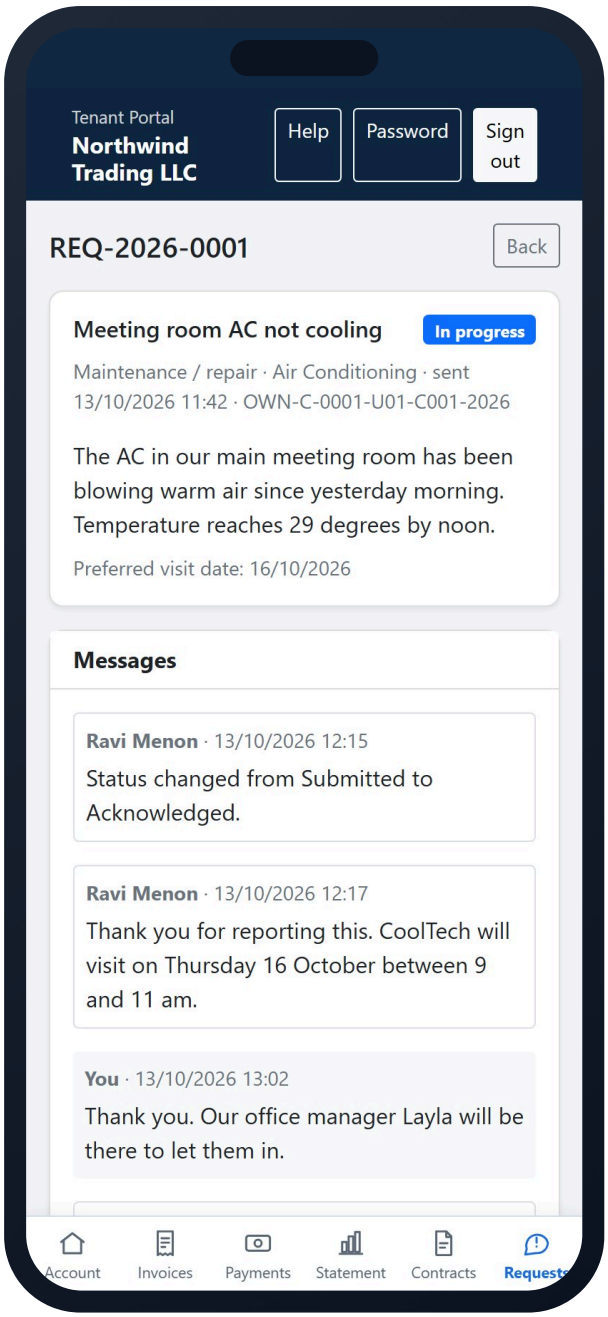



Raising a request from a phone.

## Following your request

Open the request at any time to see its status and our messages, and to reply. Its status moves from **Submitted** to **Acknowledged** when we have seen it, to **In progress** when work starts, and to **Resolved** with our response when it is done.

You can **withdraw** a request until we start work on it.




The same request as the tenant sees it — the staff internal note is not there.

> **About requests for more time to pay**
>
> A request is not an agreement. The amount you owe does not change, and your current due date still applies unless we confirm otherwise. If we agree, you will see *Agreed and applied* on the request and the new due date on the invoice.

**Get our replies on your phone**

On the **Account** page, the **App and notifications** card lets you install the portal on your phone and turn on notifications. You then hear from us when we reply to a request or when its status changes, without signing in to check. On iPhone, first tap **Share**, then **Add to Home Screen**, and open the portal from there. You can turn notifications off again from **Help**.

## Installing the portal on your phone

### iPhone or iPad

1. Open the portal's address in **Safari**.
2. Tap **Share** (the square with an arrow pointing up), scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
3. Open the portal from the new icon on your home screen and sign in again.
4. Tap the **phone button** at the top, then **Turn on notifications**, and **Allow**. This needs iOS 16.4 or later.

### Android

1. Open the portal's address in **Chrome** and sign in.
2. Tap **Install app** on the card (or the menu ⋮ ▸ **Install app**).
3. Open it from its icon and tap **Turn on notifications**, then **Allow**.

Closed the card by mistake? Tap the **phone button** at the top of the portal: the card is always on the Help page. If notifications are blocked, allow them for the portal in your phone's settings and tap **Turn on notifications** again.

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# AI Assistant

Where: **Assistant button, bottom right**

The **AI Assistant** answers questions about your company's records and about how RealEstateManager works, by voice or by typing. It can also prepare entries for you — a receipt, a tenant, a journal — but it never saves anything itself: every change appears as a card that you confirm with a click.

> **Where it is**
>
> The round **Assistant** button at the bottom right of every screen opens the assistant panel. You only see it if your administrator has switched the assistant on and given you the **Use the AI Assistant** permission.

## Asking questions

1. Open the panel and type a question, then press **Send**. Or select the **microphone** and simply speak; the first time, the browser asks for permission to use the microphone.
2. The assistant looks the answer up in your records and replies. When you talk, it answers aloud and the conversation is written in the panel as well.
3. Ask follow-up questions in the same way. **Mute** pauses the microphone; **End session** or closing the panel finishes the conversation.

Examples: "*Which tenants are overdue?*", "*How many units are vacant in Marina Heights?*", "*Show contract OWN-R-0001-U01-C001-2026*", "*What was the profit for September?*", "*Trial balance at 30 September*", "*Which cheques fall due this month?*", "*How do I close a month?*". It understands English and Arabic.

## Having it prepare an entry

Ask in plain words, for example "*Record 5,000 received by bank transfer against invoice INV-…*" or "*Clear cheque 104207 today*". The assistant runs the same checks as the screen — closed periods, balances, duplicates, approvals — and shows a **Please confirm** card describing exactly what will happen.

- **Confirm** saves it through the same process as the screen and shows the reference, with a link to the record.
- **Cancel** drops it. Nothing was saved.
- A card left unconfirmed expires after ten minutes.

> **Saying "yes" is not enough**
>
> Only a click on **Confirm** saves anything. This is deliberate: a misheard word must never change your accounts.

It can prepare, each with its own confirm card:

| Area | Entries |
|---|---|
| **Master data** | New properties, units (many at once, codes generated), tenants and vendors |
| **Leasing** | A draft contract, renewing a contract (a new draft from the day after it ends), sending a draft for approval or activating it |
| **Receivables** | Receipts against invoices, receiving a set of post-dated cheques, clearing a cheque, posting a contract's draft rent invoices, a draft credit note |
| **Payables** | A draft vendor bill (with quantity and unit price), paying a vendor's open bills or an advance — payment approval limits still apply |
| **Cash and accounting** | Petty cash vouchers, draft manual journals, posting a draft journal |
| **Tenant requests** | Replying to or updating a tenant service request |

For each, it asks for anything missing, repeats the facts back, then shows the card. Ending a contract early is not in the system yet; the assistant says so.

## Filling in the screen you are on

On any entry form — a new bill, contract, tenant, journal — say *"fill this in"* and give the details. The assistant reads the form, types the values (adding line rows if needed) and highlights them in yellow. It never saves: you check the fields and select the screen's own **Save**.

## Opening a screen for you

Ask "*Open a new unit for Marina Heights, 7th floor, 1,250 sq ft, rent 82,000*". The assistant opens the screen from your menu with those fields filled in; a yellow banner says what was filled and anything it could not find. Opening a page ends the conversation, so the assistant asks its questions first. It only opens this system's own screens that your permissions allow.

## Reading a scanned invoice

Select the **paperclip** and choose a supplier invoice (PDF or photo). The assistant reads it, repeats the supplier, number, date, lines and total with any warnings, and either fills the bill form you are on or prepares a draft bill for you to confirm.

## Market rent benchmark

Ask "*What is the market rent for a 2-bedroom apartment on Al Marjan Island?*". The assistant searches the web and returns the typical rent, the range, the rent per sq ft, whether the figures are **asking** or **contracted** rents, and every source with its date — beside **your own** rents for the same kind of unit there and the gap in percent. The figures are indicative. A search is kept for a day.

## What it will not do

- Anything your own permissions do not allow — it tells you which permission or screen is involved.

- Approve contracts or payments, delete posted records, reset posted entries, close periods, or manage users, permissions, companies or subscriptions.
- See any company other than the one you are working in.

## Privacy

Your questions, and the records the assistant reads to answer them, are sent to OpenAI to produce the reply. OpenAI does not use data sent through its business API to train its models. Passwords and sign-in details are never sent. The conversation and every confirmed action are kept in the system's audit records.

A scanned invoice, Emirates ID or passport you upload is sent to OpenAI to be read. A market rent search sends only the place and the kind of unit — never a tenant, contract or company figure.

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# Owner Withdrawals Explained

Money the owner takes out of the business for personal use is not a company expense. It is a **distribution** — a movement in equity. Putting it through the company's expense accounts would understate profit and misstate the Profit & Loss.

But the owner still wants to know what they spent it on. RealEstateManager solves this with a dedicated analysis dimension: the posting goes to a single equity account, and each line carries an **owner withdrawal category** that says what the money was for.

> **Why this is not a chart-of-accounts problem**
>
> Adding expense accounts for "school fees" or "personal travel" would put the owner's private life into the company's books and inflate its cost base. Adding them as unit cost centres would be worse still — cost centres in this system are *units*, used to allocate rental revenue and property costs to the space that generated them. Owner spending relates to no unit at all.
>
> A separate dimension keeps the chart of accounts clean, keeps cost centres meaningful, and still gives the owner a full breakdown.

## The owner's current account

The standard chart seeds one equity account for this purpose:

| Code | Account | Type |
|---|---|---|
| `34100` | Owner's Current Account | Equity, flagged as an owner account |

Because it is equity, a **credit** balance means the business owes the owner, and a **withdrawal is a debit** that reduces that balance. Capital the owner puts in is a credit.

If you have more than one owner, add one account per owner — `34200`, `34300` and so on — under **System Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts**, setting **Owner Account** to *Yes* on each. The same category list serves all of them, and each gets its own column in the report. Only a postable Equity account can be flagged this way; the setting is ignored on any other type.

## Recording a withdrawal

**Operations ▸ Owner Withdrawals**

The owner's withdrawals have their own screen. The debit side is fixed - it is always the owner's current account, and it cannot be changed there (if several owner accounts exist, one per partner, only those are offered). You choose what the money was spent on and where it was paid from.

1. Enter the **Date** and the **Amount**.
2. Choose what it was **Spent on** - the withdrawal category.

3. Choose where it was **Paid from**: normally `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents, or petty cash, or a card or payable account if it was charged there.
4. Add a description and the cheque or transfer reference, and select **Save and Post**. It is posted at once.

Below the form, every movement on the owner accounts in the chosen period is listed - including any made by manual journal - with its category, the account on the other side, and the totals withdrawn and put in. **Charts and report** opens the Owner Withdrawals report for the same period, with a bar chart of the withdrawals by category and a line chart of the withdrawals month by month with their running total.

To correct a withdrawal, reset its journal to draft in Journal Inquiry - it then drops out of the figures - and record it again.

## From a manual journal

**Operations ▸ Manual Journals ▸ New Manual Journal**

A manual journal can still carry a withdrawal category, for the occasional entry the withdrawal screen does not cover. The **Owner Withdrawal Category** column is hidden to keep the journal simple; select **+ Owner withdrawal category** at the top right of the journal lines to show it (**-** hides it again). It activates only on a line posted to an account flagged as an owner account; on every other line it stays locked.

### Example: the owner pays school fees of 25,000 from the company bank account

| Account | Category | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| `34100` Owner's Current Account | OW-30 Education | 25,000.00 | — |
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | — | — | 25,000.00 |

No expense account is touched, so company profit is unaffected. The owner's equity balance falls by 25,000 and the spend is tagged as Education.

### Owner introduces 100,000 of capital

| Account | Category | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents | — | 100,000.00 | — |
| `34100` Owner's Current Account | leave blank | — | 100,000.00 |

Leave the category blank on money coming *in*. Categories describe expenditure; a contribution is not expenditure.

> **The category is refused on any other account**
>
> If you try to save a category against an account that is not flagged as an owner account, the journal is rejected with a message naming the offending account. This is enforced on the server, not just hidden in the screen — it is what guarantees personal spending can never reach a company account by accident.

## Clearing the balance at year end

The owner's current account carries forward like any equity account. If you want to clear it against retained earnings — for example when drawings are formally treated as a distribution of profit — post a manual journal debiting `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years and crediting `34100` Owner's Current Account. Leave the category blank: it is a transfer, not expenditure.

The categories themselves are maintained under Owner Withdrawal Categories, and the spending is reported in Owner Reports.

## The location

The category says what the money was spent on; the **location** says where: the house, the farm, the private office. Any category can be used at any location, so "Utilities" needs only one category for all of them. The location is required on the Owner Withdrawals screen and optional in the General Journal, and the report shows the withdrawals by category and location. Withdrawals recorded before locations existed show under *No location*. The list is kept under System Setup in Owner Withdrawal Locations.

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# Chart of Accounts Reference

The standard chart created for every new company. Group accounts are shown in bold and cannot be posted to.

| Code | Account | Type | Reporting group |
|---|---|---|---|
| **10000** | **Assets** | Asset | Assets |
| 11100 | Cash and Cash Equivalents | Asset | Assets |
| 11120 | Bank - Owners' Funds | Asset | Assets |
| 11150 | Petty Cash | Asset | Assets |
| 11200 | Accounts Receivable (control) | Asset | Assets |
| 11300 | VAT Recoverable | Asset | Assets |
| 11400 | PDC On Hand | Asset | Assets |
| 11450 | Cheques Under Collection | Asset | Assets |
| 11500 | Prepaid Expenses | Asset | Assets |
| 11550 | Advances to Suppliers | Asset | Assets |
| 11600 | Employee Advances | Asset | Assets |
| 11650 | Maintenance Materials Stock | Asset | Assets |
| 15100 | Investment Property | Asset | Assets |
| 13100 | Properties Under Development - For Sale | Asset | Assets |
| 11250 | Receivable from Unit Buyers | Asset | Assets |
| 13200 | Completed Properties Held for Sale | Asset | Assets |
| 15150 | Accumulated Depreciation - Investment Property | Asset | Assets |
| 15200 | Fixed Assets | Asset | Assets |
| 15300 | Accumulated Depreciation (contra) | Asset | Assets |
| 15400 | Fixed Asset Clearing | Asset | Assets |
| 15500 | Investment Property Under Construction | Asset | Assets |
| 15600 | Capital Work in Progress | Asset | Assets |
| **20000** | **Liabilities** | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21100 | Accounts Payable (control) | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21200 | Advances from Customers (unearned revenue) | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21250 | Advances from Unit Buyers | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21300 | Tenant Security Deposits | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21400 | VAT Payable | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21500 | Due to Landlords | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21600 | PDC Contra | Liability | Liabilities |

| Code | Account | Type | Reporting group |
|---|---|---|---|
| 21700 | Salaries Payable | Liability | Liabilities |
| 21800 | End of Service Benefits Provision | Liability | Liabilities |
| **30000** | **Equity** | Equity | Equity |
| 31100 | Share Capital | Equity | Equity |
| 32100 | Retained Earnings – Prior Years | Equity | Equity |
| 33100 | Current Year Profit or Loss | Equity | Equity |
| 34100 | Owner's Current Account (owner account) | Equity | Equity |
| **40000** | **Revenue** | Revenue | Revenue |
| 41100 | Rental Revenue – Owned | Revenue | Revenue |
| 41200 | Revenue from Sale of Properties | Revenue | Revenue |
| 42100 | Management Fee Revenue | Revenue | Revenue |
| 43100 | Other Income | Revenue | Revenue |
| **50000** | **Direct Expenses** | Expense | DirectExpense |
| 51100 | Property Operating Expenses | Expense | DirectExpense |
| 51200 | Cost of Properties Sold | Expense | DirectExpense |
| 52100 | Property Maintenance | Expense | DirectExpense |
| **60000** | **General Expenses** | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 61100 | Administrative Expenses | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 61200 | Irrecoverable VAT - Capital Assets Scheme | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 62100 | Depreciation Expense | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 63100 | Finance Costs | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 64100 | Basic Salaries | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 64200 | Staff Allowances | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 64300 | Overtime and Bonuses | Expense | GeneralExpense |
| 64400 | End of Service Benefits Expense | Expense | GeneralExpense |

## Accounts you add yourself

| Code | Account | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| e.g. 11160 | Petty Cash – *site name* | One Asset account per additional petty cash float, with **Petty Cash Float** set to Yes. See Petty Cash. |
| 34200… | Owner's Current Account – *owner name* | One Equity account per additional owner, with **Owner Account** set to Yes. See Owner Withdrawals Explained. |
| 39999 | Opening Balance Control Account | Equity. Absorbs any imbalance in opening balances. Should return to zero. See Opening Balances. |

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# Accounting Entries Reference

Every journal the system posts automatically. All are generated with balanced debits and credits; the system rejects any entry that does not balance.

| Transaction | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| **Customer invoice** owned property | 11200 Accounts Receivable — total | 21200 Advances from Customers — subtotal<br>21400 VAT Payable — VAT |
| **Customer invoice** managed property, in the company's name | 11200 Accounts Receivable — total | 21500 Due to Landlords — subtotal<br>21400 VAT Payable — VAT |
| **Customer receipt** | 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 11200 Accounts Receivable |
| **PDC received** memorandum | 11400 PDC On Hand | 21600 PDC Contra |
| **PDC deposited** sent to the bank | 21600 PDC Contra (reversal)<br>11450 Cheques Under Collection | 11400 PDC On Hand (reversal)<br>11200 Accounts Receivable, or 21200 Advances in advance mode |
| **PDC cleared** after deposit | 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 11450 Cheques Under Collection |
| **PDC bounced** charged back | 11200 Accounts Receivable, or 21200 Advances in advance mode | 11450 Cheques Under Collection |
| **PDC withdrawn** before deposit | 21600 PDC Contra (reversal) | 11400 PDC On Hand (reversal) |
| **Cheque charge invoice** withdrawal or returned cheque | 11200 Accounts Receivable — total | The mapped charge income account (43100 Other Income by default)<br>21400 VAT Payable — VAT |
| **PDC cleared** straight from hand, receivable mode | 21600 PDC Contra (reversal)<br>11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 11400 PDC On Hand (reversal)<br>11200 Accounts Receivable |
| **PDC cleared** straight from hand, advance mode | 21600 PDC Contra (reversal)<br>11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 11400 PDC On Hand (reversal)<br>21200 Advances from Customers |
| **Security deposit** | 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 21300 Tenant Security Deposits |
| **Revenue recognition** owned property | 21200 Advances from Customers | 41100 Rental Revenue – Owned |
| **Revenue recognition** managed property | 21500 Due to Landlords | 42100 Management Fee Revenue |
| **Development cost** bill or direct cost | 13100 / 15500 / 15600 the project's work in progress | 21100 Accounts Payable, 11100 Cash or the account chosen |
| **Completion transfer** by unit use | 13200 Held for Sale / 15100 Investment Property / 15200 Fixed Assets | The project's work-in-progress account |
| **Investment property depreciation** monthly, building only | 62100 Depreciation Expense | 15150 Accumulated Depreciation - Investment Property |

| Transaction | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| **Unit sale payment**<br>before handover | 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents | 21250 Advances from Unit Buyers<br>21400 VAT Payable — standard-rated sales |
| **Unit handover**<br>revenue at handover | 21250 Advances applied<br>11250 Unpaid balance<br>51200 Cost of Properties Sold | 41200 Revenue from Sale of Properties<br>21400 VAT on the balance<br>13200 Completed Properties Held for Sale |
| **Capital Assets Scheme**<br>tax repaid | 61200 Irrecoverable VAT - CAS | 11300 VAT Recoverable |
| **Commission tax invoice**<br>VAT on our commission, monthly | 21500 Due to Landlords | 21400 VAT Payable |
| **Owner settlement**<br>paying a landlord | 21500 Due to Landlords | 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents (or the account chosen) |
| **Vendor bill**<br>one debit per line | Each line's account — line net + any irrecoverable VAT<br>11300 VAT Recoverable — recoverable VAT | 21100 Accounts Payable — total |
| **Vendor payment**<br>of open bills | 21100 Accounts Payable | The bank or cash account paid from |
| **Vendor advance**<br>paid before a bill | 11550 Advances to Suppliers | The bank or cash account paid from |
| **Advance applied to bills** | 21100 Accounts Payable | 11550 Advances to Suppliers |
| **Customer invoice**<br>managed property, in the owner's name | 11200 Accounts Receivable — total | 21500 Due to Landlords — subtotal<br>21500 Due to Landlords — VAT, the owner's to declare |
| **Customer receipt**<br>managed property, by who holds the rent | The company's bank, 11120 Bank - Owners' Funds, or 21500 Due to Landlords when paid to the owner directly | 11200 Accounts Receivable |
| **Cost charged to an owner**<br>recharge or disbursement | 21500 Due to Landlords — the cost, and its VAT | 21100 Accounts Payable, the petty cash float or 11650 Maintenance Materials Stock<br>21400 VAT Payable — our 5% on a recharge |
| **Salary advance** | 11600 Employee Advances | The bank or cash account paid from |
| **Payroll approved**<br>monthly salary cost | 64100 Basic Salaries, 64200 Staff Allowances, 64300 Overtime and Bonuses<br>64400 End of Service Benefits Expense | 21700 Salaries Payable — net pay<br>11600 Employee Advances — instalments recovered<br>21800 End of Service Benefits Provision |
| **Salaries paid**<br>each payment batch | 21700 Salaries Payable | The bank account paid from |
| **Petty cash voucher** | Expense account on the voucher | The petty cash float account |

| Transaction | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| **Petty cash replenishment** | The petty cash float account | Funding account — bank or main cash |
| **Fixed asset acquisition cost** | 15400 Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable)<br>or expense account (not capitalisable) | 11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable |
| **Fixed asset capitalisation** | 15200 Fixed Assets | 15400 Fixed Asset Clearing |
| **Depreciation** | 62100 Depreciation Expense | 15300 Accumulated Depreciation |
| **Prepayment setup** | 11500 Prepaid Expenses | 11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable |
| **Prepayment amortisation** | Expense account on the schedule | 11500 Prepaid Expenses |
| **Fiscal year closing** | Each revenue account — its balance<br>32100 Retained Earnings — if a net loss | Each expense account — its balance<br>32100 Retained Earnings — if a net profit |

Which of these are posted at once and which wait as drafts is set out screen by screen in Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

## Status Values Reference

| Record | Status | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| **Unit** | Vacant | Available to lease. |
| | Occupied | Under an active lease. Set automatically. |
| | UnderMaintenance | Temporarily out of service. |
| | Reserved | Held for a prospective tenant. |
| **Lease** | Draft | Being prepared. |
| | Awaiting approval | Submitted to an approver; the unit is held. Returned contracts go back to Draft. |
| | Active | In force: activated, or approved where approval is required. |
| | Terminated | Ended early. |
| | Expired | Ran to its end date. |
| | Renewed | Replaced by a successor contract. |
| **Customer invoice** | Draft | Generated, not posted. No ledger impact. |
| | Posted | Journal written; fully outstanding. |
| | PartiallyPaid | Part settled. |
| | Paid | Fully settled. |
| | Credited | Fully reduced by credit notes. |
| | Cancelled | Voided. |
| **Credit note** | Draft | Saved, not posted. The invoice is not reduced yet. |
| | Posted | Invoice balance and output VAT reduced. |
| **E-invoice** (invoice or credit note) | Not required | Individual tenant, e-invoicing off, or before the start date. |
| | To generate | In scope; no file yet. |
| | Ready to send | File produced and checked. |
| | Sent to provider | Handed to the provider. Locked — correct only by credit note. |
| | Accepted | Validated, delivered and reported. Final. |
| | Rejected | Refused by the provider. Fix and generate again. |
| **PDC receipt** | Draft | Transient state during creation. |
| | Received | On hand; memorandum posted. |
| | Deposited | At the bank for collection; in Cheques Under Collection and credited to the tenant. |
| | Cleared | Honoured by the bank; cash recorded. |

| Record | Status | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| | Bounced | Returned unpaid; charged back to the tenant until replaced. |
| | Withdrawn | Handed back to the tenant before deposit, with a withdrawal charge. |
| | Replaced | A bounced or withdrawn cheque since replaced or paid otherwise. |
| **Vendor bill** | Draft | Entered, not posted. |
| | Posted | Journal written; payable outstanding. |
| | PartiallyPaid | Part settled. |
| | Paid | Fully settled. |
| **Revenue recognition** | Planned | Scheduled, not yet posted. |
| | Posted | Journal written; revenue earned. |
| **Prepayment schedule** | Active | Instalments still to release. |
| | Completed | Fully amortised. |
| **Journal entry** | Draft | Saved, not in any report. Can be posted. |
| | Posted | In the accounts. Can be reset to draft unless locked or depended on. |
| | Period locked | Shown when the entry's period is closed. Cannot be posted or reset. |
| **Tenant request** | Submitted | New; not yet seen. |
| | Acknowledged | Seen by staff. Tenant can still withdraw. |
| | InProgress | Work started. |
| | Resolved | Done, with a response to the tenant. |
| | Rejected | Shown as *Declined*; will not be done, with the reason. |
| | Cancelled | Shown as *Withdrawn*; cancelled by the tenant. |
| | Closed | Finished; no more messages. |
| **Tenant portal login** | Active | Can sign in. |
| | Suspended | Sign-in blocked; account and history kept. |
| **Security deposit** | Held | Received and held for the tenant. |
| | Applied | Set against what the tenant owed. |
| | Refunded | Paid back to the tenant. |
| | Forfeited | Kept to cover damages. |
| **Vendor payment** | Posted | In the accounts; its bills are settled. |

| Record | Status | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| | Awaiting approval / draft | Held for payment approval, or reset for a correction. |
| **Fixed asset** | Draft | Accepting acquisition costs; not depreciated. |
| | Active | Capitalised: in the asset account, with a depreciation schedule. |
| **Employee** | Active | Employed and paid by the payroll. |
| | Suspended | Employed but left out of the payroll. |
| | Resigned | Left; paid up to the last working day. |
| | Terminated | Dismissed; paid up to the last working day. |
| **Leave request** | Pending | Waiting for HR to decide. |
| | Approved | Counts against the balance (annual) or the pay (unpaid). |
| | Rejected | Turned down. |
| | Cancelled | Approved leave that was not taken. |
| **Payroll transaction** | Pending | Waiting for approval; not paid. |
| | Approved | Paid or deducted by the next payroll. |
| | Rejected | Not paid. |
| **Payroll run** | Draft | Being prepared. Nothing in the accounts. |
| | Approved | Salary cost posted; salaries payable. |
| | PartlyPaid | Some payment batches made. |
| | Paid | Every salary paid. |
| **Accounting period** | Open | Accepts postings. |
| | Closed | Locked; figures are final. |
| | Reopened | Opened again on an approved request; to be corrected and closed again. |

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# Troubleshooting

## A transaction I saved is missing from a report

It is almost certainly still a **draft**. Manual journals, revenue recognition and prepayments save drafts. Receipts, PDCs, deposits, payments and petty cash post on save, but are kept as drafts if the posting was refused - a yellow message said why at the time.

1. Open **Operations** ▸ **Journal Inquiry**.
2. Set **Posted Only** to **No**, set the dates and select **Go**.
3. Post the entry, or use **Post All Drafts**.

See Draft, Post & Reset to Draft.

## "Reset to Draft" is greyed out or refused

Either the period is closed, or something depends on the entry — a receipt against the invoice, a payment against the bill, a posted PDC clearance. Reset the later transaction first, or post a correcting journal in an open period.

## I cannot see the Add or Edit buttons on master data

Your account has *View Master Data* only. Ask the master data owner, or an administrator to change your permissions — see Master Data rules.

## "...is already registered to..." when saving a tenant or vendor

The trade licence, ID, passport or TRN you entered belongs to an existing record, which the message names. Open that record instead of creating a duplicate. If it is genuinely a different party, check the number was typed correctly.

## A vendor bill will not let me enter VAT

The supplier is not marked **VAT registered**, or has no TRN on file. Correct the vendor record if they are in fact registered — see Vendors. A bill already saved keeps the treatment it was saved with.

## The Trial Balance does not balance

Because the system rejects any unbalanced journal, transactions cannot cause this. The cause is opening balances.

1. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances**.
2. Read the **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** card. It will equal the Trial Balance difference exactly.
3. Identify the missing side. Debits exceeding credits means a credit-side opening balance is missing — almost always equity.

4. Open **System Setup** ▸ **Chart of Accounts**, edit `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, and enter the balancing figure.
5. Return to Opening Balances and confirm the green **Balanced** badge, then re-run the Trial Balance.

> **Worked diagnosis**
> Trial Balance shows debits 375,000 and credits 175,000 — a difference of 200,000. The credit side contains only transaction balances, and Share Capital and Retained Earnings are both nil. The conclusion is that 200,000 of asset opening balances were entered with no matching equity opening balance. Entering 200,000 on `31100` or `32100` balances both the Trial Balance and the Balance Sheet.

## The Balance Sheet does not balance

- Check opening balances as in D.1 — the same difference appears in both reports.
- Check that every prior fiscal year has been closed. Unclosed prior-year profit sits in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present.

## Revenue is missing from the Profit & Loss

- Run **System Setup** ▸ **Revenue Recognition** up to the report date. Invoicing alone does not create revenue.
- Confirm the invoices themselves are **Posted**, not still in Draft.
- For a managed property, remember only the commission is revenue — the rent belongs to the landlord.

## A transaction will not post

| Message | Cause and fix |
|---|---|
| "Journal entry is not balanced." | A manual journal line has an amount in both the debit and credit columns, or the totals differ. Correct the line. |
| "A journal entry must contain at least two lines." | Add the counterpart line. |
| "Account mapping for … is not configured." | Open **System Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping** and select a valid, active account for that mapping. |
| "Contract number already exists." | Contract numbers are unique per company. Use a different one. |
| "This unit already has an overlapping active lease." | Terminate or adjust the existing lease first. |
| "Cheque number already exists." | Cheque numbers are unique per company. Check whether the PDC was already logged. |
| "PDC amount cannot exceed the outstanding invoice balance." | Reduce the amount, or split the cheque across invoices. |
| "Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12." | Billing frequency must divide 12 exactly. |

## A menu is not visible

- Confirm the permission with your administrator (Companies, Users & Permissions).
- Check that the company's subscription has not expired — expiry withdraws the processing menus.
- Confirm you are in the right company using the company selector.

## A tenant's balance looks wrong

1. Run **Reporting** ▸ **Tenant Statement** for the tenant across the full period.
2. Check for invoices still in Draft — they are not in the ledger.
3. Check for PDCs still in Received status — the cash has not arrived yet.
4. Check for a security deposit wrongly entered as a customer receipt.
5. Confirm the tenant's opening balance was entered on the tenant record, not on the AR account.

## A tenant cannot request maintenance

The tenant has an overdue invoice or a returned cheque not yet replaced, so maintenance requests are on hold. The portal tells them the amount. Once the money is received or the cheque replaced, the hold lifts by itself. See Tenant Requests.

## New maintenance jobs are not assigned to anyone

No user has **Carry Out Maintenance Jobs** in this company. Give the maintenance engineer the **Maintenance Engineer / Technician** role — see Maintenance Jobs. A supervisor can assign waiting jobs from the job card.

## A tenant is told "Invalid username or password"

Check the username and that portal access is active on the tenant's **Portal Access** page; reset the password there if needed. Tenants can sign in on the main Login page or the portal address.

## A scanned invoice or ID could not be read

Reading uses the AI Assistant's OpenAI service. If it is not switched on, or the scan is unclear, enter the details by hand. A blurred photo, a password-protected PDF or a file over the size limit cannot be read.

## After an update, a screen shows a database error

A message such as "*Invalid column name*" or "*Invalid object name*" right after a new version means a database change was not applied. Database changes now apply themselves when the site starts.

1. The platform owner opens **System Setup** ▸ **Database Updates**.
2. If the last start shows **Stopped on an error**, send that page to your developer. Do not run the script by hand in the hosting console: the application would not know, and would try it again.

3. If it shows **Up to date**, the problem is elsewhere - report it through **System Setup** ▸ **Send Feedback**.

See Subscription, Audit Log & Feedback.

# Glossary

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Accrual basis** | Recording income when it is earned and expenses when they are incurred, regardless of when cash moves. The basis this system uses. |
| **Advances from Customers** | Account `21200`. Rent billed but not yet earned. A liability, released to revenue month by month. |
| **Control account** | A GL account whose balance is the total of a sub-ledger — Accounts Receivable over tenants, Accounts Payable over vendors. |
| **Double entry** | Every transaction affects at least two accounts with equal debits and credits, so the ledger is always self-proving. |
| **Due to Landlords** | Account `21500`. Rent collected on a managed property that belongs to its owner. |
| **Fiscal year** | The company's twelve-month reporting year, starting in the configured fiscal year start month. |
| **Managed property** | A property you administer for a third-party owner. Only your commission is revenue. |
| **Invoicing in the owner's name** | An option on a managed property: tenants' invoices show the owner as supplier with the owner's TRN (no VAT when the owner has none), the company acting as agent. The rent VAT is the owner's. |
| **Maintenance store** | Account `11650` Maintenance Materials Stock: items kept for maintenance, bought in and issued to jobs. A control account, not an inventory system. |
| **Attested contract** | The tenancy contract as attested (registered) by the municipality, kept under the contract's documents. |
| **Natural balance** | The side an account normally sits on: debit for assets and expenses, credit for liabilities, equity and revenue. |
| **Opening balance** | A balance brought forward from a previous system at go-live. |
| **Owned property** | A property you own. The rent is your revenue. |
| **PDC** | Post-dated cheque — a cheque held today, payable on a future date. |
| **Posting** | Writing a document's journal into the general ledger. Before posting, a document has no accounting effect. |
| **Revenue recognition** | Releasing billed rent into revenue as the occupancy is provided, one month at a time. |
| **Sub-ledger** | A detailed register behind a control account — the tenant register, the vendor register, the fixed asset register. |
| **Trial balance** | A listing of every account balance at a date, proving total debits equal total credits. |
| **Unearned revenue** | See Advances from Customers. |
| **Accredited Service Provider (ASP)** | A company accredited by the Ministry of Finance to send and receive e-invoices for a business and report them to the FTA. Every business in scope must appoint one. |

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Credit note** | A document that reduces or cancels an invoice. Under e-invoicing the only lawful way to correct one already reported. |
| **E-invoice** | An invoice issued as a structured file in the UAE format (PINT AE) and sent through an ASP, rather than as paper or PDF. |
| **PINT AE** | The UAE's official e-invoice format, based on the international Peppol standard. |
| **TIN** | Tax Identification Number: 10 digits, the first ten of a TRN. A business's address on the e-invoicing network. |
| **Accounting date** | On a vendor bill, the date its journal is booked to, which decides the period. Usually the bill date; later when the bill arrives after its month has closed. |
| **Commercial invoice** | A supplier invoice that carries no VAT, because the supplier is not VAT registered. The whole amount is a cost. |
| **Draft** | A journal that has been saved but not posted. It has no effect on any report until posted. |
| **Input tax attribution** | How a cost relates to your supplies — Taxable, Exempt or Residual — which decides how much of its VAT you can reclaim. |
| **Internal note** | A message on a tenant request that only staff can see. |
| **Petty cash float** | A small sum of cash kept on site, held in its own asset account. |
| **Post** | Put a draft journal into the accounts, so the reports include it. |
| **Reset to Draft** | Take a posted journal back out of the accounts so its document can be corrected. |
| **Tax invoice** | An invoice that charges VAT and meets UAE requirements. *Full* when the customer has a TRN, *simplified* when not. |
| **Tenant portal** | The separate site where tenants see their own account and send requests. |
| **TRN** | Tax Registration Number, issued by the Federal Tax Authority to a VAT-registered business. |
| **Wash-up** | The year-end correction of input VAT reclaimed on shared costs, from the provisional rate to the rate actually earned. |

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